

Amphitryo, Asinaria, Aulularia, Bacchides, Captivi

Titus Maccius Plautus

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK AMPHITRYO,
ASINARIA, AULULARIA, BACCHIDES, CAPTIVI ***

A few typographical errors have been corrected. They have been marked in the text with popups. Greek words that may not display correctly in all browsers are similarly transliterated: ὤς.

Footnotes are collected at the end of each play. Where a footnote refers to an omitted passage, the verses before and after the omission have been numbered in parentheses:

(182)

(184)

All other line numbers are from the original text.

PLAUTUS

WITH AN ENGLISH TRANSLATION BY

PAUL NIXON

DEAN OF BOWDOIN COLLEGE, MAINE

IN FIVE VOLUMES

I

AMPHITRYON
THE COMEDY OF ASSES
THE POT OF GOLD
THE TWO BACCHISES
THE CAPTIVES

CAMBRIDGE, MASSACHUSETTS
HARVARD UNIVERSITY PRESS

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The Index of Proper Names is not included in this e-text.

THE GREEK ORIGINALS OF THE PLAYS IN THIS VOLUME

In this and each succeeding volume a summary will be given of the consensus of opinion¹ regarding the Greek originals of the plays in the volume and regarding the time of presentation in Rome of Plautus's

adaptations. It may be that some general readers will be glad to have even so condensed an account of these matters as will be offered them.

The original of the *Amphitruo* is not now thought to have been a work of the Middle Comedy but of the New Comedy, very possibly Philemon's Νὺξ μακρά. A clue to the Greek play's date is found in the description of Amphitryon's battle with the Teloboians,² a battle fought after the manner of those of the Diadochi who came into prominence at the death of Alexander the Great. The date of the Plautine adaptation of this play, as in the case of the *Asinaria*, *Aulularia*, *Bacchides*,³ and *Captivi*, is quite uncertain, beyond the fact that it no doubt belongs, like almost all of his extant work, to the last two decades of his life, 204-184 B.C. The *Amphitruo* is one of the five⁴ plays in the first two volumes whose scene is not laid in Athens.

The Ὀναγός of a certain Demophilus,⁵ otherwise unknown to us, was the original of the *Asinaria*. The assertion of Libanus that he is his master's Salus⁶ is thought to be a fling at the honours decreed certain of the Diadochi, who were called, while still alive, Σωτῆρες. This possibility, together with the fact that the Pellaean⁷ merchant and the Rhodian⁸ Periphanes travel to Athens—northern Greece and the Aegaeon therefore being pacified and Athens at peace with Macedon—would indicate that the Ὀναγός was written while Demetrius Poliorcetes controlled Macedon, 294-288 B.C.

Very slender evidence connects the *Aulularia* with some unknown play of Menander's in which a miser is represented δεδιώς μή τι τῶν ἔιδον ὁ καπνὸς οἴχοιτο φερών. Euclio's distress⁹ at seeing any smoke escape from his house seems at least to suggest that Plautus may have borrowed the *Aulularia* from Menander. The allusion to *praefectum mulierum*,¹⁰ rather than *censorem*, would seem to show that in the original γυναικοὶ ὀμὸν had been written; this would prove the Greek play to have been presented while Demetrius of Phalerum was in power at Athens (317-307 B.C.), where he introduced this detested office, which was done away with by 307 B.C.

Ritschl¹¹ has shown clearly enough that the original of the *Bacchides* was Menander's Δις ἐξαπατῶν. The fact that Athens, Samos, and

Ephesus are at peace, that the Aegaeon is not swept by hostile fleets, that one can travel freely between Athens and Phoeis, together with the allusion to Demetrius,¹² lead one to believe that the *Δις ἑξαπατῶν* was written either between the years 316-307 or 298-296 B.C.

The original of the *Captivi* is quite unknown, while the war between the Aetolians and Eleans gives the only clue to the date of this original. Hueffner¹³ considers it probable that the war was that between Aristodemus and Alexander, and the Greek play was produced shortly after 314 B.C. Others¹⁴ assume that the scene of the play would not be Aetolia unless Aetolia had become an important state, and that the war was therefore one of the third century B.C.

¹: See especially Hueffner, *De Plauti Comoediarum Exemplis Atticis*, Göttingen, 1894; Legrand, *Daos*, Paris, 1910, English translation by James Loeb under title *The New Greek Comedy*, William Heinemann, 1916; Leo, *Plautinische Forschungen*, Berlin, 1912.

²: *Amph.* 203 seq.

³: Produced later than the *Epidicus*. Cf. *Bacch.* 214.

⁴: *Amphitruo*, Thebes, *Captivi*, Aetolia, *Cistellaria*, Sicyon, *Curculio*, Epidaurus (the Caria first referred to in v. 67 was a Greek town, not the state in Asia Minor), *Menaechmi*, Epidamnus.

⁵: *Asin.* Prol. 10-11.

⁶: *Asin.* 713.

⁷: *Asin.* 334.

⁸: *Asin.* 499.

⁹: *Aulul.* 299, 301.

¹⁰: *Aulul.* 504.

¹¹: Ritschl, *Parerga*, pp. 405 seq. Cf. Menander, *Fragments*, 125, 126.

¹²: *Bacch.* 912.

[13](#): Hueffner, *op. cit.* pp. 41-42.

[14](#): Cf. Legrand, *op. cit.* p. 18.

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INTRODUCTION

Little is known of the life of Titus Maccius Plautus. He was born about 255 B.C. at Sarsina, in Umbria; it is said that he went to Rome at an early age, worked at a theatre, saved some money, lost it in a mercantile venture, returned to Rome penniless, got employment in a mill and wrote, during his leisure hours, three plays. These three plays were followed by many more than the twenty extant, most of them written, it would seem, in the latter half of his life, and all of them adapted from the comedies of various Greek dramatists, chiefly of the New Comedy.^{[15](#)} Adaptations rather than translations they certainly were. Apart from the many allusions in his comedies to customs and conditions distinctly Roman, there is evidence enough in Plautus's language and style that he was not a close translator. Modern translators who have struggled vainly to reproduce faithfully in their own tongues, even in prose, the countless puns and quips, the incessant alliteration and assonance in the Latin lines, would be the last to admit that Plautus, writing so much, writing in verse, and writing with such careless, jovial, exuberant ease, was nothing but a translator in the narrow sense of the term.

Very few of his extant comedies can be dated, so far as the year of their production in Rome is concerned, with any great degree of certainty. *The Miles Gloriosus* appeared about 206, the *Cistellaria* about 202, *Stichus* in 200, *Pseudolus* in 191 B.C.; the *Truculentus*, like *Pseudolus*, was composed when Plautus was an old man, not many years before his death in 184 B.C.

Welcome as a full autobiography of Plautus would be, in place of such scant and tasteless biographical morsels as we do have, only less welcome, perhaps, would be his own stage directions for his plays,

supposing him to have written stage directions and to have written them with something more than even modern fullness. We should learn how he met the stage conventions and limitations of his day; how successfully he could, by make-up and mannerism, bring on the boards palpably different persons in the Scapins and Bobadils and Doll Tear-sheets that on the printed page often seem so confusingly similar, and most important, we should learn precisely what sort of dramatist he was and wished to be.

If Plautus himself greatly cared or expected his restless, uncultivated, fun-seeking audience to care, about the construction of his plays, one must criticize him and rank him on a very different basis than if his main, and often his sole, object was to amuse the groundlings. If he often took himself and his art with hardly more seriousness than does the writer of the vaudeville skit or musical comedy of to-day, if he often wished primarily to gain the immediate laugh, then much of Langen's long list of the playwright's dramatic delinquencies is somewhat beside its intended point.

And in large measure this—to hold his audience by any means—does seem to have been his ambition: if the joke mars the part, down with the part; if the ludicrous scene interrupts the development of the plot, down with the plot. We have plenty of verbal evidence that the dramatist frequently chose to let his characters become caricatures; we have some verbal evidence that their "stage business" was sometimes made laughably extravagant; in many cases it is sufficiently obvious that he expected his actors to indulge in grotesqueries, well or ill timed, no matter, provided they brought guffaws. It is probable, therefore, that in many other cases, where the tone and "stage business" are not as obvious, where an actor's high seriousness might elicit catcalls, and burlesque certainly would elicit chuckles, Plautus wished his players to avoid the catcalls.

This is by no means the universal rule. In the writer of the *Captivi*, for instance, we are dealing with a dramatist whose aims are different and higher. Though Lessing's encomium of the play is one to which not all of us can assent, and though even the *Captivi* shows some technical flaws, it is a work which must be rated according to the standards we

apply to a *Minna von Barnhelm* rather than according to those applied to a *Pinafore*: here, certainly, we have comedy, not farce.

But whatever standards be applied to his plays their outstanding characters, their amusing situations, their vigour and comicality of dialogue remain. Euclio and Pyrgopolynices, the straits of the brothers Menaechmus and the postponement of Argyrippus's desires, the verbal encounter of Tranio and Grumio, of Trachalio and the fishermen—characters, situations, and dialogues such as these should survive because of their own excellence, not because of modern imitations and parallels such as Harpagon and Parolles, the misadventures of the brothers Antipholus and Juliet's difficulties with her nurse, the remarks of Petruchio to the tailor, of Touchstone to William.

Though his best drawn characters can and should stand by themselves, it is interesting to note how many favourite personages in the modern drama and in modern fiction Plautus at least prefigures. Long though the list is, it does not contain a large proportion of thoroughly respectable names: Plautus rarely introduces us to people, male or female, whom we should care to have long in the same house with us. A real lady seldom appears in these comedies, and—to approach a paradox—when she does she usually comes perilously close to being no lady; the same is usually true of the real gentleman. The generalization in the Epilogue of *The Captives* may well be made particular: "Plautus finds few plays such as this which make good men better." Yet there is little in his plays which makes men—to say nothing of good men—worse. A bluff Shakespearean coarseness of thought and expression there often is, together with a number of atrocious characters and scenes and situations. But compared with the worst of a Congreve or a Wycherley, compared with the worst of our own contemporary plays and musical comedies, the worst of Plautus, now because of its being too revolting, now because of its being too laughable, is innocuous. His moral land is one of black and white, mostly black, without many of those really dangerous half-lights and shadows in which too many of our present day playwrights virtuously invite us to skulk and peer and speculate.

Comparatively harmless though they are, the translator has felt obliged to dilute certain phrases and lines.

The text accompanying his version is that of Leo, published by Weidmann, 1895-96. In the few cases where he has departed from this text brief critical notes are given; a few changes in punctuation have been accepted without comment. In view of the wish of the Editors of the Library that the text pages be printed without unnecessary defacements, it has seemed best to omit the lines that Leo brackets as un-Plautine¹⁶: attention is called to the omission in each case and the omitted lines are given in the note; the numbering, of course, is kept unchanged. Leo's daggers and asterisks indicating corruption and lacunae are omitted, again with brief notes in each case.

The translator gladly acknowledges his indebtedness to several of the English editors of the plays, notably to Lindsay, and to two or three English translators, for a number of phrases much more happily turned by them than by himself: the difficulty of rendering verse into prose—if one is to remain as close as may be to the spirit and letter of the verse, and at the same time not disregard entirely the contributions made by the metre to gaiety and gravity of tone—is sufficient to make him wish to mitigate his failure by whatever means. He is also much indebted to Professors Charles Knapp, K. C. M. Sills, and F. E. Woodruff for many valuable suggestions.

*Brunswick, Me.,
September, 1913.*

¹⁵: The *Asinaria* was adapted from the Ὀναγὸς of Demophilus; the *Casina* from the Κληρούμενοι, the *Rudens* from an unknown play, perhaps the Πήρα, of Diphilus; the *Stichus*, in part, from the Ἀδελφοί α' of Menander. Menander's Δις ἑξαπατῶν was probably the source of the *Bacchides*, while the *Aulularia* and *Cistellaria* probably were adapted from other plays (titles unknown) by Menander. The *Mercator* and *Trinummus* are adaptations of Philemon's Ἐμπορος and Θησαυρός, the *Mostellaria* very possibly is an adaptation of his Φάσμα, the *Amphitruo*, perhaps, an adaptation of his Νὺξ μακρά.

¹⁶: It seemed best to make no exceptions to this rule; even such a line as *Bacchides* 107 is therefore omitted. Cf. Lindsay, *Classical*

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P = the supposed archetype of BCDVEJ.

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AMPHITRVO

AMPHITRYON

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ARGVMENTVM I¹

In faciem versus Amphitruonis
Iuppiter,

ARGUMENT OF THE PLAY (I)

While Amphitryon was engaged in
a war with his foes, the
Teloboians, Jupiter assumed his

dum bellum gereret cum Telobois
hostibus,
Alcmenam uxorem cepit usurariam.
Mercurius formam Sosiae servi gerit
absentis: his Alcmena decipitur dolis.
postquam rediere veri Amphitruo et
Sosia,
uterque deluduntur in mirum modum.
hinc iurgium, tumultus uxori et viro,
donec cum tonitru voce missa ex
aethere
10 adulterum se Iuppiter confessus
est.

ARGVMENTVM II

A more captus Alcmenas Iuppiter
Mutavit sese in formam eius
coniugis,
Pro patria Amphitruo dum decernit
cum hostibus.
Habitu Mercurius ei subservit
Sosiae.
Is advenientis servum ac dominum
frustra habet.
Turbas uxori ciet Amphitruo, atque
invicem
Raptant pro moechis. Blepharo
captus arbiter
Vter sit non quit Amphitruo
decernere.
Omnem rem noscunt. geminos
Alcmena enititur.²

appearance and took the loan of
his wife, Alcmena. Mercury takes
the form of an absent slave, Sosia,
and Alcmena is deceived by the
two impostors. After the real
Amphitryon and Sosia return they
both are deluded in extraordinary
fashion. This leads to an
altercation and quarrel between
wife and husband, until there
comes from the heavens, with a
peal of thunder, the voice of
Jupiter, who owns that he has been
the guilty lover.

ARGUMENT OF THE PLAY (II)

Jupiter, being seized with love for
Alcmena, changed his form to that
of her husband, Amphitryon, while
he was doing battle with his
enemies in defence of his country.
Mercury, in the guise of Sosia,
seconds his father and dupes both
servant and master on their return.
Amphitryon storms at his wife:
charges of adultery, too, are
bandied back and forth between
him and Jupiter. Blepharo is
appointed arbiter, but is unable to
decide which is the real
Amphitryon. They learn the whole
truth at last, and Alcmena gives
birth to twin sons.

PERSONAE

MERCVRIVS DEUS
SOSIA SERVUS
IVPPITER DEUS
ALCVMENA MATRONA
AMPHITRVO DUX
BLEPHARO GUBERNATOR
BROMIA ANCILLA

Scaena Thebis.

PROLOGVS³

MERCVRIVS DEVS

Ut vos in vobis mercimoniis
emundis vendundisque me laetum
lucris
adficere atque adiuvere in rebus
omnibus
et ut res rationesque vestrorum
omnium
bene me expedire vobis peregrisque et
domi
bonoque atque amplo auctare
perpetuo lucro
quasque incepistis res quasque
inceptabitis,
et uti bonis vos vestrosque omnis
nuntiis
me adficere vobis, ea adferam, ea uti
nuntiem
10 quae maxime in rem vestram
communem sient—

DRAMATIS PERSONAE

MERCURY, *a god.*
SOSIA, *slave of Amphitryon.*
JUPITER, *a god.*
ALCMENA, *wife of Amphitryon.*
AMPHITRYON, *commander-in-
chief of the Theban army.*
BLEPHARO, *a pilot.*
BROMIA, *maid to Alcmena.*

*Scene:—Thebes. A street before
Amphitryon's house.*

PROLOGUE

SPOKEN BY THE GOD
MERCURY

According as ye here assembled
would have me prosper you and
bring you luck in your buyings and
in your sellings of goods, yea, and
forward you in all things; and
according as ye all would have me
find your business affairs and
speculations happy outcome in
foreign lands and here at home,
and crown your present and future
undertakings with fine, fat profits
for evermore;

and according as ye would have
me bring you and all yours glad
news, reporting and announcing
matters which most contribute to
your common good (for ye
doubtless are aware ere now that
'tis to me the other gods have

nam vos quidem id iam scitis
concessum et datum
mi esse ab dis aliis, nuntiis praesim et
lucro—:

haec ut me voltis adprobare adnitier,⁴
(13)

(15) ita huic facietis fabulae silentium
itaque aequi et iusti his eritis omnes
arbitri.

Nunc cuius iussu venio et quam ob
rem venerim
dicam simulque ipse eloquar nomen
meum.

Iovis iussu venio, nomen Mercurio
est mihi.

20 pater huc me misit ad vos oratum
meus,

tam etsi, pro imperio vobis quod
dictum foret,
scibat facturos, quippe qui
intellexerat

vereri vos se et metuere, ita ut
aequom est Iovem;

verum profecto hoc petere me
precario

a vobis iussit, leniter, dictis bonis.
etenim ille, cuius huc iussu venio,
Iuppiter

non minus quam vostrum quivis
formidat malum:

humana matre natus, humano patre,
mirari non est aequom, sibi si
praetimet;

yielded and granted plenipotence
o'er messages and profits);
according as ye would have me
bless you in these things, then in
such degree will ye (*suddenly
dropping his pomposity*) keep still
while we are acting this play and
all be fair and square judges of the
performance.

Now I will tell you who bade me
come, and why I came, and
likewise myself state my own
name. Jupiter bade me come: my
name is Mercury (*pauses,
evidently hoping he has made an
impression*). My father has sent me
here to you to make a plea, yea,
albeit he knew that whatever was
told you in way of command you
would do, inasmuch as he realized
that you revere and dread him as
men should Jupiter.

But the fact remains that he has
bidden me make this request in
suppliant wise, with gentle, kindly
words. (*confidentially*) For you
see, that Jupiter that "bade me
come here" is just like any one of
you in his horror of (*rubbing his
shoulders reflectively*) trouble^A:
his mother being human, also his
father, it should not seem strange if
he does feel apprehensive
regarding himself.

30 atque ego quoque etiam, qui Iovis
sum filius,
contagione mei patris metuo malum.
propterea pace advenio et pacem ad
vos afferō⁵:
iustam rem et facilem esse oratam a
vobis volo,
nam iusta ab iustis iustus sum orator
datus.

nam iniusta ab iustis impetrari non
decet,
iusta autem ab iniustis petere
insipientia est;
quippe illi iniqui ius ignorant neque
tenent.
nunc iam huc animum omnes quae
loquar advortite.
debetis velle quae velimus: meruimus
40 et ego et pater de vobis et re
publica;

nam quid ego memorem,—ut alios in
tragoediis
vidi, Neptunum Virtutem Victoriā
Martem Bellonam, commemorare
quae bona
vobis fecissent,—quis bene factis
meus pater,
deorum regnator⁶ architectus⁷
omnibus?

sed mos numquam illi fuit patri
meo,⁸
ut exprobraret quod bonis faceret
boni;
gratum arbitratur esse id a vobis sibi

Yes, and the same is true of me,
the son of Jupiter: once my father
has some trouble I am afraid I
shall catch it, too. (*rather
pompously again*) Wherefore I
come in peace and peace do I
bring to you. It is a just and trifling
request I wish you to grant: for I
am sent as a just pleader pleading
with the just for what is just.

It would be unfitting, of course, for
unjust favours to be obtained from
the just, while looking for just
treatment from the unjust is folly;
for unfair folk of that sort neither
know nor keep justice. Now then,
pay attention all of you to what I
am about to say. Our wishes
should be yours: we deserve it of
you, my father and I, of you and of
your state.

Ah well, why should I—after the
fashion of other gods, Neptune,
Virtue, Victory, Mars, Bellona,
whom I have seen in the tragedies
recounting their goodness to you—
rehearse the benefits that my
father, ruler of the gods, hath
builded up for all men?

It never was a habit of that sire of
mine to twit good people with the
good he did them; he considers
you grateful to him for it and

meritoque vobis bona se facere quae
facit.

50 Nunc quam rem oratum huc veni
primum proloquar,
post argumentum huius eloquar
tragoediae.
quid? contraxistis frontem, quia
tragoediam

dixi futuram hanc? deus sum,
commutavero.

eandem hanc, si voltis, faciam ex
tragoedia
comoedia ut sit omnibus isdem
vorsibus.

utrum sit an non voltis? sed ego
stultior,
quasi nesciam vos velle, qui divos
siem.

teneo quid animi vestri super hac re
siet:

faciam ut commixta sit: sit
tragicomoedia.

60 nam me perpetuo facere ut sit
comoedia,
reges quo veniant et di, non par
arbitror.
quid igitur? quoniam his servos
quoque partes habet,
faciam sit, proinde ut dixi,
tragicomoedia.

nunc hoc me orare a vobis iussit
Iuppiter,
ut conquaestores singula in subsellia
eant per totam caveam spectatoribus,

worthy of the good things he does
for you.

Now first as to the favour I have
come to ask, and then you shall
hear the argument of our tragedy.
What? Frowning because I said
this was to be a tragedy? I am a
god: I'll transform it.

I'll convert this same play from
tragedy to comedy, if you like, and
never change a line. Do you wish
me to do it, or not? But there! how
stupid of me! As if I didn't know
that you do wish it, when I'm a
deity. I understand your feelings in
the matter perfectly. I shall mix
things up: let it be tragi-comedy.

Of course it would never do for me
to make it comedy out and out,
with kings and gods on the boards.
How about it, then? Well, in view
of the fact that there is a slave part
in it, I shall do just as I said and
make it tragi-comedy.

Now here is the favour Jove bade
me ask of you: (*with great
solemnity*) let inspectors go from
seat to seat throughout the house,
and should they discover claqueurs

si cui favitores delegates viderint,
ut is in cavea pignus capiantur togae;

sive qui ambissint palmam
histrionibus,
70 sive cuiquam artifici, si per
scriptas litteras
sive qui ipse ambissit seu per
internuntium,
sive adeo aediles perfidiose cui duint,
sirempse legem iussit esse Iuppiter,
quasi magistratum sibi alterive
ambiverit.

virtute dixit vos victores vivere,
non ambitione neque perfidia: qui
minus
eadem histrioni sit lex quae summo
viro?
virtute ambire oportet, non
favitoribus.
sat habet favitorum semper qui recte
facit,
80 si illis fides est quibus est ea res in
manu.

hoc quoque etiam mihi pater in
mandatis dedit,
ut conquaestores fierent histrionibus:
qui sibi mandasset delegati ut
plauderent
quive quo placeret alter fecisset
minus,
eius ornamenta et corium uti
concliderent.

planted for the benefit of any
party, let them take as security
from all such in the house—their
togas.

Or if there be those who have
solicited the palm for actors, or for
any artist—whether by letter, or by
personal solicitation, or through an
intermediary—or further, if the
aediles do bestow the said palm
upon anyone unfairly, Jove doth
decree that the selfsame law obtain
as should the said party solicit
guiltily, for himself or for another,
public office.

'Tis worth has won your wars for
you, saith he, not solicitation or
unfairness: why should not the
same law hold for player as for
noblest patriot? Worth, not hired
support, should solicit victory. He
who plays his part aright ever has
support enough, if it so be that
honour dwells in those whose
concern it is to judge his acts.

This injunction, too, did Jove lay
upon me: that inspectors should be
appointed for the actors, to the end
that whosoever has enjoined
claqueurs to clap himself, or
whosoever has endeavoured to
compass the failure of another,
may have his player's costume cut
to shreds, also his hide.

mirari nolim vos, quapropter Iuppiter
nunc histriones curet; ne miremini:
ipse hanc acturust Iuppiter
 comoediam.

quid? admirati estis? quasi vero
 novom

90 nunc proferatur, Iovem facere
 histrioniam;

etiam, histriones anno cum in
 proscenio hic
Iovem invocarunt, venit, auxilio is
 fuit⁹ (92)

(94) hanc fabulam, inquam, hic
 Iuppiter hodie ipse aget,
et ego una cum illo. nunc vos
 animum advortite,

dum huius argumentum eloquar
 comoediae.

Haec urbs est Thebae. in illis
 habitat aedibus
Amphitruo, natus Argis ex Argo
 patre,
quicum Alcmena est nupta, Electri
 filia.

100 is nunc Amphitruo praefectust
 legionibus,
nam cum Telobois bellum est
 Thebano populo.

is prius quam hinc abut ipsemet in
 exercitum,
gravidam Alcmenam uxorem fecit
 suam.
nam ego vos novisse credo iam ut sit
 pater meus,

I would not have you wonder why
Jove is now regardful of actors; do
not so: he himself, Jove, will take
part in this comedy. What?
Surprised? As if it were actually a
new departure, this, Jove's turning
actor!

Why, just last year when the actors
on this very stage called upon
Jupiter, he came,^B and helped them
out. This play, then, Jove himself
will act in to-day, and I along with
him. Now give me your attention
while I unfold the argument of our
comedy.

This city here is Thebes. In that
house there (*pointing*) dwells
Amphitryon, born in Argos, of an
Argive father: and his wife is
Alcmena, Electrus's daughter. At
present this Amphitryon is at the
head of the Theban army, the
Thebans being at war with the
Teloboians.

Before he himself left to join his
troops, his wife, Alcmena, was
with child by him. (*apologetically*)
Now I think you know already
what my father is like—how free
he is apt to be in a good many
cases of this sort and what an

quam liber harum rerum multarum
siet

quantusque amator sit quod
complacitum est semel.

is amare occepit Alcumenam clam
virum
usuramque eius corporis cepit sibi,
et gravidam fecit is eam compressu
suo.

110 nunc de Alcmena ut rem teneatis
rectius,

utrimque est gravida, et ex viro et ex
summo Iove.

et meus pater nunc intus hic cum illa
cubat,

et haec ob eam rem nox est facta
longior,

dum cum illa quacum volt
voluptatem capit;

sed ita adsimulavit se, quasi
Amphitruo siet.

Nunc ne hunc ornatum vos meum
admiremini,
quod ego huc processi sic cum servili
schema:

veterem atque antiquam rem novam
ad vos proferam,
propterea ornatus in novom incessi
modum.

120 nam meus pater intus nunc est
eccum Iuppiter;
in Amphitruonis vertit sese imaginem
omnesque eum esse censent servi qui
vident:

impetuous lover he is, once his
fancy is taken.

Well, Alcmena caught his fancy,
without her husband knowing it,
and he enjoyed her and got her
with child. So now Alcmena, that
you may see it quite clearly, is
with child by both of them, by her
husband and by almighty Jove.

And my father is there inside this
very moment with her in his arms,
and it is on this account that the
present night has been prolonged
while he enjoys the society of his
heart's delight. All this in the guise
of Amphitryon, you understand.

Now don't be surprised at this get-
up of mine and because I appear
here in the character of a slave as I
do: I am going to submit to you a
new version of a worn and ancient
tale, hence my appearance in a
new get-up.

The point is, my father Jupiter is
now inside there, mark you. He
has turned himself into the very
image of Amphitryon, and all the
servants that see him believe that's

ita versipellem se facit quando lubet.

ego servi sumpsi Sosiae mi
 imaginem,
qui cum Amphitruone abiit hinc in
 exercitum,
ut praeservire amanti meo possem
 patri
atque ut ne, qui essem, familiares
 quaerent,
versari crebro hic cum viderent me
 domi;
nunc, cum esse credent servom et
 conservom suom,
130 haud quisquam quaeret qui siem
 aut quid venerim.

Pater nunc intus suo animo morem
 gerit:
cubat complexus cuius cupiens
 maxime est;
quae illi ad legionem facta sunt
 memorat pater
meus Alcumenae: illa illum censet
 virum
suom esse, quae cum moecho est. ibi
 nunc meus pater
memorat, legiones hostium ut
 fugaverit,
quo pacto sit donis donatus plurimis.
ea dona, quae illic Amphitruoni sunt
 data,
abstulimus: facile meus pater quod
 volt facit.
140 nunc hodie Amphitruo veniet huc
 ab exercitu

who he is. See how he can change
his skin when he likes!

And as for me, I have assumed the
form of Amphitryon's slave Sosia,
who went away to the army with
him, my idea being to subserve my
amorous sire and not have the
domestics ask who I am when they
see me busy about the house here
continually. As it is, when they
think I am a servant and one of
their own number, not a soul will
ask me who I am or what I've
come for.

So now my father is inside
indulging his heart's desire as he
lies there with his arms around the
lady-love he particularly dotes on.
He is telling Alcmena what
happened during the campaign:
and she all the time thinking him
her husband when he's not. On he
goes there with his stories of
putting the legions of the foe to
flight and being presented with
prizes galore.

The prizes Amphitryon did receive
there we stole—things my father
fancies do come easy to him! Now
Amphitryon will return from the
army to-day, and the slave I am
representing, too.

et servos, cuius ego hanc fero
imaginem.

nunc internosse ut nos possitis
facilius,
ego has habebo usque in petaso
pinnulas;
tum meo patri autem torulus inerat
aureus
sub petaso: id signum Amphitruoni
non erit.
ea signa nemo horum familiarium
videre poterit: verum vos videbitis.

sed Amphitruonis illic est servos
Sosia:
a portu illic nunc cum lanterna
advenit.

150 abigam iam ego illum
advenientem ab aedibus.
adeste: erit operae pretium hic
spectantibus
Iovem et Mercurium facere
histrioniam.

ACTVS I

Sos.

Qui me alter est audacior homo aut qui
confidentior,
iuventutis mores qui sciam, qui hoc noctis
solus ambulem?
quid faciam nunc, si tres viri me in carcerem
compegerint?

To make it easier for you to tell us
apart I shall always wear this little
plume on my hat: yes, and as for
my father he will have a little gold
tassel hanging from his:

Amphitryon will not have this
mark. They are marks that none of
the household here will be able to
see, but you will.

(looking down street) But there is
Amphitryon's servant Sosia—just
coming from the harbour with a
lantern. I'll bustle him away from
the house as soon as he gets here.
Watch now! It will be worth your
while to attend when Jove and
Mercury take up the histrionic art.
(steps aside)

ACT I

(Time, night.)

ENTER *Sosia*, LANTERN IN
HAND.

Sos.

*(stopping and peering
around timorously)* Who's a
bolder man, a more
audacious man than I am—
know all about the young
bloods and their capers, I
do, yet here I am strolling

inde cras quasi e promptaria cella depromar
ad flagrum,
nec causam liceat dicere mihi, neque in ero
quicquam auxili
nec quisquam sit quin me malo omnes esse
dignum deputent.

159-160 ita quasi incudem me miserum
homines octo validi caedant:

161-162 ita peregre adveniens hospitio
publicitus accipiar.

haec eri immodestia
coegit, me qui hoc noctis a portu
ingratiis excitavit.
nonne idem hoc luci me mittere
potuit?

opulento homini hoc servitus dura
est,
hoc magis miser est divitis servos
noctesque diesque assiduo satis
superque est,

around all alone at this time
of night! (*seems to hear
something and jumps*)

What if the police should
lock me up in jail? To-
morrow I should be taken
out of that preserve closet
and get served—to a rope's
end; and not a word would
they let me say for
myself, ^C and not a bit of
help could I get from
master, and there wouldn't
be a soul but what would
reckon I deserved a hiding.

Those eight strong wardens
would pound my poor
carcass just as if I was an
anvil: that is how I should
be entertained on coming
home from abroad—a
public reception.

(*disgustedly*) It's master's
impatience forced me into
this, routing me out from
the harbour at this time of
night, against my will.

Might have sent me on the
same errand by daylight,
mightn't he?

This is where it comes hard
slaving it for a nabob, this
is where a plutocrat's
servant is worse off—night
and day there's work
enough and more for him,
no end, always something

quod facto aut dicto adeost opus,
quietus ne sis.

170 ipse dominus dives, operis et
laboris expers,
quodcumque homini accidit libere,
posse retur:

(172) aequom esse putat, non reputat
laboris quid sit¹⁰

(174) ergo in servitute expetunt multa
iniqua:

habendum et ferundum hoc onust
cum labore.

Mer.

Satius me queri illo modo servitutum:
hodie qui fuerim liber,
cum nunc potivit pater servitutis,
his qui verna natus est queritur.

Sos.

180 Sum vero verna verbero: num numero mi
in mentem fuit,
dis advenientem gratias pro meritis agere
atque alloqui?
ne illi edepol si merito meo referre studeant
gratiam,
aliquem hominem allegent qui mihi
advenienti os occillet probe,

to be done, yes, or said, so
that you can't rest.

And your plutocrat of a
master, that never does a
handsturn of work himself,
takes it for granted that any
whim that comes into a
man's head can be
gratified: yes, he counts
that the fair thing, and
never takes account of how
much the work is. Ah, I tell
you, there's a great deal of
injustice this slavery lets
you in for: you've got to
take your load and carry it,
and that is work.

Mer.

(*aside*) It would be more in
order for Mercury to do
some of this grumbling
about menial station—was
free this very day, and now
his father has made a slave
of him. It's this fellow, a
born drudge, that is
grumbling.

Sos.

(*frightened again*) I need a
drubbing, I do, drudge that
I am. I was not too quick,
was I, to think of
addressing the gods and
giving 'em due thanks on
my arrival? Oh Lord! if
they took a notion to pay

quoniam bene quae in me fecerunt ingrata ea
habui atque inrita.

Mer.

Facit ille quod volgo haud solent, ut quid se
sit dignum sciat.

Sos.

Quod numquam opinatus fui neque alius
quisquam civium
sibi eventurum, id contigit, ut salvi
poteremur domi.
victores victis hostibus legiones reveniunt
domum,
duello exstincto maximo atque internecatis
hostibus.

190 quod multa Thebano populo acerba obiecit
funera,
id vi et virtute militum victum atque
expugnatum oppidum est
imperio atque auspicio eri mei Amphitruonis
maxime.
praeda atque agro adoriaque adfecit
populares suos
regique Thebano Creoni regnum stabilivit
suom.

me back my dues, they'd
commission some one to
mash my face for me in
fine shape on my arrival,
now that I haven't
appreciated the good turns
they've done me and have
let 'em go for nothing.
(*makes sure he is safe*)

Mer.

(*aside*) Rather uncommon
that,—his knowing what he
deserves to get.

Sos.

What I never dreamed
would happen nor anyone
else on our side, either, has
happened, and here we are
safe and sound.

(*magnificently*) Our legions
come back victorious, our
foes vanquished, a mighty
contest concluded and our
enemies massacred to a
man.

The town that has brought
an untimely death to many
a Theban citizen has been
crushed and captured by
the strength and valour of
our soldiery, aye, and
chiefly under the command
and auspices of my own
master, Amphitryon. He
has furnished forth his
countrymen with booty and

me a portu praemisit domum, ut haec
nuntiem uxori suae,
ut gesserit rem publicam ductu imperio
auspicio suo.
ea nunc meditabor quo modo illi dicam, cum
illo advenero.
si dixero mendacium, solens meo more
fecero.

nam cum pugnabant maxume, ego tum
fugiebam maxume;
200 verum quasi adfuerim tamen simulabo
atque audita eloquar.
sed quo modo et verbis quibus me deceat
fabularier,
prius ipse mecum etiam volo his meditari.
sic hoc proloquar.

Principio ut illo advenimus, ubi primum
terram tetigimus,
continuo Amphitruo delegit viros primorum
principes;
eos legat, Telobois iubet sententiam ut dicant
suam;
si sine vi et sine hello velint rapta et raptores
tradere,

land and fame, and fixed
King Creon firm upon his
Theban throne.

(*subsiding*) As for me, he
has sent me on ahead home
from the harbour to tell his
wife the news: how the
state was served under the
leadership, command, and
auspices of—his very own
self. (*meditating*) Now let
me think how I am to tell
her the tale when I get
there. If I do work in a lie
or two, it won't be anything
extraordinary for me.

The fact is, it was just
when they were doing their
hardest fighting that I was
doing my hardest running.
Oh well, I'll pretend I was
there just the same, and
recite what I heard tell
about it. But the neatest
way to narrate my story—
and the words to use—I
must practise a bit by
myself beforehand here.

(*pauses*) Here's how we'll
begin. (*lays lantern down
and addresses supposed
Alcmene importantly*) First
and foremost, when we
reached there, as soon as
we had touched land,
straightway Amphitryon
picks out the most

si quae asportassent redderent, se exercitum
extemplo domum
reducturum, abituros agro Argivos, pacem
atque otium
dare illis; sin aliter sient animati neque dent
quae petat,
210 sese igitur summa vi virisque eorum
oppidum oppugnassere.

Haec ubi Telobois ordine iterarunt quos
praeferat
Amphitruo, magnanimi viri freti virtute et
viribus
superbe nimis ferociter legates nostros
increpant,
respondent bello se et suos tutari posse,
proinde uti
propere irent, de suis finibus exercitus
deducerent.
haec ubi legati pertulere, Amphitruo castris
ilico
producit omnem exercitum. Teloboae contra
ex oppido

illustrious of his captains.
These he sends forth as
legates and bids convey his
terms to the Teloboians, to
wit: should they wish,
without contention and
without strife, to deliver up
pillage and pillagers and
restore whatsoever they
had carried off, he himself
would lead his army home
forthwith and the Argives
would leave their land and
grant them peace and
quietude; but were they
otherwise disposed, and
disinclined to yield what he
sought, he would thereupon
with all the force at his
command make onslaught
on their city.

When Amphitryon's
ambassadors had duly
made this proclamation to
the Teloboians, they,
doughty warriors,
confiding in their courage
and glorying in their
strength, made right rough
and haughty answer to our
embassy, saying that they
could defend themselves
and theirs by force of arms,
and that accordingly they
should depart at once and
lead their troops out from
the Teloboian borders. On

legiones educunt suas nimis pulcris armis
praeditas.

postquam utrimque exitum est
maxima copia,
220 dispertiti viri, dispertiti ordines,
nos nostras more nostro et modo
instruximus
legiones, item hostes contra legiones suas
instruunt.

deinde utrique imperatores in medium
exeunt,
extra turbam ordinum colloquuntur
simul.
convenit, victi utri sint eo proelio,
urbem agrum aras focos seque uti
dederent.

ostquam id actum est, tubae contra
utrimque occanunt,
onsonat terra, clamorem utrimque
efferunt.
mperator utrimque, hinc et illinc, Iovi
230 vota suscipere, utrimque hortari
exercitum.
tum pro se quisque id quod quisque
potest et valet

receiving this report from
his legates, Amphitryon at
once led forth his whole
army from camp. And from
the city, too, the Teloboians
led out their legions in
goodly panoply.

After both sides had
marched out in full force,
troops arrayed, and ranks
arrayed, we drew up our
legions according to our
usual method and manner:
our foemen likewise draw
up their legions facing
ours.

Then forward into the
centre of the field stride the
leaders of both hosts, and
there out beyond the
serried lines they hold
colloquy. This pact was
made, that they who were
conquered in this battle
should surrender city and
land, shrines, homes, and
persons.

This done, the trumpets
blared on either side; earth
echoes; on either side the
battle cry is raised. The
generals on either side,
both here and there, offer
their vows to Jove, and on
either side cheer their
warriors. Then each man
lays about him with his

edit, ferro ferit, tela frangunt, boat
caelum fremitu virum, ex spiritu atque
anhelitu
nebula constat, cadunt volnerum vi viri.

Denique, ut voluimus, nostra superat manus:
hostes crebri cadunt, nostri contra ingruunt
vi¹¹ feroces.
sed¹² fugam in se tamen nemo convortitur
nec recedit loco quin statim rem gerat;
240 animam omittunt prius quam loco
demigrent:
quisque ut steterat iacet optinetque ordinem.

hoc ubi Amphitruo erus conspicatust,
ilico equites iubet dextera inducere.
equites parent citi: ab dextera maximo
cum clamore involant impetu alacri,
foedant et proterunt hostium copias
iure iniustas.

Mer.

every ounce of strength and
strikes home with his
blade: lances shiver: the
welkin rings with the roar
of heroes: up from their
gasping, panting breath a
cloud arises: men drop
beneath the weight of
wounds.

At last, as we wished, our
host prevails: the foemen
fall in heaps: on and on we
press, fired by our might.
Yet for all that, none turns
in flight nor yields an inch,
but stands his ground and
hews away. They lose their
lives sooner than quit their
post. As each had stood, so
he lies, and keeps the line
unbroken.

When my lord Amphitryon
noted this, he straightway
ordered that the cavalry on
our right be led to the
charge. Swift they obey,
and with terrific yells
swooping down from the
right in mad career they
mangle and trample
underfoot the forces of our
foes and right our wrongs.
(wipes his brow and
meditates)

Mer.

Numquam etiam quicquam adhuc verborum
est prolocutus perperam:
namque ego fui illi in re praesenti et meus,
cum pugnatum est, pater.

Sos.

250 Perduelles penetrant se in fugam; ibi
nostris animus additust:
vortentibus Teloboïs telis complebantur
corpora,
ipsusque Amphitruo regem Pterelam sua
obtruncavit manu.
haec illic est pugnata pugna usque a mani ad
vesperum—
hoc adeo hoc commemini magis, quia illo
die inpransus fui—
sed proelium id tandem diremit nox
interventu suo.

postridie in castra ex urbe ad nos veniunt
flentes principes:
velatis manibus orant ignoscamus peccatum
suum,
deduntque se, divina humanaque omnia,
urbem et liberos
indicionem atque in arbitratum cuncti
Thebano populo.
260 post ob virtutem ero Amphitruoni patera
donata aurea est,

(*aside*) Not a single,
solitary word of fiction has
he uttered yet: for I was
there myself while the
battle was actually going
on, and my father too.

Sos.

(*gathering himself
together*) Their warriors
take to flight; at this new
courage animates our men.
When the Teloboians turn
their backs we stick them
full of spears, and
Amphitryon himself cut
down King Pterelas with
his own hand. This fight
was fought out all through
the day there from morn till
eve. (*reflectively*) I
remember this point more
distinctly because that noon
I went without my lunch.
But darkness at last
intervened and terminated
the engagement.

The following day their
foremost men come
tearfully from the city to
our camp, their hands
veiled in suppliant wise,
and entreat us to pardon
their transgression: and one
and all they surrender their
persons, their entire
possessions sacred and
profane, their city and their

qui Pterela potitare solitus est rex. haec sic
dicam erae
nunc pergam eri imperium exequi et me
domum capessere.

Mer.

Attat, illic huc iturust. ibo ego illi obviam,
neque ego huc hominem hodie ad aedis has
sinam umquam accedere;
quando imago est huius in me, certum est
hominem eludere.
et enim vero quoniam formam cepi huius in
med et statum,
decet et facta moresque huius habere me
similes item,
itaque me malum esse oportet, callidum,
astutum admodum
atque hunc, telo suo sibi, malitia a foribus
pellere.
270 sed quid illuc est? caelum aspectat.
observabo quam rem agat.

children to the Theban
people to have and to hold
as they deem fit. Then, for
his valour, my lord
Amphitryon was presented
with a golden bowl from
which King Pterelas was
wont to drink. (*heaves deep
sigh of relief*) This is how I
will tell it to the mistress.
Now I'll go finish up the
job for master and take
myself home. (*picks up
lantern*)

Mer.

(*aside*) Oho! about to come
this way! I'll step up and
meet him. The fellow shall
never reach this house at
present: I won't have it.
Now that I am his double I
fully intend to befool the
fellow. And I say,
considering I have taken on
his looks and dress, it is
appropriate for me to ape
his ways and general
conduct, too. I must be a
sly rascal, then, shifty
as the deuce, yes, and drive
him away from the door
with his own weapon,
roguery. (*looking at Sosia
who is gaping at the stars*)
What's he at, though?
Staring at the sky! I must
keep an eye on him.

Sos.

Certe edepol, si quicquamst aliud quod
credam aut certo sciam,
credo ego hac noctu Nocturnum
obdormivisse ebrium.
nam neque se Septentriones quoquam in
caelo commovent,
neque se Luna quoquam mutat atque uti
exorta est semel,
nec Iugulae neque Vesperugo neque
Vergiliae occidunt.
ita statim stant signa, neque nox quoquam
concedit die.

Mer.

Perge, Nox, ut occepisti, gere patri morem
meo:
optumo optume optumam operam das,
datam pulchre locas.

Sos.

Neque ego hac nocte longiorem me vidisse
censeo,
280 nisi item unam, verberatus quam pependi
perpetem;
eam quoque edepol etiam multo haec vicit
longitudine.
credo edepol equidem dormire Solem, atque
adpotum probe;
mira sunt nisi invitavit sese in cena
plusculum.

Sos.

My goodness, if there's
anything I can believe or
know for sure, I surely do
believe old Nocturnus went
to bed this night in liquor.
Why, the Great Bear hasn't
moved a step anywhere in
the sky, and the moon's just
as it was when it first rose,
and Orion's Belt, and the
Evening Star, and the
Pleiades aren't setting,
either. Yes, the
constellations are standing
stock still, and no sign of
day anywhere.

Mer.

(aside) Go on as you have
begun, Night: oblige my
father: you're doing
splendidly in a splendid
work for a splendid deity:
you'll find it a fine
investment.

Sos.

I don't think I ever did see a
longer night—barring that
one when I got whipped
and was left strung up till
morning. And goodness
me, in length this one's way
ahead of even that one.
Gad, I certainly do believe
old Sol's asleep, asleep and
dead drunk. It's a wonder if

Mer.

Ain vero, verbero? deos esse tui similis
putas?
ego pol te istis tuis pro dictis et male factis,
furcifer,
accipiam; modo sis veni huc: invenies
infortunium.

Sos.

Ubi sunt isti scortatores, qui soli inviti
cubant?
haec nox scita est exercendo scorto conducto
male.

Mer.

Meus pater nunc pro huius verbis recte et
sapienter facit,
290 qui complexus cum Alcumena cubat
amans animo obsequens.

Sos.

Ibo ut erus quod imperavit Alcumenae
nuntiem.
sed quis hic est homo, quem ante aedis video
hoc noctis? non placet.

he hasn't drunk his own
health a bit too much at
dinner.

Mer.

(aside) So, you scoundrel?
Think the gods are like
yourself, eh? By heaven,
I'll give you a reception to
match this talk and roguery
of yours, you gallows-bird.
Just you be good enough to
step this way, and you shall
meet with a mishap.

Sos.

Where are those young
blades that hate a lonely
couch? Here is your lovely
night for gallivanting with
an expensive lady.

Mer.

(aside) According to this
chap, my father's making
good, intelligent use of his
time—loving to his heart's
content with Alcmena in
his fond embrace.

Sos.

Now for the message
master told me to give
mistress. *(aside as he
moves toward house and
sees Mercury)* But who's
that fellow in front of the
house at this time o' night?
(halts, frightened) I don't
like it.

Mer.

Nullust hoc metuculosus aequē.

Sos.

Mi in mentem
venit,
illic homo hoc de umero volt pallium
detexere.

Mer.

Timet homo: deludam ego illum.

Sos.

Perii, dentes pruriunt;
certe advenientem hic me hospitio pugneo
accepturus est.
credo misericors est: nunc propterea quod
me meus erus
fecit ut vigilarem, hic pugnīs faciet hodie ut
dormiam.
oppido interii. obsecro hercle, quantus et
quam validus est.

Mer.

300 Clare advorsum fabulabor, ut his
auscultet quae loquar;
igitur magis demum maiorem in sese
concupiet metum,
agite, pugni, iam diu est quom ventri victum
non datis:

Mer.

(aside) Of all the
pusillanimous rogues!

Sos.

(aside) It looks to me as if
this fellow wants to take
my cloak off for me.

Mer.

(aside) Our friend is
scared: we'll have some
sport with him.

Sos.

(aside) Oh Lord, my teeth
do—itch! He's going to
give me a welcome on my
arrival, he surely is,—a
fisty welcome! He's a kind-
hearted soul, I do believe.
Seeing how master's kept
me awake all night, he's
going to up with his fists
now and put me to sleep.
Oh, I'm dead entirely! For
God's sake look at the size
of him, and strong,
heavens!

Mer.

(aside) I'll speak out aloud,
so that he can hear what I
say, and then I warrant he'll
feel shakier still. *(loudly,*
with melodramatic
fierceness) Fists, be up and
doing! 'Tis long since ye

iam pridem videtur factum, heri quod
homines quattuor
in soporem collocastis nudos.

Sos.

Formido male,
ne ego hic nomen meum commutem et
Quintus fiam e Sosia;
quattuor nudos sopori se dedisse hic
autumat;
metuo ne numerum augeam illum.

Mer.

Em, nunciam ergo: sic
volo.
Sos.
Cingitur; certe expedit se.

Mer.

Non feret quin
vapulet.
Sos.
Quis homo?

Mer.

Quisquis homo huc profecto venerit,
pugnos edet.
Sos.

have made provision for
my paunch. It seems an age
since yesterday when ye
stripped stark four men and
laid them away in slumber.

Sos.

(*aside*) Oh, but I'm awfully
scared my name will be
changed here and now,
from Sosia to Sosia the
Fifth. Four men he's
stripped already and sent to
slumberland, so he says:
I'm afraid I'm going to
swell that list.

Mer.

(*tightening his girdle*)
There, now then! 'Tis well.
Sos.

(*aside*) Loins girded! He is
surely getting ready for
business.

Mer.

He shall not escape a
trouncing.

Sos.

(*aside, anxiously*) Who,
who?

Mer.

I tell ye, any man that
comes this way shall eat
fists.
Sos.

310 Apage, non placet me hoc noctis esse:
cenavi modo:
proin tu istam cenam largire, si sapis,
esurientibus.

Mer.

Haud malum huic est pondus pugno.

Sos.

Perii, pugnos
ponderat.

Mer.

Quid si ego illum tractim tangam, ut
dormiat?

Sos.

Servaveris,
nam continuas has tris noctes pervigilavi.

Mer.

Pessumest,
facimus nequiter, ferire malam male discit
manus;
alia forma esse oportet quem tu pugno
legeris.

Sos.

Illic homo me interpolabit meumque os
finget denuo.

(aside) No you don't! I
don't care about eating at
this time o' night. It wasn't
long ago I dined. So if
you've got any sense, you
just bestow that dinner on
the hungry.

Mer.

(examining his right fist)
There's some weight in that
fist.

Sos.

(aside) I'm finished! He's a-
weighing his fists!

Mer.

(sparring) What if I should
stroke him softly into
somnolence?

Sos.

(aside) You'd save my life:
I haven't slept a wink for
three nights running.

Mer.

(swinging heavily)
Downright sinful, this! This
is a shame! 'Tis wrong of
my arm to learn really to
jab a jaw! *(to arm as he
feels biceps)* Merely graze
a man with thy fist and his
shape must needs be
altered.

Sos.

(aside) That bully's going
to do me up and mould my

Mer.

Exossatum os esse oportet quem probe
percusseris.

Sos.

Mirum ni hic me quasi murenam exossare
cogitat.
320 ultro istunc qui exossat homines, perii, si
me aspexerit.

Mer.

Olet homo quidam malo suo.

Sos.

Ei, numnam ego
obolui?

Mer.

Atque haud longe abesse oportet, verum
longe hinc afuit.

Sos.

Illi homo superstitiosust.

Mer.

Gestiunt pugni mihi.

Sos.

Si in me exercituru's, quaeso in parietem ut
primum domes.

face all over again for me.

Mer.

The face that thou shalt
smite in earnest is bound
thereafter to be boneless.

Sos.

(*aside*) Sure enough he's
reckoning on boning me
like a lamprey. I—I object
to these man-boners. It's all
up if he catches sight of
me.

Mer.

(*sniffing the air*) Ha! I
smell somebody, and woe
to him!

Sos.

(*aside*) Oh, dear! It can't be
he's got a whiff of me?

Mer.

Aye, and he must be near at
hand, albeit he has been
afar from here.

Sos.

(*aside*) The fellow's got
second sight.

Mer.

My fists are rampant.

Sos.

(*in low tone*) If you intend
to put 'em through their
paces on me, for heaven's
sake break 'em in first on
the wall.

Mer.

Vox mi ad aures advolavit.

Sos.

Ne ego homo infelix
fui,
qui non alas intervelli: volucrem vocem
gestito.

Mer.

Illic homo a me sibi malam rem arcessit
iumento suo.

Sos.

Non equidem ullum habeo iumentum.

Mer.

Onerandus est pugnīs
probe.

Sos.

Lassus sum hercle, navi ut vectus huc sum:
etiam nunc nauseo;
330 vix incedo inanis, ne ire posse cum onere
existimes.

Mer.

Certe enim his nescio quis loquitur.

Sos.

Salvos sum, non
me videt:

Mer.

A voice hath flown unto
my ear.

Sos.

(*aside*) There you are! I
swear I am an unlucky
devil not to have clipped its
wings, and me with such a
bird-like voice.

Mer.

Yon wight doth summon
me to wallop his beast's
back for him.

Sos.

(*aside*) Never a beast do I
own, not I.

Mer.

He needs a lusty load of
buffets.

Sos.

(*in low tone*) Oh Lord! and
me all done up with that
sea trip home! I'm seasick
even now. It's all I can do
to stump along empty
handed, so don't think I can
travel with a load.

Mer.

Yea, of a truth some one is
talking here.

Sos.

(*in lower tone*) Saved! He
doesn't see me. It's Some
one he says is talking: and

nescioquem loqui autumat; mihi certo
nomen Sosiaest.

Mer.

Hinc enim mihi dextra vox auris, ut videtur,
verberat.

Sos.

Metuo, vocis ne vicem hodie hic vapulem,
quae hunc verberat.

Mer.

Optume eccum incedit ad me.

Sos.

Timeo, totus torpeo.
non edepol nunc ubi terrarum sim scio, si
quis roget,
neque miser me commovere possum prae
formidine.
ilicet, mandata eri perierunt una et Sosia.
verum certum est confidenter hominem
contra conloqui,
340 qui possim videri huic fortis, a me ut
abstineat manum.

Mer.

Quo ambulas, tu qui Vulcanum in cornu
conclusum geris?

my same is Sosia, I know
that for a fact.

Mer.

Yes, a voice from the right
here, as it seems, doth
strike my ear.

Sos.

(aside) I'm afraid he'll soon
pummel me instead of my
voice for its striking him.
(steps forward timidly)

Mer.

Oho! Splendid! He moves
this way.

Sos.

(aside) I'm scared, I'm
simply stiff! Good
gracious, I don't know
where in the world I am,
not if anyone asked me. Oh
dear, I can't move a step for
fear! This ends me!
Master's orders are done
for, and Sosia, too. But I'm
resolved—I'm going to
speak right up to him
boldly, so that I can make
him think I'm a dangerous
character and let me be.
(tries to swagger)

Mer.

Whither dost stroll, thou
who conveyest *(pointing to
lantern)* Vulcan pent within
yon horn?

Sos.

Quid id exquiris tu, qui pugnīs os exossas
hominibus?

Mer.

Servosne es an liber?

Sos.

Utcumque animo
conlibitum est meo.

Mer.

Ain vero?

Sos.

Aio enim vero.

Mer.

Verbero.

Sos.

Mentiris

nunc.

Mer.

At iam faciam ut verum dīxas dicere.

Sos.

Quid eo est

opus?

Mer.

Possum scire, quo profectus, cuius sis aut
quid veneris?

Sos.

Sos.

What dost want to know
for, thou who bonest folks'
faces for 'em with yon
fists?

Mer.

Art slave or free?

Sos.

Whichever I please.

Mer.

So? In sooth?

Sos.

Yes, so in sooth.

Mer.

Thou whipped slave!

Sos.

You lie: I'm none.

Mer.

(*advancing*) But I shall
soon make thee say 'tis
true.

Sos.

(*shrinking back*) Oh, what's
the use of that?

Mer.

(*sternly*) May I be
informed where thou art
bound, who owns thee, or
why thou camest? (*halts*)

Sos.

Huc eo, eri iussu, eius sum servos. numquid
nunc es certior?

Mer.

Ego tibi istam hodie, scelestes, comprimam
linguam.

Sos.

Haud potes:
bene pudiceque adservatur.

Mer.

Pergin argutarier?
quid apud hasce aedis negoti est tibi?

Sos.

350 Immo quid
tibi est?

Mer.

Rex Creon vigiles nocturnos singulos semper
locat.

Sos.

Bene facit: quia nos eramus peregre, tutatust
domi;
at nunc abi sane, advenisse familiares dicito.

Mer.

Nescio quam tu familiaris sis: nisi actutum
hinc abis,
familiaris accipiere faxo haud familiariter.

(*encouraged*) I'm bound for
here—master's orders—and
I'm his slave. Are you any
wiser now?

Mer.

I'll soon make thee hold thy
tongue, miscreant!

Sos.

No chance, she's
chaperoned in nice modest
fashion.

Mer.

Still at thy quips, eh? What
business hast thou at this
house?

Sos.

Well, and what have you?

Mer.

King Creon posts separate
sentries about here every
night.

Sos.

(*in superior manner*) Much
obliged. Seeing we were
abroad, he's kept guard for
us at home. But now you
can be off: say the family
servants have got back.

Mer.

Thou a family servant,
indeed! Unless thou dost
disappear instantly, I
warrant ye I'll welcome

Sos.
Hic inquam habito ego atque horunc servos
sum.

Mer.
At scin quo
modo?
faciam ego hodie te superbum, nisi hinc abis.

Sos.
Quonam
modo?

Mer.
Auferere, non abibis, si ego fustem
sumpsero.

Sos.
Quin me esse huius familiai familiarem
praedico.

Mer.
360 Vide sis quam mox vapulare vis, nisi
actutum hinc abis.

Sos.
Tun domo prohibere peregre me
advenientem postulas?

Mer.
Haecine tua domust?

servants of the family with
strange familiarity.

Sos.
Here's where I live, I tell
you. This is my master's
house.

Mer.
But knowest thou what? I'll
soon be making an exalted
man of thee, an' thou
decampest not.

Sos.
Exalted! How is that?

Mer.
You shall be carried off on
people's shoulders—no
walking—once I take my
club to you.

Sos.
I'm a member of the
household here, I do avow.

Mer.
Kindly consider how soon
you want a thrashing,
unless you vanish instantly.

Sos.
So you want to forbid me
the house when I'm getting
back from foreign parts,
you?

Mer.
Is this the house where you
belong?

Sos.

Ita inquam.

Mer.

Quis erus est igitur
tibi?

Sos.

Amphitruo, qui nunc praefectus Thebanis
legionibus,
quicum nupta est Alcumena.

Mer.

Quid ais? quid nomen
tibi est?

Sos.

Sosiam vocant Thebani, Davo prognatum
patre.

Mer.

Ne tu istic hodie malo tuo compositis
mendaciis
advenisti, audaciai columen, consutis dolis.

Sos.

Immo equidem tunicis consutis huc advenio,
non dolis.

Mer.

At mentiris etiam: certo pedibus, non tunicis
venis.

Sos.

Sos.

That's what I say.

Mer.

Who is your master, then?

Sos.

Amphitryon, now in
command of the Theban
army, and his wife is
Alcmena.

Mer.

How say you? Your name!

Sos.

Sosia the Thebans call me,
Sosia, son of Davus.

Mer.

Ah! 'twas an evil hour for
thee, when thou camest
here, thou pinnacle of
impudence, with thy
premeditated lies and
patched-up fabrications.

Sos.

You're wrong, I vow: I've
come with my tunic
patched up, not my
fabrications.

Mer.

Ha, lying again! Thou dost
clearly come with thy feet,
not thy tunic.

Sos.

Ita profecto.

Mer.

370 Nunc profecto vapula ob
mendacium.

Sos.

Non edepol volo profecto.

Mer.

At pol profecto
ingratiis.
hoc quidem profecto certum est, non est
arbitrarium.

Sos.

Tuam fidem obsecro.

Mer.

Tun te audes Sosiam esse
dicere,
qui ego sum?

Sos.

Perii.

Mer.

Parum etiam, praeut
futurum est, praedicas.
quoius nunc es?

Sos.

Tuos, nam pugnis usu fecisti
tuom.
pro fidem, Thebani cives.

(dryly) Naturally.

Mer.

And naturally now get
thrashed for fibbing.
(advances)

Sos.

(retreats) Oh dear, I object,
naturally.

Mer.

Oh well, naturally that is
immaterial. My "naturally,"
at least, is a cold hard fact,
no matter of opinion. (beats
him)

Sos.

(squirming) Easy, easy, for
Heaven's sake!

Mer.

Durst say that thou art
Sosia when I am he?

Sos.

Murder! murder!

Mer.

(continuing to beat him)
Murder? A mere nothing
compared with what is
coming. Whose are you
now?

Sos.

Yours! Your fists have got a
title to me by limitation.
Help, Thebans, help!

Mer.
Etiam clamas,
carnifex?
loquere, quid venisti?
Sos.
Ut esset quem tu pugnīs
caederes.
Mer.
Cuius es?
Sos.
Amphitruonis, inquam, Sosia.
Mer.
Ergo istoc
magis,
quia vaniloquo's, vapulabis: ego sum, non tu,
Sosia.
Sos.
380 Ita di faciant, ut tu potius sis atque ego te
ut verberem.
Mer.
Etiam muttis?
Sos.
Iam tacebo.
Mer.
Quis tibi erust?
Sos.
Quem tu
voles.
Mer.

Mer.
So? Bellowing, varlet?
Speak up, why camest
thou?
Sos.
Just to give you some one
to punch, sir.
Mer.
Whose are you?
Sos.
Amphitryon's Sosia, I tell
you.
Mer.
Well then, you shall be
pummelled the more for
talking nonsense. You
Sosia! I am he myself.
Sos.
(in low tone) I wish to God
you were, instead of me,
and I was thumping you.
Mer.
Ha! Muttering, eh?
Sos.
I won't, I won't, sir!
Mer.
Who is your master?
Sos.
Anyone you like, sir.
Mer.

Quid igitur? qui nunc vocare?

Sos.

Nemo nisi quem
iusseris.

Mer.

Amphitruonis te esse aiebas Sosiam.

Sos.

Peccaveram.
nam Amphitruonis¹³ socium ne me esse
volui dicere.

Mer.

Sciebam equidem nullum esse nobis nisi me
servom Sosiam.
fugit te ratio.

Sos.

Utinam istuc pugni
fecissent tui.

Mer.

Ego sum Sosia ille quem tu dudum esse
aiebas mihi.

Sos.

Obsecro ut per pacem liceat te alloqui, ut ne
vapulem.

Mer.

Immo indutiae parumper fiant, si quid vis
loqui.

Sos.

Indeed? And your name
now?

Sos.

Nothing but what you
order, sir.

Mer.

You were saying you were
Amphitryon's Sosia.

Sos.

All a mistake, sir;
"Amphitryon's associate" I
meant, sir, really I did.

Mer.

Ah, I knew quite well there
was no servant Sosia at our
place except me. You made
a slip.

Sos.

Oh, how I wish your fists
had!

Mer.

I am that Sosia you claimed
to be a while ago.

Sos.

For heaven's sake, sir, let
me have a word with you
in peace without getting
pummelled.

Mer.

No peace—but I consent to
a short armistice, if you
have anything to say.

Sos.

390 Non loquar nisi pace facta, quando
pugnis plus vales.

Mer.

Dic si quid vis, non nocebo.

Sos.

Tuae fide credo?

Mer.

Meae.

Sos.

Quid si falles?

Mer.

Tum Mercurius Sosiae iratus
siet.

Sos.

Animum advorte. nunc licet mihi libere
quidvis loqui.

Amphitruonis ego sum servos Sosia.

Mer.

Etiam

denuo?

Sos.

Pacem feci, foedus feci. vera dico.

Mer.

Vapula.

Sos.

Ut libet quid tibi libet fac, quoniam pugnis
plus vales;

I won't say it, not unless
peace is made: your fists
are too much for me.

Mer.

Out with what you want: I
shall not hurt you!

Sos.

Can I take your word for
that?

Mer.

You can.

Sos.

What if you fool me?

Mer.

(solemnly) Then may Sosia
feel the wrath of Mercury!

Sos.

Listen here, sir. Now I'm
free to come out plain with
anything. I am
Amphitryon's Sosia, I am.

Mer.

(advancing) What? Again?

Sos.

(vigorously) I made peace
—I struck a treaty! It's the
truth.

Mer.

Be thrashed to you!

Sos.

Suit yourself, do what suits
you, seeing your fists are

verum, utut es facturus, hoc quidem hercle
haud reticebo tamen.

Mer.

Tu me vivos hodie numquam facies quin sim
Sosia.

Sos.

Certe edepol tu me alienabis numquam quin
noster siem;
nec nobis praeter me alius quisquam est
servos Sosia. ¹⁴ 400

Mer.

Hic homo sanus non est.

Sos.

(402) Quod mihi praedicas
vitium, id tibi est.
quid, malum, non sum ego servos
Amphitruonis Sosia?
nonne hac noctu nostra navis huc ex portu
Persico
venit, quae me advexit? nonne me huc erus
misit meus?

nonne ego nunc sto ante aedes nostras? non
mi est lanterna in manu?
non loquor, non vigilo? nonne hic homo
modo me pugnīs contudit?
fecit hercle, nam etiam misero nunc mihi
malae dolent.

too much for me.
(*doggedly*) But just the
same, no matter what you
do, I won't keep that back,
by gad, not that.

Mer.

You shall never live to
make me anyone but Sosia,
never.

Sos.

And by thunder, you shall
never do me out of being
our family's servant. No sir,
and I'm the only servant
Sosia we have.

Mer.

The man is crazy.

Sos.

Crazy? You're putting your
own complaint off on to
me. (*half to himself*) See
here, dash it, an't I
Amphitryon's servant
Sosia? Didn't our ship
arrive this night from Port
Persicus, and I on it? Didn't
my own master send me
here?

An't I standing in front of
our own house this minute?
Haven't I got a lantern in
my hand? An't I talking?
An't I awake? Didn't this
chap just give me a
bruising? Lord, but he did!

quid igitur ego dubito, aut cur non intro eo in
nostram domum?

Mer.

Quid, domum vostram?

Sos.

Ita enim vero.

Mer.

410 Quin quae

dixisti modo
omnia ementitu's: equidem Sosia
Amphitruonis sum.
nam noctu hac soluta est navis nostra e portu
Persico,
et ubi Pterela rex regnavit oppidum
expugnativimus.
et legiones Teloboarum vi pugnando
cepimus,
et ipse Amphitruo optruncavit regem
Pterelam in proelio.

Sos.

Egomet mihi non credo, cum illaec autumare
illum audio;
hic quidem certe quae illic sunt res gestae
memorat memoriter.
sed quid ais? quid Amphitruoni doni a
Teloboio datum est?

Mer.

Why, my poor jaws ache
even now. What am I
hesitating for, then? Or
why don't I go inside our
house?

Mer.

What? Your house?

Sos.

Yes, just so.

Mer.

You lie, I tell you: your
every word has been a lie. I
am Amphitryon's Sosia,
beyond dispute. Why, this
very night we unmoored
and left Port Persicus; and
we have seized the city
where King Pterelas held
sway; and we subdued the
legions of the Teloboians
by our sturdy onslaught;
and Amphitryon himself
slew King Pterelas on the
field of battle.

Sos.

(*aside*) I can't believe my
own ears when I hear that
fellow going on so. My
word, he certainly does reel
our doings there all off pat.
(*aloud*) But I say—what
was Amphitryon presented
with from the Teloboian
spoils?

Mer.

Pterela rex qui potitare solitus est patera aurea.

Sos.

Elocutus est. ubi patera nunc est?

Mer.

420 Est in cistula;

Amphitruonis obsignata signo est.

Sos.

Signi dic quid

est?

Mer.

Cum quadrigis Sol exoriens. quid me captas, carnufex?

Sos.

Argumentis vicit, aliud nomen quaerundum est mihi.

nescio unde haec hic spectavit. iam ego hunc decipiam probe;

nam quod egomet solus feci, nec quisquam alius affuit,

in tabernaclo, id quidem hodie numquam poterit dicere.

si tu Sosia es, legiones cum pugnabant maxime,

quid in tabernaclo fecisti? victus sum, si dixeris.

A golden bowl that King Pterelas was wont to drink from.

Sos.

(*aside*) He's hit it! (*aloud*) Where is the bowl now?

Mer.

In a little chest, sealed with Amphitryon's signet.

Sos.

What's on the signet, tell me that?

Mer.

Sol rising in a four horse chariot. (*blustering*) Why this attempt to catch me, caitiff?

Sos.

(*aside*) This evidence settles me. I've got to find me a new name. I don't understand where he saw all this from. (*reflecting*) Ah, now I'll trick him in good style. Yes, something I did when I was all alone, and not another soul there, in the tent,—he'll never be able to tell me about that, anyway. (*aloud*) Well, if you're Sosia, what did you do in the tent when the soldiers were in the thick of the fight? Answer me that and I give in.

Mer.

Cadus erat vini: inde implevi hirneam.

Sos.

viam.

Ingressust

Mer.

430 Eam ego, ut matre fuerat natum, vini
eduxi meri.

Sos.

Factum est illud, ut ego illic vini hirneam
ebiberim meri.
mira sunt nisi latuit intus illic in illac hirnea.

Mer.

Quid nunc? vincon argumentis, te non esse
Sosiam?

Sos.

Tu negas med esse?

Mer.

Quid ego ni negem, qui egomet
siem?

Sos.

Per Iovem iuro med esse neque me falsum
dicere.

Mer.

At ego per Mercurium iuro, tibi Iovem non
credere;
nam iniurato scio plus credet mihi quam
iurato tibi.

Mer.

There was a cask of wine: I
drew off a jugful.

Sos.

(*aside*) He's on the right
track.

Mer.

Then I drained it, wine
pure as it came from its
mother.

Sos.

(*aside*) That's a fact—I did
drink off a jug of wine,
neat. Most probably the
fellow was hiding in that
same jug!

Mer.

Well, have I convinced you
that you are not Sosia?

Sos.

You deny it, do you?

Mer.

Of course I deny it, being
Sosia myself.

Sos.

No, I am,—I swear it by
Jupiter, and swear I'm not
lying, too!

Mer.

But I swear by Mercury
that Jupiter disbelieves
you. Why, man, he will
take my bare word against

Sos.

Quis ego sum saltem, si non sum Sosia? te
interrogo.

Mer.

Ubi ego Sosia nolim esse, tu esto sane Sosia;
440 nunc, quando ego sum, vapulabis, ni hinc
abis, ignobilis.

Sos.

Certe edepol, quom illum contemplo et
formam cognosco meam,
quem ad modum ego sum—saepe in
speculum inspexi—nimis similest mei;
itidem habet petasum ac vestitum: tam
consimilest atque ego;
sura, pes, statura, tonsus, oculi, nasum vel
labra,
malae, mentum, barba, collus: totus. quid
verbis opust?

si tergum cicatricosum, nihil hoc similist
similius.
sed quom cogito, equidem certo idem sum
qui semper fui.
novi erum, novi aedis nostras; sane sapio et
sentio.

your solemn oath, no doubt
about it.

Sos.

For mercy's sake who am I,
if I'm not Sosia? I ask you
that.

Mer.

When I do not wish to be
Sosia, be Sosia yourself, by
all means. Now that I am
he, you either pack, or take
a thrashing, you unknown
riff raff.

Sos.

*(aside, looking him over
carefully)* Upon my soul,
now I look him over, and
consider my own looks, my
own appearance—I've
peeped in a mirror many a
time—he is precious like
me. Has on a travelling hat,
yes, and clothes the same
as mine. He's as like me as
I am myself! Same leg—
foot— height— haircut—
eyes— nose— lips, even—
jaw— chin— beard— neck
— everything. Well— well,
well, well!

If he's got a backful of
whip scars, you couldn't
find a liker likeness
anywhere. *(pause)* But—
when I think it over—I'm
positive I'm the same man I

non ego illi obtempero quod loquitur,
pultabo foris.

Mer.

Quo agis te?

Sos.

Domum.

Mer.

450 Quadrigas si nunc
inscendas Iovis
atque hinc fugias, ita vix poteris effugere
infortunium.

Sos.

Nonne erae meae nuntiare quod erus meus
iussit licet?

Mer.

Tuae si quid vis nuntiare: hanc nostram adire
non sinam.
nam si me inritassis, hodie lumbifragium
hinc auferes.

Sos.

always was, of course I am.
(*with growing conviction*) I
know master, I know our
house. I'm sane and sound,
I've got my senses. I won't
take any notice of what he
says, not I. I'll knock at the
door (*moves toward*
Amphitryon's house)

Mer.

(*blocking him off*) Where
now?

Sos.

Home.

Mer.

(*advancing*) And shouldst
thou climb into Jupiter's
four horse chariot and seek
to flee, e'en so thou canst
hardly fly misfortune.

Sos.

I can tell my own mistress
what my own master
ordered me to tell her, can't
I?

Mer.

Thy own mistress, aye,—
whatever likes thee: but
never shalt thou approach
ours here. Yea, provoke
me, and thou draggest
hence a shipwreck of a
man. (*advancing*)

Sos.

Abeo potius. di immortales, obsecro vostram
fidem,
ubi ego perii? ubi immutatus sum? ubi ego
formam perdididi?
an egomet me illic reliqui, si forte oblitus
fui?
nam hic quidem omnem imaginem meam,
quae antehac fuerat, possidet.

vivo fit quod numquam quisquam mortuo
faciet mihi.
ibo ad portum atque haec uti sunt facta ero
dicam meo;

460

nisi etiam is quoque me ignorabit; quod ille
faxit Iuppiter,
ut ego hodie raso capite calvos capiam
pilleum.

I. 2.

Mer.

Bene prospere hoc hodie operis
processit mihi:
amovi a foribus maximam
molestiam,
patri ut liceret tuto illam amplexarier.

(*retreating*) Don't, don't,—
I'll be off!(*aside*) Ye
immortal gods! For
heaven's sake, where did I
lose myself? Where was I
transformed? Where did I
drop my shape? I didn't
leave myself behind at the
harbour, did I, if I did
happen to forget it? For,
my word, this fellow has
got hold of my complete
image, mine that was!

Here I am alive and folks
carry my image—more
than anyone will ever do
when I'm dead. I'll go down
to the harbour and tell my
master all about these
goings on—that is unless
he doesn't know me, too,—
and I hope to Jupiter he
won't, so that I may shave
my hair off this very day
and stick my bald head in a
freeman's cap.

[EXIT *Sosia*.

Scene 2.

Mer.

Well, my little affair has
progressed finely, famously. I have
sent a confounded nuisance to the
right-about from the door and
given my father a chance to
embrace the lady there in safety.

iam ille illuc ad erum cum
Amphitruonem advenerit,
narrabit servom hinc sese a foribus
Sosiam
amovisse; ille adeo illum mentiri sibi
credet, neque credet huc profectum,
ut iusserat.

470 erroris ambo ego illos et
dementiae
complebo atque omnem
Amphitruonis familiam,
adeo usque, satietatem dum capiet
pater
illius quam amat. igitur demum
omnes scient
quae facta. denique Alcumenam
Iuppiter
rediget antiquam coniugi in
concordiam.

nam Amphitruo actutum uxori turbas
conciat
atque insimulabit eam probri; tum
meus pater
eam seditionem illi in tranquillum
conferet.
nunc de Alcumena dudum quod dixi
minus,
480 hodie illa pariet filios geminos
duos

alter decumo post mense nascetur
puer
quam seminatust, alter mense
septumo;
eorum Amphitruonis alter est, alter
Iovis:

Now when our friend gets back
there to his master, Amphitryon,
he'll tell his tale how it was servant
Sosia that packed him off. Yes, and
then Amphitryon will think he is
lying, and never came here as he
ordered.

I'll muddle up the pair of them,
bedevil them completely, and
Amphitryon's whole household,
too, and keep it up till my father
has his fill of her whom he loves:
then all shall know the truth, but
not before. And finally Jupiter will
renew the former harmony
between Alcmena and her spouse.

For you see, Amphitryon, will be
raging at his wife shortly, and
accusing her of playing him false:
then my father will step in and
quell the riot. Now about Alcmena
—something I left unsaid a while
ago—now she shall bring forth
twin sons,

one being a ten months' boy, the
other a seven. One is Amphitryon's
child, the other Jove's: the younger
boy, however, has the greater
father, and vice versa. You see how
it is now, do you?

verum minori puero maior est pater,
minor maiori. iamne hoc scitis quid
siet?

sed Alcumenae huius honoris gratia
pater curavit uno ut fetu fieret,
uno ut labore absolvat aerumnas
duas¹⁵. (488)

491 quamquam, ut iam dudum dixi,
resciscet tamen
Amphitruo rem omnem. quid igitur?
nemo id probro
profecto ducet Alcumenae; nam
deum
non par videtur facere, delictum
suom
suamque ut culpam expetere in
mortalem ut sinat.

orationem comprimam: crepuit foris.
Amphitruo subditivos eccum exit
foras
cum Alcumena uxore usuraria.

But out of consideration for
Alcmena here, my father has
provided that there shall be only
one parturition: he intends to make
one labour suffice for two. But
Amphitryon, though, as I told you
some time since, will be informed
of the whole affair. But what of
that? Certainly no one will hold
Alcmena guilty: no, no, it would
seem highly unbecoming for a god
to let a mortal take the
consequences of his misdeeds and
his indiscretions.

(*listening*) Enough of this: there
goes the door. Ah, the counterfeit
Amphitryon comes out with his
borrowed wife, Alcmena! (*steps
aside*)

I. 3.

Iup.

Bene vale, Alcumena, cura rem communem,
quod facis;
500 atque inperce quaeso: menses iam tibi
esse actos vides.
mihi necesse est ire hinc; verum quod erit
natum tollito.

Scene 3.

ENTER *Jupiter* AND *Alcmena*
FROM THE HOUSE.

Jup.

Good-bye and God bless
you, my dear. Continue to
look out for our common
interests, and do be sure not
to overdo: you are near your
time now, you know. I am
obliged to leave you—but
don't expose the child.

Alc.

Quid istuc est, mi vir, negoti, quod tu tam subito domo abeas?

Iup.

Edepol haud quod tui me neque domi distaedeat;
sed ubi summus imperator non adest ad exercitum,
citius quod non facto est usus fit quam quod facto est opus.

Mer.

Nimis hic scitust sycophanta, qui quidem meus sit pater.
observatote eum, quam blande muliori palpabitur.

Alc.

Ecaster te experior quanti facias uxorem tuam.

Iup.

Satin habes, si feminarum nulla est quam aequae diligam?

Mer.

510 Edepol ne illa si istis rebus te sciat operam dare
ego faxim ted Amphitruonem esse malis, quam Iovem.

Alc.

(*plaintively*) Why, my husband, what is it takes you away so suddenly?

Jup.

No weariness of you and home, I swear to that. But when the commander-in-chief is not with his army, things are much more liable to go wrong than right.

Mer.

(*aside*) Ah, he's a sly old dodger—does me D credit, my father does! Notice how suavely he'll smooth her down.

Alc.

(*pouting*) Oh yes, I'm learning how much you think of your wife.

Jup.

(*fondly*) Isn't it enough that you're the dearest woman in the world to me? (*embraces her*)

Mer.

(*aside*) Now, now, sir! Just let the lady up yonder (*pointing thumb heavenward*) learn of your performances here, and I'll guarantee you'd rather be Amphitryon than Jove.

Alc.

Experiri istuc mavellem me quam mi
memorarier.
prius abis quam lectus ubi cubuisti concaluit
locus.
heri venisti media nocte, nunc abis. hoc in
placet?

Mer.

Accedam atque hanc appellabo et
subparasitabor patri.
numquam edepol quemquam mortalem
credo ego uxorem suam
sic ecclitum amare, proinde ut hic te
ecclitum deperit.

Iup.

Carnufex, non ego te novi? abin e conspectu
meo?
quid tibi hanc curatio est rem, verbero, aut
muttito?
quon ego iam hoc scipione—

Alc.

Ah noli.

Iup.

520 Muttito

modo.

Mer.

Alc.

Actions speak louder than
words. Here you are leaving
me before your place on the
couch had time to get warm.
You came last night at
midnight, and now you are
going. Does that seem
right?

Mer.

(*aside*) I'll go slip a word in
and play henchman to my
father. (*to Alcmena,*
stepping up) Lord, ma'am, I
don't believe there's a
mortal man alive loves his
own wife (*glancing slyly at*
Jupiter) so madly as the
mad way he dotes on you.

Jup.

(*angrily*) You rascal, don't I
know you? Out of my sight,
will you! What business
have you to interfere with
this matter, or to breathe a
word about it, you scamp?
I'll take my cane this instant
and—

Alc.

(*seizing his arm*) Oh, please
don't!

Jup.

You just breathe a word
now!

Mer.

Nequiter paene expeditur prima parasitatio.

Iup.

Verum quod tu dicis, mea uxor, non te mi
irasci decet.
clanculum abii a legione: operam hanc
subrupui tibi,
ex me primo ut prima scires, rem ut
gessissem publicam.
ea tibi omnia enarravi. nisi te amarem
plurimum,
non facerem.

Mer.

Facitne ut dixi? timidam palpo
percutit.

Iup.

Nunc, ne legio persentiscat, clam illuc
redeundum est mihi,
ne me uxorem praevertisse dicant prae re
publica.

Alc.

Lacrimantem ex habitu concinnas tu tuam
uxorem.

Iup.

Tace,
ne corrumpe oculos, redibo actutum.

(*aside dryly*) The
henchman's first try at
henching pretty nearly came
to grief.

Jup.

But as to what you say,
precious,—you oughtn't to
be cross with me. It was on
the sly that I left my troops:
this is a stolen treat, stolen
for your sake, so that your
first news of how I served
my country might come
first from me. And now I
have told you the whole
story. I wouldn't have done
such a thing, if I hadn't
loved you with all my heart.

Mer.

(*aside*) Doing as I said, eh?
Stroking her down, patting
her back, poor thing.

Jup.

Now I must slip back, so
that my men may not get
wind of this and say I put
my wife ahead of the public
welfare.

Alc.

(*tearfully*) And make your
own wife cry at your
leaving her!

Jup.

(*affectionately*) Hush! Don't
spoil your eyes: I shall be

Alc.

530 Id actutum

diu est.

Iup.

Non ego te hic lubens relinquo neque abeo
abs te.

Alc.

Sentio,

nam qua nocte ad me venisti, eadem abis.

Iup.

Cur me

tenes?

tempus est: exire ex urbe prius quam
lucescat volo.

nunc tibi hanc pateram, quae dono mi illi ob
virtutem data est,

Pterela rex qui potitavit, quem ego mea
occidi manu,

Alcumena, tibi condono.

Alc.

Facis ut alias res

soles.

ecastor condignum donum, qualest qui
donum dedit.

Mer.

Immo sic: condignum donum, qualest cui
dono datumst.

Iup.

Pergin autem? nonne ego possum, furcifer,
te perdere?

back soon.

Alc.

That "soon" is a long, long
time.

Jup.

It's not that I like to leave
you here and go away.

Alc.

So I perceive—going away
the same night you came to
me! (*clings to him*)

Jup.

Why do you hold me? It is
time: I wish to get out of the
city before daybreak.

(*producing a golden bowl*)

Here is the bowl they
presented me for bravery on
the field—the one King
Pterelas used to drink from,
whom I killed with my own
hand—take it as a gift from
me, Alcmena.

Alc.

(*taking bowl eagerly*) That
is so like you! Oh, your gift
just matches the giver!

Mer.

Oh no, not the giver—that
gift matches the getter.

Jup.

(*savagely*) So? At it again?
Is there no choking you off,

Alc.
540 Noli amabo, Amphitruo, irasci Sosiae
causa mea.

Iup.
Faciam ita ut vis.

Mer.
Ex amore hic admodum
quam saevos est.

Iup.
Numquid vis?

Alc.
Ut quom absim me ames, me
tuam te absente tamen.

Mer.
Eamus, Amphitruo. lucescit hoc iam.

Iup.
Abi prae,
Sosia,
Iam ego sequar. numquid vis?

Alc.
Etiam: ut actutum
advenias.

you jailbird? No? (*advances
with upraised cane*)

Alc.
(*holding him back*) Please,
Amphitryon, don't be angry
with Sosia on my account.

Jup.
(*halting*) Anything you
please.

Mer.
(*aside*) Love has made an
out-and-out savage of him.

Jup.
(*kissing Alcmena and
turning to go*) Nothing else,
then?

Alc.
This,—even though I am
not near you, love me still,
your own true wife, absent
or not.

Mer.
Let's go, sir; it is getting
light already.

Jup.
Go ahead, Sosia; I shall be
with you in a moment.

[EXIT *Mercury*.
(*kisses Alcmena again and
turns to go*) Nothing
further?

Alc.
Yes, yes—do come back
soon.

Jup.

Licet,
prius tua opinione hic adero: bonum
animum habe.
nunc te, nox, quae me mansisti, mitto uti
cedas die,
ut mortalis inlucescat luce clara et candida.
atque quanto, nox, fuisti longior hac
proxuma,
tanto brevior dies ut fiat faciam, ut aequè
disparet.
550 sed dies e nocte accedat. ibo et
Mercurium sequar.

Jup.

Indeed I will: I shall be here
sooner than you think.
Come, come, cheer up!
(*embraces her and moves
away*)
[EXIT *Alcmena* INTO HOUSE,
SADLY.
Now, Night, who hast
tarried for me, I dismiss
thee: give place to Day, that
he may shine upon mortals
in radiance and splendour.
And Night, since thou wert
longer than the last, I shall
make the day so much the
shorter, that there may be
fair adjustment. But let day
issue forth from night. Now
to follow after Mercury.
[EXIT *Jupiter*.

ACTVS II

Amph.

Age i tu secundum.

Sos.

Sequor, subsequor

te.

Amph.

ACT II

(*Half an hour has elapsed.*)

ENTER *Amphitryon* FOLLOWED BY
Sosia. SLAVES WITH BAGGAGE IN
REAR.

Amph.

(*to lagging Sosia*) Here you! After
me, come!

Sos.

Coming, sir! Right at your heels.

Amph.

Scelestissimum te arbitror.

Sos.

Nam quam ob
rem?

Amph.

Quia id quod neque est neque fuit
neque futurum est mihi praedicas.

Sos.

Eccere, iam tuatim
facis tu, ut tuis nulla apud te fides sit.

Amph.

Quid est? quo modo? iam quidem
hercle ego tibi istam scelestam,
scelus, linguam abscidam.

Sos.

Tuos sum,
proinde ut commodumst et lubet
quidque facias
tamen quin loquar haec uti facta sunt
hic,
560 numquam ullo modo me potes
detertere.

Amph.

Scelestissime, audes mihi praedicare
id,
domi te esse nunc, qui hic ades?

Sos.

Vera dico.

Amph.

It's my opinion you are a damned
rascal.

Sos.

(*hurt*) Oh sir, why?

Amph.

(*angrily*) Because what you tell me
is not so, never was so, never will
be.

Sos.

See there now! Just like you—you
can never trust your servants.

Amph.

(*misunderstanding*) What? How is
that? Well, by heaven now, I'll cut
out that villainous tongue for you,
you villain!

Sos.

(*stubbornly*) I am yours, sir: so do
anything that suits your
convenience and taste. However, I
shall tell everything just as it
happened here, and you shall never
frighten me out of that, never.

Amph.

You confounded rascal, do you
dare tell me you are at home this
very minute, when you are here
with me?

Sos.

It is a fact, sir.

Amph.

Malum quod tibi di dabunt, atque ego
hodie
dabo.

Sos.

Istuc tibist in manu, nam tuos
sum.

Amph.

Tun me, verbero, audes erum
ludificari?
tunc id dicere audes, quod nemo
umquam homo antehac
vidit nec potest fieri, tempore uno
homo idem duobus locis ut simul sit?

Sos.

Profecto, ut loquor res ita est.

Amph.

Iuppiter te
perdat.

Sos.

570 Quid mali sum, ere, tua ex
re promeritus?

Amph.

Rogasne, improbe, etiam qui ludos
facis me?

Sos.

Merito maledicas mihi, si id ita
factum est.¹⁶
verum haud mentior, resque uti facta
dico.

Amph.

Homo hic ebrius est, ut opinor.

Sos.

A fact you shall soon suffer for—
the gods will see to that, and so
will I.

Sos.

That rests with you, sir: I am your
man.

Amph.

You dare make fun of me,
scoundrel, your master? You dare
tell me a thing no one ever saw
before, an impossible thing—the
same man in two places at one
time?

Sos.

Really, sir, it is just as I say.

Amph.

Jove's curse on you!

Sos.

What harm have I done you to be
punished, sir?

Amph.

Harm? You reprobate! Still making
a joke of me, are you?

Sos.

You would have a right to call me
names, if that was so. But I am not
lying, sir: it happened just as I say.

Amph.

The man is drunk, I do believe.

Sos.

Utinam ita essem.

Amph.

575 Optas quae

facta.

Sos.

Egone?

Amph.

Tu istic. ubi bibisti?

Sos.

Nusquam equidem bibi.

Amph.

Quid hoc sit

hominis?

Sos.

576 Equidem decies dixi:

577 domi ego sum, inquam, ecquid
audis?

et apud te adsum Sosia idem.

578 satin hoc plane, satin diserte,
ere, nunc videor
tibi locutus esse?

Amph.

579 Vah,

apage te a me.

Sos.

580 Quid est negoti?

Amph.

Pestis te tenet.

Sos.

Nam quor istuc
dicis? equidem valeo el salvos

(*heartily*) Wish I was!

Amph.

(*dryly*) Your wish is already
gratified.

Sos.

Is it?

Amph.

It is. Where did you get drink?

Sos.

I did not, not I, nowhere.

Amph.

(*despairingly*) What am I to make
of the fellow?

Sos.

I have told you how it is ten times
over: I am at home, I say. Do you
hear that? Yes, and I am here with
you, the same Sosia. There sir, do
you think that is putting it plainly
enough, lucidly enough for you?

Amph.

(*shoving him aside*) Bah! Get
away with you.

Sos.

What is the matter?

Amph.

You have the plague.

Sos.

Why, what do you say that for?
Really, sir, I feel well, I am all

sum recte, Amphitruo.

Amph.

583 At te ego faciam
hodie proinde ac meritis es,
584a ut minus valeas et miser sis,
584b salvos domum si rediero: iam
585a sequere sis, erum qui ludificas
585b dictis delirantibus,

qui quoniam erus quod imperavit
neglexisti persequi,
nunc venis etiam ultro inrisum
dominum: quae neque fieri
possunt neque fando umquam accepit
quisquam proferens, carnifex;
quod ego hodie in tergum faxo ista
expetant mendacia.

Sos.

590 Amphitruo, miserrima ista
miseria est servo bono,
apud erum qui vera loquitur, si id vi
verum vincitur.

Amph.

Quo id, malum, pacto potest nam—
mecum argumentis puta—
fieri, nunc uti tu et hic sis et domi? id
dici volo.

Sos.

Sum profecto et hic et illic. hoc
cuius mirari licet,
neque tibi istuc mirum¹⁷ magis
videtur quam mihi.

Amph.

right.

Amph.

But I shall soon see you get your
deserts: you will not feel so well,
you will be wretched enough, once
I get back home all right. Be so
good as to follow me, you that
make a butt of your master with
your idiotic drivel.

Seeing you neglected to carry out
your master's orders, you now
have the effrontery to come and
laugh at him, to boot,—with your
tales of what can never happen,
what no man ever heard of, you
rascal. By heaven, those lies
of yours shall fall on your own
back, I promise you!

Sos.

(*plaintively*) It is hard, sir, horribly
hard, on a good servant that tells
his master plain facts to have his
facts confuted by a flogging.

Amph.

Curse it! How in the world is it
possible—argue it out with me—
for you to be here now, and at
home, too? Tell me that, will you?

Sos.

I am here and I am there, I
positively am. I don't care who
wonders at it: it is no more
wonderful to you than it is to me,
sir.

Amph.

Quo modo?

Sos.

Nihilo, inquam, mirum magis
tibi istuc quam mihi;
neque, ita me di ament, credebam
primo mihimet Sosiae,
donec Sosia illic egomet fecit sibi uti
crederem.
ordine omne, uti quicque actum est,
dum apud hostis sedimus,
600 edissertavit. tum formam una
abstulit cum nomine.
neque lac lactis magis est simile
quam ille ego similest mei.
nam ut dudum ante lucem a portu me
praemisisti domum—

Amph.

Quid igitur?

Sos.

Prius multo ante aedis
stabam quam illo adveneram.

Amph.

Quas, malum, nugas? satin tu sanus
es?

Sos.

Sic

sum ut vides.

Amph.

Huic homini nescio quid est mali
mala obiectum manu,
postquam a me abiit.

Sos.

How is that?

Sos.

I say it is not a bit more wonderful
to you than to me. So help me
heaven, I didn't believe my own
self, Sosia, at first, not till that
other Sosia, myself, made me
believe him. He reeled off every
thing just as it happened while we
were on the field there with the
enemy; and besides, he had stolen
my looks along with my name.
One drop of milk is no more like
another than that I is like me. Why,
when you sent me ahead home
from the harbour before dawn a
while ago—

Amph.

What then?

Sos.

I was standing in front of the
house long before I got there.

Amph.

What confounded rubbish! Are
you actually in your senses?

Sos.

You can see for yourself I am.

Amph.

The fellow is bewitched somehow:
the evil hand has been laid on him
since he left me.

Sos.

Fateor, nam sum obtusus
pugnis pessume.

Amph.

Quis te verberavit?

Sos.

Egomet memet, qui
nunc sum domi.

Amph.

Cave quicquam, nisi quod rogabo te,
mihi responderis.
omnium primum iste qui sit Sosia,
hoc dici volo.

Sos.

Tuos est servos.

Amph.

610 Mihi quidem uno te
plus etiam est quam volo,
neque postquam sum natus habui nisi
te servom Sosiam.

Sos.

At ego nunc, Amphitruo, dico:

Sosiam servom tuom
praeter me alterum, inquam,
adveniens faciam ut offendas
domi,

Davo prognatum patre eodem quo
ego sum, forma, aetate item
qua ego sum. quid opust verbis?
geminus Sosia hic factust tibi.

Amph.

Nimia memoras mira. sed vidistin
uxorem meam?

Sos.

Right you are! Evil? The way I got
beaten to jelly was damned evil.

Amph.

Who was it beat you?

Sos.

I beat myself—the I that is at
home now.

Amph.

Mind now, not a word but what I
ask you. In the first place, I wish to
be informed who that Sosia is.

Sos.

Your own slave.

Amph.

As a matter of fact, I have one too
many in you already, and never in
my life did I own a slave named
Sosia except yourself.

Sos.

Well sir, you mark my words now:
I warrant you you will come upon
a second servant Sosia of yours
besides me when you reach home,
yes sir, one whose father was
Davus the same as mine, and who
is just like me and just my age,
too. Enough said, sir. Sosia has
twinned here for you.

Amph.

(*impressed*) Strange, very strange
indeed! But did you see my wife?

Sos.

Quin intro ire in aedis numquam
licitum est.

Amph.

Quis te prohibuit?

Sos.

Sosia ille, quem iam dudum dico, is
qui me contudit.

Amph.

Quis istic Sosia est?

Amph.

Ego, inquam.
quotiens dicendum est tibi?

Amph.

Sed quid ais? num obdormivisti
dudum?

Sos.

Nusquam gentium.

Amph.

Ibi forte istum si vidisses quendam in
somnia Sosiam—

Sos.

Non soleo ego somniculose eri
imperia persequi.
vigilans vidi, vigilans nunc te video,
vigilans fabulor,
vigilantem ille me iam dudum
vigilans pugnis contudit.

Why, sir, never a foot was I
allowed to put in the house.

Amph.

Who hindered you?

Sos.

That Sosia I have been telling of
all along, the one that smashed me
up.

Amph.

Who is that Sosia?

Amph.

I am, I say. How many times do
you need to be told?

Amph.

(*reflecting*) But look here, you
were not asleep a while ago, were
you?

Sos.

Not a bit of it, sir.

Amph.

Then perhaps, if you had seen that,
well, that Sosia of yours in your
dreams—

Sos.

I don't do my master's orders
drowsily. Wide awake I was, eyes
open; I am wide awake with 'em
open on you now; I am wide
awake telling my story; and I was
wide awake when he hammered
me a while back, yes, and
(*ruefully*) he was wide awake.

Amph.
 Quis homo?
Sos.
 Sosia, inquam, ego ille.
 quaeso, nonne intellegis?
Amph.
 Qui, malum, intellegere quisquam
 potis est? ita nugas blatis.

Sos.
 Verum actutum nosces, quom illum
 nosces servom Sosiam.

Amph.
 Sequere hac igitur me, nam mi istuc
 primum exquisito est opus.¹⁸ (628)

Amph.
 Who?
Sos.
 Sosia, I tell you, that me. Pray do
 not you understand?
Amph.
 How the devil can any man
 understand? Such stuff and
 nonsense!
Sos.
 (*significantly*) Well, you will know
 what I mean very soon, once you
 know that servant Sosia.
Amph.
 (*going toward house*) Come then,
 this way. This matter needs my
 investigation first of all. (*stops to
 examine house from distance and
 talks with Sosia*)

II. 2.

Alc.
 633 Satin parva res est voluptatum in vita
 atque in aetate agunda
 praequam quod molestum est? ita cuique
 comparatum est in aetate hominum;
 ita divis est placitum, voluptatem ut maeror
 comes consequatur:
 quin incommodi plus malique ilico adsit,
 boni si optigit quid.

Scene 2

ENTER *Alcmena* INTO
 DOORWAY.

Alc.
 Oh, are not the pleasures
 in life, in this daily
 round, trifling compared
 with the pains! It is our
 common human lot, it is
 heaven's will, for sorrow
 to come following after
 joy: yes, yes, and to
 have a larger share of
 trouble and distress the

nam ego id nunc exerior domo atque ipsa
de me scio, cui voluptas
parumper datast, dum viri mei mihi potestas
videndi fuit
noctem unam modo; atque is repente abiit a
me hinc ante lucem.
sola hic mihi nunc videor, quia ille hinc
abest quem ego amo praeter omnes. 640
plus aegri ex habitu viri, quam ex adventu
voluptatis cepi.

sed hoc me beat
saltem, quom perduellis vicit et domum
laudis compos revenit:
id solacio est.
absit, dum modo laude parta
domum recipiat se; feram et perferam
usque
abitu eius animo forti atque offirmato, id
modo si mercedis
datur mi, ut meus victor vir belli
clueat.
satis mi esse ducam.
virtus praemium est optimum;
virtus omnibus rebus anteit profecto:
650 libertas salus vita res et parentes, patria et
prognati
tutantur, servantur:

moment something nice
has happened.

Ah, I am learning this
now at first hand,
learning it of my own
experience—a few short
hours of happiness,
allowed to see my
husband for just one
night; and then away he
goes all of a sudden
before daylight! It does
seem so lonely here
now, when the one I
love best is gone. I have
felt more unhappy at his
going than happy at his
coming.

But there is thus much
to be thankful for, at
least: he has been
victorious and come
home a hero—that is
one comfort. He may
leave me, if only he
returns to me with a
glorious name: I will
bear his going, yes, and
keep on bearing it to the
end firmly and
unflinchingly, only let
me have the reward of
hearing my husband
hailed conqueror. That is
enough for me! Courage
is the very best gift of
all; courage stands

virtus omnia in sese habet, omnia
adsunt
bona quem penest virtus

Amph.

Edepol me uxori exoptatum credo
adventurum domum,
quae me amat, quam contra amo, praesertim
re gesta bene,
victis hostibus. quos nemo posse superari
ratust,
eos auspicio meo atque ductu primo coetu
vicimus
certe enim med illi expectatum optato
venturum scio.

Sos.

Quid? me non rere expectatum amicae
venturum meae?

Alc.

Meus vir hic quidem est.

Amph.

before everything, it
does, it does! It is what
maintains and preserves
our liberty, safety, life,
and our homes and
parents, our country and
children. Courage
comprises all things: a
man with courage has
every blessing.

Amph.

By Jove, my wife will
certainly be delighted to
have me home—loving
each other as we do!
Especially now that we
have been successful,
and the enemy, that
every one thought
invincible, beaten,
beaten at the first set-to
under my auspices and
leadership. Ah yes, my
arrival will surely be a
very welcome event to
her.

Sos.

What? And don't you
think mine is going to be
welcome to my lady
friend?

Alc.

(*seeing them*) Why, here
is my husband!

Amph.

Sequere hac tu me.

Alc.

660 Nam quid ille
revortitur,
qui dudum properare se aibat? an ille me
temptat sciens
atque id se volt experiri, suom abitum ut
desiderem?
ecastor med haud invita se domum recipit
suam.

Sos.

Amphitruo, redire ad navem meliust nos.

Amph.

Qua gratia?

Sos.

Quia domi daturus nemo est prandium
advenientibus

Amph.

Qui tibi nunc istuc in mentemst?

Sos.

Quia enim sero advenimus.

Amph.

Qui?

Sos.

(*to Sosia*) Here you, this way! (*goes on toward house*)

Alc.

(*aside*) What in the world is he back for so soon after saying he must hurry off! Is he trying me on purpose, does he want to test how much I miss him when he goes? Bless his heart, I have no objection to his coming home again!

Sos.

(*seeing her*) We had better make for the ship once more, sir.

Amph.

Why?

Sos.

No one at home is going to give the new arrivals a breakfast, that is why.

Amph.

And how does that thought happen to occur to you?

Sos.

Because we've come too late.

Amph.

How so?

Sos.

Quia Alcumenam ante aedis stare
saturam intellego.

Amph.

Gravidam ego illanc hic reliqui, quom abeo.

Sos.

Ei perii

miser.

Amph.

Quid tibi est?

Sos.

Ad aquam praebendam
commodum adveni domum,
670 decumo post mense, ut rationem te putare
intellego

Amph.

Bono animo es.

Sos.

Scin quam bono animo sim? si
situlam cepero,
numquam edepol tu mihi divini creduis post
hunc diem,
ni ego illi puteo, si occepso, animam omnem
inter traxero.

Amph.

(*pointing*) Well, there's
mistress in front of the
house, and she has a sort
of well-fed look about
her.

Amph.

I had hopes when I went
away, Sosia, of being
made a father.

Sos.

Heaven help me!

Amph.

What is the matter?

Sos.

(*disgustedly*) I have got
home exactly in time to
draw the water: it is the
tenth month since,
according as I follow
your reckoning.

Amph.

(*laughing*) Cheer up,
cheer up!

Sos.

Know how cheerful I
am, do you, sir? Let me
get hold of a bucket, and
by gad, don't ever trust
my sacred oath again, if
I do not drain that well
of its last breath, once I
begin.

Amph.

Sequere hac me modo, alium ego isti rei
allegabo, ne time.

Alc.

Magis nunc me meum officium facere, si
huic eam advorsum, arbitror.

Amph.

Amphitruo uxorem salutat laetus speratam
suam,
quam omnium Thebis vir unam esse
optimam diiudicat,
quamque adeo cives Thebani vero rumiferant
probam.
valuistin usque? exspectatum advenio?

Sos.

Haud vidi

magis.
680 exspectatum eum salutat magis haud
quicquam quam canem.

Amph.

Et quom te¹⁹ gravidam et quom te pulchre
plenam aspicio, gaudeo.

Alc.

Come now, this way
with me. (*moves toward
house again*) I will
appoint some one else to
that office, never fear.

Alc.

(*aside*) I suppose it
would be more duteous
of me to go to meet him.
(*advances slowly*)

Amph.

(*with playful
courtliness*) Gladly does
Amphitryon greet his
darling wife, whom her
husband judges to be the
one best lady in all
Thebes; yea, and justly
do the citizens of Thebes
bruit her virtue.
(*earnestly*) Have you
been well all this time?
Are you glad to see me?

Sos.

(*aside*) Glad? None
more so! Welcomes him
about as warmly as she
would a dog!

Amph.

Ah, it is splendid to see
your condition, dear, and
to see you getting on so
finely.

Alc.

Obsecro ecastor, quid tu me deridiculi gratia
sic salutas atque appellas, quasi dudum non
videris
quasique nunc primum recipias te domum
huc ex hostibus?²⁰ (684)

Amph.

(686) Immo equidem te nisi nunc hodie
nusquam vidi gentium.

Alc.

Cur negas?

Amph.

Quia vera didici dicere.

Alc.

Haud aequom
facit
qui quod didicit id dediscit. an periclitamini
quid animi habeam? sed quid huc vos
revortimini tam cito?
690 an te auspiciū commoratum est an
tempestas continet
qui non abiisti ad legiones, ita uti dudum
dixeras?

Amph.

Good gracious! Why are
you making fun of me
with all these greetings
and salutations, as if you
had not seen me a little
while ago and were just
this moment back from
the war?

Amph.

(surprised) Why, why,
but I have not seen you
—no, nowhere at all
except this very instant.

Alc.

What makes you deny
it?

Amph.

Because I have learned
to tell the truth.

Alc.

It is not a good plan to
learn a thing and then
unlearn it. Or is this a
test of my feelings? But
why are you returning
so quickly? Were you
delayed by bad omens,
or is it the weather
detains you, that you
have not gone away to
the army, as you spoke
of doing a little while
ago?

Amph.

Alc.

Equidem ecastor vigilo, et vigilans id quod
factum est fabulor.
nam dudum ante lucem et istunc et te vidi.

Amph.

loco?

Alc.

Hic in aedibus ubi tu habitas.

Amph.

factum est.

Sos.

taces?

quid si e portu navis huc nos dormientis
detulit?

Amph.

Etiam tu quoque adsentaris huic?

Sos.

Quid vis fieri?
non tu scis? Bacchae bacchanti si velis
advorsarier,
ex insana insaniorem facies, feriet saepius;
si obsequare, una resolves plaga.

(*indignantly*) To be sure
I am awake, and awake
as I relate what
happened. Why, just a
little while ago before
dawn I saw that man and
you, both.

Amph.

Where was this?

Alc.

Here in your very own
house, sir.

Amph.

Impossible!

Sos.

Hush, sir, hush! What if
the ship carried us here
from the harbour in our
sleep?

Amph.

Ha! you are siding with
her too, are you?

Sos.

(*wisely*) Well, what do
you want? Don't you
understand? You but
cross a Bacchante when
the Bacchic frenzy fills
her, and you'll make the
crazy thing crazier still
and she'll hit you all the
more: humour her, and

Amph.

At pol qui certa
res
hanc est obiurgare, quae me hodie
advenientem domum
noluerit salutare.

Sos.

Inritabis crabrones.

Amph.

Tace.

Alcumena, unum rogare te volo.

Alc.

Quid vis

roga.

Amph.

Num tibi aut stultitia accessit aut superat
superbia?

Alc.

710 Qui istuc in mentemst tibi ex me, mi vir,
percontarier?

Amph.

Quia salutare advenientem me solebas
antidhac,

she'll call it quits after
one blow.

Amph.

Humour her? By the
Lord, it will be bad
humour, that's sure,—
arriving home to-day
and she unwilling to
give me a decent
welcome!

Sos.

You'll be poking up a
hornet's nest.

Amph.

Silence! (*to Alcmena,
sternly*) Alcmena, there
is something I wish to
ask you.

Alc.

Anything you please.

Amph.

Are you obsessed by
some foolish notion, or
is this pride running
away with you?

Alc.

What makes it enter
your head to ask me
such a question, my
husband?

Amph.

Because till to-day you
used to welcome me on

appellare, itidem ut pudicae suos viros quae
sunt solent.
eo more expertem te factam adveniens
offendi domi.

Alc.

Ecce equidem te certo heri advenientem
ilico,
et salutavi et valuissesne usque exquisivi
simul,
mi vir, et manum prehendi et osculum tetuli
tibi.

Sos.

Tu heri hunc salutavisti?

Alc.

Et te quoque etiam,

Sosia.

Sos.

Amphitruo, speravi ego istam tibi parituram
filium;
verum non est puero gravida.

Amph.

Quid igitur?

Sos.

Insania.

Alc.

my arrival and greet me
as modest wives
generally do their
husbands. Yet here I
come home to find you
have dropped the habit.

Alc.

Why mercy me, when
you came home
yesterday I certainly did
welcome you the
moment you appeared,
and asked you in the
same breath if you had
been well all the time,
and seized your hand
and gave you a kiss.

Sos.

Welcomed him
yesterday, did you?

Alc.

Yes, and you, too, Sosia.

Sos.

Sir, I hoped she was
going to bear you a son;
but it's no child she's
got.

Amph.

What, then?

Sos.

A crazy streak.

Alc.

720 Equidem sana sum et deos quaeso, ut
salva pariam filium.
verum tu malum magnum habebis, si his
suom officium facit:
ob istuc omen, ominator, capies quod te
condecet.

Sos.

Enim vero praegnati oportet et malum et
malum dari,
ut quod obrodat sit, animo si male esse
occeperit.

Amph.

Tu me heri hic vidisti?

Alc.

Ego, inquam, si vis decies
dicere.

Amph.

In somnis fortasse?

Alc.

Immo vigilans vigilantem.

Amph.

mihi.

Sos.

Ei misero

(*angrily*) Indeed I have
not, and I pray heaven I
may safely bear a son.
But you, sir, shall have
an ample supply of
aches and pains, if your
master here does his
duty! You shall be well
rewarded for that omen,
Sir Omener.

Sos.

Really now, ma'am, it's a
lady in your condition
ought to have aches and
pains, yes, and an apple
supply, too, so as to
have something to chew
on in case she gets to
feeling seedy.

Amph.

You saw me here
yesterday?

Alc.

Yes, I,—if you must be
told ten times over.

Amph.

In your sleep, perhaps?

Alc.

No, no, awake,—and
you were awake, too.

Amph.

Oh, this is terrible,
terrible!

Sos.

Quid tibi est?

Amph.

Delirat uxor.

Sos.

Atra bili percita est.
nulla res tam delirantis homines concinnat
cito.

Amph.

Ubi primum tibi sensisti, mulier,
impliciscier?

Alc.

Equidem ecastor sana et salva sum.

Amph.

730 Quor igitur praedicas,
te heri me vidisse, qui hac noctu in portum
advecti sumus?
ibi cenavi atque ibi quievi in navi noctem
perpetem,
neque meum pedem huc intuli etiam in
aedis, ut cum exercitu
hinc profectus sum ad Teloboas hostis
eosque ut vicimus.

Alc.

Immo mecum cenavisti et mecum cubuisti.

Amph.

What ails you?

Amph.

Sos.

Bilious attack, sir, black
bile. There's nothing sets
'em raving so soon.

Amph.

When did you first feel
it coming on, woman?

Alc.

Goodness me! I'm
perfectly sane and
sound.

Amph.

Then why are you
declaring you saw me
yesterday, when we
reached port last night? I
took dinner there and
spent the whole livelong
night there on board my
ship, and I have not set
foot in this house from
the time I and my troops
started on our campaign
against the Teloboians
and conquered them.

Alc.

The idea! You had
dinner with me and went
to bed with me.

Amph.

	Quid	What?
est?		
<i>Alc.</i>		<i>Alc.</i>
Vera dico.		I tell you the truth, sir.
<i>Amph.</i>		<i>Amph.</i>
Non de hac quidem hercle re; de aliis nescio.		Good God! Not in that, anyhow: about other matters I can't say.
<i>Alc.</i>		<i>Alc.</i>
Primulo diluculo abiisti ad legiones.		And at the very break of day you went away to the army.
<i>Amph.</i>		<i>Amph.</i>
	Quo	How's that?
modo?		
<i>Sos.</i>		<i>Sos.</i>
Recte dicit, ut commeminit: somnium narrat tibi.		Quite straight, sir, as far as her memory goes:
sed, mulier, postquam experrecta es, te prodigiali Iovi		she's giving you her dream. But I say, ma'am,
740 aut mola salsa hodie aut ture comprecata oportuit.		this morning after you woke up you ought to have taken some salted cakes, or incense, and prayed to Jove—he has charge of prodigies.
<i>Alc.</i>		<i>Alc.</i>
Vae capiti tuo.		Oh confound you, sir!
<i>Sos.</i>		<i>Sos.</i>
Tua istuc refert—si curaveris.		(innocently) That would do you good, ma'am—if you would see to it.
<i>Alc.</i>		<i>Alc.</i>

Iterum iam hic in me inclementer dicit, atque
id sine malo.

Amph.

Tace tu. tu dic: egone abs te abii hinc hodie
cum diluculo?

Alc.

Quis igitur nisi vos narravit mi, illi ut fuerit
proelium?

Amph.

An etiam id tu scis?

Alc.

Quippe qui ex te audivi, ut
urbem maximam
expugnassess regemque Pterelam tute
occideris.

Amph.

Egone istuc dixi?

Alc.

Tute istic, etiam adstante
hoc Sosia.

Amph.

Audivistin tu me narrare haec hodie?

Sos.

There he is, rude to me
again, and not suffering
for it!

Amph.

(to *Sosia*) Keep still,
you! (to *Alcmena*) And
you—I left you this
morning at daybreak,
did I?

Alc.

Why, who else but you
two told me how the
battle there went?

Amph.

You don't mean to say
you know about that?

Alc.

Naturally, since I heard
from your own lips how
you took that great city
and killed King Pterelas
yourself.

Amph.

I told you that, I?

Alc.

Yes, you yourself,—
with *Sosia* here standing
by, too.

Amph.

(to *Sosia*) Have you ever
heard me say a word of
this?

Sos.

Ubi ego

audiverim?

Amph.
Hanc roga.

Sos.
Me quidem praesente numquam
factum est, quod sciam.

Alc.
Mirum quin te adversus dicat.

Amph.
aspice. 750 Sosia, age me huc

Sos.
Specto.

Amph.
Vera volo loqui te, nolo adsentari
mihi.
audivistin tu hodie me illi dicere ea quae illa
autumat?

Sos.
Quaeso edepol, num tu quoque etiam
insanis, quom id me interrogas,
qui ipse equidem nunc primum istanc
tecum conspicio simul?

Amph.

Heard you? Where?

Amph.
(sullenly) Ask her.

Sos.
You never did so far as I
know, leastways with
me at hand.

Alc.
(ironically) It is strange
he declines to contradict
his own master.

Amph.
Sosia, here! Look me in
the eye.

Sos.
(obeying) Very good, sir.

Amph.
What I want from you is
the truth, no
obsequiousness. Did you
ever hear me utter a
syllable of what she
says?

Sos.
Well, upon my word, I
should like to ask if you
are not crazy yourself,
asking me a question
like that—and I just this
minute setting eyes on
her for the first time
along with you?

Amph.

Quid nunc, mulier? audin illum?

Alc.

Ego vero, ac falsum
dicere.

Amph.

Neque tu illi neque mihi viro ipsi credis?

Alc.

Eo fit quia mihi
plurimum credo et scio istaec facta proinde
ut proloquor.

Amph.

Tun me heri advenisse dicis?

Alc.

Tun te abiisse hodie
hinc negas?

Amph.

Nego enim vero, et me advenire nunc
primum aio ad te domum.

Alc.

760 Obsecro, etiamne hoc negabis, te auream
pateram mihi
dedisse dono hodie, qua te illi donatum esse
dixeras?

Amph.

What now, madam? Do
you hear him?

Alc.

To be sure I do—telling
lies.

Amph.

You won't believe him,
or me, your own
husband, either?

Alc.

That is only because I
believe myself most of
all, and I know
everything occurred just
as I tell you.

Amph.

And you say that I
arrived yesterday?

Alc.

And you deny that you
left to-day?

Amph.

Deny it? Of course I do.
And I say I'm just now
coming home to you for
the first time.

Alc.

And will you deny this,
too, pray,—that you
gave me the golden
bowl to-day that was
presented to you there,
as you said?

Amph.

Neque edepol dedi neque dixi; verum ita
animatus fui
itaque nunc sum, ut ea te patera donem. sed
quis istuc tibi dixit?

Alc.

Ego equidem ex te audiui et ex tua accepi
manu pateram.

Amph.

Mane, mane, obsecro te. nimis demiror,
Sosia,
qui illaec illic me donatum esse aurea patera
sciat,
nisi tu dudum hanc convenisti et narravisti
haec omnia.

Sos.

Neque edepol ego dixi neque istam vidi nisi
tecum simul.

Amph.

Quid hoc sit hominis?

Alc.

Vin proferri pateram?

Amph.

By heaven! I neither
gave it nor said it. But I
did intend to make you a
gift of that bowl, and do
still. Who told you of
that, though?

Alc.

Why, I heard about it
from your own lips and
received the bowl from
your own hand.

Amph.

One moment, please,
one moment! (*turning to
Sosia*) It is very
extraordinary. Sosia,
how she knows I was
presented with a golden
bowl there, unless you
met her a while ago
yourself and told her the
whole story.

Sos.

By gad, sir, I never told
her, no, nor saw her,
except here with you.

Amph.

(*helplessly*) What sort of
a creature have I got
here?

Alc.

Would you like to have
the bowl brought?

Amph.

volo.
Alc.
 770 Fiat heus tu, Thessala, intus pateram
 proferto foras,
 qua hodie meus vir donavit me.

Amph.

 Secede huc tu,
 Sosia,
 enim vero illud praeter alia mira miror
 maxime,
 si haec habet pateram illam.

Sos.
 An etiam credis id, quae in
 hac cistellula
 tuo signo obsignata fertur?

Amph.
 Salvom signum
 est?
Sos.

 Inspice.

Amph.
 Recte, ita est ut obsignavi.

Sos.

Indeed I should.

Alc.
 Very well. (*calling to
 maid within*) Ho, there!
 Thessala, bring out the
 bowl my husband gave
 me to day.

Amph.
 Sosia! Come over here.
 (*they withdraw
 somewhat*) Upon my
 soul, it will be the most
 astounding of all these
 astounding
 circumstances, if she has
 that.

Sos.
 Do you really believe
 that, sir, when I've got it
 in this little chest here,
 sealed with your own
 signet?

Amph.
 Is the seal intact?

Sos.
 (*showing chest*) Look
 and see.

Amph.
 (*doing so*) It is all right
 —just as I sealed it.

Sos.

Quaesio, quin tu istanc
iubes
pro cerrita circumferri?

Amph.

Edepol qui facto est opus;
nam haec quidem edepol larvarum plenast.

Alc.

Quid verbis opust?
em tibi pateram, eccam.

Amph.

Cedo mi.

Alc.

Age aspice huc sis
nunciam
tu qui quae facta infitiare, quem ego iam hic
convincam palam
estne haec patera qua donatu's illi?

Amph.

Summe Iuppiter,
quid ego video? haec ea est profecto patera.
perii, Sosia.

Sos.

Aut pol haec praestigiatrix multo mulier
maxima est
aut pateram hic inesse oportet.

For heaven's sake, why
don't you have her
treated for lunacy?

Amph.

By Jove, so I should!
Why, bless my soul,
she's full of evil spirits!

ENTER *Thessala* WITH
BOWL.

Alc.

Are you satisfied, sir?
There! Your bowl, see!

Amph.

(*dumbfounded*) Give it
here!

Alc.

Come now, be so good
as to look at it, you that
do a thing and then
disown it. I shall refute
you plainly, sir, here and
now. Is this the bowl
which they presented to
you there, or not?

Amph.

(*taking it*) Jove
almighty! What do I
see? The selfsame bowl,
it is, it is! This is
frightful, Sosia!

Sos.

By gad, she's either the
greatest enchantress
alive, easily, or the bowl

Amph.

cistulam.

Sos.

Quid ego istam exsolvam? obsignatast recte,
res gesta est bene:
tu peperisti Amphitruonem, ego alium peperī
Sosiam;
nunc si patera pateram peperit, omnes
congeminauimus.

Amph.

Certum est aperire atque inspicere.

Sos.

Vide sis signi quid
siet,
ne posterius in me culpam conferas.

Amph.

Aperi modo;
nam haec quidem nos delirantis facere dictis
postulat.

Alc.

Unde haec igitur est nisi abs te quae mihi
dono data est?

Amph.

Opus mi est istuc exquisito.

must be inside here.
(*pointing to chest*)

Amph.

Come, come, unfasten
the chest!

Sos.

Unfasten it? Why? It's
sealed all right,
everything is shipshape.
You have spawned
another Amphitryon; I
have spawned another
Sosia; now if the bowl
has spawned another
bowl, we've all doubled.

Amph.

I'm resolved: it must be
opened and inspected.

Sos.

You please take a look at
the seal, sir, so that you
won't blame me later.

Amph.

(*looking*) Yes, yes, open
up! Why, the woman is
bent on driving us mad
with her talk.

Alc.

Where did this come
from, then, if not as a
present from you?

Amph.

(*curtly*) This matter
needs my investigation.

Sos.

Iuppiter, pro Iuppiter.

Amph.

Quid tibi est?

Sos.

Hic patera nulla in cistulast.

Amph.

Quid ego

audio?

Sos.

Id quod verumst.

Amph.

At cum cruciatu iam, nisi
apparet, tuo.

Alc.

Haec quidem apparet.

Amph.

Quis igitur tibi dedit?

Alc.

Qui me

rogat.

Sos.

Me captas, quia tute ab navi clanculum huc
alia via
praecucurristi, atque hinc pateram tute
exemisti atque eam
huic dedisti, post hanc rursum obsignasti
clanculum.

Sos.

(*busy with chest*) By
Jove! Oh, by Jove!

Amph.

(*excited*) What is it?

Sos.

There's no bowl in the
chest here at all!

Amph.

What's that you say?

Sos.

It's the honest truth.

Amph.

But your skin shall soon
pay for it, if it's not
forthcoming.

Alc.

This one is forthcoming,
at any rate.

Amph.

(*roughly*) Who gave it
you, then?

Alc.

(*calmly*) My questioner.

Sos.

(*to Amphitryon*) Trying
to catch me! The fact is
you ran on ahead from
the ship yourself by
another road on the sly,
and took the bowl out

Amph.
Ei mihi, iam tu quoque huius adiuvas
insaniam?
an heri nos advenisse huc?

Alc.
Aio, adveniensusque
ilico
800 me salutavisti, et ego te, et osculum tetuli
tibi.
Sos.
Iam illud non placet principium de osculo.

Amph.
Perge
exsequi.
Alc.
Lavisti.
Amph.
Quid postquam lavi?
Alc.
Accubuisti.

Sos.

yourself, and gave it to
her, and then sealed up
the chest again on the
sly.

Amph.
Oh, ye gods! So now
you are abetting her
delusions, too! (*to*
Alcmena, with forced
calmness) We came here
yesterday, you say?

Alc.
Yes, and the moment
you arrived you greeted
me, and I you, and I
gave you a kiss.

Sos.
Now I don't like that,
that beginning with a
kiss!

Amph.
Go on, go on!

Alc.
Then you bathed.

Amph.
And after bathing?

Alc.
You took your place on
the dining couch.

Sos.

Euge

optime,
nunc exquire.
Amph.
Ne interpella. perge porro
dicere.

Alc.
Cena adposita est, cenavisti mecum, ego
accubui simul.

Amph.
In eodem lecto?
Alc.
In eodem.

Sos.
Ei, non placet
convivium.
Amph.
Sine modo argumenta dicat. quid postquam
cenavimus?

Alc.
Te dormire aibas, mensa ablata est.
cubitus hinc abiimus.

Amph.
Ubi tu cubuisti?
Alc.

Bravo, sir! Great work!
Now get to the bottom
of it.

Amph.
(to *Sosia*) No
interruptions! (to
Alcmena) Go on with
your story.

Alc.
Dinner was served: we
dined together: I took
my place on the couch,
too.

Amph.
The same couch?
Alc.
Surely.

Sos.
Oho! This banqueting
looks bad!

Amph.
(to *Sosia*) That will do.
Let her state her case.
(to *Alcmena*) What after
we dined?

Alc.
You said you were
sleepy: the table was
removed: we went off to
bed.

Amph.
Where did you sleep?
Alc.

In eodem lecto tecum una
in cubiculo.
Amph.
Perdidisti.
Sos.
Quid tibi est?
Amph.
Haec me modo ad
mortem dedit.
Alc.
Quid iam, amabo?
Amph.
Ne me appella.
Sos.
Quid tibi est?
Amph.
810 Perii
miser,
quia pudicitiae huius vitium me hinc absente
est additum.
Alc.
Obsecro ecaster, cur istuc, mi vir, ex ted
audio?
Amph.
Vir ego tuos sim? ne me appella, falsa, falso
nomine.
Sos.

Why, with you, in our
room.
Amph.
Oh, my God!
Sos.
What ails you?
Amph.
She has killed me, killed
me!
Alc.
Why, my dear man,
what do you mean?
Amph.
(furiously) Don't speak
to me!
Sos.
What ails you?
Amph.
Oh, God help me! She's
been seduced while I
was gone!
Alc.
Good heavens! For
mercy's sake how can
you say such a thing, my
dear husband?
Amph.
Am I your husband? Oh,
you false wretch, none
of your false names for
me!
Sos.

Haeret haec res, si quidem haec iam mulier
facta est ex viro.

Alc.

Quid ego feci, qua istaec propter dicta
dicantur mihi?

Amph.

Tute edictas facta tua, ex me quaeris quid
deliqueris.

Alc.

Quid ego tibi deliqui, si, cum nupta sum,
tecum fui?

Amph.

Tun mecum fueris? quid illac impudente
audacius?
saltem, tute si pudoris egeas, sumas mutuom.

Alc.

820 Istuc facinus, quod tu insimulas, nostro
generi non decet.
tu si me inpudicitiai captas, capere non
potes.

Amph.

Pro di immortales, cognoscin tu me saltem,
Sosia?

Here's a pretty mess, if
he is turned into a
woman and is not her
husband!

Alc.

What have I done to be
talked to like that?

Amph.

You have recounted
your doings yourself—
and you ask me what the
harm is!

Alc.

Pray tell me what I have
done in being with you,
the man I married?

Amph.

You with me? Of all
brazen shamelessness!
You might at least
borrow some sense of
decency, if you have
none of your own!

Alc.

Such behaviour as you
accuse me of does not
become members of my
family, sir. Angle for me
if you wish, you cannot
catch me in such
unspeakable conduct.

Amph.

Great God! You know
me, anyhow, Sosia, don't
you?

Sos.

Propemodum.

Amph.

Cenavin ego heri in navi in
portu Persico?

Alc.

Mihi quoque adsunt testes, qui illud quod
ego dicam adsentiant.

Sos.

Nescio quid istuc negoti dicam, nisi si
quispiam est
Amphitruo alius, qui forte ted hinc absenti
tamen
tuam rem curet teque absente hic munus
fungatur tuom.
nam quod de illo subditivo Sosia mirum
nimis,
certe de istoc Amphitruone iam alterum
mirum est magis.

Amph.

830 Nescio quis praestigiator hanc frustratur
mulierem.

Alc.

Sos.

Well, rather!

Amph.

Didn't I dine yesterday
on shipboard at Port
Persicus?

Alc.

Yes, and I too have
witnesses to corroborate
what I say.

Sos.

I can't puzzle it out, sir,
unless there's some other
Amphitryon to manage
your business, no matter
if you are away, and to
do your job for you
when you have gone. I
tell you what, that sham
Sosia was monstrous
surprising, but this
second Amphitryon is
certainly more so.

Amph.

Some magician or other
has bedevilled the
woman!

Alc.

Per supremi regis regnum iuro et matrem
familias
Iunonem, quam me vereri et metuere est par
maxume,
ut mi extra unum te mortalis nemo corpus
corpore
contigit, quo me impudicam faceret.

Amph.

Vera istaec velim.

Alc.

Vera dico, sed nequiquam, quoniam non vis
credere.

Amph.

Mulier es, audacter iuras.

Alc.

Quae non deliquit,
decet
audacem esse, confidenter pro se et proterve
loqui.

Amph.

Satis audacter.

Alc.

Ut pudicam decet.

Amph.

Enim verbis

proba's. [21](#)

Alc.

(*slowly and impressively*) I swear by
the kingdom of the King
on high and by Juno, the
matron goddess I most
should reverence and
fear—so may she bless
me as no mortal man,
save you only, has taken
me to him as a wife.

Amph.

Ah, I wish it was the
truth!

Alc.

It is the truth, but what
of that, when you refuse
to believe me!

Amph.

You're a woman; you
swear boldly.

Alc.

A woman who has done
nothing wrong ought to
be bold, yes, and self
confident and forward in
her own defence.

Amph.

Bold, with a vengeance!

Alc.

As innocence should be.

Amph.

Yes, you're immaculate
as far as talk goes.

Alc.

Non ego illam mihi dotem duco esse, quae
dos dicitur,
840 sed pudicitiam et pudorem et sedatum
cupidinem,
deum metum, parentum amorem et
cognatum concordiam,
tibi morigera atque ut munifica sim bonis,
prosim probis.

Sos.

Ne ista edepol, si haec vera loquitur,
examussum est optima.

Amph.

Delenitus sum profecto ita, ut me qui sim
nesciam.

Sos.

Amphitruo es profecto, cave sis ne tu te usu
perduis:
ita nunc homines immutantur, postquam
peregre advenimus.

Amph.

Mulier, istam rem inquisitam certum est non
amittere.

(*quietly*) Personally I do not feel that my dowry is that which people call a dowry, but purity and honour and self control, fear of God, love of parents, and affection for my family, and being a dutiful wife to you, sir, lavish of loving-kindness and helpful through honest service.

Sos.

My word! She's a regular pattern of perfection, if she's telling the truth.

Amph.

Upon my soul, I have been so bewitched I don't know who I am!

Sos.

You're Amphitryon right enough, sir—but just look out you don't lose your title to yourself by limitation, the way folks are getting changed about these days since we came back from abroad.

Amph.

(*to Alcmena, sternly*) This matter shall not escape investigation,

Alc.

Edepol me libente facies.

Amph.

Quid ais? responde

mihi.

quid si adduco tuom cognatum huc ab navi
Naucratem,

850 qui mecum una vectust una navi, atque is
si denegat

facta quae tu facta dicis, quid tibi aequom est
feri?

numquid causam dicis, quin te hoc multem
matrimonio?

Alc.

Si deliqui, nulla causa est.

Amph.

Convenit. tu, Sosia,

duc hos intro. ego huc ab navi mecum
adducam Naucratem.

Sos.

Nunc quidem praeter nos nemo est. dic mihi
verum serio:

ecquis alius Sosia intust, qui mei similis siet?

madam, I am resolved
on that.

Alc.

Dear me, sir, do
investigate, and
welcome!

Amph.

See here, answer me this
—what if I bring your
own relative, Naucrates,
over from the ship? He
made the voyaage with
me on the same vessel—
now if he denies that I
did as you say what do
you deserve? Have you
any reason to give that I
should not divorce you?

Alc.

None, if I have done
wrong.

Amph.

Agreed! (*turning to
Sosia*) Sosia, take these
fellows in. (*pointing to
slaves with luggage*) I
will bring Naucrates
here from the ship.
(*Sosia sends slaves
inside*)

[EXIT *Amphitryon*.

Sos.

(*to Alcmena,
confidentially*) Now
then, ma'am, no one's

Alc.
Abin hinc a me dignus domino servos?

Sos.

Abeo, si iubes.

Alc.
Nimis ecaster facinus mirum est, qui illi
conlibitum siet
meo viro sic me insimulare falso facinus tam
malum.
860 quicquid est, iam ex Naucrate cognato id
cognoscam meo.

ACTVS III

Iup.
Ego sum ille Amphitruo, cui est
servos Sosia.
idem Mercurius qui fit, quando
commodumst,
in superiore qui habito cenaculo,

here besides us.
(*elaborately makes sure
of it*) Do be serious and
tell me the truth—is
there another Sosia
inside who's just like
me?

Alc.
(*indignantly*) Will you
leave my sight, sir—you
slave worthy of your
master!

Sos.

Sure, ma'am, if you say
so.

[EXIT INTO HOUSE.]

Alc.
Merciful heavens! It's
simply unintelligible,
how my husband could
think fit to accuse me of
such atrocious conduct
without the slightest
cause. Well, whatever it
is, I shall soon know
about it from Naucrates,
one of my own family.
[EXIT INTO HOUSE.]

ACT III

Jup.
(*in jocular, self-satisfied tone*) I am
that Amphitryon who has a servant
Sosia, which same turns into
Mercury on occasion, I being the
Amphitryon who lodge in the

qui interdum fio Iuppiter, quando
lubet;
huc autem quom extemplo adventum
adporto, ilico
Amphitruo fio et vestitum immuto
meum.

nunc huc honoris vestri venio gratia,
ne hanc inchoatam transigam
comoediam;
simul Alcumenae, quam vir insontem
proberi
870 Amphitruo accusat, veni ut
auxilium feram:
nam mea sit culpa, quod egomet
contraxerim,
si id Alcumenae innocenti expetat.

nunc Amphitruonem memet, ut
occepi semel,
esse adsimulabo, atque in horum
familiam
frustrationem hodie iniciam
maximam;
post igitur demum faciam res fiat
palam
atque Alcumenae in tempore
auxilium feram
faciamque ut uno fetu et quod
gravida est viro
et me quod gravidast pariat sine
doloribus.

880 Mercurium iussi me continue
consequi,
si quid vellem imperare. nunc hanc
adloquar.

upper attic (*pointing heavenward*)
and become Jupiter at times, when
the humour seizes me. As soon as I
wend my way into these parts,
however, on the spot I am
Amphitryon and change my
clothes.

I now appear out of regard for you,
so as not to terminate this inchoate
comedy. At the same time I am
here to help out Alcmena, poor
innocent, denounced as disloyal by
her lord, Amphitryon. For it would
be sinful of me, if the storm I have
brewed should descend on the
head of guileless Alcmena.

I will pretend for the present to be
Amphitryon myself, as I have
already, and thoroughly confound
this family to-day, Then, after that,
I will eventually clear matters up,
yes, and aid Alcmena in due
season, contriving that she give
birth at one time to both the
children she carries, her husband's
and my own, without a pang.
Mercury has his orders to attend
me closely, in case I have
commands to give. Now for a
word with the lady.

III. 2.

Alc.

Durare nequeo in aedibus. ita me
probri,
stupri, dedecoris a viro argutam meo!
ea quae sunt facta infecta ut reddat
clamitat.

quae neque sunt facta neque ego in
me admisi arguit;
atque id me susque deque esse
habituram putat.

non edepol faciam, neque me
perpetiar probri
falso insimulatam, quin ego illum aut
deseram
aut satis faciat mi ille atque adiuret
insuper,
890 nolle esse dicta quae in me
insontem protulit.

Iup.

Faciendum est mi illud, fieri quod
illaec postulat,
si me illam amantem ad sese studeam
recipere,
quando ego quod feci, id factum
Amphitruoni offuit
atque illi dudum meus amor
negotium
insonti exhibuit, nunc autem insonti
mihi
illius ira in hanc et male dicta
expetent.

Scene 2

ENTER *Alcmena* FROM HOUSE.

Alc.

I can't stand staying in the house!
To be branded so with shame,
disloyalty, disgrace, by my own
husband! How he clamours to
make facts no facts! And what
never happened, things I never,
never did, he accuses me of, and
thinks I'll consider it quite
immaterial.

Good gracious, but I won't! I won't
endure such an awful, unjustified
accusation: I will leave him, or he
must apologize, one or the other,
yes, and swear he is sorry, too, for
the things he has said to an
innocent woman.

Jup.

(*aside, dryly*) Hm! It's incumbent
upon me to meet her demands, if I
wish the loving creature to take me
into her good graces again. Since
my doings offended Amphitryon,
and this love affair of mine lately
occasioned his guiltless self some
consternation, it is turn about now,
and my guiltless self has to suffer
for the scorn and contumely he
heaped on her.

Alc.

Sed eccum video qui me miseram
arguit
stupri, dedecoris.

Iup.

Te volo, uxor,
conloqui.
quo te avortisti?²²

Alc.

Ita ingenium
meumst:
900 inimicos semper osa sum
optuerier.

Iup.

Heia autem inimicos?

Alc.

Sic est, vera
praedico;
nisi etiam hoc falso dici
insimulaturus es.

Iup.

Nimis iracunda es.

Alc.

Potin ut abstineas
manum?
nam certo, si sis sanus aut sapias
satis,
quam tu impudicam esse arbitrere et
praedices,
cum ea tu sermonem nec ioco nec
serio

Alc.

(*aside, seeing him*) Ah, there he is
—the man that charges his
wretched wife with disloyalty and
shame!

Jup.

I wish to speak with you, my dear.
(*circling her as she turns her back
on him*) Turned away? Where to?

Alc.

It is natural I should, sir: I always
loathed looking at enemies.

Jup.

Oh, I say now! Enemies?

Alc.

Yes, enemies: and that's the truth
of it—unless you intend to term
this a lie, too.

Jup.

(*trying to fondle her*) You're too
irritable.

Alc.

(*pulling away*) Can't you keep
your hands off? Why surely, sir, if
you were sane or had a particle of
sense about you, when you think
your wife is immodest and tell her
so yourself, you wouldn't hold any
conversation with her at all in jest
or earnest, unless you were the
silliest of silly men.

tibi habeas, nisi sis stultior
stultissimo.

Iup.

Si dixi, nihilo magis es, neque ego
esse arbitror,
et id huc revorti uti me purgarem tibi.
910 nam numquam quicquam meo
animo fuit aegrius,
quam postquam audiui ted esse
iratum mihi.
cur dixisti? inquires. ego expediam
tibi.

non edepol quo te esse impudicam
crederem;
verum periclitatus sum animum
tuum,
quid faceres et quo pacto id ferre
induceres.
equidem ioco illa dixeram dudum
tibi,
ridiculi causa. vel hunc rogato
Sosiam.

Alc.

Quin huc adducis meum cognatum
Naucratem,
testem quem dudum te adducturum
dixeras,
te huc non venisse?

Iup.

920 Si quid dictum est
per iocum,
non aequum est id te serio
praevortier.

Alc.

Jup.

My saying so doesn't make you so
any the more, And I don't think
you so, either; and I've come back
to set myself right with you. For I
never did feel sicker at heart about
anything than after I heard you
were provoked with me. "Why did
you say it?" you'll ask. I'll clear up
that point for you.

Bless your heart, it wasn't because
I believed you were immodest. I
was just testing your feelings to
see what you'd do and how you'd
take it. (*forcing a laugh*) Really it
was all a joke, what I said just
now, merely a bit of fun. Why, you
can ask Sosia here. (*pointing to
house*)

Alc.

(*coldly*) Why do you not bring my
relative Naucrates, as you just now
said you would, to prove you had
not been here?

Jup.

If something is said in joke, it's not
fair to take it in earnest.

Alc.

Ego illud scio quam doluerit cordi
meo.

Iup.

Per dexteram tuam te, Alcmena, oro
obsecro.
da mihi hanc veniam, ignosce, irata
ne sies.

Alc.

Ego istaec feci verba virtute irrita;
nunc, quando factis me impudicis
abstini,
ab impudicis dictis avorti volo.
valeas, tibi habeas res tuas, reddas
meas.
iuben mi ire comites

Iup.

Sanan es?

Alc.

Si

non iubes,
ibo egomet; comitem mihi
Pudicitiam duxero.²³ 930

Iup.

Mane. arbitrato tuo ius iurandum
dabo,
me meam pudicam esse uxorem
arbitrarier.
id ego si fallo, tum te, summe
Iuppiter,
quaeso, Amphitruoni ut semper iratus
sies.

Alc.

I know one thing—that joke of
yours cut me to the heart, sir.

Jup.

(*seizing her hand*) I beg and
beseech you, Alcmena, by this
right hand of yours, do forgive me
for it; pardon me: don't be angry!

Alc.

Your charges are refuted by my
honest life; now, sir, having been
guiltless of gross behaviour, I will
not be subjected to gross language.
Good bye. Keep your own things
and return me mine. Will you order
my attendants to follow me? (*turns
to go*)

Jup.

Are you in your senses?

Alc.

If you decline to do so, I will go
with my woman's honour as my
only escort. (*walks away*)

Jup.

(*holding her*) Wait, wait! I'll swear
to it—at your dictation—that I
believe my wife is virtuous. If I
deceive you in this, then, Jove
almighty, I invoke thy curse upon
Amphitryon for evermore.

Alc.

A, propitius sit potius.

Iup.

Confido fore;
nam ius iurandum verum te
advorsum dedi.
iam nunc irata non es?

Alc.

Non sum.

Iup.

Bene
facis.
nam in hominum aetate multa
eveniunt huius modi:
capiunt voluptates, capiunt rursum
miserias;
940 irae interveniunt, redeunt rursum
in gratiam.
verum irae si quae forte eveniunt
huius modi
inter eos, rursum si reventum in
gratiam est,
bis tanto amici sunt inter se quam
prius.

Alc.

Primum cavisse oportuit ne diceres,
verum eadem si isdem purgas mi,
patiunda sunt.

Iup.

Iube vero vasa pura adornari mihi,
ut quae apud legionem vota vovi. si
domum

(hurriedly) Oh no! His blessing,
his blessing!

Jup.

I trust to have it, for it is a reliable
oath I have given you. (*drawing
her close*) Now you're not angry,
are you?

Alc.

(submitting) No.

Jup.

(caressing her) That's a good girl.
Why, life is full of incidents of this
sort. Human beings lay hold on
pleasures and then again on pains.
Quarrels come between them, and
then they are reconciled again. But
if any such quarrel as this does
happen to arise between them, then
when it blows over they are twice
as fond of one another as they
were before.

Alc.

You should have been careful not
to say such a thing in the first
place; but if you apologize so
nicely for hurting me so, I can't
complain.

Jup.

Well, well, then, have the
sacrificial vessel prepared for me
so that I can pay all the vows I

rediissem salvos, ea ego exsolvam
omnia.

Alc.

Ego istuc curabo.

Iup.

Evocate huc

Sosiam;

950 gubernatorem, qui in mea navi
fuit

Blepharonem arcessat, qui nobiscum
prandeat

is adeo²⁴ inpransus ludificabitur,
cum ego Amphitruonem collo hinc
obstricto traham.

Alc.

Mirum quid solus secum secreto ille
agat.

atque aperiuntur aedis. exit Sosia.

vowed for a safe return home
when I was in the field.

Alc.

I will attend to that.

Jup.

(*to maids in doorway*) Call Sosia
out. I want him to invite Blepharo,
the pilot aboard my ship, to lunch
with us. (EXEUNT *maids*) (*aside*) As
a matter of fact, friend Blepharo
will be left unlunched and looking
foolish when I turn Amphitryon
out neck and crop.

Alc.

(*aside*) I wonder what he's talking
about all to himself! Ah, there goes
the door! Sosia's coming out.

III. 3.

Sos.

Amphitruo, assum. si quid opus est, impera,
imperium exequar.

Iup.

Sosia, optume advenis.

Sos.

Iam pax est inter vos duos?
nam quia vos tranquillos video, gaudeo et
volup est mihi.

Scene 3.

ENTER *Sosia*.

Sos.

Present, sir. If anything's
needed, order away and I'll
fulfil orders.

Jup.

Sosia, you are the very
man I want.

Sos.

Is there peace between you
two now, sir? I tell you
what, it's a pleasure, it's a
joy, to see you looking

atque ita servom par videtur frugi sese
instituere
960 proinde eri ut sint, ipse item sit; voltum e
vultu comparet
tristis sit, si eri sint tristes; hilarus sit, si
gaudeant
sed age responde: iam vos rediistis in
concordiam?

Iup.

Derides, qui scis haec dudum me dixisse per
iocum.

Sos.

An id ioco dixisti? equidem serio ac vero
ratus.

Iup.

Habui expurigationem; facta pax est.

Sos.

Optume est.

Iup.

Ego rem divinam intus faciam, vota quae
sunt.

Sos.

Censeo.

Iup.

Tu gubernatorem a navi huc evoca verbis
meis

peaceful. Yes, and to my
way of thinking, an honest
servant ought to stick to
this principle: be like what
his betters are, model his
expression on theirs, be in
the dumps if they are in the
dumps, and jolly if they are
happy. But come, sir,
answer me. Have you
made friends again now,
eh?

Jup.

(*reprovingly*) Mocker!
What I said a while ago
was all in fun, and you
know it.

Sos.

In fun, was it? Upon my
soul, I thought it was the
solemn truth.

Jup.

I have explained: peace is
made.

Sos.

That's grand, sir.

Jup.

I will make those offerings
I vowed, inside.

Sos.

Very good, sir.

Jup.

As for you, convey my
invitation to Pilot Blepharo

Blepharonem, qui re divina facta mecum
prandeat.

Sos.

Iam hic ero, cum illic censebis esse me.

Iup.

Actutum huc redi.

Alc.

970 Numquid vis, quin abeam iam intro, ut
apparentur quibus opust?

Iup.

I sane, et quantum potest parata fac sint
omnia.

Alc.

Quin venis quando vis intro? faxo haud
quicquam sit morae.

Iup.

Recte loquere et proinde diligentem ut
uxorem decet.
iam hisce ambo, et servos et era, frustra sunt
duo,
qui me Amphitruonem rentur esse: errant
probe.
nunc tu divine huc fac adsis Sosia—
audis quae dico, tam etsi praesens non ades
—
fac Amphitruonem advenientem ab aedibus
ut abigas; quovis pacto fac commentus sis.

to come over from the ship
and lunch with me after the
sacrifice is done.

Sos.

I'll be here by the time you
think I'm there, sir.

Jup.

Yes, hurry back home.

[EXIT *Sosia*.]

Alc.

Is there anything else, or
shall I go in now and see to
the things you'll need?

Jup.

Do, by all means, and get
everything ready as
quickly as you can.

Alc.

Come in as soon as you
wish. I'll make sure there's
nothing to delay you.

Jup.

(*tenderly*) That's the way
for an attentive wife to
talk.

[EXIT *Alcmena*. There we
are! Both of 'em fooled,
servant and mistress, took
in thinking me
Amphitryon. A sad
mistake! Hark ye, Sosia the
divine, appear! You hear
what I say, even though
absent in the flesh. Drive
Amphitryon away from the

980 volo deludi illunc, dum cum hac usuraria
uxore nunc mihi morigero. haec curata sint
fac sis, proinde adeo ut velle med intellegis,
atque ut ministres mihi, mihi cum
sacrificem.

III. 4.

Mer.

Concedite atque abscedite omnes, de
via decedite,
nec quisquam tam audax fuat homo,
qui obviam obsistat mihi.
nam mihi quidem hercle qui minus
liceat deo minitarier
populo, ni decedat mihi, quam
servolo in comoediis?
ille navem salvam nuntiat aut irati
adventum senis:
ego sum Iovi dicto audiens, eius
iussu nunc huc me adfero.
990 quam ob rem mihi magis par est
via decedere et concedere.

pater vocat me, eum sequor, eius
dicto imperio sum audiens;
ut filium bonum patri esse oportet,
itidem ego sum patri.

house when he arrives—
any device you please.

He must be hoodwinked
while I proceed to divert
myself with my wife on
loan. Kindly see that this is
managed precisely as you
know I wish it to be, and
do me service while I am
sacrificing to myself.

[EXIT *Jupiter*.]

Scene 4.

ENTER *Mercury* HURRIEDLY WITH
BURLESQUE IMPORTANCE.

Mer.

(*to imaginary passers-by*) Get
away, get out, get off the street,
every one! Let no man be so bold
as to block my path. (*to audience*)
For damme, just tell me why a god
like me hasn't as much right to
hector people that hinder him as
your paltry slave in the comedies?
He brings word the ship is safe, or
the choleric old man approaching:
(*magnificently*) as for me, I
hearken to the word of Jove and at
his bidding do I now hie me hither.
Wherefore 'tis still more seemly to
get out, to get off the street for me.
My father calls me; I come,
obedient to his best and will.
(*confidingly*) I am a good son to
my father, as a son should be. I
back him up in his gallantries,

amanti sub parasitor, hortor, adsto,
admoneo, gaudeo.

si quid patri volup est, voluptas ea
mihi multo maxumast.

amat: sapit; recte facit, animo quando
obsequitur suo,
quod omnis homines facere oportet,
dum id modo fiat bono.

nunc Amphitruonem volt deludi
meus pater: faxo probe
iam his deludetur, spectatores, vobis
inspectantibus.

capiam coronam mi ni caput,
adsimulabo me esse ebrium;
1000 atque illuc sursum escendero:
inde optume aspellam virum
de supero, cum huc accesserit;
faciam ut sit madidus sobrius.
deinde illi actutum sufferet suos
servos poenas Sosia:
eum fecisse ille hodie arguet quae
ego fecero hic. quid mea?
meo me aequomst morigerum patri,
eius studio servire addecet.

sed eccum Amphitruonem, advenit;
iam ille hic deludetur probe,
siquidem vos voltis auscultando
operam dare.
ibo intro, ornatum capiam qui potis
debet;
dein susum ascendam in tectum, ut
illum hinc prohibeam.

encourage him, stand by him,
advise him, rejoice with him. If
anything gratifies my father, it
gratifies me infinitely more.

He's in love: he's wise; he does
well to indulge his inclinations. It
is what every one ought to do, that
is within due bounds. At present
my father wishes Amphitryon to
be fooled: fooled he shall be
finely, I promise you, here and
now, spectators, and under your
inspection.

I'm going to put a garland on my
head and make believe I'm drunk,
yes, and I'll climb out on the roof
yonder (*pointing to Amphitryon's
house*) and repel our returning
hero in glorious style from up
above there. I'll see that he's both
soaked and sober. Then that
servant Sosia of his shall promptly
smart for it, Sosia being accused of
doing what I do here. But what of
that? I must humour my own
father: it is only dutiful to meet his
desires.

(*looking down street*) But there's
Amphitryon coming! Here and
now he'll be finely fooled—if
you'll only take the trouble to
attend. I'll go inside and make up
as a person flown with wine; then
I'll up on the roof to keep him off.
[EXIT INTO HOUSE.]

ACTVS IV

Amph.

Naucratem quem convenire volui, in
navi non erat,
1010 neque domi neque in urbe
invenio quemquam qui illum
viderit.

nam omnis plateas perreptavi,
gymnasia et myropolia;
apud emporium atque in macello, in
palaestra atque in foro,
in medicinis, in tonstrinis, apud
omnis aedis sacras
sum defessus quaeritando. nusquam
invenio Naucratem.

nunc domum ibo atque ex uxore hanc
rem pergam exquirere,
quis fuerit quem propter corpus suum
stupri compleverit
nam me, quam illam quaestionem
inquisitam hodie amittere,
mortuom satrust. sed aedis
occluserunt. eugepae,
pariter hoc fit atque ut alia facta sunt.
feriam foris.
1020 aperite hoc. heus, ecquis hic est?
ecquis hoc aperit ostium?

IV. 2.

Mer.

Quis ad fores est?

ACT IV

ENTER *Amphitryon* WEARILY.

Amph.

Naucrates, whom I wanted to get
hold of wasn't on the ship, and not
a soul can I find at his house or in
the city who has seen him. Why,
I've hobbled through every street,
gymnasium, and perfumery shop:
down in the bazaar and the market,
at the athletic field and the forum,
too, at the doctor's, the barber's,
the holy temples from first to last,
—I'm tired to death looking for
him and not a sign of Naucrates
anywhere.

Now I'm going home and ask my
wife some more questions about
this, and (*savagely*) find out who it
is she has prostituted herself for.
Ah, I'd sooner die than let the day
pass without having this matter
settled. (*trying door*) Well! they've
locked up the house! Nice doings!
Quite in accord with the rest of it.
I'll knock. (*does so*) Open up here!
Hey! is anyone in? Open—
somebody! (*knocks more lustily*)

Scene 2.

Mercury, MUCH DISHEVELED,
APPEARS ON ROOF.

Mer.

(*thickly*) Who's at the door?

<i>Amph.</i>		<i>Amph.</i>
	Ego sum.	I am.
<i>Mer.</i>		<i>Mer.</i>
	Quid ego sum?	I am, eh?
<i>Amph.</i>		<i>Amph.</i>
	Ita loquor.	(<i>sharply</i>) So I say.
<i>Mer.</i>		<i>Mer.</i>
	Tibi	Jupiter and ... all the ... gods ... are
Iuppiter		surely angry at you ... demolishing
dique omnes nati certo sunt, qui sic		our door so.
frangas fores.		
<i>Amph.</i>		<i>Amph.</i>
Quo modo?		What do you mean!
<i>Mer.</i>		<i>Mer.</i>
Eo modo, ut profecto vivas		Here's ... what I mean ... you're
aetatem miser.		certainly going to have a bad, bad
		time of it.
<i>Amph.</i>		<i>Amph.</i>
Sosia.		(<i>sternly</i>) Sosia!
<i>Mer.</i>		<i>Mer.</i>
Ita, sum Sosia, nisi me esse		Just so! That's me ... unless you
oblitum existimas.		think I've forgotten. Now what do
quid nunc vis?		... you want?
<i>Amph.</i>		<i>Amph.</i>
Sceleste, at etiam quid		Rascal! Do you actually dare ask
velim, id tu me rogas.		me that—what I want?
<i>Mer.</i>		<i>Mer.</i>
Ita, rogo. paene effregisti, fatue,		Of course I do. You've almost
foribus cardines		hammered the doors off their
an foris censebas nobis publicitus		hinges, you ... stupid. Didn't
praeberier?		suppose we were supplied with
		doors at public expense, did you?

quid me aspectas, stolidus? quid nunc
vis tibi? aut quid tu es homo?

Amph.

Verbero, etiam quis ego sim me
rogitas, ulmorum Acheruns?
1030 quem pol ego hodie ob istaec
dicta faciam ferventem flagris.

Mer.

Prodigum te fuisse oportet olim in
adulescentia.

Amph.

Quidum?

Mer.

Quia senecta aetate a me
mendicas malum.

Amph.

Cum cruciatu tuo istaec hodie, verna,
verba funditas.

Mer.

Sacrufico ego tibi.

Amph.

Qui?

Mer.

Quia enim te
macto infortunio.

What are you staring at me for,
you ... booby? What are you after
now? Who are you?

Amph.

You scoundrel! Still asking me
who I am, you death on rods, you?
By gad, I'll warm you up with a
whip to day for this insolence!

Mer.

You must have been a waster ... in
your ... younger days.

Amph.

How so?

Mer.

Well ... here you are in your
declining years begging ... me for
trouble.

Amph.

You shall soon suffer for this flow
of language, you drudge.

Mer.

I'm sacrificing to ye, I am.

Amph.

How?

Mer.

(slyly poisoning a pail of water)
Why, because I'm making you an
offering of a ... calamity.

-

*At this point there is a gap in the MSS. Only a few
lines have been preserved. Leo outlines the lost part
as follows: After Mercury has had sufficient*

amusement with Amphitryon, the disturbance calls Alcmena from within. She has a dispute with her husband—Jupiter had left her earlier so that he might offer sacrifice—and shuts him out of the house. Perhaps Amphitryon went away to summon friends to aid him: at any rate, Sosia appears with Blepharo and gets a bad welcome from his master, despite Blepharo's patronage, and then escapes. Jupiter comes out of the house. Husband and lover abuse each other vigorously and a scuffle ensues. Blepharo is appealed to by Amphitryon, only to be made ridiculous by Jupiter.

-			
Amph.		Amph.	
I		But I'll make you an offering of	
At ego te cruce et cruciatu mactabo,		torture and torment, you whipping	
mastigia.		post.	
Mer.		Mer.	
II		The master, Amphitryon, is busy.	
Erus Amphitruost occupatus.			
Mer.		Mer.	
III		— now you still have a chance	
(XV LG) abiendi nunc tibi etiam		to leave.	
occasiost.			
Mer.		Mer.	
IV		It would serve you right to have a	
(III)		pot of ashes broken on your head.	
Optimo iure infringatur aula cineris			
in caput.			
Mer.		Mer.	
V		You would certainly ask to have	
(IV)		one jar of water emptied on your	
Ne tu postules matulam unam tibi		head.	
aquae infundi in caput			

Mer.

VI

(VII)

Larvatu's edepol hominem miserum
medicum quaerita.

Alc.

VII

(XI)

Exiuravisti te mihi dixisse per iocum.

Alc.

VIII

(XII)

Quaeso advenienti morbo medicari
iube

tu certe aut larvatus aut cecus es.

Alc.

IX

(XIII)

Nisi hoc ita factum est, proinde ut
factum esse autumo,
non causam dico quin vero insimules
proberi.

Amph.

X

(XVI)

Cuius? quae me absente corpus
volgavit suum.

Amph.

XI

(V)

Quid minitabas te facturum, si istas
pepulissem fores?

Amph.

Mer.

Bewitched! Dear, dear! poor man!
Look for a doctor.

Alc.

You swore solemnly that you said
it to me in fun.

Alc.

For mercy's sake have this disease
treated at the outset; you surely are
bewitched or crazed.

Alc.

If this did not take place just as I
state, you have every right to
accuse me of unchastity.

Amph.

Whose? A woman that prostituted
herself in my absence!

Amph.

What were you threatening to do,
if I pounded on that door?

Amph.

XII

(VI)

Ibi scrobes ecfodito tu plus
sexagenos in die.

Amph.

XIII

(XVII)

Noli pessimo precari

Bleph.

XIV

(XVIII) animam comprime

Iup.

XV

(IX)

Manifestum hunc optorto collo teneo
furem flagiti

Amph.

XVI

(X)

Immo ego hunc, Thebani cives, qui
domi uxorem meam

impudicitia impedivit, teneo,
thensaurum stupri

Amph.

XVII

(VIII)

Nilne te pudet, scelestes, populi in
conspectum ingredi?

Amph.

XVIII

(XIX) clandestino.

Amph. sive Iup.

There dig more than sixty ditches a
day.

Amph.

Don't intercede for an utter rascal.

Bleph.

—— save your breath.

Jup.

I have him by the scruff of the
neck, an outrageous thief caught in
the act.

Amph.

No, no, Theban citizens, I have
him, the monster of lust who has
brought disgrace on my wife at
home.

Amph.

Aren't you at all ashamed, you
villain, to come out into public
sight?

Amph.

—— clandestinely.

Amph. or Iup.

XIX

(XIV)

Qui nequeas nostrorum uter sit
Amphitruo decernere.

You who are unable to decide
which of us is Amphitryon.

IV. 3.

Bleph.

Vos inter vos partite; ego abeo, mihi
negotium est;
neque ego umquam usquam tanta mira me
vidisse censeo.

Amph.

Blepharo, quaeso ut advocatus mi adsis
neve abeas.

Bleph.

Vale.
quid opust me advocato, qui utri sim
advocatus nescio?

Iup.

Intro ego hinc eo. Alcumena parturit.

Amph.

Perii
miser.
1040 quid ego faciam, quem advocati iam
atque amici deserunt?

Scene 3.

Bleph.

(*disgustedly*) You must
untangle your own selves: I'm
going: I have an engagement.
(*aside*) Never did I see such
marvels anywhere, I do
believe. (*turns to go*)

Amph.

Blepharo! Stand by me, for
mercy's sake, and be my
assistant: don't go!

Bleph.

Good-bye. What's the use of
my being an assistant when I
don't know which to be it to?
[EXIT *Blepharo*.]

Jup.

(*aside*) I'm going inside
myself: Alcmena's delivery is
at hand.

[EXIT *Jupiter* INTO HOUSE,
UNSEEN BY *Amphitryon*.]

Amph.

(*wildly*) Heavens! oh,
Heavens! What shall I do now
when assistants and friends
desert me? By the Lord, that
villain shall never make game
of me and escape, whoever he

numquam edepol me inultus istic
 ludificabit, quisquis est;
 nam iam ad regem recta me ducam resque
 ut facta est eloquar.²⁵
 ego pol illum ulciscar hodie Thessalum
 veneficum,
 qui pervorse perturbavit familiae mentem
 meae.
 sed ubi illest? intro edepol abiit, credo ad
 uxorem meam.
 qui me Thebis alter vivit miserior? quid
 nunc agam?
 quem omnes mortales ignorant et
 ludificant ut lubet.
 certumst, intro rumpam in aedis: ubi
 quemque hominem aspexero,
 si ancillam seu servom sive uxorem sive
 adulterum
 1050 seu patrem sive avom videbo,
 obtruncabo in aedibus.
 neque me Iuppiter neque di omnes id
 prohibebunt, si volent,
 quin sic faciam ut constitui. pergam in
 aedis nunciam.

ACTVS V

Brom.

is! I'll go straight to the king
 this moment and tell him all
 as it happened. I swear I'll
 have my revenge this day on
 that Thessalian sorcerer who
 has turned the wits of my
 household topsy-turvy.
(looking around) Where is he,
 though? Good God! He's gone
 inside—to my wife, no doubt!

Oh, of all miserable men in
 Thebes! What shall I do now?
 Disowned and humbugged by
 every mortal soul to suit their
 humour! *(pause)* My mind's
 made up—I'll burst into the
 house, and every human
 creature there I set my eyes
 on, maid or man, wife or
 paramour, father or
 grandfather, I'll cut them
 down in my halls! And not the
 will of Jupiter and all the gods
 shall stop my doing as I've
 determined! I'll in this
 minute! *(he rushes toward
 door: a peal of thunder: he
 falls to ground motionless)*

ACT V

(Half an hour has elapsed.)

ENTER *Bromia* FROM HOUSE, IN
 A PANIC.

Brom.

Spes atque opes vitae meae iacent
sepultae in pectore,
neque ullast confidentia iam in corde,
quin amiserim;
ita mihi videntur omnia, mare terra
caelum, consequi,
iam ut opprimar, ut enicer. me miseram,
quid agam nescio.

ita tanta mira in aedibus sunt facta. vae
miserae mihi,
animo malest, aquam velim. corrupta sum
atque absumpta sum.
caput dolet, neque audio, nec oculis
prospicio satis,
1060 nec me miserior femina est neque ulla
videatur magis.

ita erae meae hodie contigit. nam ubi
parturit, deos sibi invocat,
strepitus, crepitus, sonitus, tonitrus:
ut subito, ut propere, ut valide
tonuit!
ubi quisque institerat, concidit crepitu. ibi
nescio quis maxuma
voce exclamat: "Alcumena, adest
auxilium, ne time:
et tibi et tuis propitius caeli cultor
advenit.
exsurgite" inquit "qui terrore meo
occidistis prae metu."

Oh, my hopes and chances of
getting out of this alive are
dead and buried inside of me!
There's not a thing left to keep
my courage up now! The way
everything—sea, land, sky—
does seem set on crushing me,
killing me off this instant! Oh
dear, oh dear! What to do I
don't know.

Such amazing things as did
happen in there! Oh, poor me!
I feel faint. Oh, for some
water! I'm a wreck, I'm all
done up. My head's splitting,
and I can't hear or see right,
either. There isn't a
wretcheder woman on earth,
or one that could seem so,
either.

The experience mistress did
have this day! As soon as her
time comes she calls on the
gods to help her, and there's a
grumbling and rumbling and
smashing and crashing—what
a crash, so sudden and quick
and heavy it was! Every one
fell flat where he stood at the
peal. And then some one or
other called out in a mighty
voice: "Alcmena, help is at
hand: be not afraid. To thee
and thine the sovereign of the
skies comes in kindness.
Rise," he said, "ye who have

ut iacui, exsurgo. ardere censui aedis,
ita tum confulgebant.
ibi me inclamat Alcumena; iam ea res me
horrore adficit,
erilis praevertit metus: accurro, ut
sciscam quid velit.
1070 atque illam geminos filios pueros
peperisse conspicio;
neque nostrum quisquam sensimus, quom
peperit, neque providimus.

sed quid hoc? quis hic est senex, qui
ante aedis nostras sic iacet?
numnam hunc percussit
Iuppiter?
credo edepol, nam, pro Iuppiter, sepultus
quasi sit mortuos.
ibo et cognoscam, quisquis est. Amphitruo
hic quidem est erus meus.
Amphitruo.

Amph.

Perii.

Brom.

Surge.

Amph.

Interii.

Brom.

fallen in terror, from dread of
me."

Having dropped, I got on my
feet: I thought the house was
afire, the way it was all lit up
then. Just then Alcmena calls
for me to come. I was
trembling already at what
happened, but fear of mistress
prevailed, and up I run to find
out what she wants. And there
I see she has given birth to
twins, boys, and not a soul of
us noticed when it happened,
or is ready for it!

(*sees prostrate Amphitryon*)
But what's this? Who's this
old man lying like this in
front of our house? Why, can
it be he's struck by lightning?
Why, mercy me, I do believe
so! For, good gracious, he's as
completely disposed of as if
he was a corpse! I'll go find
out, whoever it is.

(*approaches*) It's Amphitryon!

It's my master! (*calling*)

Amphitryon!

Amph.

(*feebly*) Heaven help me!

Brom.

Get up, sir.

Amph.

I'm dead!

Brom.

	Cedo manum.	Give me your hand, sir. (<i>takes it</i>)
<i>Amph.</i>		<i>Amph.</i>
	Quis me	Who has hold of me?
tenet?		
<i>Brom.</i>		<i>Brom.</i>
Tua Bromia ancilla.		Your servant maid, sir, Bromia.
<i>Amph.</i>		<i>Amph.</i>
Totus timeo, ita me inrepuuit Iuppiter. nec secus est, quasi si ab Acherunte veniam. sed quid tu foras egressa es?		I'm paralysed with fear! Oh, Jove, what a bolt! I feel as if I were getting back—from the next world. (<i>he gets up</i>) But what made you come out?
<i>Brom.</i>		<i>Brom.</i>
Eadem nos formido timidas terrore impulit 1080 in aedibus, tu ubi habitas. nimia mira vidi. vae mihi, Amphitruo, ita mihi animus etiam nunc abest.		We poor women were struck with the same terror in this house of yours, sir. I've seen the most amazing things! Oh deary me, master, I'm just clean dazed even now!
<i>Amph.</i>		<i>Amph.</i>
	Agedum	Come, come, quick, tell me— do you know me for your master, Amphitryon?
expedi: scin me tuom esse erum Amphitruonem?		
<i>Brom.</i>		<i>Brom.</i>
	Scio.	Surely, sir.
<i>Amph.</i>		<i>Amph.</i>
	Vide etiam	Here, look, look again!
nunc.		
<i>Brom.</i>		<i>Brom.</i>
	Scio.	(<i>obeying</i>) Surely, sir.

Amph.

Haec sola sanam mentem gestat meorum
familiarium.

Brom.

Immo omnes sani sunt profecto.

Amph.

At me uxor
insanum facit
suis foedis factis.

Brom.

At ego faciam, tu idem
ut aliter praedices,
Amphitruo, piam et pudicam esse tuam
uxorem ut scias.
de ea re signa atque argumenta paucis
verbis eloquar.
omnium primum: Alcumena geminos
peperit filios.

Amph.

Ain tu, geminos?

Brom.

Geminos.

Amph.

Di me servant.

Brom.

Sine me
dicere,
1090 ut scias tibi tuaeque uxori decs esse
omnis propitios.

Amph.

Amph.

(*half aside*) She's the only one
of my household that has any
sanity about her.

Brom.

Oh no, sir, they're all sane, of
course they are.

Amph.

Well, my wife had driven me
insane with her infamous
actions!

Brom.

(*warmly*) Well, I'll make you
change that tune, sir, your
very own self, and make you
realize that your wife is a
pious, honest woman, sir. I'll
soon give you signs and
proofs of that. First of all, she
has given birth to twin sons.

Amph.

What's that—twins?

Brom.

Twins.

Amph.

The gods are with me!

Brom.

Let me go on, so that you may
know all the gods mean well
by you and your wife, sir.

Amph.

Loquere.

Brom.

Postquam parturire hodie uxor
occepit tua,
ubi utero exorti dolores, ut solent
puerperae
invocat deos immortales, ut sibi auxilium
ferant,
manibus puris, capite operto. ibi continuo
contonat
sonitu maxumo; aedes primo ruere
rebamur tuas.
aedes totae confulgebant tuae, quasi
essent aureae.

Amph.

Quaeso absolvito hinc me extemplo,
quando satis deluseris.
quid fit deinde?

Brom.

Dum haec aguntur, interea
uxorem tuam
neque gementem neque plorantem
nostrum quisquam audivimus;
1100 ita profecto sine dolore peperit.

Amph.

Iam istuc
gaudeo,
utut erga me merita est.

Brom.

Mitte ista atque haec
quae dicam accipe.

Yes, yes.

Brom.

After she began to feel near
her time to-day and her pains
were setting in, she called on
the immortal gods to help her
—as women do, sir, in labour
—with clean washed hands
and covered head. She had no
sooner begun than there was a
frightful thunder clap. At first
we thought your house was
tumbling down: your whole
house was shining, sir, just as
if it was gold.

Amph.

For heaven's sake hurry up
and don't keep me on
tenterhooks! I have had
enough of your trifling! What
happened next?

Brom.

While this was going on, not
one of us heard your wife
groan or whimper a bit, sir,
the whole time: that's how she
bore those boys, sir—never a
pang, that's plain.

Amph.

(heartily) Well now, I'm glad
of that, no matter what her
behaviour to me has been.

Brom.

Do let that be, sir, and listen.
After they were born she told

postquam peperit, pueros lavere iussit nos.
occepimus.

sed puer ille quem ego lavi, ut magnus et
multum valet!

neque eum quisquam colligare quivit
incunabulis.

Amph.

Nimia mira memoras; si istaec vera sunt,
divinitus
non metuo quin meae uxori latae
suppetiae sient.

Brom.

Magis iam faxo mira dices. postquam in
cunas conditust,
devolant angues iubati deorsum in
impluvium duo
maximi: continuo extollunt ambo capita.

Amph.

mihi.

Brom.

1110 Ne pave. sed angues oculis omnis
circumvisere.
postquam pueros conspicati, pergunt ad
cunas citi.
ego cunas recessim rursum vorsum
trahere et ducere,
metuens pueris, mihi formidans; tantoque
anguis acius
persequi. postquam conspexit anguis ille
alter puer,

us to bathe them. We began.
But that boy I bathed! How
big and strong he was! Not a
soul of us could wrap him in
his swaddling clothes.

Amph.

A most astounding story! If it
be true, there's no doubt that
my wife received divine aid.

Brom.

You'll call this more
astounding still, sir, I warrant
you. After he was tucked in
his cradle, two enormous
crested serpents came slipping
down into the fountain basin:
the next second both of them
were lifting up their heads.

Amph.

Heavens and earth!

Brom.

Don't be scared. Well, the
serpents glared around at all
of us. As soon as they spied
the boys they made for the
cradles like a flash. I backed
away, fearful for the boys and
frightened for myself, pulling
and hauling the cradles along
after me with the serpents a-
chasing us all the angrier. The
minute that boy I was telling

Ei

citus e cunis exilit, facit recta in anguis
impetum:
alterum alteraprehendit eos manu
perniciter.

Amph.

Mira memoras, nimis formidolosum
facinus praedicas;
nam mihi horror membra misero percipit
dictis tuis.
quid fit deinde? porro loquere.

Brom.

Puer ambo angues enicat.
1120 dum haec aguntur, voce clara
exclamat uxorem tuam—

Amph.

Quis homo?

Brom.

Summus imperator divom atque
hominum Iuppiter.
is se dixit cum Alcumena clam consuetum
cubitibus,
eumque filium suum esse qui illos angues
vicerit;
alterum tuum esse dixit puerum.

Amph.

Pol me haud paenitet,
si licet boni dimidium mihi dividere cum
Iove.
abi domum, iube vasa pura actutum
adornari mihi,
ut Iovis supremi multis hostiis pacem
expetam.

of sets eyes on the serpents
he's up and out of that cradle
in a trice, rushing straight for
'em and grabbing 'em one in
each hand quick as a wink.

Amph.

Astounding! Astounding! A
perfectly horrifying tale!
Mercy on us! why, your very
words palsy me! What then?
Go on, go on!

Brom.

The boy chokes both serpents
to death. While this is going
on, in a clear voice he calls
out the name of your wife—

Amph.

Who does?

Brom.

The almighty ruler of gods
and men, Jupiter. He said that
he himself had secretly shared
Alcmene's bed and that that
was his son who had crushed
the serpents: the other one, he
said, was your own child.

Amph.

Well, well, well! I make no
complaint at being permitted
to have Jove as partner in my
blessings. In with you, girl!
Have sacrificial vessels made
ready for me instantly so that
I may seek the favour of

ego Teresiam coniectorem advocabo et
consulam
quid faciundum censeat; simul hanc rem
ut facta est eloquar.
1130 sed quid hoc? quam valide tonuit. di,
obsecro vostram fidem.

V. 2.

Iup.

Bono animo es, adsum auxilio,
Amphitruo, tibi et tuis:
nihil est quod timeas. hariolos,
haruspices
mitte omnes; quae futura et quae
facta eloquar,
multo adeo melius quam illi, quom
sum Iuppiter.
primum omnium Alcumenae usuram
corporis
cepi, et concubitu gravidam feci filio.
tu gravidam item fecisti, cum in
exercitum
profectu's: uno partu duos peperit
simul.
eorum alter, nostro qui est susceptus
semine,
1140 suis factis te immortalis adficiet
gloria.

omnipotent Jove with ample
offerings.

[EXIT *Bromia*.]

I'll summon Tiresias the
prophet and consult with him
as to what he thinks should be
done, and at the same time tell
him all that's happened,
(*thunder*) But what's this?
That awful thunder peal!
Heaven preserve us!

Scene 2.

Jupiter APPEARS ABOVE.

Jup.

Be of good cheer. I am here with
aid, Amphitryon, for thee and
thine. Thou hast naught to fear.
Seers, soothsayers—have none of
them. I will make known to thee
future and past alike, and better far
than they, moreover, for I am
Jupiter. First of all, then, I took thy
Alcmena to myself and by me she
was made a mother.

By thee too was she with child
when thou didst go forth to war: at
one birth she bore them both. The
one begotten of my seed shall win
thee undying glory by his works.
Live again in fond concord as of
old with thy wife Alcmena: she has
done naught to merit thy reproach:
my power was on her. I now depart

tu cum Alcumena uxore antiquam in
gratiam
redi: haud promeruit quam ob rem
vitio vorteres;
mea vi subactast facere. ego in
caelum migro.

V. 3.

Amph.

Faciam ita ut iubes et te oro,
promissa ut serves tua,
ibo ad uxorem intro, missum facio
Teresiam senem.

nunc, spectatores, Iovis summi causa
clare plaudite.

to heaven.
[EXIT *Jupiter*.]

Scene 3.

Amph.

(*reverently*) Thy will shall be done:
and keep thy word with me, I beg
thee. (*after a pause*) I'll in and see
my wife! No more of old Tiresias!

(*to the audience*)

Now, spectators, for the sake of
Jove almighty, give us some loud
applause.

[EXIT.]

1. None of the Arguments prefixed to the plays is by Plautus. Their date is disputed, the acrostics having been written during the first century B.C., perhaps, the non acrostics later.

2. Corrupt (Leo): *Alcumena* MSS: *illa* Bothe.

3. The genuineness of the Prologues of these plays has long been a moot question. The tendency of the more recent investigators has been to hold that

A. Actors might be whipped on occasion.

B. An allusion to some play in which Jupiter appeared in time to save some situation.

C. Being a slave.

D. Mercury was the patron god of roguery.

all were, at least in part, written by Plautus himself.

[4.](#) Leo brackets following v., 14:

*lucrum ut perenne vobis semper
suppetat.*

[5.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *affero* MSS: *fero*
Acidalius, followed by Lindsay
and others.

[6.](#) Leo assumes lacuna here.

[7.](#) *architectust* Pareus: *architectus*
MSS. Lambinus suggests that the
actor who took the part of Jupiter
may have been a builder.

[8.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *illi* MSS: *ille illi*
Ussing, followed by Lindsay.

[9.](#) Leo brackets following v., 93:

praeterea certo prodit in tragoedia.

[10.](#) Leo brackets following v., 173:

*nec aequom anne iniquom imperet
cogitabit.*

[11.](#) *vicimus vi* MSS: Leo brackets
vicimus.

[12.](#) Corrupt (Leo): "*Convertitur
pro convertit,*" Nonius 480.

[13.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *neme esse*
MSS: among the many
emendations is *sane* (Palmer).

[14.](#) Leo brackets following v., 401:

*qui cum Amphitruone hinc una ieram
in exercitum.*

[15.](#) Leo brackets following v., 489-
90:

et ne in suspicione ponatur stupri

490 *et clandestina ut celetur*
consuetio.

[16.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *si non id ita* J.

[17.](#) Leo notes slight *lacuna* here:
mirum MSS: *mirum mirum*
Spengel.

[18.](#) Leo brackets following v., 629-
632:

sed vide ex navi efferantur quae
imperavi iam omnia.

Sos.

630 *Et memor sum et diligens, ut quae*
imperes comparcant;
non ego cum vino simitu ebibi
imperium tuom.

Amph.

Vtinam di faxint, infecta dicta re
eveniant tua.

[19.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *quom te*
gravidam MSS: *quom gravidam*
Pylades.

[20.](#) Leo brackets following v., 685:
atque me nunc proinde appellas
quasi multo post videris?

[21.](#) *enim verbis probas* Lachmann:
probas vel *proba's* Lindsay: *in*
verbis probas MSS.

[22.](#) Leo notes *lacuna* here. *Ita*
ingenium MSS: *Ita ingeni*
ingenium Seyffert, followed by
Lindsay.

[23.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *duxero* MSS:
adsero Leo.

[24.](#) Leo notes *lacuna* here and
suggests *is a Mercurio impransus.*

[25.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *nam iam* MSS:
iam Gruter.

-

ASINARIA

THE COMEDY OF ASSES

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[ACT II](#)

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ARGVMENTVM

**ARGUMENT OF THE
PLAY**

A manti argento filio auxiliarier
S ub imperio vivens volt senex
 uxorio.
I taque ob asinos relatum pretium
 Saureae
N umerari iussit servolo Leonidae.
A d amicam id fertur. cedit noctem
 filius.
R ivalis amens ob praereptam
 mulierem,
I s rem omnem uxori per parasitum
 nuntiat.
A ccurrit uxor ac virum e lustris rapit.

An old gentleman, whose wife is
 the head of the household, desires
 to give his son financial support in
 a love affair. He therefore had
 some money, brought to Saurea in
 payment for some asses, counted
 out to a certain rascally servant of
 his own, Leonida. This money
 goes to the young fellow's
 mistress, and he concedes his
 father an evening with her. A rival
 of his, beside himself at being
 deprived of the girl, sends word,
 by a parasite, to the old
 gentleman's wife, of the whole
 matter. In rushes the wife and
 drags her husband from the house
 of vice.

PERSONAE

LIBANVS SERVVS
 DEMAENETVS SENEX
 ARGYRIPPVS ADVLESCENS
 CLEARETA LENA
 LEONIDA SERVVS
 MERCATOR
 PHILAENIVM MERETRIX
 DIABOLVS ADVLESCENS
 PARASITVS
 ARTEMONA MATRONA

DRAMATIS PERSONAE

LIBANUS, *slave of Demaenetus.*
 DEMAENETUS, *an old*
gentleman of Athens.
 ARGYRIPPUS, *his son.*
 CLEARETA, *a procuress.*
 LEONIDA, *slave of Demaenetus.*
 A TRADER.
 PHILAENIUM, *a courtesan,*
daughter of Cleareta.
 DIABOLUS, *a young gentleman*
of Athens.
 A PARASITE.
 ARTEMONA, *wife of*
Demaenetus.

Scene:—Athens. A street running
in front of the houses of

*Demaenetus and Cleareta:
between the houses is a narrow
lane.*

PROLOGVS

Hoc agite sultis, spectatores,
nunciam,
quae quidem mihi atque vobis res
vertat bene
gregique huic et dominis atque
conductoribus.
face nunciam tu, praeco, omnem
auritum poplum.

age nunc reside, cave modo ne
gratiis.
nunc quid processerim huc et quid
mihi voluerim
dicam: ut sciretis nomen huius
fabulae;
nam quod ad argumentum attinet,
sane brevest.

nunc quod me dixi velle vobis dicere,
10 dicam: huic nomen Graece
Onagost fabulae;
Demophilus scripsit, Maccus vortit
barbare;
Asinariam volt esse, si per vos licet.
inest lepos ludusque in hac
comoedia,
ridicula res est. date benigne operam
mihi,
ut vos, ut alias, pariter nunc Mars
adiuvet.

PROLOGUE

Kindly give us your entire
attention now, spectators: I heartily
hope it will result in benefit to me,
also to you, and to this company
and its managers, and to those that
hire them. (*turning to a herald*)
Herald, provide all this crowd with
ears at once. (*the herald proclaims
silence*)

Enough enough! Sit down—and be
sure you put that in your bill! (*to
audience*) Now I shall say why I
have come out before you here and
what I wished: I have come to
acquaint you with the name of this
play. For as far as the plot is
concerned, that is quite simple.

Now I shall say what I said I
wished to say: the Greek name of
this play is ONAGOS:
Demophilus wrote it: Maccus
translated it into a foreign tongue.
He wishes to call it THE
COMEDY OF ASSES, by your
leave. It is a clever comedy, full of
drollery and laughable situations.
Do oblige me by being attentive,
that now too, as in other days,
Mars may be with you.

ACTVS I

Lib.

Sicut tuom vis unicum gnatum tuae
superesse vitae sospitem et superstitem,
ita ted obtestor per senectutem tuam
perque illam, quam tu metuis, uxorem
tuam,
20 si quid med erga hodie falsum dixeris,
ut tibi superstes uxor aetatem siet
atque illa viva vivos ut pestem oppetas.

Dem.

Per Dium Fidium quaeris: iurato mihi
video necesse esse eloqui quidquid roges.¹
(24)
(27) proinde actutum istuc quid sit quod
scire expetis
eloquere: ut ipse scibo, te faciam ut scias.

Lib.

Die obsecro hercle serio quod te rogem,
cave mihi mendaci quicquam.

Dem.

rogas?

Lib.

30 Quin tu ergo

ACT I

ENTER *Demaenetus*, FROM HIS
HOUSE, BRINGING *Libanus*.

Lib.

(*very solemnly*) As you hope
to have your only son
survive hale and hearty, sir,
when you're gone yourself, I
implore you, sir, by your
hoary hairs and by the one
you dread, your wife, sir—if
you tell me any lie to-day,
may she outlast you by years
and years, yes, sir, and you
die a living death with her
alive.

Dem.

(*laughing*) You beg me by
the very God of Truth. Once
under oath, I see I must tell
you whatever you ask. Come
then, quick! Let me hear
what you wish to know, and
so far as I know myself, I
shall let you know.

Lib.

For God's sake, sir, do please
answer my question
seriously! No lying to me,
sir, mind that!

Dem.

Then why not ask your
question?

Lib.

Num me illuc ducis, ubi lapis lapidem
terit?

Dem.

Quid istuc est? aut ubi istuc est terrarum
loci?² (32)

Lib.

(34) Apud fustitudinas, ferricrepinas insulas,
ubi vivos homines mortui incursant boves.

Dem.

Modo pol percepi, Libane, quid istuc sit
loci:
ubi fit polenta, te fortasse dicere.

Lib.

Ah,
neque hercle ego istuc dico nec dictum
volo,
teque obsecro hercle, ut quae locutu's
despuas.

Dem.

Fiat, geratur mos tibi.

Lib.

40 Age, age usque
excrea.

Dem.

Etiamne?

Lib.

(*anxiously*) You won't take
me where stone rubs stone,
sir?

Dem.

What do you mean? Where
in the world is that?

Lib.

There at the Clubbangian-
Chainclangian Islands, sir,
where dead oxen attack
living men.

Dem.

(*reflecting, then with a
chuckle*) Bless my soul! At
last I get your meaning,
Libanus—the barley mill^A: I
daresay that's the place you
mention.

Lib.

(*in grotesque terror*) Oh
Lord, no! I'm not mentioning
that, and I don't want it
mentioned, either, and for the
love of heaven, sir, do spit
away that word!

Dem.

(*spitting*) All right. Anything
to humour you.

Lib.

Go on, sir, go on! Hawk it
way up!

Dem.

(*spitting again*) Will that do?

Lib.

Age quaeso hercle usque ex
penitis faucibus,
etiam amplius.

Dem.

Nam quo usque?

Lib.

Usque ad mortem
volo.

Dem.

Cave sis malam rem.

Lib.

Uxoris dico, non tuam.

Dem.

Dono te ob istuc dictum, ut expers sis
metu.

Lib.

Di tibi dent quaecumque optes.

Dem.

Redde operam
mihi.
cur hoc ego ex te quaeram? aut cur miniter
tibi
propterea quod me non scientem feceris?
aut cur postremo filio suscenseam,
patres ut faciunt ceteri?

Lib.

Go on, sir, for God's sake,
way from the bottom of your
gullet! (*Demaenetus spits
violently*) Farther down still,
sir!

Dem.

Eh? How far?

Lib.

(*half aside*) To the door of
death, I hope.

Dem.

(*angrily*) Kindly look out,
my man, look out!

Lib.

(*hastily*) Your wife's, sir, I
mean, not yours.

Dem.

(*laughing*) Never fear—for
that remark I grant you
immunity.

Lib.

And heaven grant you all
your prayers, sir.

Dem.

Now listen to me for a
change. Why should I ask
you about this? Or threaten
you because you haven't
informed me? Or for that
matter, why should I fly into
a rage at my son, as other
fathers do?

Lib.

50 Quid istuc novi

est?
demiror quid sit et quo evadat sum in metu.

Dem.

Equidem scio iam, filius quod amet meus
istanc meretricem e proxumo Philaenium.
estne hoc ut dico, Libane?

Lib.

Rectam instas viam.
ea res est. sed eum morbus invasit gravis.

Dem.

Quid morbi est?

Lib.

Quia non suppetunt dictis data.

Dem.

Tune es adiutor nunc amanti filio?

Lib.

Sum vero, et alter noster est Leonida.

Dem.

Bene hercle facitis et a me initis gratiam.
60 verum meam uxorem, Libane, nescis
qualis sit?

Lib.

(*aside*) Hm! What's this
surprise? Wonder what it
means! Where it will end is
what scares me.

Dem.

As a matter of fact, I know
already that my son has an
affair with that wench,
Philaenium, next door. Isn't
that so, Libanus?

Lib.

You're on the right track, sir.
That's how it is. But he has
suffered a severe shock.

Dem.

Shock? What?

Lib.

Well, his presents are falling
short of his promises.

Dem.

Are you aiding my son in
this amour?

Lib.

Indeed I am, sir, and so is my
mate, your servant Leonida.

Dem.

Well, well, my lad, thanks!
You are both earning my
gratitude. But (*looking
cautiously around*) my wife,
Libanus, don't you know her
temperament?

Lib.

Tu primus sentis, nos tamen in pretio
sumus.

Dem.

Fateor eam esse importunam atque
incommodam.

Lib.

Posterius istuc dicis quam credo tibi.

Dem.

Omnes parentes, Libane, liberis suis
qui mi auscultabunt, facient obsequellam³
quippe qui mage amico utantur gnato et
benevolo.
atque ego me id facere studeo, volo amari a
meis;

volo me patris mei similem, qui causa mea
nauclerico ipse ornatu per fallaciam
70 quam amabam abduxit ab lenone
mulierem;
neque puduit eum id aetatis sycophantias
struere et beneficiis me emere gnatum
suom sibi.
eos me decretumst persequi mores patris.

nam me hodie oravit Argyrippus filius,

(*with certainty*) You feel it
first, sir, but we get plenty of
it.

Dem.

(*awkwardly*) I confess that
she is ... high-handed and ...
hard to get along with.

Lib.

I believe that before you
speak a word, sir.

Dem.

(*with an air of profound
moral conviction*) Libanus,
all parents who take my
advice will be a bit indulgent
to their children, seeing it
makes a son more friendly
and affectionate. Yes, and I
am anxious to be so myself. I
wish to be loved by my own
flesh and blood;

I wish to model myself on
my own father who dressed
up as a shipmaster for my
sake and swindled a slave-
dealer out of a girl I was in
love with. He felt no shame
at going in for hocus-pocus
at his time of life, and buying
his son's affection, mine, by
his kindnesses. These
methods of my father's I
have resolved to follow out
myself.

Well now, this very day my
boy Argyrippus begged me

uti sibi amanti facerem argenti copiam;
et id ego percupio obsequi gnato meo.⁴ (76)
(78) quamquam illum mater arte
contenteque habet,
patres ut consueverunt: ego mitto omnia
haec.

80 praesertim quom is me dignum quoi
concrederet
habuit, me habere honorem eius ingenio
deceat;
quom me adiit, ut pudentem gnatum
acquomst patrem,
cupio esse amicae quod det argentum suae.

Lib.

Cupis id quod cupere te nequiquam
intellego.
dotalet servom Sauream uxor tua
adduxit, cui plus in manu sit quam tibi.

Dem.

Argentum accepi, dote imperium vendidi.
nunc verba in pauca conferam quid te
velim.
viginti iam usust filio argenti minis:
face id ut paratum iam sit.

Lib.

90 Unde gentium?

Dem.

to supply him with some
money, saying he was in
love: and I heartily desire to
oblige the dear lad. No
matter if his mother does
keep a firm, tight rein on him
and play the ordinary father's
part, none of that for me.

And seeing he has regarded
me as worthy of his
confidence, I have special
reason to respect his
inclinations. Now that he has
applied to me, as a respectful
son should to his father, I am
desirous that he should have
some money for his mistress.

Lib.

You're desirous of something
you'll desire in vain, sir, I
reckon. Your wife's brought
along Saurea, that dower
slave of hers, to have more
power than you.

Dem.

(bitterly) Sold myself! Gave
up my authority for a dowry!
(pause) Now, in a word, here
is what I want of you. My
son needs eighty pounds^B at
once: will you see it is
procured at once.

Lib.

Where in the world from?

Dem.

Me defraudato.

Lib.

Maxumas nugas agis:
nudo detrahare vestimenta me iubes.
defraudem te ego? age sis, tu sine pennis
vola.
tene ego defraudem, cui ipsi nihil est in
manu,
nisi quid tu porro uxorem defraudaveris?

Dem.

Qua me, qua uxorem, qua tu servom
Sauream
potes, circumduce, aufer; promitto tibi
non offuturum, si id hodie effeceris.

Lib.

Iubeas una opera me piscari in aere,
venari autem rete iaculo in medio mari.

100

Dem.

Tibi optionem sumito Leonidam,
fabricare quidvis, quidvis comminiscere:
perficito, argentum hodie ut habeat filius,
amicae quod det.

Lib.

Quid ais tu, Demaenete?

Cheat me out of it.

Lib.

What awful nonsense you do
talk! You're telling me to
strip the clothes off a naked
man. I cheat you out of it?
Come, sir, will you kindly
fly without wings! I cheat
you out of it, when you don't
own a thing, unless you've
played the same game and
cheated your wife out of
something?

Dem.

Well, me, or my wife, or
servant Saurea—do your
best, swindle us, rook us, I
promise you your interests
won't suffer, if you
accomplish this to-day.

Lib.

You might as well order me
to go a-fishing in the air, yes,
and to take my casting net
and do some deep sea—
hunting.

Dem.

Have Leonida for your
adjutant: manufacture
something, devise something
—anything: see you get the
money to-day for my son to
give his girl.

Lib.

Look here.

Dem.
Quid vis?
Lib.
Si forte in insidias devenero,
tun redimes me, si me hostes interceperint?

Dem.
Redimam.
Lib.
Tum tu igitur aliud cura quid lubet.
ego eo ad forum, nisi quid vis.

Dem.
Ei, bene
ambula.
atque audin etiam?

Lib.
Ecce.

Dem.
Si quid te volam,
ubi eris?

Lib.
110 Ubicumque libitum erit animo
meo
profecto nemo est quem iam dehinc
metuam mihi
ne quid nocere possit, cum tu mihi tua
oratione omnem animum ostendisti tuom

Dem.
Well?
Lib.
Suppose I happen to fall into
an ambushade, ransom me,
will you, if I'm intercepted
by the enemy?

Dem.
I will.
Lib.
(*after a pause, airily*) Well
then, in that case you may
dismiss the matter from your
mind. I'm off to the forum,
unless you want me further.

Dem.
Go ahead! A pleasant stroll
to you! (*Libanus walks
away*) And I say,—listening
still, are you?

Lib.
(*pertly, without turning*)
Behold me!

Dem.
If I want you for anything,
where will you be?

Lib.
Precisely where it pleases
my fancy. (*half aside*) I tell
you what, from now on I
won't be scared of a man
alive, for fear he can do me
any harm, after your showing
me all the secrets of your

quin te quoque ipsum facio haud magni, si
hoc patro.
pergam quo occepi atque ibi consilia
exordiar.

Dem.

Audin tu? apud Archibulum ego ero
argentarium.

Lib.

Nempe in foro?

Dem.

Ibi, si quid opus fuerit.

Lib.

Meminero.

Dem.

Non esse servos peior hoc quisquam potest
nec magis versutus nec quo ab caveas
aegrius
120 eidem homini, si quid recte curatum
velis,
mandes: moriri sese misere mavolet,
quam non perfectum reddat quod
promiserit.

nam ego illud argentum tam paratum filio
scio esse quam me hunc scipionem contui.
sed quid ego cesso ire ad forum, quo
inceperam?

soul. Why, you won't count
for much with me your own
self, either, if I carry this
through. (*setting off again*)
I'll go along to where I was
bound and lay my plans
there.

Dem.

Look here! I shall be at
banker Archibulus's.

Lib.

In the forum, you mean?

Dem.

Yes, there,—if anything's
needed.

Lib.

(*nonchalantly*) I'll keep it in
mind.

[EXIT *Libanus* TO FORUM.]

Dem.

A more rascally servant than
this of mine can't be found,
or a wilier one, or one harder
to guard against. But he's just
your man to commit a matter
to, if you want it well
managed: he'd prefer to
expire in pain and torment
rather than fail to fulfil his
promise to the letter.

Why, I'm just as confident
that that money is in store for
my son as that I've got my
eyes on this cane here. But I
must be off to the forum,

⁶atque ibi manebo apud argentarium.

I. 2.

Argyr.

Sicine hoc fit? foras aedibus me eici?
promerenti optume hocin preti
redditur?

bene merenti mala es, male merenti
bona es;

130 at malo cum tuo, nam iam ex hoc
loco

ibo ego ad tres viros vostraque ibi
nomina

faxo erunt, capitis te perdam ego et
filiam,

perlecebrae, permities,
adulescentum exitium.

nam mare haud est mare, vos mare
acerrimum;

nam in mari repperi, his elavi bonis.

ingrata atque inrita esse omnia
intellego

quae dedi et quod bene feci, at
posthac tibi

male quod potero facere faciam,
meritoque id faciam tuo.

ego pol te redigam eodem unde
orta es, ad egestatis terminos,

140 ego edepol te faciam ut quae
sis nunc et quae fueris scias.

where I was going. Yes, and
I'll wait there at the banker's.
[EXIT *Demaenetus*.

Scene 2.

ENTER *Argyrippus* PRECIPITATELY
FROM HOUSE OF *Cleareta*.

Argyr.

(*violently to those within*) So that's
the way, is it? Thrown out of
doors, am I? This is my reward for
all the good turns I've done you,
eh? Evil for good and good for evil
is your system. But it will be evil
for you! I'll go direct from here to
the police and leave your names
with 'em. I'll humble you and your
daughter! You decoys, you
destroyers, you wreckers of young
fellows! Why, the sea's no sea: you
are—the wildest sea of all! Why at
sea I made my money, here I am
cleaned out of it.

All I've given you and all I've done
for you gets no thanks, goes for
nothing, I find: but after this all I
can do against you I'll do, and do it
with good reason. By the Lord, I'll
put you down where you came
from, the depths of destitution, I
will. By heaven, I'll make you
appreciate what you are now and
what you were.

quae prius quam istam adii
 atque amans ego animum
 meum isti dedi,
 sordido vitam oblectabas pane
 in pannis inopia,
 atque ea si erant, magnas
 habebas omnibus dis gratias;
 eadem nunc, cum est melius,
 me, cuius opera est, ignoras
 mala,
 reddam ego te ex fera fame
 mansuetem, me specta modo.

 nam isti quid succenseam ipsi?
 nihil est, nihil quicquam
 meret;
 tuo facit iussu, tuo imperio
 paret: mater tu. eadem era es.
 te ego ulciscar, te ego ut digna
 es perdam atque ut de me
 meres,
 at scelesti vident ut ne id
 quidem, me dignum esse
 existumat
 150 quem adeat, quem
 conloquatur quoique irato
 supplicet?

 atque eccam inlecebra exit
 tandem; opinor hic ante
 ostium
 meo modo loquar quae volam,
 quoniam intus non licitum est
 mihi.

I. 3.

You, who before I courted that girl
 of yours and offered her my loving
 heart, used to regale yourself on
 coarse bread in rags and poverty:
 yes, and gave hearty thanks to
 Heaven, if you got your bread and
 rags. Yet here you are, now that
 you are better off, snubbing me
 that made you so, curse you! I'll
 tame you down, you wild beast, by
 the famine treatment: trust me for
 that.

As for that girl of yours, why
 should I be angry with her? She's
 done nothing, she's not at all to
 blame. It is your dictates she
 follows, your orders she obeys:
 you're mother and mistress both.
 You're the one I'll have revenge
 on; you're the one I'll ruin as you
 deserve, as your behaviour to me
 merits. (*pauses and glares at
 house*) But d'ye see how the
 wretch doesn't even think it worth
 while to come to me, talk with me,
 go on her knees to me, when I'm in
 a rage?

(*Cleareta's door opens*) Ah, there
 she is coming out at last, the
 decoy! I wager I'll have my full
 say in my own fashion out in front
 of the door here, seeing I couldn't
 do it inside.

Scene 3.

Cle.

Unum quodque istorum verbum
nummis Philippis aureis
non potest auferre hinc a me si quis
emptor venerit;
nec recte quae tu in nos dicis, aurum
atque argentum merumst:
fixus hic apud nos est animus tuos
clavo Cupidinis.
remigio veloque quantum poteris
festina et fuge:
quam magis te in altum capessis, tam
aestus te in portum refert.

Argyr.

Ego pol istum portitorem privabo
portorio;
160 ego te dehinc ut merita es de me
et mea re tractare exsequar,
quom tu med ut meritus sum non
tractas atque eicis domo.

Cle.

Magis istuc percipimus lingua dici,
quam factis fore.

Argyr.

Solus solitudine ego ted atque ab
egestate abstuli;
solus si ductem, referre gratiam
numquam potes.

Cle.

Solus ductato, si semper solus quae
poscam dabis;

ENTER *Cleareta* FROM HOUSE.

Cle.

(*calmly and pleasantly*) Not a single one of those words do I part with for golden sovereigns, not if some purchaser comes along: uncomplimentary remarks about us from you are good coin of the realm. Your heart is fastened to us here with one of Cupid's spikes through it. Out with oar and up with sail, speed your fastest and scud away: the more you put out to sea, the more the tide brings you back to harbour.

Argyr.

(*grimly*) By the Lord, I'll hold back that harbour master's harbour dues; from this time forth you'll get the treatment you merit of me and my exchequer, for this unmerited treatment of me, this turning me out of the house.

Cle.

(*lightly*) Such things are easier said than done, I observe.

Argyr.

I, and I alone, am the man that rescued you from loneliness and destitution; even if I should take the girl for myself alone, you'd still be in my debt.

Cle.

Take her for yourself alone, if you alone will always give me what I

semper tibi promissum habeto hac
lege, dum superes datis.

Argyr.

Qui modus dandi? nam numquam tu
quidem expleri potes;
modo quom accepisti, haud multo
post aliquid quod poscas paras.

Cle.

Quid modist ductando, amando?
numquamne expleri potes?
170 modo remisisti, continuo iam ut
remittam ad te rogas.

Argyr.

Dedi equidem quod mecum egisti.

Cle.

Et tibi ego
misi mulierem:
par pari datum hostimentumst, opera
pro pecunia.

Argyr.

Male agis mecum.

Cle.

Quid me accusas, si
facio officium meum?
nam neque fictum usquamst neque
pictum neque scriptum in poematis
ubi lena bene agat cum quiquam
amante, quae frugi esse volt.

Argyr.

demand. You can always be sure of
her—on condition your presents
are the biggest.

Argyr.

And what end to the presents?
Why, you can never be sated. Now
you get something, and a minute
later you're devising some new
demand.

Cle.

And what end to the taking her, to
the lovey-doveying? Can you
never be sated? Now you have sent
her back to me, and the next
instant you're crying for me to
send her back to you.

Argyr.

Well, I paid you what we agreed
on.

Cle.

And I let you have the girl: my
policy has been fair give and take
—services rendered for cash.

Argyr.

You're using me shamefully.

Cle.

Why find fault with me for doing
my plain duty? Why, nowhere in
stone, paint, or poem is a lady in
my line portrayed as using any
lover well—if she wants to get on.

Argyr.

Mihi quidem te parcere aequomst
tandem, ut tibi durem diu.

Cle.

Non tu scis? quae amanti parcat,
eadem sibi parcat parum.
quasi piscis, itidemst amator lenae:
nequam est, nisi recens;
is habet sucum, is suavitatem, eum
quo vis pacto condias
180 vel patinarium vel assum, verses
quo pacto lubet:
is dare volt, is se aliquid posci, nam
ibi de pleno promitur;

neque ille scit quid det, quid damni
faciat: illi rei studet,
volt placere sese amicae, volt mihi,
volt pedisequae,
volt famulis, volt etiam ancillis; et
quoque catulo meo
subblanditur novos amator, se ut
quom videat gaudeat.
vera dico: ad suum quemque
hominem quaestum esse aequomst
callidum.

Argyr.

Perdidici istaec esse vera damno cum
magno meo.

Cle.

Si ecaster nunc habeas quod des, alia
verba praehibeas;

(*appealingly*) You really ought to
use me sparingly, though, so that I
may last you a long time.

Cle.

(*coolly*) You miss the point? The
lady that spares her lover spares
herself too little. Lovers are the
same as fish to us—no good unless
they're fresh. Your fresh ones are
juicy and sweet; you can season
them to taste in a stew, bake them,
and turn them every way. Your
fresh one wants to give you things,
wants to be asked for something:
in his case it all comes from a full
cupboard, you see;

and he has no idea what he's
giving, what it costs him. This is
his only thought: he wants to
please, please his girl, please me,
please the waiting-woman, please
the men servants, please the maid
servants, too: yes, the new lover
makes up to my little dog, even, so
that he may be glad to see him.
This is the plain truth: every one
ought to keep a sharp eye for the
main chance.

Argyr.

I have thoroughly learned the truth
of that, and a pretty penny it's cost
me.

Cle.

Tut, tut! If you had anything left to
give us, your language would be
different; now that you have

nunc quia nihil habes, maledictis te
eam ductare postulas.

Argyr.

Non meum est.

Cle.

190 Nec meum quidem
edepol, ad te ut mittam gratiis.
verum aetatis atque honoris gratia
hoc fiet tui,
quia nobis lucro fuisti potius quam
decori tibi:
si mihi dantur duo talenta argenti
numerata in manum,
hanc tibi noctem honoris causa
gratiis dono dabo.

Argyr.

Quid si non est?

Cle.

Tibi non esse credam,
illa alio ibit tamen.

Argyr.

Ubi illaec quae dedi ante?

Cle.

Abusa. nam si
ea durarent mihi,
mulier mitteretur ad te, numquam
quicquam poscerem.
diem aquam solem lunam noctem,
haec argento non emo:
ceterum quae volumus uti Graeca
mercamur fide.

nothing, you expect to get her by
abuse.

Argyr.

That's not my way.

Cle.

Nor mine, sir, to let you have her
gratis—mercy, no! But,
considering your youth and our
high regard for you, this shall be
done, seeing you have been more
of an income to us than a credit to
yourself: just hand me over
(*casually*) four hundred pounds in
cash and you shall have this
evening with her, in token of said
high regard, as a free gift from me.

Argyr.

What if I haven't it?

Cle.

(*smiling, but firm*) I'll give you
credit—that you haven't it: the girl
shall go to some one else,
however.

Argyr.

Where is what I gave you before?

Cle.

Spent. Why, if it had lasted, you
should have your lady, and not a
thing would I be asking for.
Daylight, water, sunlight,
moonlight, darkness—for these
things I have to pay no money:
everything else we wish to use we
purchase on Greek credit.

200 quom a pistore panem petimus,
vinum ex oenopolio.
si aes habent, dant mercem: eadem
nos disciplina utimur.
semper oculatae manus sunt nostrae,
credunt quod vident.
vetus est: "nihili coactiost"—scis
cuius. non dico amplius.

Argyr.

Aliam nunc mi orationem despoliato
praedicas,
longe aliam, inquam, praebes nunc
atque olim, quom dabam,
aliam atque olim, quom inliciebas me
ad te blande ac benedice.
tum mi aedes quoque arridebant, cum
ad te veniebam, tuae;
me unice unum ex omnibus te atque
illam amare aibas mihi;

ubi quid dederam, quasi columbae
pulli in ore ambae meo
210 usque eratis, meo de studio studia
erant vostra omnia,
usque adhaerebatis: quod ego
iusseram, quod volueram
faciebatis, quod nolebam ac
votueram, de industria
fugiebatis, neque conari id facere
audebatis prius.
nunc neque quid velim neque nolim
facitis magni, pessumae.

When we go to the baker for
bread, to the vintner for wine, their
rule is commodities for cash: we
use the same system ourselves.
Our hands have eyes always:
seeing is believing with them. As
the old proverb has it: "There's no
getting"—you know what. I say no
more.

Argyr.

It's a different sort of eloquence
you use on me now I've been
fleeced, very different, I say, from
that former sort when I was giving
you things, different from that
former sort when you were luring
me on with your smooth, suave
talk. Then your very house used to
be wreathed in smiles, when I
turned up. You used to say I was
the one and only love in all the
world for you and her.

After I'd given you anything the
both of you used to keep hanging
on my lips like a pair of young
doves. Whatever I fancied, you
fancied, and nothing else. You
used to keep clinging to me. I
ordered a thing, wished a thing,—
you used to do it: I disliked a
thing, forbade a thing,—you used
to take pains to avoid doing it: you
didn't dare attempt to do it then.
Now you don't care tuppence what
I like, or don't like, you vile
wretches!

Cle.

Non tu scis? hic noster quaestus
aucupi simillimust.
auceps quando concinnavit aream,
offundit cibum;
aves adsuescunt: necesse est facere
sumptum qui quaerit lucrum;
saepe edunt: semel si sunt captae,
rem solvent aucupi.
219, 220 itidem his apud nos: aedes
nobis area est, auceps sum ego,
esca est meretrix, lectus inlex est,
amatores aves;

bene salutando consuescunt,
compellando blanditer,
osculando, oratione vinnula,
venustula.
si papillam pertractavit, haud est ab
re aucupis;
savium si sumpsit, sumere eum licet
sine retibus.
haecine te esse oblitum, in ludo qui
fuisti tam diu?

Argyr.

Tua ista culpa est, quae discipulum
semidoctum abs te amoves.

Cle.

Remeato audacter, mercedem si eris
nactus; nunc abi.

Argyr.

Cle.

(*still cheerfully superior*) You miss
the point? This profession of ours
is a great deal like bird-catching.
The fowler, when he has his
fowling-floor prepared, spreads
food around; the birds become
familiarized: you must spend
money, if you wish to make
money. They often get a meal: but
once they get caught they recoup
the fowler. It is quite the same with
us here: our house is the floor, I
am the fowler, the girl the bait, the
couch the decoy, the lovers the
birds.

They become familiar through
pleasant greetings, pretty speeches,
kisses, cooey, captivating little
whispers. If he cuddles her close in
his arms, well, no harm to the
fowler. If he takes a naughty kind
of kiss, he can be taken himself,
and no net needed. You to forget
all this, and so long in the school,
too?

Argyr.

It's your fault, if I have: you
expelled your pupil when he was
half taught.

Cle.

Trot along back to us boldly, if you
find the tuition fee: for the present
run away. (*turns to go in*)

Argyr.

Mane, mane, audi. dic, quid me
aequom censes pro illa tibi dare,
annum hunc ne cum quiquam alio
sit?

Cle.

230 Tene?

viginti minas;
atque ea lege: si alius ad me prius
attulerit, tu vale.

Argyr.

At ego est etiam prius quam abis
quod volo loqui.

Cle.

Dic

quod lubet.

Argyr.

Non omnino iam perii, est relicuom
quo peream magis.
habeo unde istuc tibi quod poscis
dem; sed in leges meas
dabo, uti scire possis, perpetuom
annum hunc mihi uti serviat
nec quemquam interea alium admittat
prorsus quam me ad se virum.

Cle.

Quin, si tu voles, domi servi qui sunt
castrabo viros.
postremo ut voles nos esse,
syngraphum facito adferas;
ut voles, ut tibi lubebit, nobis legem
imponito:

Wait, wait, listen! Tell me, what do
you think I ought to give you to
have her all to myself this next
year?

Cle.

(laughingly) What? You? *(after a
pause)* Eighty pounds: yes, and on
this condition—if some one else
brings me the money before you
do, good-bye to you. *(again
turning to go)*

Argyr.

But there's something more I want
to say before you go.

Cle.

Say on, anything.

Argyr.

I'm not entirely ruined yet: there is
a balance left for further ruin. I can
give you what you ask. But I'll
give it to you on my own terms,
and here they are—she's to be at
my disposal this whole next year
through, and all that time not a
single man but me is to come near
her.

Cle.

(cheerfully ironical) Why, if you
choose, I'll change all the men
servants in the house to maids. In
short, bring along a contract
stating how you wish us to behave.
All you desire, all you like,—
impose your own terms on us: only

240 modo tecum una argentum
adferto, facile patiar cetera.
portitorum simillumae sunt ianuae
lenoniae:
si adfers, tum patent, si non est quod
des, aedes non patent.

Argyr.

Interii, si non invenio ego illas viginti
minas,
et profecto, nisi illud perdo argentum,
pereundum est mihi.
nunc pergam ad forum atque experiar
opibus, omni copia,
supplicabo, exobsecrabo ut quemque
amicum videro,
dignos indignos adire atque experiri
certumst mihi,⁷
nam si mutuas non potero, certumst
sumam faenore.

ACTVS II

Lib.

Hercle vero, Libane, nunc te meliust
expergiscier
250 atque argento comparando fingere
fallaciam.
iam diu est factum quom discesti ab
ero atque abiisti ad forum,⁸ (251)

bring along the money, too; the
rest is easy for me. Our doors are
much like those of a custom house:
pay your fee, and they are open: if
you can't, they are—(*going into
house and closing the door in his
face with a provoking laugh*) not
open.

Argyr.

(*drearily*) It's all over with me, if I
don't get hold of that eighty
pounds: yes, one thing is sure, that
money goes to pot, or else my life
must. (*a pause, then with
animation*) I'll off to the forum this
moment and try to raise it by every
means in my power: I'll entreat,
ex-supPLICATE every friend I see.
Good and bad—I'll up and try
them all, I'm resolved on that: and
if I can't get it as a friendly loan,
I'm resolved to borrow it at usury.
[EXIT *Argyrippus*.

ACT II

(*A couple of hours have elapsed.*)

ENTER *Libanus* WITH WORRIED AIR.

Lib.

By gad, Libanus, you'd certainly
better rouse yourself now and
contrive some trick for collecting
that cash. It's a long time since you
left your master and hied yourself
to the forum, to loaf and snooze
away there till this time of day.

(253) ibi tu ad hoc diei tempus
dormitasti in otio.

quin tu abs te socordiam omnem
reice et segnitiem amove
atque ad ingenium vetus versutum te
recipis tuom
serva erum, cave tu idem faxis alii
quod servi solent,
qui ad eri fraudationem callidum
ingenium gerunt.

unde sumam? quem intervortam? quo
hanc celocem conferam?
impetratum, inauguratumst quovis
admittunt aves,
260 picus et cornix ab laeva, corvos
parra ab dextera
consuadent; certum herclest vostram
consequi sententiam

sed quid hoc, quod picus ulmum
tundit? non temerariumst.
certe hercle ego quantum ex augurio
eius pici intellego,
aut mihi in mundo sunt virgae aut
atriensi Saureae
sed quid illuc quod exanimatus currit
huc Leonida?
metuo quom illic obscaevavit meae
falsae fallaciae.

Come on, shake off all this dull
sloth, away with sluggishness, yes,
and get back that old gift of guile
of yours! Save your master: mind
you don't do the same as other
servants that use their wily wits to
gull him.

(*pause*) Where shall I get it? Who
shall I swindle? Where shall I steer
this cutter? (*looking upwards, then
jubilantly*) I've got my auspices,
my auguries: the birds let me steer
it where I please! Woodpecker and
crow on the left, raven and barn
owl on the right. "Go ahead," they
say! By Jove, I'll follow your
advice, I certainly will.

(*looking upward again*) What's
this, though,—the woodpecker
tapping an elm? ^C That's not for
nothing! Lord! So far as I
understand the omen of this
woodpecker, that certainly means
there are rods in pickle for me, or
for steward Saurea. (*looking down
street*) But what's wrong—Leonida
running up here all out of breath?
I'm afraid now that the bird there
has predicted trouble for my artful
arts.

II. 2.

Scene 2.

Leon.

Ubi ego nunc Libanum requiram aut
familiarem filium,
ut ego illos lubentiores faciam quam
Lubentias?
maximam praedam et triumphum eis
adfero adventu meo
270 quando mecum pariter potant, pariter
scortari solent,
hanc quidem, quam nactus, praedam
pariter cum illis partiam.

Lib.

Illic homo aedis compilavit, more si fecit
suo.
vae illi, qui tam indiligenter observavit
ianuam.

Leon.

Aetatem velim servire, Libanum ut
conveniam modo.

Lib.

Mea quidem hercle opera liber numquam
fies ocus.

Leon.

Etiam de tergo ducentas plagas praegnatis
dabo.

Lib.

ENTER *Leonida* IN GREAT
EXCITEMENT, WITHOUT SEEING
Libanus.

Leon.

Where shall I look for
Libanus now, or young
master, so that I can make
them more delighted than
Delight herself? Oh, the
mighty prize and triumph my
coming confers on 'em!
Seeing they guzzle along
with me, and chase the girls
along with me, I'll certainly
go shares in this prize I've got
along with them.

Lib.

(*aside*) The fellow's been
robbing a house if he's acted
naturally. Lord help the poor
devil that minded the door so
carelessly!

Leon.

I'd be willing to slave it all
my life, only let me meet
Libanus.

Lib.

(*aside*) By Jove, you'll never
be free a minute sooner for
any help you get from me.

Leon.

I'll even give two hundred
swollen welts from off my
back to see him.

Lib.

Largitur peculium, omnem in tergo
thensaurum gerit.

Leon.

Nam si huic sese occasione tempus
supterduxerit,
numquam edepol quadrigis albis indipiscet
postea;
280 erum in obsidione linquet, inimicum
animos auxerit.
sed si mecum occasionem opprimere hanc,
quae obvenit, studet,
maximas opimitates, gaudio exfertissimas
suis eris ille una mecum pariet, gnatoque
et patri,
adeo ut aetatem ambo ambobus nobis sint
obnoxii,
nostro devincti beneficio.

Lib.

Vinctos nescio quos
ait;
non placet: metuo, in commune ne quam
fraudem frausus sit.

Leon.

Perii ego oppido, nisi Libanum invenio
iam, ubiubi est gentium.

Lib.

(*aside*) He's generous with
what he has: carries all his
coffers on his back.

Leon.

For if this chance is let slide,
he'll never catch it again, by
Jove, not with a chariot and
four, white^D horses. He'll be
leaving his master under
siege and increasing the
courage of his enemies. But if
he's ready to take part with
me and pounce on this
opportunity that's turned up,
he'll be my partner in
hatching the biggest, joy-
stuffedest jubilee that ever
was for his masters, son and
father both, yes, and put the
pair of 'em under obligations
to the pair of us for life, too,
chained tight by our services.

Lib.

(*aside*) Chained, he says:
some one or other chained! I
don't like it. I'm afraid he's
been trumping up some
trumpery that'll involve the
both of us.

Leon.

(*quivering with excitement*)
I'm absolutely done for, if I
don't find Libanus at once,
wherever he is.

Lib.

Illic homo socium ad malam rem quaerit
quem adiungat sibi.
non placet: pro monstro extemplo est,
quando qui sudat tremit.

Leon.

290 Sed quid ego his properans concesso
pedibus. lingua largior?
quin ego hanc iubeo tacere, quae loquens
lacerat diem?

Lib.

Edepol hominem infelicem, qui patronam
conprimat.
nam si quid scelesti fecit, lingua pro illo
perierat.

Leon.

Adproperabo, ne post tempus praedae
praesidium parem.

Lib.

Quae illaec praeda est? ibo advorsum
atque electabo, quidquid est.
iubeo te salvere voce summa, quo ad vires
valent.

Leon.

Gymnasium flagri, salveto.

That chap's after a mate to
yoke with in a race for a
thrashing. I don't like it! it
means something bad soon,
when a man in a sweat
shivers.

Leon.

But why am I holding in my
feet and letting out my
tongue, and I in such a hurry?
Why don't I tell it to shut up,
with its wagging the day to
shreds?

Lib.

(*aside*) Good Lord! Poor
devil—choking off his
patroness! Why, once he's
been up to some rascality, it's
that same tongue perjures
herself for him.

Leon.

I'll cut along, so as not to
procure protection for the
prize when it's too late.
(*moves away*)

Lib.

What's that prize? I'll up and
worm it out of him, whatever
it is. (*aloud*) Good day to you
—(*raising his voice, Leonida
having paid no attention*) as
loud a one as my lungs allow!

Leon.

Ah there, (*turning and
stopping*) you whip

Lib.

Quid agis, custos
carceris?

Leon.

O catenarum colone.

Lib.

O virgarum lascivia.

Leon.

Quot pondo ted esse censes nudum?

Lib.

Non edepol
scio.

Leon.

300 Scibam ego te nescire, at pol ego, qui
ted expendi, scio:
nudus vinctus centum pondo es, quando
pendes per pedes.

Lib.

Quo argumento istuc?

Leon.

Ego dicam, quo
argumento et quo modo.
ad pedes quando adligatumst aequom
centumpondium,
ubi manus manicae complexae sunt atque
adductae ad trabem,
nec dependes nec propendes—quin malus
nequamque sis.

developer!

Lib.

How goes it, gaol guard?

Leon.

Oh you fetter farmer.

Lib.

Oh you rod tickler!

Leon.

How much do you think you
weigh, stripped?

Lib.

Lord! I don't know.

Leon.

I knew you didn't know: but
by the Lord, I know for I've
weighed you. Stripped and
tied you weigh a hundred
pounds—when you're
hanging by your heels.

Lib.

What's your proof of that?

Leon.

I'll tell you my proof and my
method. When a fair
hundred- weight is fastened
to your feet, with the
handcuffs hugging your
hands lashed to a beam,
you're not a bit under or over
the weight of—a good-for-
nothing rascal.

Lib.

Vae tibi.

Leon.

Hoc testamento Servitus legat tibi.

Lib.

Verbivellationem fieri compendi volo.
quid istud est negoti?

Leon.

Certum est credere,

Lib.

Audacter

licet.

Leon.

Sis amanti subvenire familiari filio,
310 tantum adest boni improviso, verum
commixtum malo:
omnes de nobis carnificum
concelebrabuntur dies.
Libane, nunc audacia usust nobis inventa
et dolis.
tantum facinus modo inveni ego, ut nos
dicamur duo
omnium dignisimi esse, quo cruciatus
confluent,

Lib.

Ergo mirabar quod dudum scapulae
gestibant mihi,

Lib.

You be damned!

Leon.

Precisely what you are down
for yourself in Slavery's will.

Lib.

Let's cut short this war of
words. What's that business
of yours?

Leon.

I've determined to trust you.

Lib.

You can—boldly.

Leon.

If you've got a mind to help
the young master in his love
affair, there's such an
unexpected supply of good
luck come to hand—mixed
with bad, though—that the
public torturers will have a
regular festival at our
expense every day. Libanus,
now we need grit and guile.
I've just now come upon such
a deed for us to do, that we
two will be called the
worthiest men alive—to be
where the torture's thickest.

Lib.

(dryly) Aha! I was wondering
what made my shoulders
tingle a while ago: they began

hariolari quae occeperunt, sibi esse in
mundo malum.
quidquid est, eloquere.

Leon.

Magna est praeda cum
magno malo.

Lib.

Si quidem omnes coniurati cruciamenta
conferant,
habeo opinor familiare tergum, ne
quaeram foris.

Leon.

320 Si istam firmitudinem animi optines,
salvi sumus.

Lib.

Quin si tergo res solvenda est, rapere
cupio publicum:
pernegabo atque obdurabo, periurabo
denique.

Leon.

Em ista virtus est, quando usust qui
malum fert fortiter;
fortiter malum qui patitur, idem post
potitur bonum.

Lib.

Quin rem actutum edisseris? cupio malum
nanciscier.

Leon.

prognosticating trouble was
in pickle for 'em. Whatever it
is, out with it!

Leon.

It's a big prize and a big risk.

Lib.

No matter if they all combine
to pile the torments on, I
fancy I've got a back of my
own, without having to look
for one outside.

Leon.

That's the spirit, hold to it and
we're safe.

Lib.

Pooh! if it's my back that is to
pay the score, I'm ripe for
sacking the Treasury: then I'll
say up and down I didn't,
stick to it I didn't, yes, yes,
take my solemn oath I didn't.

Leon.

There! That's courage—to
take hard knocks like a man
when occasion calls. The
chap that endures hard
knocks like a man enjoys a
soft time later on.

Lib.

Why don't you hurry up and
unfold your tale? I long for
some hard knocks.

Leon.

Placide ergo unum quidquid rogita, ut
adquiescam. non vides
me ex cursura anhelitum etiam ducere?

Lib.

Age, age,
mansero
tuo arbitrato, vel adeo usque dum peris.

Leon.

Ubinam
est erus?

Lib.

Maior apud forumst, minor hic est intus.

Leon.

Iam satis est
mihi.

Lib.

Tum igitur tu dives es factus?

Leon.

330 Mitte ridicularia.

Lib.

Mitto.⁹ istuc quod adfers aures expectant
meae.

Leon.

Animum adverte, ut aequae mecum haec
scias.

Lib.

Taceo.

Leon.

Easy then with each question,
so that I can get a rest. Don't
you see I'm still puffing after
that run of mine?

Lib.

All right, all right, I'll wait till
you're ready, yes, ready to
expire, for that matter.

Leon.

(after a pause) Where the
deuce is master?

Lib.

Old one's at the forum, young
one's inside here. (pointing to
Clearetas house)

Leon.

That'll do! I'm satisfied.

Lib.

Satisfied? So you're a
millionaire already, are you?

Leon.

Don't try to be funny.

Lib.

I won't. (grandly) My ears
await your tidings.

Leon.

Listen here, and you'll know
about things as well as I do.

Lib.

I'm dumb.

Leon.

Beas.
meministin asinos Arcadicos mercatori
Pellaeo
nostrum vendere atriensem?

Lib.

Memini. quid tum
postea?

Leon.

Em ergo is argentum huc remisit, quod
daretur Saureae
pro asinis. adulescens venit modo, qui id
argentum attulit.

Lib.

Ubi is homost?

Leon.

Iam devorandum censes, si
conspexeris?

Lib.

Ita enim vero. sed tamen, tu nempe eos
asinos praedicas
340 vetulos, claudos, quibus subtrita ad
femina iam erant ungulae?

Leon.

Ipsos, qui tibi subvectabant rure hue virgas
ulmeas.

Lib.

Teneo, atque idem te hinc vexerunt
vinctum rus.

(*ironically*) Oh, bliss! Do you
remember those Arcadian
asses our steward sold to the
merchant from Pella?

Lib.

I do. Well, what next?

Leon.

Now then! He's sent the
money for 'em, to be paid to
Saurea. A young chap's just
arrived with it.

Lib.

(*with a start*) Where is he?

Leon.

Think he ought to be
swallowed down the minute
you spy him, eh?

Lib.

Aye, that I do! But let me see,
of course you mean those
poor old lame asses with their
hoofs worn away up to their
hocks?

Leon.

Precisely! the ones that used
to come down from the farm
with loads of elm rods for
you.

Lib.

I have you: yes, the same
ones that carried you off to
the farm in fetters.

Lib.

Memor es

probe,
verum in tonstrina ut sedebam, me infit
percontarier,
ecquem filium Stratonis noverim
Demaenetum.
dico me novisse extemplo et me eius
servom praedico
esse, et aedis demonstravi nostras.

Lib.

Quid tum

postea?

Leon.

Ait se ob asinos ferre argentum atriensi
Saureae,
viginti minas, sed eum sese non nosse
hominem qui siet,
ipsum vero se novisse callide
Demaenetum.
quoniam ille elocutus haec sic—

Lib.

Quid tum?

Leon.

350 Ausculta

ergo, scies.
extemplo facio facetum me atque
magnificum virum,
dico med esse atriensem. sic hoc respondit
mihi:
"ego pol Sauream non novi neque qua
facie sit scio.

Lib.

Remarkable memory, yours!
However, when I was in the
barber's chair he speaks up
and asks me if I know a
Demaenetus, the son of
Strato. I say yes at once, and
declare that I'm his servant,
and I told him where our
house was.

Lib.

Well, what next?

Leon.

He says he's bringing money
for the asses to steward
Saurea, eighty pounds; but
that he doesn't know the man
at all: says he knows
Demaenetus himself well,
though. After he had given
me an account of things this
way—

Lib.

What next?

Leon.

Well, listen and you'll find
out. Instantly I pose as a fine,
superior sort of creature and
tell him I am the steward.
Here's the way he answered
me: "Well, well," says he, "I
am not acquainted with
Saurea personally and I don't
know what he looks like. You

te non aequomst suscensere. si erum vis
Demaenetum,
quem ego novi, adduce: argentum non
morabor quin feras."

ego me dixi erum adducturum et me domi
praesto fore;
ille in balineas iturust, inde huc veniet
postea.
quid nunc consili captandum censes? dic.

Lib.

Em istuc

ago,
quo modo argento intervortam et
adventorem et Sauream.
iam hoc opus est exasciato¹⁰; nam si ille
argentum prius ³⁶⁰
hospes huc affert, continuo nos ambo
exclusi sumus.
nam me hodie senex seduxit solum sorsum
ab aedibus,
mihi tibiue interminatust nos futuros
ulmeos,
ni hodie Argyripo essent viginti argenti
minae;

iussit vel nos atriensem vel nos uxorem
suam
defraudare, dixit sese operam promiscam
dare.

have no reason to take
offence. Bring along your
master Demaenetus whom I
do know, if you please: I'll let
you have the money without
delay."

I told him I would bring my
master and be at home
waiting for him. He's going to
the baths: then he'll be here
later. What do you propose
now for a plan of campaign?
Tell me.

Lib.

(*thinking*) That's the point!
Just what I'm casting about
for—some way to relieve
newcomer and Saurea of the
cash. We must have our
scheme roughed out at once;
for let that stranger fetch his
money before we're ready
and the next minute we're
both shut out of it. You see,
the old man took me aside
out of the house to-day all by
myself: swore he'd made the
pair of us perfectly elmy, if
eighty pounds was not
forthcoming for Argyrippus
this very day.

He gave us orders to do the
steward out of it, or else his
wife: said he'd stand by us
whichever it was. Now you
be off to the forum to master

nunc tu abi ad forum ad erum et narra haec
ut nos acturi sumus:
te ex Leonida futurum esse atriensem
Sauream,
dum argentum afferat mercator pro asinis.

Leon.

Faciam ut
iubes.

Lib.

370 Ego illum interea hic oblectabo, prius
si forte advenerit.

Leon.

Quid ais?

Lib.

Quid vis?

Leon.

Pugno malam si tibi
percussero,
mox cum Sauream imitabor, caveto ne
suscenseas.

Lib.

Hercle vero tu cavebis ne me attingas, si
sapis,
ne hodie malo cum auspicio nomen
commutaveris.

Leon.

Quaeso, aequo animo patitor.

Lib.

and tell him what our game
will be: that you are going to
change from Leonida to
steward Saurea when the
trader brings the money for
the asses.

Leon.

I'll do as you say. (*moves off*)

Lib.

I'll entertain him here myself
meanwhile, if he happens to
come before you do.

Leon.

(*halting*) I say.

Lib.

What do you want?

Leon.

(*gravely*) In case I punch
your jaw for you later on
when I'm imitating Saurea,
take care you don't get angry.

Lib.

By gad, you'd just better take
care yourself not to touch me,
if you know what's what, or
you'll find you've picked an
unlucky day for changing
your name.

Leon.

Come, come, put up with it
patiently.

Lib.

Patitor tu item, cum ego
te referiam.

Leon.

Dico ut usust fieri.

Lib.

Dico hercle ego quoque
ut facturus sum.

Leon.

Ne nega.

Lib.

Quin promitto, inquam, hostire
contra ut merueris.

Leon.

Ego abeo, tu iam, scio, patiere. sed quis
hic est? is est,
ille est ipsus. iam ego recurro huc. tu hunc
interea his tene.
volo seni narrare.

Lib.

380 Quin tuom officium
facis ergo ac fugis?

Yes, and you put up with it
when I hit you back.

Leon.

I'm telling how it's got to be
done.

Lib.

And by the Lord, I'm telling
how I'm going to do it.

Leon.

Don't refuse.

Lib.

Oh, I agree, I agree—to pay
you back all you earn.

Leon.

(*turning to go*) I'm off: you'll
put up with it now, I know
you will. (*looking down
street*) Hullo! Who's this! It's
he, the very man! I'll hurry
back here soon! You keep
him here while I'm gone. I
must tell the old man. (*stops
to look again*)

Lib.

(*sneeringly*) Why don't you
play your part then, and—run
away?

[EXIT *Leonida*.]

II. 3.

Merc.

Scene 3.

ENTER *Trader*, WITH SERVANT.

Trader

Ut demonstratae sunt mihi, hasce aedis
esse oportet,
Demaenetus ubi dicitur habitare. i,
puere, pulta
atque atriensem Sauream, si est intus,
evocato huc.

Lib.

Quis nostras sic frangit fores? ohe,
inquam, si quid audis.

Merc.

Nemo etiam tetigit. sanum es?

Lib.

At censebam
attigisse
propterea, huc quia habebas iter. nolo
ego fores conservas
meas a te verberarier. sane ego sum
amicus nostris.

Merc.

Pol haud periculum est, cardines ne
foribus effringantur,
si istoc exemplo omnibus qui quaerunt
respondebis.

Lib.

390 Ita haec morata est ianua: extemplo
ianitorem
clamat, procul si quem videt ire ad se
calcitronem.
sed quid venis? quid quaeritas?

(*looking at house of Demaenetus*) According to directions, this must be the house where they say Demaenetus lives. (*to servant*) Go knock, my lad, and if steward Saurea is in there, call him out. (*servant goes toward house*)

Lib.

(*stepping forward*) Who's that battering our door so? Whoa there, I say—if you're not deaf!

Trader

No one has touched it yet. Are you in your senses?

Lib.

Well, I was thinking you had touched it, seeing you were making this way. I don't want you to beat that door—it's a fellow servant of mine. I tell you what, I love my fellow servants.

Trader

Gad! No danger of the door being battered off its hinges, if you answer all callers in that style.

Lib.

Here's the way this door has been trained: once it sights some bully in the distance coming towards it, it bawls for the porter directly. But what's

		your business? What are you after?
<i>Merc.</i>		<i>Trader</i>
	Demaenetum	I wished to see Demaenetus.
volebam.		
<i>Lib.</i>		<i>Lib.</i>
Si sit domi, dicam tibi.		If he was at home, I'd tell you.
<i>Merc.</i>		<i>Trader</i>
	Quid eius	What about his steward?
atriensis?		
<i>Lib.</i>		<i>Lib.</i>
Nihilo mage intus est.		No, he's not in, either.
<i>Merc.</i>		<i>Trader</i>
	Ubi est?	Where is he?
<i>Lib.</i>		<i>Lib.</i>
	Ad tonsorem	Said he was going to the barber's.
ire dixit.		
<i>Merc.</i>		<i>Trader</i>
Conveni. sed post non redit?		I met him. But he has not been back since?
<i>Lib.</i>		<i>Lib.</i>
	Non edepol.	Lord, no! What did you want?
quid volebas?		
<i>Merc.</i>		<i>Trader</i>
Argenti viginti minas, si adesset, accepisset.		He would have got eighty pounds, if he was here.
<i>Lib.</i>		<i>Lib.</i>
Qui pro istuc?		What for?
<i>Merc.</i>		<i>Trader</i>

Asinos vendidit Pellaeo
mercatori
mercatu.

Lib.

Scio. tu id nunc refers? iam
hic credo eum adfuturum.

Merc.

Qua facie voster Saurea est? si is est,
iam scire potero.

Lib.

Macilentis malis, rufulus aliquantum,
ventriosus,
400 truculentis oculis, commoda statura,
tristi fronte.

Merc.

Non potuit pictor rectius describere eius
formam.

Lib.

Atque hercle ipsum adeo contuor,
quassanti capite incedit.
quisque obviam huic occesserit irato,
vapulabit.

Merc.

Siquidem hercle Aeacidinis minis
animisque expletus incedit,
si med iratus tetigerit, iratus vapulabit.

He sold some asses at the
market to a trader from Pella.

Lib.

I know. Bringing the cash now,
are you? He'll be here soon, I,
fancy.

Trader

What does your Saurea look
like? (*aside*) Now I can find out
if that fellow is my man.

Lib.

(*reflectively*) Lantern-jawed—
reddish hair— pot-bellied—
savage eyes— average height—
and a scowl.

Trader

(*aside*) No painter could give
me a more living likeness of
that fellow.

Lib.

(*looking down street*) Yes, and
what's more, he's in sight
himself, by gad,—swaggering
along and shaking his head!
Anyone that crosses his path
when he's angry gets thrashed.

Trader

Good Lord! No matter if he
swaggers along as full of fire
and fury as Achilles—if your
angry man lays a hand on me,
it's your angry man gets
thrashed.

II. 4.

ENTER *Leonida*, APPARENTLY IN A RAGE.

Leon.

Quid hoc sit negoti, neminem meum
dictum magni facere?

Libanum in tonstrinam ut iusseram
venire, is nullus venit.

ne ille edepol tergo et cruribus consuluit
haud decore.

Merc.

Nimis imperiosust.

Lib.

Vae mihi.

Leon.

410 Hodie

salvere iussi
Libanum libertum? iam manu emissu's?

Lib.

Obsecro

te.

Leon.

Ne tu hercle cum magno malo mihi
obviam occessisti.
cur non venisti, ut iusseram, in
tonstrinam?

Lib.

Scene 4.

Leon.

What does this mean? Does no
one mind what I say? I told
Libanus to come to the barber's
shop, and he never came at all.
By the Lord, he hasn't given
due thought to the welfare of
his hide and shanks, that's a
fact!

Trader

(*aside*) A precious domineering
chap!

Lib.

(*affecting terror*) Oh, I'm in for
it!

Leon.

(*to Libanus ironically*) Ah,
greetings to Libanus the
freedman, is it, to-day? Have
you been manumitted now?
(*advancing*)

Lib.

(*cowering*) Please, please, sir!

Leon.

By heaven, I'll certainly give
you good reason to regret
crossing my path. Why didn't
you come to the barber's, as I
ordered?

Lib.

moratust.
Leon.
 Siquidem hercle nunc summum Iovem
 te dicas detinuisse
 atque is precator adsiet, malam rem
 effugies numquam.
 tu, verbero, imperium meum
 contempsisti?

Lib.

 hospes.
Merc.
 Quaeso hercle noli, Saurea, mea causa
 hunc verberare.
Leon.
 Utinam nunc stimulus in manu mihi sit.

Merc.

 quaeso.
Leon.
 Qui latera conteram tua, quae occalluere
 plagis.
 420 abscede ac sine me hunc perdere, qui
 semper me ira incendit,
 cui numquam unam rem me licet semel
 praecipere furi,
 quin centiens eadem imperem atque
 ogganniam, itaque iam hercle

Hic me

Perii,

Quiesce

(pointing to trader) This gentleman delayed me.

Leon.

(without looking at trader)
 Damme! You can go on and say Jove Almighty detained you, yes, and he can come here and plead your case, but you shall never escape a flogging. You scorned my authority, you whipping post?

Lib.

(running behind trader) Oh kind stranger, I'm a dead man!

Trader

By Jove, Saurea! Now, now, don't flog him, for my sake!

Leon.

(paying no attention) Oh, if I could only get hold of an ox goad now!

Trader

Now, now, calm down.

Leon.

So as to stave in those ribs of yours that have grown callous to blows! *(to trader)* Out of my way, and let me murder the rascal that always sets me afire with rage, that never lets one order from me suffice for one job, the criminal, but keeps me commanding and growling the

clamore ac stomacho non queo labori
suppeditare.
iussin, sceleste, ab ianua hoc stercus
hinc auferri?
iussin columnis deici operas araneorum?
iussin in splendorem dari bullas has
foribus nostris?
nihil est: tamquam si claudus sim, cum
fustist ambulandum.
quia triduum hoc unum modo foro
operam adsiduam dedo,
dum reperiam qui quaeritet argentum in
faenus, hic vos
430 dormitis interea domi, atque erus in
hara, haud aedibus habitat,
em ergo hoc tibi.

Lib.

Hospes, te obsecro,
defende.

Merc.

oro,
mea causa ut mittas.

Leon.

Eho, ecquis pro vectura
olivi
rem solvit?

same thing a hundred times
over. Good Lord, it's come to
the point where I can't stand the
work, what with yelling and
storming at him!

Didn't I tell you to carry off this
dung from the doorway, you
villain? Didn't I tell you to
clean the spiders' webs off the
columns? Didn't I tell you to
rub these door knobs till they
shone?

It's no good: anyone would
think I was lame, the way I
have to travel around after you
with a cane. Because I've been
constantly busy at the forum
just for the last three days,
trying to find some one to place
a loan with, here you've been
drowsing all the time at home,
and your master living in a pig-
pen, not a house. There now,
take that! (*strikes him*)

Lib.

Kind stranger! For heaven's
sake protect me!

Trader

Come, Saurea, do let him off
for my sake.

Leon.

(*to Libanus*) Hey, you! Did
anyone pay for the shipping of
that oil?

Lib.

Solvit.

Leon.

Cui datumst?

Lib.

Sticho

vicario ipsi
tuo.

Leon.

Vah, delenire apparas, scio mihi
vicarium esse,
neque eo esse servom in aedibus eri qui
sit pluris quam illest.
sed vina quae heri vendidi vinario
Exaerambo,
iam pro eis satis fecit Sticho?

Lib.

Fecisse satis

opinor,
nam vidi huc ipsum adducere trapezitam
Exaerambum.

Leon.

Sic dederō. prius quae credidi vix anno
post exegi;
nunc satagit: adducit domum etiam ultro
et scribit nummos.

440 Dromo mercedem rettulit?

Lib.

Lib.

Yes, sir.

Leon.

Who to?

Lib.

To Stichus himself, sir, your
own deputy.

Leon.

Hm-m! trying to smooth me
down! To be sure I have a
deputy, and there's not a slave
in the master's house that is a
more valuable man than that
deputy, either. But how about
the wine I sold to Exaerambus
the vintner yesterday—has he
settled with Stichus for it yet?

Lib.

I reckon he has, sir: for I saw
Exaerambus bringing the
banker here himself.

Leon.

That's the style for me! Last
time I trusted him I barely got
the money out of him a year
afterwards. Now he pays his
bills: even brings his banker
over to the house besides, and
writes his cheque. Has Dromo
brought home his wages?

Lib.

opinor.
Leon.
 Quid relicuom?
Lib.
 Aibat reddere quom
 extemplo redditum esset;
 nam retineri, ut quod sit sibi operis
 locatum efficeret.
Leon.
 Scyphos quos utendos dedi Philodamo,
 rettulitne?
Lib.
 Non etiam.
Leon.
 Hem non? si velis, da,¹¹
 commoda homini amico.
Merc.
 Perii hercle, iam his me abegerit suo
 odio.
Lib.
 iam satis tu.
 audin quae loquitur?
Leon.
 Audio et quiesco.
Merc.

Only half, I think.
Leon.
 And the rest?
Lib.
 He said he'd give it to you as
 soon as it was given to him;
 claimed it was kept back so that
 he'd finish up a job that was
 placed with him.
Leon.
 Those cups that I lent
 Philodamus—has he returned
 'em?
Lib.
 Not yet.
Leon.
 Hey? No? (*sourly*) Give things
 away, if you like,—give 'em to
 a friend on loan.
Trader
 (*half aside, wearily*) Oh, the
 devil! The fellow will be
 driving me off before long with
 his confounded talk.
Lib.
 (*aside to Leonida*) Hi, you!
 That's enough now! D'ye hear
 what he says?
Leon.
 (*aside to Libanus*) I hear; I'll
 calm down.
Trader

Tandem,
opinor,
conticuit. nunc adeam optimum est,
prius quam incipit tinnire.
quam mox mi operam das?

Leon.

Ehem, optume. quam
dudum tu advenisti?
450 non hercle te provideram—quaeso ne
vitio vortas—
ita iracundia obstitit oculis.

Merc.

Non mirum
factum est.
sed si domi est, Demaenetum volebam.

Leon.

Negat esse
intus.
verum istuc argentum tamen mihi si vis
denumerare,
repromittam istoc nomine solutam rem
futuram.

Merc.

Sic potius, ut Demaeneto tibi ero
praesente reddam.

Lib.

Erus istunc novit atque erum hic.

Merc.

(*aside*) Silent at last, I do
believe. Best approach him
now before he begins to rattle
on again. (*aloud to Leonida*)
How soon can you give me
your attention?

Leon.

(*looking at him and affecting
surprise*) Aha! Splendid! How
long have you been here? Well,
well, I hadn't noticed you
before! I trust you won't feel
offended. I was so angry that it
affected my eyesight.

Trader

Nothing strange in that. But I
wished to see Demaenetus, if
he is at home.

Leon.

He (*indicating Libanus*) says
he's not in. But as to that
money, though,—count it out to
me, if you like, and then I'll
engage that your account with
us is settled.

Trader

I should prefer to make the
payment in the presence of
your master Demaenetus.

Lib.

(*protestingly*) Oh, master
knows him and he knows
master.

Trader

Ero huic praesente
reddam.

Lib.

Da modo meo periculo, rem salvam ego
exhibebo;
nam si sciat noster senex fidem non esse
huic habitam,
suscenseat, quoi omnium rerum ipse
semper credit.

Leon.

460 Non magni pendo. ne duit, si non
volt, sic sine astet.

Lib.

Da, inquam. vah, formido miser, ne hic
me tibi arbitretur
suasisse, sibi ne crederes. da, quaeso, ac
ne formida:
salvom hercle erit.

Merc.

Credam fore, dum quidem
ipse in manu habebō.
peregrinus ego sum, Sauream non novi.

Lib.

At nosce
sane.

Merc.

Sit, non sit, non edepol scio. si is est,
eum esse oportet.

(*firmly*) I shall pay him in his
master's presence.

Lib.

Oh now, give it to him, at my
risk: I'll make it all right. Why,
if our old man knew Saurea
here was doubted, he'd be
furious: he always trusts him
with everything himself.

Leon.

(*very superior*) It's of no
importance. He can keep it, if
he wants. Let him stand by
with it there.

Lib.

(*aside to trader*) I say, do give
it to him. Oh dear, this is awful!
I'm afraid he'll think I
persuaded you not to trust him.
Give it to him, for mercy's
sake, and don't be afraid. Good
Lord, it'll be all right!

Trader

I trust it will be, so long as I
keep hold of it myself, anyway.
I am a stranger here: I don't
know Saurea.

Lib.

(*pointing to Leonida*) Well, just
make his acquaintance, then.

Trader

Whether he is the man or not, I
don't know, by gad. If he is, he
is, of course. I certainly do

ego certe me incerto scio hoc daturum
nemini homini.

Leon.

Hercle istum di omnes perduint. verbo
cave supplicassis.
ferox est viginti minas meas tractare
sese.
nemo accipit aufer te domum, abscede
hinc, molestus ne sis.

Merc.

470 Nimis iracunde. non decet superbum
esse hominem servom.

Leon.

Malo hercle iam magno tuo, ni isti nec
recte dicis.

Lib.

Impure, nihili. non vides irasci?

Leon.

porro.

Lib.

Flagitum hominis. da, obsecro, argentum
huic, ne male loquatur.

Merc.

know that when I am uncertain
I give this (*showing a wallet*) to
nobody on earth.

Leon.

Be damned to the fellow! (*to Libanus*) Not a word of
entreaty, you! He's puffed up at
having the handling of my
eighty pounds. (*to trader*) No
one will take it! Home with
you! Away with you! Don't
bother me!

Trader

(*scoffingly*) Quite in a pet! The
idea of a mere slave being
arrogant!

Leon.

(*to Libanus*) By heaven, you'll
soon pay dear for it, if you
don't abuse him!

Lib.

(*loudly to trader*) You dirty
thing, you, you good for
nothing! (*in lower tone*) Don't
you see he's angry?

Leon.

(*to Libanus*) Go on, get at him!

Lib.

(*loudly*) You scandal of a man!
(*in lower tone*) Do give him the
money, for heaven's sake, so
that he won't call you bad
names.

Trader

Malum hercle vobis quaeritis.

Leon.

Crura hercle
diffringentur,
ni istum impudicum percies.

Lib.

Perii hercle. age
impudice,
scelestes, non audes mihi scelestis
subvenire?

Leon.

Pergin precari pessimo?

Merc.

Quae res? tun
libero homini
male servos loquere?

Leon.

Vapula.

Merc.

Id quidem tibi
hercle fiet,
ut vapules, Demaenetum simulae
conspexero hodie.¹² 479

Leon.

484-485 Quid, verbero? ain tu, furcifer?
erum nos fugitare censes?
ei nunciam ad erum, quo vocas, iam
dudum quo volebas.

Gad! It's a bad time you two
are looking for.

Leon.

(to Libanus) By the Lord, your
legs shall be broken to
splinters, if you don't give that
shameless rascal a blowing up.

Lib.

(to trader in low tone) Oh
Lord! I'm in for it! (loudly)
Come, you shameless rascal,
you wretch, won't you help me,
poor wretch that I am?

Leon.

(to Libanus) Continuing to
coax that criminal, are you?

Trader

(getting indignant) How is this?
You dare to abuse a free man,
you, you slave?

Leon.

You be thrashed!

Trader

Be thrashed? Precisely what
will be done to you, by gad, the
moment I set eyes on
Demaenetus to-day!

Leon.

What, you whipping post? So,
you gallows-bird? D'ye think
we skulk from our master? On
with you straight to the master
you summon us to, the master

Merc.

Nunc demum? tamen numquam hinc
feres argenti nummum, nisi me
dare iusserit Demaenetus.

Leon.

Ita facito, age
ambula ergo.
tu contumeliam alteri facias, tibi non
dicatur?
tam ego homo sum quam tu.

Merc.

Scilicet. ita res est.

Leon.

490

Sequere hac ergo
praefiscini hoc nunc dixerim: nemo
etiam me accusavit
merito meo, neque me alter est Athenis
hodie quisquam,
cui credi recte aequae putent.

Merc.

Fortassis. sed
tamen me
numquam hodie induces, ut tibi credam
hoc argentum ignoto.
lupus est homo homini, non homo, quom
qualis sit non novit.

Leon.

you've wanted to see this long
time past. (*goes toward forum*)

Trader

At last, eh? But never a penny
do you get from me, unless I
am instructed to give it to you
by Demaenetus.

Leon.

All right, all right! Come, step
along, then! Do you want to
insult another man and not get
it back? I'm as much of a man
as you are!

Trader

No doubt. Quite so.

Leon.

Come along this way, then.
(*stops*) If I may say so without
presumption, let me tell you
this now: no one has ever yet
accused me justly, and there's
not a single other man in all
Athens that people think
worthy of such confidence as
me, either.

Trader

I dare say. But notwithstanding,
never will you induce me to-
day to trust this money to you,
a stranger, (*somewhat*
apologetically) "Man is no
man, but a wolf, to a stranger."

Leon.

Iam nunc secunda mihi facis. scibam
huic te capitulo hodie.
facturum satis pro iniuria; quamquam
ego sum sordidatus,
frugi tamen sum, nec potest peculium
enumerari.

Merc.

Fortasse.

Leon.

Etiam¹³ Periphanes Rhodo
mercator dives
500 absente ero solus mihi talentum
argenti soli
adnumeravit et mihi credidit, nequest
deceptus in eo.

Merc.

Fortasse.

Leon.

Atque etiam tu quoque ipse.
si esses percontatus
me ex aliis, scio pol crederes nunc quod
fers.

Merc.

negassim.

Haud

(*encouraged*) Now there, that's
decent of you! I knew you'd
soon be making amends to a
good fellow for doing him an
injustice. No matter if I do look
shabby, I'm an honest man just
the same, and as for the cash
I've laid by—it can't be
counted.

Trader

(*sceptically*) I dare say.

Leon.

Even Periphanes, the rich
trader from Rhodes, counted
out two hundred pounds to me
when master was away and we
were all by ourselves,—he
trusted me, and he wasn't
deceived in doing so, either.

Trader

I dare say.

Leon.

Yes, and even you yourself,
too, if you had only inquired
from others about me, I know
you would trust me with what
you've got there, good Lord,
yes!

Trader

(*icily*) I should be sorry to deny
it. (*motions Leonida to lead the
way to Demaenetus*)

[EXEUNT THE THREE TO THE
FORUM, *Leonida* IREFUL.]

ACTVS III

Cle.

Nequeon ego ted interdictis facere
mansuetem meis?
an ita tu es animata, ut qui matris expers
imperio sies?

Phil.

Ubi piem Pietatem, si istoc more
moratam tibi
postulem placere, mater, mihi quo pacto
praecipis?¹⁴ (507)

Cle.

(509) Hocine est pietatem colere. matris
imperium minuere?

Phil.

510 Neque quae recte faciunt culpo neque
quae delinquent amo.

Cle.

Satis dicacula es amatrix.

Phil.

Mater, is quaestus
mihi est:
lingua poscit, corpus quaerit; animus
orat, res monet.

Cle.

ACT III

(Half an hour has elapsed.)

ENTER *Cleareta* AND *Philaenium*
FROM THEIR HOUSE.

Cle.

Have I no power to make you
submit when I prohibit a thing?
Can it be that you feel inclined
to rid yourself of your mother's
authority?

Phil.

How should I be showing
myself duteous to Filial Duty,
mother, if I tried to please you
by practising such practices
and doing as you prescribe?

Cle.

Is this regarding filial duty, to
lessen a mother's authority?

Phil.

I don't find fault with mothers
that do right, and I don't like
ones that do wrong.

Cle.

A glib enough little hussy!

Phil.

(lightly) All in my profession,
mother: tongue asks, body
teases; fancy prompts,
circumstances suggest.

Cle.

Ego te volui castigare, tu mi accusatrix
ades.

Phil.

Neque edepol te accuso neque id me
facere fas existimo.
verum ego meas queror fortunas, cum
illo quem amo prohibeor.

Cle.

Ecqua pars orationis de die dabitur mihi?

Phil.

Et meam partem loquendi et tuam trado
tibi;
ad loquendum atque ad tacendum tute
habeas portisculum.
quin pol si reposivi remum, sola ego in
casteria
520 ubi quiesco, omnis familiae causa
consistit tibi.

Cle.

Quid ais tu, quam ego unam vidi
mulierem audacissimam?
quotiens te votui Argyrippum filium
Demaeneti
compellare aut contrectare, conloquive
aut contui?
quid dedit? quid ad nos iussit deportari?
an tu tibi
verba blanda esse aurum rere, dicta docta
pro datis?

I intended to scold you, and
here you are turning on me!

Phil.

Oh, no! I'm not turning on you:
I don't think that would be
right. But I do think it's a cruel
fate to be kept away from the
man I love.

Cle.

Am I to get some share of the
speechmaking before
nightfall?

Phil.

I give you my share and your
own, too: you can be
boatswain yourself and give
the signal for talking and
keeping still. But goodness me,
if I once lay down the oar, I,
and stay by myself resting in
the rowers' room, the progress
of this whole household stops
short, you see.

Cle.

Look here! Of all the impudent
young misses I have ever seen!
How many times have I
forbidden you to have
communication or contact or
chitchat with Demaenetus's
son, Argyrippus, or to cast
your eyes on him? What has he
given us? What has he had sent
us? Do you think pretty
speeches are gold pieces, witty

ultra amas, ultra expetessis, ultra ad te
accersi iubes
illos qui dant, eos derides; qui deludunt,
deperis.

an te id expectare oportet, si quis
promittat tibi
te facturum divitem, si moriatur mater
sua?
ecastor¹⁵ nobis periculum magnum et
familiae portenditur, 530
dum eius expectamus mortem, ne nos
moriatur fame.
nunc adeo nisi mi huc argenti adfert
viginti minas,
ne ille ecastor hunc trudetur largus
lacrumarum foras.
hic dies summus quo est¹⁶ apud me
inopiae excusatio.

Phil.

Patiar, si cibo carere me iubes, mater
mea.

Cle.

Non voto te amare qui dant quia
amentur gratia.

Phil.

Quid si hic animus occupatus, mater,
quid faciam? mone.

Cle.

words presents? You make
love to him yourself, run after
him yourself, have him called
yourself. Men that give you
things you treat with contempt;
those that trifle with you you
dote on.

Have you any business waiting
for it to happen, if a man does
promise to make you rich, if
his mother dies? Mercy me,
while we wait for her to die, up
looms a big risk of ourselves
and our household dying of
starvation! Now let me tell you
this: unless he brings me
eighty pounds, I swear to
goodness that fellow shall be
bundled out of the house,
liberal as he is—of tears! This
is the last day I accept pleas of
poverty.

Phil.

Tell me to do without food,
mother dear, and I'll endure
that.

Cle.

I have nothing to say against
your loving men who give you
something to be loved for.

Phil.

What if my heart isn't free,
mother? What then? Advise
me.

Cle.

Em,
meum caput contemples si quidem ex re
consultas tua.

Phil.

539, 540 Etiam opilio qui pascit, mater,
alienas ovis,
aliquam habet peculiarem, qui spem
soletur suam.
sine me amare unum Argyrippum animi
causa, quem volo.

Cle.

Intro abi, nam te quidem edepol nihil est
impudentius.

Phil.

Audientem dicto, mater, produxisti
filiam.

Look! Consider these grey
hairs of mine, if you really
have any regard for your own
good.

Phil.

Even the shepherd that
pastures other peoples' sheep
has some ewe lamb of his very
own, mother, one that he
builds happy hopes on. Do let
me love Argyrippus alone, the
man I want, just for love's
sake.

Cle.

Inside with you! Why, mercy
on us, a more shameless minx
than you really can't exist.

Phil.

(*tearfully*) You've trained ...
your ... daughter ... to ... be
obedient ... mother.

[EXIT *Philaenium* INTO HOUSE,
FOLLOWED BY *Cleareta*.]

III. 2.

Lib.

Perfidiae laudes gratiasque habemus
merito magnas,
quom nostris sycophantiis, dolis
astutiisque,¹⁷ (546)
advorsum stetimus lamminas,¹⁸ crucesque
compedesque, (548)

Scene 2.

ENTER FROM FORUM *Libanus*
AND *Leonida*, LATTER CARRYING
A WALLET.

Lib.

(*chanting ecstatically*) All
praise and thanks be to holy
Perfidy as she deserves, since
by our swindles, shams, and
wiles we have defied hot irons
and crosses and gyves, and

549, 550 nervos, catenas, carceres,
numellas, pedicas, boias
inductoresque¹⁹ acerrumos gnarosque
nostri tergi.²⁰ (551)

(554) eae nunc legiones, copiae
exercitusque eorum
vi pugnando periuriis nostris fugae potiti.
id virtute huius collegae²¹ meaque
comitate
factumst. qui me vir fortior ad sufferundas
plagas?

Leon.

Edepol virtutes qui tuas non possis
concludare
sic ut ego possim, quae domi duellique
male fecisti.
560 ne illa edepol pro merito tuo memorari
multa possunt:

ubi fidentem fraudaveris, ubi ero infidelis
fueris,
ubi verbis conceptis sciens libenter
periuraris,
ubi parietes perfoderis, in furto ubi sis
prehensus,
ubi saepe causam dixeris pendens
adversus octo
artutos, audacis viros, valentis virgatores.

Lib.

thongs, chains, cells, shackles,
fettters, collars, and painters—
painters keen as can be and
intimate with our backs!

All these regiments,
battalions, and armies of
theirs have been put to flight,
after fierce fighting, by our
fabrications. 'Tis the valour of
my colleague hath done it,
with my own kind assistance.
Who's a stouter-hearted hero
than I am at taking thwacks?

Leon.

(*sneeringly*) Good Lord! Your
deeds of valour—you couldn't
celebrate them the way I
could your villainies at home
and in the field. Gad! you
certainly can be accredited
with a lengthy list of things
along that line.

Item, cheated a confiding
friend; item, faithless to
master; item, committed
perjury consciously,
cheerfully, in set form of
words; item, dug your way
into houses through the walls;
item, caught at thieving; item,
strung up repeatedly and
plead your case before eight
bold, brawny beef-eaters with
a gift for club swinging.

Lib.

Fateor profecto ut praedicas, Leonida,
esse vera;
verum edepol ne etiam tua quoque
malefacta iterari multa
et vero possunt; ubi sciens fideli infidus
fueris,
ubi pressus in furto sies manifesto et
verberatus,²² 569
(571) ubi eris damno, molestiae et dedecori
saepe fueris,

ubi creditum quod sit tibi datum esse
pernegaris,²³ (572)
(574) ubi saepe ad languorem tua duritia
dederis octo
validos lictores, ulmeis adfectos lentis
virgis.
num male relata est gratia, ut collegam
collaudavi?

Leon.

Ut meque teque maxime atque ingenio
nostro decuit.

Lib.

Iam omitte ista atque hoc quod rogo
responde.

Leon.

Rogita

quod vis.

Lib.

Argenti viginti minas habesne?

Leon.

I am quite ready to admit that
is a just statement of the case,
Leonida; but, Lord! the list of
even your own villainies, too,
can certainly be made lengthy
enough, without injustice.
Item, consciously treacherous
to a trusting friend; item,
caught stealing redhanded and
whipped; item, repeatedly
brought loss, trouble, and
disgrace on your masters;
item, had money left in your
keeping and swore and swore
it wasn't; item, repeatedly
exhausted by your toughness
eight strong lictors equipped
with pliant elm rods. (*pause*)
Have I celebrated my
colleague highly enough to
pay him back—eh, what?

Leon.

(*thoughtfully*) Yes, pretty
much what you and I and our
characters deserved.

Lib.

Drop your nonsense now and
answer me this question.

Leon.

Ask your question.

Lib.

(*triumphantly*) The eighty
pounds, have you got it?

Leon.

Hariolare.

580 edepol senem Demaenetum lepidum
fuisse nobis:
ut adsimulabat Sauream med esse quam
facete!
nimis aegre risum contini, ubi hospitem
inclamavit,
quod se absente mihi fidem habere
noluisset.
ut memoriter me Sauream vocabat
atriensem.

Lib.

Mane dum.

Leon.

Quid est?

Lib.

Philaenium estne haec quae
intus exit
atque Argyrippus una?

Leon.

Opprime os, is est.
subauscultemus.

Lib.

Lacrumantem lacinia tenet lacrumans.
quidnam esse dicam?
taciti auscultemus.

Leon.

Attatae, modo hercle in
mentem venit,
nimis vellem habere perticam.

You're a prophet! By gad, old
Demaenetus did do the
handsome thing by us. The
way he pretended I was
Saurea—clever, my word! I
did have a deuce of a time
holding in when he hauled our
guest over the coils for not
being willing to trust me in
his absence. The way he
remembered to keep calling
me steward Saurea!

Lib.

(*looking toward Cleareta's
house*) Wait, though!

Leon.

What's up?

Lib.

Isn't this Philaenium coming
out here, yes, and Argyrippus
along with her?

Leon.

(*in low tone*) Shut your mouth
—so it is. Let's do some
eaves-dropping (*they retire*)

Lib.

Both crying and she holding
on to the lappet of his cloak!
What on earth is the matter!
Let's keep still and listen.

Leon.

Oh-h! Jove! It has just
occurred to me; how I do
wish I had a pole!

Lib.

Quoi rei?

Leon.

Qui

verberarem

590 asinos, si forte occeperint clamare hinc
ex crumina

Lib.

What for?

Leon.

To whop those asses, if they
happen to start braying in the
wallet here.

III. 3.

Scene 3.

ENTER *Argyrippus* AND
Philaenium FROM THE
DOORWAY OF *Cleareta's* HOUSE
WHERE THEY HAVE BEEN
STANDING.

Argyr.

Cur me retentas?

Phil.

Quia tui amans abeuntis

egeo.

Argyr.

Vale.

Phil.

Aliquanto amplius valerem, si his
maneres.

Argyr.

Salve.

Phil.

Salvere me iubes, quoi tu abiens
offers morbum?

Argyr.

(*sadly*) Why hold me back?

Phil.

(*tearfully*) Because it's
dreadful having you leave me
when I love you so.

Argyr.

(*trying half heartedly to
release himself*) Farewell!

Phil.

(*still clinging to him*) I
should fare much better if
you'd stay with me.

Argyr.

And God bless you!

Phil.

You ask God to bless me
when you curse me yourself
by going?

Argyr.

Mater supremam mihi tua dixit, domum ire
iussit.

Phil.

Acerbum funus filiae faciet, si te carendum
est.

Lib.

Homo hercle hinc exclusust foras.

Leon.

Ita res est.

Argyr.

Mitte

quaeso.

Phil.

Quo nunc abis? quin tu hic manes?

Argyr.

Nox, si voles,

manebo.

Lib.

Audin hunc opera ut largus est nocturna?
nunc enim esse
negotiosum interdus videlicet Solonem,
600 leges ut conscribat, quibus se populus
teneat. gerrae!
qui sese parere apparent huius legibus,
profecto
numquam bonae frugi sient, dies
noctesque potent.

Argyr.

Your mother said this was to
be my last hour; she has
ordered me home.

Phil.

She'll make her daughter die
in misery, if I must be
deprived of you.

Lib.

(*aside to Leonida*) By gad!
He's been shut out of the
house here.

Leon.

So he has.

Argyr.

(*dismally*) Come, come, let
go! (*pulls away from her and
turns to go*)

Phil.

Where are you off to now?
Why don't you stay here?

Argyr.

I will at night, if you want.

Lib.

Hear the chap—how free he
is with his attentions by
night? For now in the
daytime he's a hard-working
Solon, drawing up laws to
bind the people—oh, yes he
is! Rot! Folks that set
themselves to obey his laws
won't ever be good for

Leon.

Ne iste hercle ab ista non pedem discedat,
si licessit,
qui nunc festinat atque ab hac minatur sese
abire.

Lib.

Sermoni iam finem face tuo. huius
sermonem accipiam.

Argyr.

Vale.

Phil.

Quo properas?

Argyr.

Bene vale, apud Orcum
te videbo
nam equidem me iam quantum potest a
vita abiudicabo.

Phil.

Cui tu, obsecro, immerito meo me morti
dedere optas?

Argyr.

Ego te? quam si intellegam deficere vita,
iam ipse
610 vitam meam tibi largiar et de mea ad
tuam addam.

anything, that's sure,—except
drinking day and night.

Leon.

Good Lord! The fellow
wouldn't move a step from
her, if he had his way, not he,
for all this rush of his and
threats to leave her

Lib.

Come, make an end of your
talk. I want to take in some
of his.

Argyr.

(tragically) Farewell! (starts
away)

Phil.

Where are you hurrying to?

Argyr.

Farewell! Be happy. I shall
see you in the world to come!
For upon my soul, this world
and I shall now be divorced
as soon as possible!

Phil.

(running up and clinging to
him) Oh, for heaven's sake,
why, why do you wish to
condemn me to death
yourself, innocent as I am?

Argyr.

I you? If I saw your life was
ebbing, I'd freely give you
my own at once and add my
years to yours.

Phil.

Cui ergo minitans mihi, te vitam esse
amissurum?
nam quid me facturam putas, si istuc quod
dicis faxis?
mihi certum est facere in me omnia eadem
quae tu in te faxis.

Argyr.

Oh melle dulci dulcior tu es.

Phil.

Certe enim tu vita es
mi.
complectere.

Argyr.

Facio lubens.

Phil.

Utinam sic
efferamur.

Leon.

O Libane, uti miser est homo qui amat.

Lib.

Immo hercle
vero,
qui pendet multo est miserior.

Leon.

Scio qui
periculum feci.
circum sistamus, alter hinc, hinc alter
appellemus.

Phil.

Then why do you threaten
me with throwing away your
life? For what do you think I
will do, if you do what you
say? My mind's made up: I'll
do to myself just precisely
what you do to yourself.

Argyr.

Oh, you're sweeter than
sweet honey!

Phil.

And you're my very life, I
know that. Do put your arms
around me!

Argyr.

(*doing so*) Yes, yes, gladly!

Phil.

Oh, if we could only be
carried to the grave like this!

Leon.

I say, Libanus, what a poor
devil a chap in love is!

Lib.

By Jove, no! A chap hung up
by his heels is a much poorer
devil, believe me.

Leon.

I know that: I've tried it. (*a
pause*) Let's surround him,
and give him a salute, one
from here (*pointing*) and the
other from here. (*they station
themselves: then, giving the*

ere, salve. sed num fumus est haec mulier
quam amplexare?

Argyr.

Quidum?

Leon.

620 Quia oculi sunt tibi
lacrumantes, eo rogavi.

Argyr.

Patronus qui vobis fuit futurus, perdidistis.

Leon.

Equidem hercle nullum perdidici, ideo quia
numquam ullum habui.

Lib.

Philaenium, salve.

Phil.

Dabunt di quae velitis
vobis.

Lib.

Noctem tuam et vini cadum velim, si
optata fiant.

Argyr.

Verbum cave faxis, verbero.

Lib.

*signal to Libanus to chime in,
loudly to Argyrippus)* Good
day, sir! (*the lovers give a
start*) But—this lady you're
hugging isn't smoke, is she?

Argyr.

Smoke? Why so?

Leon.

Well, your eyes are watering;
that's why I asked.

Argyr.

(*tragically*) You have lost a
man who would have freed
you and been your patron,
my lads.

Leon.

Lord! I haven't lost any such,
no, indeed, seeing I never
had any such.

Lib.

Good day to you,
Philaenium.

Phil.

God grant all your wishes, to
both of you.

Lib.

I'd wish an evening with you
and a cask of wine, if
wishing was having.

Argyr.

Hold your tongue, you
rascal!

Lib.

Tibi equidem, non
mihi opto.
Argyr.
Tum tu igitur loquere quod lubet.
Lib.
Hunc hercle
verberare.
Leon.
Quisnam istuc adcredat tibi, cinaede
calamistrate?
tun verberes, qui pro cibo habeas te
verberari?
Argyr.
Ut vestrae fortunae meis praecedunt,
Libane, longe,
qui hodie numquam ad vesperum vivam.
Lib.
630 Quapropter,
quaeso?
Argyr.
Quia ego hanc amo et haec me amat, huic
quod dem nusquam quicquam est,
hinc meo amantem ex aedibus eiecit huius
mater.
argenti viginti minae me ad mortem
appulerunt,
quas hodie adulescens Diabolus ipsi
daturus dixit,
ut hanc ne quoquam mitteret nisi ad se
hunc annum totum.

Oh, wish 'em for you, I mean,
sir, not for myself.
Argyr.
Then in that case, say what
you like.
Lib.
Like? I'd like to give this
chap (*pointing to Leonida*) a
thrashing, by gad!
Leon.
(*ironically*) Well, well, who'd
believe it of you, you frizzle-
headed girl-hunter? You
thrash me, you, you that live
on thrashings?
Argyr.
(*tragical again*) Ah, Libanus,
how far preferable your lot is
to mine—I who will never
never live till evening!
Lib.
How's that, for mercy's sake?
Argyr.
Because I love her
(*indicating Philaenium*) and
she loves me, and (*bitterly*)
never a penny can I find
anywhere to give her; and her
mother has thrown me out of
the house here, me, her
daughter's lover. I'm driven
to my death by eighty
pounds, eighty pounds young
Diabolus promised to pay her

videtin viginti minae quid pollent quidve
possunt?
ille qui illas perdit salvos est, ego qui non
perdo pereo.

Lib.

Iam dedit argentum?

Argyr.

Non dedit.

Lib.

Bono animo es, ne
formida.

Leon.

Secede huc, Libane, te volo.

Lib.

Si quid vis.

Argyr.

Obsecro
vos
640 eadem istac opera suaviust complexos
fabulari.

Lib.

Non omnia eadem aequè omnibus, ere,
suavia esse scito:
vobis est suave amantibus complexos
fabulari,

to-day for letting no one else
but him have my girl the
whole of this next year. Do
you see the power, the
possibilities in eighty
pounds? The man that loses
them is saved. I don't lose
them and I'm lost myself.

Lib.

Has he paid 'em over
already?

Argyr.

No.

Lib.

Cheer up; never you fear.

Leon.

Libanus! Come over here: I
want you.

Lib.

(*obeying*) Anything to please.
(*they withdraw and talk,*
heads close together)

Argyr.

(*calling*) For heaven's sake,
you two! You'd find it
pleasanter to hug each other,
while you do your chatting!

Lib.

Tastes differ about what's
pleasant, sir, let me tell you
that. A fond pair like you find
it pleasant to hug each other
while you do your chatting;

ego complexum huius nil moror, meum
autem hic aspernatur.
proinde istud facias ipse quod faciamus
nobis suades.

Argyr.

Ego vero, et quidem edepol lubens.
interea, si videtur,
concedite istuc.

Leon.

Vin erum deludi?

Lib.

Dignust

sane.

Leon.

Vin faciam ut te Philaenium praesente hoc
amplexetur?

Lib.

Cupio hercle.

Leon.

Sequere hac.

Argyr.

Ecquid est salutis?

satis locuti.

Leon.

but, personally, I don't care
for this fellow's hugs, and as
for mine, he scorns 'em. So
you go on and practise
yourself what you preach to
us.

Argyr.

Indeed I will, by Jove, yes,
and gladly. Meanwhile you
two go on and step aside
there, if you see fit.

(embraces Philaenium)

Leon.

D'ye want to have some fun
with master?

Lib.

That I do, serves him right.

Leon.

D'ye want me to make
Philaenium give you a
squeeze right before his face?

Lib.

(enthusiastically) Gad, I long
for one!

Leon.

Come along. *(leads the way
back to Argyrippus and
(Philaenium))*

Argyr.

Any good news? You have
talked enough.

Leon.

Auscultate atque operam date et mea dicta
devorate.

650 primum omnium servos tuos nos esse
non negamus,
sed tibi si viginti minae argenti
proferentur,
quo nos vocabis nomine?

Argyr.

Libertos.

Leon.

Non

patronos?

Argyr.

Id potius.

Leon.

Viginti minae hic insunt in
crumina,
has ego, si vis, tibi dabo.

Argyr.

Di te servassint

semper,
custos erilis, decus popli, thesaurus
copiarum,
salus interioris²⁴ corporis amorisque
imperator.
hic pone, hic istam colloca cruminam in
collo plane.

Leon.

Nolo ego te, qui erus sis, mihi onus istuc
sustinere.

Argyr.

(*importantly*) Listen here,
you two; pay attention and
devour my remarks, (to
Argyrippus) First of all, we
are your slaves, we don't
deny that; but if eighty
pounds is produced for you,
what will you call us?

Argyr.

(*eagerly*) Freedmen!

Leon.

Not patrons, eh?

Argyr.

Yes, yes, patrons!

Leon.

There's eighty pounds in this
wallet here: I'll give it to you
if you like.

Argyr.

Heaven prosper you for
evermore, you guardian of
your master, you glory of the
populace, you storehouse of
supplies, saviour of the inner
man, and generalissimo of
love! Put it here, hang that
wallet here around my neck
in plain sight.

Leon.

Let my master bear such a
load? No sir, not I.

Argyr.

Quin tu labore liberas te atque istam
imponis in me?

Leon.

660 Ego baiulabo, tu, ut dacet dominum,
ante me ito inanis.

Argyr.

Quid nunc?

Leon.

Quid est?

Argyr.

Quin tradis huc cruminam
pressatum umerum?

Leon.

Hanc, cui daturus hanc, iube petere atque
orare mecum.
nam istuc proclive est, quo iubes me plane
collocare.

Phil.

Da, meus ocellus, mea rosa, mi anime,
mea voluptas,
Leonida, argentum mihi, ne nos diiunge
amantis.

Leon.

Dic me igitur tuom passerulum, gallinam,
coturnicem,

Why not take things easy
yourself and let me stand the
strain?

Leon.

I'll act as porter myself; as
for you, you walk on ahead
as a master should, empty
handed.

Argyr.

(eagerly) Well now?

Leon.

(drawling) Well what?

Argyr.

Why don't you hand the
wallet over and let it crush
my shoulder?

Leon.

She's the one, (*pointing to
Philaenium*) the one you'll
give it to, tell her to ask me
for it, tease me for it. You see
that plain site you told me to
put it on is a (*with a sly
glance at Philaenium*) slope.

Phil.

Oh, Leonida, you apple of
my eye, my rosebud, my
heart's delight, my darling,
do give me the money! Don't
separate us lovers.

Leon.

(*with burlesque fondness*)
Well then, call me your little
sparrow, hen, quail, call me

agnellum haedillum me tuom die esse vel
vitellum.

prehende auriculis, compara labella cum
labellis.

Argyr.

Ten osculetur, verbero?

Leon.

Quam vero
indignum visum est?
670 at qui pol hodie non feres, ni genua
confricantur.

Argyr.

Quidvis egestas imperat: fricentur. dan
quod oro?

Phil.

Age, mi Leonida, obsecro, fer amanti ero
salutem,
redime istoc beneficio te ab hoc, et tibi
eme hunc isto argento.

Leon.

Nimis bella es atque amabilis, et si hoc
meum esset, hodie
namquam me orares quin darem. illum te
orare meliust,
illic hanc mihi servandam dedit ei sane
bella belle,

your little lambkin, kidlet, or
calfyboy, if you prefer: take
hold of me by the earlaps and
match my little lips to your
little lips.

Argyr.

She kiss you, you scoundrel?

Leon.

Yes, it does seem a shame,
doesn't it? However, you
don't get the cash this day, by
gad, unless you rub my
knees.

Argyr.

"Need knows no shame."
Rubbed they shall be. (*gets
down on ground, with poor
grace, and clasps Leonida's
knees*) Won't you grant my
prayer? (*gets up*)

Phil.

Come, dear Leonida, please,
please save your master that
loves me so! Buy your
freedom from him by this
kindness, buy his favour for
yourself with this money!
(*embraces him*)

Leon.

(*leering at her*) Ah, you're
pretty, perfectly adorable:
and if this belonged to me, I'd
never let you tease me twice
for it, never. But he's the one
for you to tease: (*pointing to*

cape hoc sis, Libane.

Argyr.

Furcifer, etiam me delusisti?

Leon.

Numquam hercle facerem, genua ni tam
nequiter fricares.
age sis tu in partem nunciam hunc delude
atque amplexare hanc.

Lib.

Taceas, me spectes.

Argyr.

680 Quin ad hunc, Philaenium,
adgredimur,
virum quidem pol optimum et non
simulem furis huius?

Lib.

Inambulandum est: nunc mihi vicissam
supplicabunt.

Argyr.

Libanus) he gave it to me to
keep for him. At him now,
my pretty, prettily. Libanus,
catch hold of this, will you!
(*tosses him the wallet*)

Argyr.

What, you villain! Have you
been making a fool of me?

Leon.

Bless you, sir, I wouldn't,
only you made such a bad
job of rubbing my knees.
(*aside to Libanus*) Come on
now, will you; you take your
turn at fooling him and
cuddling her.

Lib.

(*aside to Leonida*) Shut up:
you watch me!

Argyr.

(*aside to Philaenium*) Why
not make up to him,
Philaenium? He's a very
decent sort, Libanus is, gad
yes, nothing like this thief.
(*indicating Leonida*)

Lib.

(*aside as they approach*)
Now for some strutting
around: here's where I come
in for being supplicated.
(*parades magnificently back
and forth*)

Argyr.

Quaeso hercle, Libane, sis erum tuis factis
sospitari,
da mihi istas viginti minas. vides me
amantem egere.

Lib.

Videbitur. factum volo. redito huc
contemno
nunc istanc tantisper iube petere atque
orare
mecum.

Phil.

Amandone exorarier vis ted
an osculando?

Lib.

Enim vero utrumque.

Phil.

Ergo, obsecro, et tu
utrumque nostrum serva.

Argyr.

O Libane, mi patrone, mi trade istuc.
magis decorumst
690 libertum potius quam patronum onus in
via portare.

Phil.

Mi Libane, ocellus aureus, donum
decusque amoris,
amabo, faciam quod voles, da istuc
argentum nobis.

Hang it all, Libanus, for
mercy's sake be a good
fellow and save your master's
life! Give me that eighty
pounds. You see I'm in love
and need the money.

Lib.

We'll see about it. Happy if I
can oblige. Come back early
in the evening. Meanwhile
now just tell the lady there to
ask me for it and tease me for
it.

Phil.

Tease it from you by loving
you, or by kissing you,
which?

Lib.

Oh well, try both of 'em.

Phil.

(*fondling him*) And both of
us, then,—do rescue us,
please, please!

Argyr.

O Libanus, my dear patron,
do hand it over to me! A
freedman is the proper
person to carry a load on the
street, not his patron.

Phil.

My own Libanus, my little
golden treasure boy, love's
gift and glory, oh, I'll adore
you, do anything for you,
only give us that money!

Lib.

Dic igitur med anitculam, columbam vel
catellum,
hirundinem, monerulam, passerulum
putillum,
fac proserpentem bestiam me, duplicem ut
habeam linguam,
circumda torquem brachiiis, meum collum
circumplecte.

Argyr.

Ten complectatur, carnufex?

Lib.

Quam vero indignus
videor?
ne istuc nequiquam dixeris tam indignum
dictum in me,
vehes pol hodie me, si quidem hoc
argentum ferre speres.

Argyr.

Ten ego veham?

Lib.

700 Tun hoc feras argentum
aliter a me?

Argyr.

Perii hercle. si verum quidem et decorum
erum vehere servom,
inscende.

Lib.

Lib.

Then call me your little
duddy, dovey, doggieboy,
your swallow, your little
jackdaw, your little tootsie
wootsie sparrowkin:
(*opening his mouth*) make a
reptile of me and let me have
a double tongue in my
mouth; throw a chain of arms
around me; clasp me close
around my neck.

Argyr.

Put her arms around you, you
gallows-bird!

Lib.

An awful shame, isn't it,
really now? Not to have you
saying such shameful things
of me free of charge, you'll
carry me on your back to-
day, by gad, that is, if you
count on getting this cash.

Argyr.

I carry you on my back—I?

Lib.

See any other way of getting
this cash, do you—you?

Argyr.

O damnation! Well, if it is
right and proper for a master
to carry a servant on his back
—get up.

Lib.

Sic isti solent superbi
subdomari.
asta igitur, ut consuetus es puer olim scin
ut dicam?
em sic. abi, laudo, nec te equo magis est
equos ullus sapiens.

Argyr.

Inscende actutum.

Lib.

Ego fecero hem quid
istuc est? ut tu incedis?
demam hercle iam de hordeo, tolutim ni
badizas.

Argyr.

Amabo, Libane, iam sat est.

Lib.

Numquam hercle
hodie exorabis
nam iam calcari quadrupedo agitabo
advorsum clivom,
postidea ad pistores dabo, ut ibi cruciere
currens.
710 asta ut descendam nunciam in proclivi,
quamquam nequam es.

Here's how those toplofty
ones are tamified. Now then,
stand by—the way you used
to do years ago as a boy.
Know how I mean?
(*Argyrippus sidles up and
bends over*) There! That's it!
Good for you! Capital! There
isn't a more knowing bit of
horse-flesh than you
anywhere.

Argyr.

Get up, and be quick about it!

Lib.

(*springing on his shoulders*)
So I will. (*Argyrippus moves
off slowly*) Hullo! What's the
matter? How you do jog
along! By gad, I'll dock your
barley directly, if you don't
stir yourself and gallop.
(*Argyrippus gallops*)

Argyr.

There's a good fellow,
Libanus,—that's enough
now!

Lib.

Not on your life—you don't
beg off this day. Why, now
I'm going to dig the spurs in
and trot you up a hill:
afterwards I'll hand you over
to the millers to do some
running for 'em at the end of
a rawhide. Stand still! so that

Argyr.

Quid nunc, amabo? quoniam, ut est
libitum, nos delusistis,
datisne argentum?

Lib.

Si quidem mihi statuam et
aram statuis
atque ut deo mi hic immolas bovem: nam
ego tibi Salus sum.

Leon.

Etiam tu, ere, istunc amoves abs te atque²⁵
ipse me adgrederere
atque illa, sibi quae hic iusserat, mihi
statuis supplicasque?

Argyr.

Quem te autem divom nominem?

Leon.

Fortunam, atque
Obsequentem.

Argyr.

Iam istoc es melior.

Lib.

I can dismount on the slope
now, even though you are a
good-for-nothing beast. (*gets
off*)

Argyr.

How about it now? There's a
good fellow! Seeing you two
have had your fill of sport
with me, going to give us the
money, are you?

Lib.

Oh well, if you put me up an
altar and statue, yes, and
offer me up an ox here the
same as a god: for I'm your
goddess Salvation, I am.

Leon.

Come, sir, get rid of that
chap, won't you, and apply to
me in person, yes, and let me
have those statues and
supplications he ordered for
himself.

Argyr.

Ah, and by what name does
your godship pass?

Leon.

Fortune, yes sir, Indulgent
Fortune.

Argyr.

Now there's where you are
better.

Lib.

An quid est homini
 Salute melius?
Argyr.
 Licet laudem Fortunam, tamen ut ne
 Salutem culpem.
Phil.
 Ecastor ambae sunt bonae.
Argyr.
 Sciam ubi boni quid
 dederint.
Leon.
 Opta id quod ut contingat tibi vis.
Argyr.
 Quid si optaro?
Leon.
 Eveniet.
Argyr.
 Opto annum hunc perpetuom mihi huius
 operas.
Leon.
 Impetrasti.
Argyr.
 Ain vero?
Leon.
 Certe inquam.
Lib.
 Ad me adi vicissim atque
 experire.

Eh? what's better for a man
 than Salvation?
Argyr.
 I can praise Fortune and still
 not disparage Salvation.
Phil.
 Mercy me, they're both good.
Argyr.
 I'll know so when I get
 something good out of them.
Leon.
 Wish for something you want
 to happen to you.
Argyr.
 What if I do?
Leon.
 It'll come true.
Argyr.
 My wish is to have this lady's
 attentions this whole next
 year through.
Leon.
 You've got it.
Argyr.
 Really? really?
Leon.
 Sure thing I tell you.
Lib.
 It's my turn—come over here
 and give me a trial. Long for

exopta id quod vis maxime tibi evenire:
fiet.

Argyr.

Quid ego aliud exoptem amplius nisi illud
cuius inopiast,
viginti argenti commodas minas, huius
quas dem matri.

Lib.

Dabuntur, animo sis bono face, exoptata
optingent.

Argyr.

Ut consuevere, homines Salus frustratur et
Fortuna.

Leon.

Ego caput huic argento fui hodie
reperiundo.

Lib.

Ego pes fui.

Argyr.

Quin nec caput nec pes
sermoni apparet.
730 nec quid dicatis scire nec me cur
ludatis possum.

Lib.

Satis iam delusum censeo. nunc rem ut est
eloquamur.
animum. Argyrippe, advorte sis. pater nos
ferre hoc iussit

something you most want to
come true: it will.

Argyr.

What could I long for more
than something I haven't got
a trace of—a round eighty
pounds to give this girl's
mother?

Lib.

Forthcoming. Keep your
courage up: your longing will
be gratified.

Argyr.

(*incredulous*) Salvation is at
her old tricks, fooling people,
and Fortune too.

Leon.

In lighting on this cash to-
day—I'm the one that's been
the head of it!

Lib.

I'm the one that's been the
foot of it!

Argyr.

And upon my soul, your
discourse is a puzzle from
head to foot. I can't
understand your talk, or why
you're making game of me.

Lib.

(*aside to Leonida*) I move
he's been fooled with long
enough. Come on, let's out
with it. (*to Argyrippus*) Your
kind attention, Argyrippus!

argentum ad ted.

Argyr.

Ut temperi opportuneque
attulistis.

Lib.

Hic inerunt viginti minae bonae, mala
opera partae;
has tibi nos pactis legibus dare iussit.

Argyr.

est, quaeso?

Quid id

Lib.

Noctem huius et cenam sibi ut dares.

Argyr.

Iube advenire
quaeso:
meritissimo eius quae volet faciemus, qui
hosce amores
nostros dispulsos compulit.

Leon.

Patierin, Argyrippe,
patrem hanc amplexari tuom?

Argyr.

Haec faciet facile ut patiar

Your father told us to bring
this money to you. (*holding
up wallet*)

Argyr.

Oh, you've brought it just in
time, just at the right
moment!

Lib.

You'll find in here eighty
good sovereigns ill-gotten: he
said to give 'em to you
according to terms agreed
upon.

Argyr.

Terms? What terms, for
mercy's sake?

Lib.

That you're to give him an
evening with this lady, and a
dinner.

Argyr.

Tell him to come along, yes,
yes! We'll do what he wants,
and quite right we should,
after the way he's gathered
our scattered love to the fold.
(*takes wallet from Libanus*)

Leon.

Going to put up with your
father's hugging her, are you,
Argyrippus?

Argyr.

(*waving wallet*) This will
easily enable me to put up

740 Leonida, curre obsecro, patrem huc
orato ut veniat.

Leon.

Iam dudum est intus.

Argyr.

Hac quidem non venit.

Leon.

Angiporto
illac per hortum circum ut clam, ne quis se
videret.
huc ire familiarium: ne uxor resciscat
metuit
de argento si mater tua sciat ut sit factum
—

Argyr.

Heia,
bene dicite.

Lib.

Ite intro cito.

Argyr.

Valete.

Leon.

Et vos
amate.

ACTVS IV

with it. Leonida, for heaven's
sake run and beg my father to
come here.

Leon.

(*pointing to Cleareta's house*)
He was in there long ago.

Argyr.

He certainly didn't come this
way.

Leon.

Sneaked in by the alley there
through the garden, so that
none of the servants would
see him enter: he's afraid of
his wife finding out. If your
mother was to learn about the
money, how it was—

Argyr.

Hold on there! No ominous
remarks!

Lib.

In with you, quick!

Argyr.

Good-bye, you two.

Leon.

And spoon away, you two.
[EXEUNT *Argyrippus* AND
Philaenium INTO *Cleareta's*
HOUSE, *Libanus* AND *Leonida*
INTO HOUSE OF *Demaenetus*.]

ACT IV

ENTER *Diabolus* AND *Parasite*.

Diab.

Agedum istum ostende quem conscripsti
syngraphum
inter me et amicam et lenam. leges pellege
nam tu poeta es prorsus ad eam rem
unicus.

Par.

Horrescet faxo lena, leges cum audiet.

Diab.

Age quaeso mi hercle translege.

Par.

Audin?

Diab.

750 Audio.

Par.

"Diabolus Glauci filius Clearetae
lenae dedit dono argenti viginti minas,
Philaenium ut secum esset noctes et dies
hunc annum totum."

Diab.

Neque cum quiquam alio
quidem.

Par.

Addone?

Diab.

Diab.

Come on, show me that
contract you drew up between
me and my mistress and the
Madame. Read over the
terms. Ah, you're the one and
only artist at this business.

Par.

(*producing a document*) I
warrant you Madame will
shudder when she hears the
terms.

Diab.

Come come, man, for the
Lord's sake let's have 'em!

Par.

Are you listening?

Diab.

Yes.

Par.

(*reading*) "Diabolus, son of
Glaucus, has given to
Cleareta, Madame, a present
of eighty pounds to the end
that Philaenium throughout
the coming year may spend
her nights and days with
him."

Diab.

Yes, and not with anyone
else, either.

Par.

Shall I add that?

Diab.

Adde, et scribas vide plane et
probe.

Par.

"Alienum hominem intro mittat neminem.
quod illa aut amicum aut patronum
nominet,
aut quod illa amicae²⁶ amatorem
praedicet,
fores occlusae omnibus sint nisi tibi.
760 in foribus scribat occupatam esse se.

aut quod illa dicat peregre allatam
epistulam,
ne epistula quidem ulla sit in aedibus
nec cerata adeo tabula; et si qua inutilis
pictura sit, eam vendat: ni in quadriduo
abalienarit, quo abs te argentum acceperit,
tuos arbitratus sit, comburas, si velis,
ne illi sit cera, ubi facere possit litteras.

vocet convivam neminem illa, tu voces;
ad eorum ne quem oculos adiciat suos.
770 si quem alium aspexit, caeca continue
siet.
tecum una potet, aequae pocula potitet:
abs te accipiat, tibi propinet, tu bibas,
ne illa minus aut plus quam tu sapiat."

Add that, and see you put it
down in a good firm hand.

Par.

(*after doing so*) "She is to
admit no male outsider into
her house. In case she call
him a mere friend or
guardian, or in case she allege
him to be the lover of a friend
of hers, her doors must be
closed to all but you. She
must post a notice on the
doors stating that she is
engaged.

Or in case she say that a letter
from foreign parts has been
delivered to her, there must
be no letter at all in the house,
nor so much as a waxen
tablet; and if there be any
undesirable picture about, let
her sell it: unless she shall
have removed it within four
days after receipt of your
money, it shall be at your
disposal: you may burn it up,
if you deem fit, that she may
have no wax whereon to
write.

She must invite no guest to
the house: you shall invite
them; and she must have eyes
for none of them. If her
glance has fallen on another
man, she must become blind
forthwith. She must drink

Diab.

placet.

Par.

"Suspiciones omnes ab se segreget.
neque illaec ulli pede pedem homini
premat,
cum surgat, neque cum in lectum
inscendat proximum,
neque cum descendat inde, det cuiquam
manum:
spectandum ne cui anulum det neque
roget.
talos ne cuiquam homini admoveat nisi
tibi.
780 cum iaciat, 'te' ne dicat: nomen
nominet.

deam invocet sibi quam libebit propitiam,
deum nullum; si magis religiosa fuerit,
tibi dicat: tu pro illa ores ut sit propitius.
neque illa ulli homini nutet, nictet, annuat.
post, si lucerna exstincta sit, ne quid sui
membri commoveat quicquam in
tenebris."

Satis

with you only, and drink with
you glass for glass: let her
receive the glass from your
hands, drink to your health,
and then do you take it and
drink, so that she may have
no—(*unobtrusively dropping
the aspirate*) whit more than
you, nor less."

Diab.

(*not noticing*) Quite
satisfactory.

Par.

"She must keep herself above
every suspicion. She must not
touch feet with any man when
she arises from table: and
when she steps upon the
adjoining couch, or steps
down therefrom, she must
take no one's hand. She must
give no one her ring to look
at, nor ask to look at his. To
no man save yourself must
she pass the dice. On making
a throw she must not say,
'Thee^E I invoke!' She is to
name your name.

Let her call upon any goddess
she pleases for favour, but
upon no god; if she have
religious scruples in regard to
this, let her tell you, and do
you make the prayer for his
favour in her stead. To no
man shall she nod, wink, or

Diab.

Optumest.
ita scilicet facturam. verum in cubiculo—
deme istuc—equidem illam moveri gestio.
nolo illam habere causam et votitam
dicere.

Par.

Scio, captiones metuis.

Diab.

Verum.

Par.

790 Ergo ut iubes
tollam.

Diab.

Quid ni?

Par.

Audi relicua.

Diab.

Loquere, audio.

Par.

"Neque ullum verbum faciat perplexabile,
neque ulla lingua sciat loqui nisi Attica,
forte si tussire occepsit, ne sic tussiat,
ut cuiquam linguam in tussiendo proserat.
quod illa autem simulet, quasi gravedo
profluat,

signify compliance. Further,
if the lamp go out, she is not
to move a single limb in the
darkness."

Diab.

Excellent! To be sure she
mustn't, (*pause*) But in our
own room—cut that clause
out—why, I'm keen as can be
for her to be lively there! I
don't want her to have an
excuse and say the contract
forbids.

Par.

I see, you fear some catch.

Diab.

Exactly.

Par.

Well then, I shall strike that
out, as you order.

Diab.

Of course you will.

Par.

Listen to the rest.

Diab.

Go on: I am listening.

Par.

"She must use no phrase of
double meaning, and must
know how to speak no
language but the Attic. If she
should happen to cough, she
is not to cough so,

hoc ne sic faciat: tu labellum abstergeas
potius quam cuiquam savium faciat
palam.

nec mater lena ad vinum accedat interim,
800 nec ulli verbo male dicat. si dixerit,
haec multa ei esto, vino viginti dies
ut careat."

Diab.

Pulchre scripsi. scitum
syngraphum.

Par.

"Tum si coronas, sarta, unguenta iusserit
ancillam ferre Veneri aut Cupidini,
tuos servos servet, Venerine eas det an
viro.

800 si forte pure velle habere dixerit,
tot noctes reddat spurcas quot pure
habuerit."

haec sunt non nugae, non enim mortualia.

(*illustrating*) in such a way as
to extend her tongue toward
anyone. Moreover, in case
she pretends to have a
running cold, she must not do
this: (*purses his lips*) you are
to wipe her little lip yourself
rather than let her pucker up
her mouth for anyone so
obviously.

Nor shall the Madame, her
mother, drop in while you are
having your wine, or say a
single abusive word to
anyone. If such a word be
said by her, the penalty shall
be this—no wine for her for
twenty days."

Diab.

Splendid document! Capital
contract!

Par.

"Then if she bid her maid
carry chaplets, wreaths,
perfumes to Venus or to
Cupid, your servant shall
observe whether she gives
them to Venus, or to a man.
Should she happen to express
a wish for religious seclusion,
she must give you as many
hours of love as she has of
loneliness." These be no
trifles; these be no dirges for
dead folk, I tell you. The

Diab.
Placent profecto leges, sequere intro.
Par.
Sequor.

IV. 2.

Diab.
810 Sequere hac, egone haec patiar
aut taceam? emori
me malim, quam haec non eius uxori
indicem.
ain tu? apud amicam munus
adulescentuli
fungare, uxori excuses te et dicas
senem?
praeripias scortum amanti atque
argentum obicias
lenae? supples clam domi uxorem
tuam?

suspendam potius me, quam tu haec
tacita auferas.
iam quidem hercle ad illam hinc ibo,
quam tu propediem,
nisi quidem illa ante occupassit te,
effliges scio,
luxuriae sumptus suppeditare ut
possies.
Par.

terms are highly satisfactory.
Follow me in.

Diab.
Very well.
Par.

[EXEUNT INTO *Cleareta's*
HOUSE: SOUND OF WRANGLING
WITHIN: RE-ENTER *Diabolus*
AND *Parasite* FROM HOUSE.]

Scene 2.

Diab.
(*incensed*) Come along! I put up
with this? I hold my tongue? I'd
rather perish from the earth than
not let it out to his wife! (*shouting*
to Demaenetus within) You will,
will you? You will play the gay
young spark with a mistress and
excuse yourself to your wife on the
plea of old age, eh? You will
snatch a girl from her lover and
toss your money to the Madame,
eh? You will filch things from your
lady at home on the sly, eh?

I'd sooner hang myself than let you
carry it off so and nothing said. By
the Lord, I'll go to her this very
minute, I will, the woman you're
bound to bring to pauperism
shortly,—if she doesn't forestall
you, that is,—just so that you may
be kept in funds for your orgies!
Par.

820 Ego sic faciundum censeo: me
honestiust,
quam te palam hanc rem facere, ne
illa existimet
amoris causa percitum id fecisse te
magis quam sua causa.

Diab.

At pol qui dixti
rectius.
tu ergo fac ut illi turbas lites concias;
cum suo sibi gnato unam ad amicam
de die
potare, illam expilare narra.

Par.

Ne mone,
ego istud curabo.

Diab.

(827) At ego te opperiar
domi.²⁷

ACTVS V

Dem.

830 Numquidnam tibi molestumst, gnate
mi, si haec nunc mecum accubat?

(*calmly, judiciously*) In my
opinion, this is the way we should
handle the case: it would look
better for me to appear in the
matter than you; she might think
you were hard hit and did it more
out of jealousy than out of regard
for her.

Diab.

Right you are, gad yes, that is
better! Then raise hell for him
yourself; stir up a row; notify her
that he's having a daylight carouse
with his own son, one girl between
'em there at her house, and she
herself being rooked for it!

Par.

No advice needed! I shall take care
of that.

Diab.

Well, I'll wait for you at home.²⁷
[EXIT.]

ACT V

THE DOOR OF *Cleareta's* HOUSE IS
OPEN, SHOWING *Argyrippus*,
Demaenetus, AND *Philaenium*
BANQUETING, *Philaenium* BEING
ON A COUCH BESIDE *Demaenetus*
AND TRYING NOT TO SEEM BORED
BY HIS GALLANTRIES.

Dem.

You don't mind it, do you, my
boy,—her being on the couch

Argyr.

Pietas, pater, oculis dolorem prohibet.
quamquam ego istanc amo,
possum equidem inducere animum, ne
aegre patiar quia tecum accubat.

Dem.

Decet verecundum esse adolescentem,
Argyrippe.

Argyr.

Edepol,

pater,
merito tuo facere possum.

Dem.

Age ergo, hoc agitemus
convivium
vino et ²⁸sermoni suavi. nolo ego metui,
amari mavolo,
mi gnate, me abs te.

Argyr.

Pol ego utrumque facio, ut
aequom est filium.

Dem.

Credam istuc, si esse te hilarum videro.

Argyr.

An tu me

tristem putas?

here with me? (*merrily chucks
Philaenium under the chin*)

Argyr.

(*dolefully*) My duty as a son
takes the sting out of the sight,
father. Even though I do love
her, of course I can persuade
myself not to be disturbed at her
being with you.

Dem.

A young fellow should be
modest, Argyrippus.

Argyr.

Ah yes, father, I can behave as
you deserve.

Dem.

(*jovially*) Come on then, let's
have a lively banquet—wine
and sweet converse, my dears!
None of your filial awe for me:
your love is what I want, my
lad.

Argyr.

(*still more dolefully*) Ah yes,
father, I give you both, as a son
should.

Dem.

I'll believe that, once I see you
looking jolly.

Argyr.

(*with a deep sigh*) You don't
think I'm ... melancholy ... do
you?

Dem.

Putem ego, quem videam aequae esse
maestum ut quasi dies si dicta sit?

Argyr.

Ne dixis istuc.

Dem.

839, 840 Ne sic fueris: ilico
ego non dixero.

Argyr.

Em aspecta: rideo.

Dem.

Utinam male qui mihi
volunt sic rideant.

Argyr.

Scio equidem quam ob rem me, pater,
tu tristem credas nunc tibi:
quia istaec est tecum. atque ego quidem
hercle ut verum tibi dicam. pater,
ea res me male habet; at non eo, quia
tibi non cupiam quae velis;
verum istam amo. aliam tecum esse
equidem facile possum perpeti.

Dem.

At ego hanc volo.

Argyr.

Ergo sunt quae exoptas:
mihi quae ego exoptem volo.

Dem.

Think so? When you look as
sepulchral as if you were
docketed for trial!

Argyr.

Don't say that.

Dem.

Don't be that, and I'll stop
saying it soon enough.

Argyr.

(making a dismal effort to look
happy) Here now! See! I'm
smiling.

Dem.

(dryly) I wish my enemies were
blessed with a smile like that.

Argyr.

Of course I know why you think
my bearing toward you now is
melancholy, father,—because
she's with you. And good
heavens, father, to tell you the
truth, I—it does make me
miserable; not because I'm not
eager to have your wishes
gratified; but I love that girl. If it
was some other one, I shouldn't
mind at all, really I shouldn't.

Dem.

I want this one, though.

Argyr.

Well then, you've got your
desire: I wish I could have the
same luck!

Dem.

Unum hunc diem perpetere, quoniam
tibi potestatem dedi,
cum hac annum ut esses, atque amanti
argenti feci copiam.

Argyr.

Em istoc me facto tibi devinxti.

Dem.

849, 850 Quin te
ergo hilarum das mihi?

V. 2.

Art.

Ain tu meum virum his potare, obsecro,
cum filio
et ad amicam detulisse argenti viginti
minas
meoque filio sciente id facere flagitium
patrem?

Par.

Neque divini neque mi humani posthac
quicquam accreduas,
Artemona, si huius rei me esse mendacem
inveneris.

Art.

At scelestas ego praeter alios meum
virum²⁹ frugi rata,

Dem.

Oh, you'll take it calmly this one
day, now that I've given you the
chance to be with her for a year,
and furnished forth my young
gallant with funds.

Argyr.

Just the point! You have me
bound hard and fast by that.

Dem.

Come then, surrender and be
jolly, won't you?

Scene 2.

ENTER *Artemona* AND *Parasite*
FROM HOUSE OF *Demaenetus*.

Art.

(*tempestuously*) What's that,
for heaven's sake,—my
husband carousing here with
his son, and brought eighty
pounds to a mistress, and my
son conniving at such an
outrage on the part of his
father, his father?

Par.

Never trust me in another
thing divine or human,
madam, if you find I have
misinformed you in this.

Art.

But oh dear me! I thought my
husband was the very
paragon of men, a sober man,

siccum, frugi, continentem, amantem
uxoris maxume.

Par.

At nunc dehinc scito illum ante omnes
minimi mortalem preti,
madidum, nihili, incontinentem atque
osorem uxoris suae.

Art.

860 Pol ni istaec vera essent, numquam
faceret ea quae nunc facit.

Par.

Ego quoque hercle illum antehac hominem
semper sum frugi ratus,
verum hoc facto sese ostendit, qui quidem
cum filio
potet una atque una amicam ductet,
decrepitus senex.

Art.

Hoc ecastor est quod ille it ad cenam
cottidie.
ait sese ire ad Archidemum, Chaeream,
Chaerestratum,
Cliniam, Chremem, Cratinum, Diniam,
Demosthenem:
is apud scortum corruptelae est liberis,
lustris studet.

Par.

a worthy, moral man that
loved his wife devotedly.

Par.

But from now on you must
realize that he is the very
scum of the earth, a toping
man, a worthless, immoral
man that hates the wife of his
bosom.

Art.

Mercy yes! unless all that
was true, he would never be
acting as he does now.

Par.

I always thought he was a
worthy man myself before to-
day, upon my soul I did: but
now he shows himself in his
true colours—carousing with
his own son and sharing his
mistress with him, the old
ruin!

Art.

Good gracious! This explains
his going out to dinner every
day! He with his tales of
going to dine with
Archidemus, Chaerea,
Chaerestratus, Clinia,
Chremes, Cratinus, Dinias,
Demosthenes—and all the
time corrupting his children
at a harlot's, haunting houses
of ill fame!

Par.

Quin tu illum iubes ancillas rapere
sublimen domum?

Art.

Tace modo. ne ego illum ecastor miserum
habebo.

Par.

scio,
ita fore illi dum quidem cum illo nupta
eris.

Art.

870 Ego
censeo.
eum³⁰ etiam hominem in senatu dare
operam aut clientibus,
ibi labore delassatum noctem totam
stertere:
ille opere foris faciendo lassus noctu ad
me advenit;
fundum alienum arat, incultum familiarem
deserit.
is etiam corruptus porro suom corrumpit
filium.

Par.

Sequere hac me modo, iam faxo ipsum
hominem manifesto opprimas.

Art.

Nihil ecastor est quod facere mavelim.

Why not tell your maids to
pick him up and take him off
home?

Art.

You just keep still. Oh, but
I'll make life miserable for
him, I swear I will!

Par.

I have no doubt about that,
just as long as he is your
husband.

Art.

(*too irate to notice
unflattering accent*) Yes,
indeed! He busy in the Senate
or helping his clients! He
wearied out by his labours
there, there, that he spends
the whole night snoring! It is
business away from home
that makes him turn up at
night all weary—the business
of ploughing other people's
fields and leaving his own
uncultivated. Corrupt
himself, he actually goes on
and corrupts his own son.

Par.

Just follow me this way: I'll
soon make you drop on our
gentleman in the very act.

Art.

Ah-h-h! There's nothing I'd
like better!

<i>Par.</i>		<i>Par.</i>
dum.	Mane	Hm! wait! (<i>goes quietly to Cleareta's door, peeps in and comes back</i>)
<i>Art.</i>		<i>Art.</i>
est?	Quid	What's the matter?
<i>Par.</i>		<i>Par.</i>
Possis, si forte accubantem tuum virum conspexeris cum corona amplexum amicam, si videas, cognoscere?		If you happened to spy your husband stretched out on a banquet couch with a garland on and a girl in his arms—if you saw him, could you recognize him?
<i>Art.</i>		<i>Art.</i>
Possum ecastor.		Indeed I can!
<i>Par.</i>		<i>Par.</i>
Em tibi hominem.		(<i>taking her cautiously to the door</i>) Behold your man!
<i>Art.</i>		<i>Art.</i>
Perii.		(<i>peeping</i>) Dreadful, dreadful!
<i>Par.</i>		<i>Par.</i>
880 Paulisper mane. aucupemus ex insidiis clanculum quam rem gerant.		(<i>drawing her aside</i>) Wait a bit! Let's lie in ambush and spy what's going on without being seen.
<i>Argyr.</i>		<i>Argyr.</i>
Quid modi, pater, amplexando facies?		(<i>resentfully</i>) Father! When is that hug going to end?
<i>Dem.</i>		<i>Dem.</i>
Fateor, gnate mi—		(<i>somewhat embarrassed</i>) I admit, my dear boy,—
<i>Argyr.</i>		<i>Argyr.</i>

Quid fatere?

Dem.

Me ex amore huius corruptum
oppido.

Par.

Audin quid ait?

Art.

Audio.

Dem.

Egon ut non domo uxori
meae
subripiam in deliciis pallam quam habet,
atque ad te deferam?
non edepol conduci possum vita uxoris
annua.

Par.

Censen tu illum hodie primum ire
adsuetum esse in ganeum?

Art.

Ille ecastor suppilabat me, quod ancillas
meas
susplicabar atque insontis miseras
cruciabam.

Argyr.

Pater,
890 iube dari vinum; iam dudum factum est
cum primum bibi.

Dem.

Admit what?

Dem.

That this lady is altogether
too much for my sense of
decorum.

Par.

(to Artemona) Do you hear
what he says?

Art.

I hear!

Dem.

(to Philaenium) Not steal my
wife's pet mantle from home
and bring it to you? By
heaven, I couldn't be hired
not to—not if she should die
within the year.

Par.

(to Artemona) Do you think
to-day is the first time that
gentleman has used such
resorts?

Art.

Mercy on us! So he was the
thief all those times I
suspected my maids, yes, and
tortured the poor innocent
things.

Argyr.

Tell them to set the wine
going, father; it seems an age
since I had my first drink.

Dem.

Da, puere, ab summo. age, tu interibi ab infimo da savium.

Art.

Perii misera, ut osculatur carnufex, capuli decus.

Dem.

Edepol animam suaviorem aliquanto quam uxoris meae.

Phil.

Dic amabo, an fetet anima uxoris tuae?

Dem.

Nauteam
bibere malim, si necessum sit, quam illam
oscularier.

Art.

Ain tandem? edepol ne tu istuc cum malo magno tuo
dixisti in me. sine, revenias modo domum,
faxo ut scias
quid pericli sit dotatae uxori vitium dicere.

Phil.

Miser ecastor es.

Art.

(*to servant*) Boy, send round the wine from the head of the table. (*to Philaenium*) Come, my dear, meanwhile you send round a naughty, naughty kiss from the foot. (*Philaenium obeys*)

Art.

Oh-h-h! Good heavens! The way he kisses, the villain, fit only to grace a coffin!

Dem.

My word! Rather sweeter breath than my wife's!

Phil.

Do tell me, there's a dear—your wife's breath isn't bad, is it?

Dem.

I'd rather drink bilge water, if it came to that, than kiss her.

Art.

(*aside*) So? You would, would you? Good gracious, sir, that fling at me will cost you dear. Very well! just you come back home, sir! I'll show you the danger of vilifying a wife with money.

Phil.

Goodness me, you poor thing!

Art.

Ecastor dignus est.

Argyr.

Quid ais,
pater?
ecquid matrem amas?

Dem.

900 Egone illam? nunc
amo, quia non adest.

Argyr.

Quid cum adest?

Dem.

Periisse cupio.

Par.

Amat homo hic
te, ut praedicat.

Art.

Ne illa ecastor faenerato funditat: nam si
domum
redierit hodie. osculando ego ulciscar
potissimum.

Argyr.

Iace, pater, talos, ut porro nos iaciamus.

Dem.

Maxime.

(*aside*) Goodness me, he
deserves to be!

Argyr.

Look here, father. Do you
love my mother?

Dem.

Love her? I? I love her now
for not being near.

Argyr.

And when she is near?

Dem.

I yearn for a death in the
family.

Par.

(*to Artemona*) This
gentleman is fond of you, it
seems.

Art.

(*aside*) Oh-h-h! won't he pay
interest on that flow of
words! Just let him come
back home to-day, and that
will be my favourite method
of revenge—kissing him.

Argyr.

(*pushing some dice toward
Demaenetus*) Your throw,
father: come, so that I can
take my turn.

Dem.

By all means. (*as he throws*)
Here's to you for me,
Philaenium, and my wife for

te, Philaenium, mihi atque uxoris mortem,
hoc Venerium est.
pueri, plaudite et mi ob iactum cantharo
mulsum date.

Art.

Non queo durare.

Par.

Si non didicisti fulloniam,
non mirandum est.³¹ in oculos invadi
optumum est.

Art.

Ego pol vivam et tu istaec hodie cum tuo
magno
malo invocavisti.

Par.

910 Ecquis currit
pollictorem accersere?

Argyr.

Mater, salve.

Art.

Sat salutis.

Par.

Mortuost
Demaenetus.
tempus est subducere hinc me; pulchre hoc
gliscit proelium.

the tomb! (*looking at throw*)
Ha! The Venus!^F (*to*
servants) A cheer, lads, and
some mead from the tankard
for that throw!

Art.

(*aside to Parasite*) This is
intolerable!

Par.

(*aside to Artemona*) No
wonder, if you never learned
the fuller's^G trade. Your best
plan is to make a dash for his
eyes.

Art.

(*bursting into house*) My
heavens, sir, I will live, and
you shall pay dear for that
petition of yours just now!
(*tableau*)

Par.

(*gleefully*) Run, some one,
and fetch the undertaker!

Argyr.

(*innocently*) How do you do,
mother?

Art.

Enough of your how d'ye do-
ing!

Par.

(*aside*) Demaenetus is dead.
Time for me to retire from
the scene; the battle waxes
finely. I'll off to Diabolus and

ibo ad Diabolum, mandata dicam facta ut
voluerit,
atque interea ut decumbamus suadebo, hi
dum litigant.

poste demum huc cras adducam ad lenam,
ut viginti minas
ei det, in partem hac amanti ut liceat ei
potirier.

Argyrippus exorari spero poterit, ut sinat
sese alternas cum illo noctes hac frui. nam
ni impetro,
regem perdidit: ex amore tantum est
homini incendium.

Art.

Quid tibi hunc receptio ad te est meum
virum?

Phil.

quidem
miseram odio enicavit.

Art.

domum. Surge, amator, i

Dem.

Nullus sum.

Art.

tell him his mandates are
executed to the letter, yes,
and suggest our taking dinner
meantime, while they fight it
out.

Then to-morrow when it's
over I'll bring him back to the
Madame so that he may give
her the eighty pounds and get
her permission for his fond
self to go shares in the girl
here. I do hope Argyrippus
can be induced to let him
have her half the time. For if
I don't get so much out of
him, I have lost a patron—all
one blaze of love, as the
fellow is.

[EXIT *Parasite.*

Art.

(to *Philaenium*) What do you
mean by receiving this man
at your house—my husband?

Phil.

Dear, dear! Why, I'm fairly
bored to death by him, for my
part.

Art.

(standing over *Demaenetus*)
Get up, my gallant; home
with you!

Dem.

(half aside, afraid to move)
I'm a dead man!

Art.

Immo es, ne nega, omnium
unus pol nequissimus.
at etiam cubat cuculus. surge amator, i
domum.

Dem.

Vae mihi.

Art.

Vera hariolare. surge, amator,
i domum.

Dem.

Abscede ergo paululum istuc.

Art.

Surge, amator, i
domum.

Dem.

Iam obsecro, uxor.

Art.

Nunc uxorem me esse
meministi tuam?
modo, cum dicta in me ingerebas, odium,
non uxor eram.

Dem.

Totus perii.

Art.

Quid tandem? anima fetetne
uxoris tuae?

Good gracious, no! You're the
vilest man living, and you
needn't deny it. But he's
roosting there still, the
cuckoo! Get up, my gallant;
home with you!

Dem.

(half aside) Oh, I'm in for it!

Art.

You are a true prophet. Get
up, my gallant; home with
you!

Dem.

Well then, do stand a bit
farther off.

Art.

Get up, my gallant; home
with you!

Dem.

For heaven's sake now, my
dear!

Art.

Now you recollect that I am
your dear, do you? A moment
ago, when you were saying
things about me, I was your
abomination, not your dear.

Dem.

(half aside) It's all up with
me, absolutely!

Art.

You really meant it, did you?
Your dear's breath smells,
does it?

Dem.
Murram olet.

Art.
Iam subrupuisti pallam, quam
scorto dares?

Phil.
930 Ecastor qui subrupturum pallam
promisit tibi.

Dem.
Non taces?

Argyr.
Ego dissuadebam, mater.

Art.
Bellum
filium.
istoscine patrem aequom est mores liberis
largirier?
nilne te pudet?

Dem.
Pol, si aliud nil sit, tui
me, uxor, pudet.

Art.
Cano capite te cuculum uxor ex lustris
rapit.

Dem.

Dem.
(*hastily*) Smells of myrrh,
myrrh!

Art.
(*ironically*) Have you stolen
the mantle yet to give this
creature?

Phil.
He promised he would steal it
from you, indeed he did!

Dem.
(*aside to Philaenium*) Shut
up, won't you?

Argyr.
I tried to dissuade him,
mother.

Art.
A pretty son! (*to*
Demaenetus) Is this the way
for a father to edify his
children? Is there nothing
you're ashamed of? (*helps*
him off the couch by the ear)

Dem.
Oh Lord! You make me
ashamed, my dear, if nothing
else would.

Art.
(*guiding him toward the*
door) It's your dear that is
dragging you from this den of
vice, your hoary-headed
cuckoo!

Dem.

Non licet manere—cena coquitur—dum
cenem modo?

Art.

Ecastor cenabis hodie, ut dignus es,
magnum malum.

Dem.

Male cubandum est: iudicatum me uxor
abducit domum.

Argyr.

Dicebam, pater, tibi, ne matri consuleres
male.

Phil.

De palla memento, amabo.

Dem.

Iuben hanc hinc
abscedere?

Art.

I domum.

Phil.

940 Da savium etiam prius
quam abis.

Dem.

I in
crucem.

Phil.

Mayn't I stay—dinner's being
cooked—just till I've dined?

Art.

Good heavens, sir! You shall
dine as you deserve today—
on dire distress.

Dem.

(aside) It's a poorish night
I'm in for: here I am
sentenced, and my wife
leading me off—home.
*(Argyrippus and Philaenium
follow them to door)*

Argyr.

I kept telling you, father, not
to play any tricks on mother.

Phil.

Remember about the mantle,
there's a dear!

Dem.

(to wife) Tell her to get out of
here, won't you?

Art.

(jerking him along) Home
with you!

Phil.

Do give me another naughty,
naughty kiss before we part.

Dem.

Go to hell!

Phil.

Immo intro potius. sequere hac me, mi anime.

Argyr.

sequor.

Ego vero

Oh no, inside, instead, (to Argyrippus, as she goes back inside) Come along with me, darling.

Argyr.

Indeed I will.

[EXEUNT OMNES.]

GREX

Hic senex si quid clam uxorem suo
animo fecit volup,
neque novum neque mirum fecit nec
secus quam alii solent;
nec quisquam est tam ingenio duro
nec tam firmo pectore,
quin ubi quicque occasionis sit sibi
faciat bene.
nunc si voltis deprecari huic seni ne
vapulet,
remur impetrari posse, plausum si
clarum datis.

EPILOGUE

(Spoken by the Company)

If this old gentleman has indulged his inclinations a bit without informing his wife, he has done nothing new or strange, or different from what other men ordinarily do. No one has such an iron nature, such an unyielding heart, as not to do himself a good turn whenever he has any chance. So now in case you wish to beg the old fellow off from a beating, we opine that you can succeed, if you—give us some loud applause.

-
[1.](#) Leo brackets following v., 25-26:
*ita me obstinate adgressu's, ut non
audeam
profecto, percontanti quin promam omnia.*

[2.](#) Leo brackets following v., 33:
*ubi flent nequam homines, qui polentam
pinsitant.*

[A.](#) Where he might be beaten with ox-hide whips.

[B.](#) It has seemed advisable to use the terms of the English coinage system throughout this version; the value of the

3. Corrupt (Leo): *obsequellam* MSS: *obsequellam eam* Acidalius.

4. Leo brackets following v., 77:
volo amori obsecutum illius, volo amet me patrem.

5. Corrupt (Leo): *venari autem rete iaculo* MSS: *reti, iaculo venari autem* Vahlen.

6. Leo notes lacuna here: *atqui ibi* MSS: *ibo atque ibi* Camerarius.

7. Corrupt (Leo): *experiri* MSS: *experi* Skutsch.

8. Leo brackets following v., 252:
igitur inveniundo argento ut fingeres fallaciam.

9. Leo notes lacuna here: *istuc* MSS: *istuc, istuc* Palmer.

10. Corrupt (Leo): *exasciato* Acidalius: *exasceatum* MSS.

11. Leo notes lacuna here: *da* MSS: *dare* Fleckeisen.

12. Leo brackets following vv., 480-483:
in ius voco te.

Leon.

Non eo.

Merc.

Non is? memento.

Leon.

money metals, however, has shrunk very considerably since Plautus's day.

C. The elm corresponded to our birch in being used for corporal punishment.

D. White horses were supposed to be the fastest.

E. Naming one's sweetheart, on making a throw, was a common custom.

F. The highest throw.

G. Fullers being accustomed to unpleasant smells.

Memini.

Merc.

*Dabitur pol supplicum mihi de tergo
vostro.*

Leon.

Vae te

*tibi quidem supplicum, carnufex de nobis
detur?*

Merc.

Atque

etiam

*pro dictis vestris maledicis poenae
pendentur mi hodie.*

[13.](#) *etiam nunc dico* MSS: Lindsay
excises *nunc dico*.

[14.](#) Leo brackets following v., 508:
Cle.

*An decorum est adversari meis te
praeceptis?*

Phil.

Quid

est?

[15.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *nobis* excised by
Bothe.

[16.](#) *quo est* Leo: not in MSS.

[17.](#) Leo brackets following v., 547:
*scapularum confidentia, virtute ulmorum
freti.*

[18.](#) *advorsum stetimus* Ussing: *qui
advorsum stimulos* MSS.

[19.](#) *Inductoresque* Acidalius and others:
indoctoresque MSS.

[20.](#) Leo brackets following v., 552—

*qui saepe ante in nostras scapulas
cicatrices indiderunt—*
and assumes lacuna following.

[21.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *collegae* MSS:
collegae mei Leo.

[22.](#) Leo brackets following v., 570:
*ubi periuraris, ubi sacro manus sis
admolitus.*

[23.](#) Leo brackets following v., 573:
*ubi amicae quam amico tuo fueris magis
fidelis.*

[24.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *interioris* MSS:
interior Bothe.

[25.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *atque ad me
adgredire* Langen.

[26.](#) Leo notes slight lacuna here.
amicae suae Gulielmius.

[27.](#) Leo brackets following v., 828, 829:
Argyr.
Age, decumbamus sis, pater.

Dem.

*Ut iusseris,
mi gnate, ita fiet.*

Argyr.

Pueri, mensam adponite.

[28.](#) et Pius: *ut* MSS.

[29.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *fui* Pylades: *fueram*
Leo.

[30.](#) Corrupt (Leo). *hominem (aut)*
Camerarius.

[31.](#) *non mirandumst*, (Artemona. Art.).
In Havet.

[27.](#)

Argyr.

Come father, let's take our
places, please.

Dem.

Just as you say, my dear boy.

Argyr. (to slaves)

Bring the table, my lads.

-

AULULARIA

THE POT OF GOLD

Argument I	ACT III	ACT IV
Argument II	Scene 2	Scene 2
Dramatis	Scene 3	Scene 3
Personae	Scene 4	Scene 4
Prologue	Scene 5	Scene 5
ACT I	Scene 6	Scene 6
Scene 2		Scene 7
ACT II		Scene 8
Scene 2		Scene 9
Scene 3		Scene 10
Scene 4		ACT V
Scene 5		Summary of missing
Scene 6		text
Scene 7		Fragments
Scene 8		Footnotes
Scene 9		

ARGVMENTVM I

Senex avarus vix sibi credens Euclio
domi suae defossam multis cum
opibus
aulam invenit, rursumque penitus
conditam
exanguis amens servat. eius filiam
Lyconides vitiat. interea senex
Megadorus a sorore suasus ducere
uxorem avari gnatam deposcit sibi.

durus senex vix promittit, atque aulae
timens
domo sublatam variis abstrudit locis.
insidias servos facit huius Lyconidis
10 qui virginem vitiat; atque ipse
obsecrat
avonculum Megadorum sibimet
cedere
uxorem amanti. per dolum mox
Euclio
cum perdidisset aulam, insperato
invenit
laetusque natam conlocat Lyconidi.

ARGVMENTVM II

ARGUMENT OF THE PLAY (I)

A miserly old man named Euclio, a man who would hardly trust his very self, on finding a pot full of treasure buried within his house, hides it away again deep in the ground, and, beside himself with terror, keeps watch over it. His daughter had been wronged by Lyconides. Meanwhile an old gentleman, one Megadorus, is persuaded by his sister to marry, and asks the miser for his daughter's hand.

The dour old fellow at length consents, and, fearing for his pot, takes it from the house and hides it in one place after another. The servant of this Lyconides, the man who had wronged the girl, plots against the miser; and Lyconides himself entreats his uncle, Megadorus, to give up the girl, and let him, the man that loves her, marry her. After a time Euclio, who had been tricked out of his pot, recovers it unexpectedly and joyfully bestows his daughter upon Lyconides.

ARGUMENT OF THE PLAY (II)

Aulam repertam auri plenam Euclio
Vi summa servat, miseris adfectus
 modis.
Lyconides istius vitiat filiam.
Volt hanc Megadorus indotatam
 ducere,
Lubensque ut faciat dat coquos cum
 obsonio.
Auro formidat Euclio, abstrudit
 foris.
Re omni inspecta compressoris
 servolus
Id surpit. illic Euclioni rem refert.
Ab eo donatur auro, uxore et filio.

Euclio, on finding a pot full of
 gold, is dreadfully worried, and
 watches over it with the greatest
 vigilance. Lyconides wrongs his
 daughter. This girl, undowered
 though she is, Megadorus wishes
 to marry, and he cheerfully
 supplies cooks and provisions for
 the wedding feast. Anxious about
 his gold, Euclio hides it outside the
 house. Everything he does having
 been witnessed, a rascally servant
 of the girl's assailant steals it. His
 master informs Euclio of it, and
 receives from him gold, wife, and
 son.

PERSONAE

LAR FAMILIARIS PROLOGVS
 EVCLIO SENEX
 STAPHYLA ANVS
 EVNOMIA MATRONA
 MEGADORVS SENEX
 PYTHODICVS SERVVS
 CONGRIO COCVS
 ANTHRAX COCVS
 STROBILVS SERVVS
 LYCONIDES ADVLESCENS
 PHAEDRIA PVELLA
 TIBICINAE

DRAMATIS PERSONAE

THE HOUSEHOLD GOD OF
 EUCLIO, *the Prologue*.
 EUCLIO, *an old gentleman of
 Athens*.
 STAPHYLA, *his old slave*.
 EUNOMIA, *a lady of Athens*.
 MEGADORUS, *an old gentleman of
 Athens, Eunomia's brother*.
 PYTHODICUS, *his slave*.
 CONGRIO, *cook*.
 ANTHRAX, *cook*.
 STROBILUS, *slave of Lyconides*.
 LYCONIDES, *a young gentleman of
 Athens, Eunomia's son*.
 PHAEDRIA, *Euclio's daughter*.
 MUSIC GIRLS.

*Scene—Athens. A street on which
are the houses of Euclio and
Megadorus, a narrow lane
between them, in front an altar.*

PROLOGVS

LAR FAMILIARIS

Ne quis miretur qui sim, paucis
eloquar
ego Lar sum familiaris ex hac familia
unde exeuntem me aspexistis. hanc
domum
iam multos annos est cum possideo et
colo
patri avoque iam huius qui nunc hic
habet
sed mi avos huius obsecrans
concredidit
thensaurum auri clam omnis. in
medio foco
defodit, venerans me ut id servarem
sibi.
is quoniam moritur—ita avido
ingenio fuit—
10 numquam indicare id filio voluit
suo,
inopemque optavit potius eum
relinquere,
quam eum thensaurum
commonstraret filio;
agri reliquit ei non magnum modum,
quo cum labore magno et misere
viveret.

PROLOGUE

SPOKEN BY EUCLIO'S HOUSEHOLD GOD

That no one may wonder who I
am, I shall inform you briefly. I am
the Household God of that family
from whose house you saw me
come. For many years now I have
possessed this dwelling, and
preserved it for the sire and
grandsire of its present occupant.
Now this man's grandsire as a
suppliant entrusted to me, in utter
secrecy, a hoard of gold: he buried
it in the centre of the hearth,
entreating me to guard it for him.

When he died he could not bear—
so covetous was he—to reveal its
existence to his own son, and he
chose to leave him penniless rather
than apprise him of this treasure.
Some land, a little only, he did
leave him, whereon to toil and
moil for a miserable livelihood.

Ubi is obiit mortem qui mihi id
aurum credidit,
coepi observare, ecqui maiorem filus
mihi honorem haberet quam eius
habuisset pater.
atque ille vero minus minusque
impendio
curare minusque me impertire
honoribus.
20 item a me contra factum est, nam
item obiit diem.
is ex se hunc reliquit qui hic nunc
habitat filium
pariter moratum ut pater avosque
huius fuit.

huic filia una est. ea mihi cottidie
aut ture aut vino aut aliqui semper
supplicat,
dat mihi coronas. eius honoris gratia
feci, thesaurum ut hic reperiret
Euclio,
quo illam facilius nuptum, si vellet,
daret
nam eam compressit de summo
adulescens loco.
is scit adulescens quae sit quam
compresserit,
30 illa illum nescit, neque
compressam autem pater.

Eam ego hodie faciam ut his senex
de proxumo
sibi uxorem poscat. id ea faciam
gratia,
quo ille eam facilius ducat qui
compresserat.

After the death of him who had
committed the gold to my keeping,
I began to observe whether the son
would hold me in greater honour
than his father had. As a matter of
fact, his neglect grew and grew
apace, and he showed me less
honour. I did the same by him: so
he also died. He left a son who
occupies this house at present, a
man of the same mould as his sire
and grandsire.

He has one daughter. She prays to
me constantly, with daily gifts of
incense, or wine, or something;
she gives me garlands. Out of
regard for her I caused Euclio to
discover the treasure here in order
that he might the more easily find
her a husband, if he wished. For
she has been ravished by a young
gentleman of very high rank. He
knows who it is that he has
wronged; who he is she does not
know, and as for her father, he is
ignorant of the whole affair.

I shall make the old gentleman
who lives next door here
(*pointing*) ask for her hand to-day.
My reason for so doing is that the
man who wronged her may marry
her the more easily. And the old

sed hic senex iam clamat intus ut
solet.
anum foras extrudit, ne sit conscia.
credo aurum inspicere volt, ne
subreptum siet.

Staph.

Nam qua me nunc causa extrusisti ex
aedibus?

Eucl.

Tibi ego rationem reddam,
stimulorum seges?
illuc regredere ab ostio. illuc sis vide,
ut incedit. at scin quo modo tibi res
se habet?
si hercle hodie fustem cepero aut
stimulum in manum,
testudineum istum tibi ego grandibo
gradum.

Staph.

50 Utinam me divi adaxint ad
suspendium
potius quidem quam hoc pacto apud
te servium.

Eucl.

At ut scelestas sola secum murmurat
oculos hercle ego istos, improba,
ecfodiam tibi,
ne me observare possis quid rerum
geram
abscede etiam nunc—etiam nunc—
etiam—ohe.

istic astato. si hercle tu ex istoc loco
digitum transvorsum aut unguem
latum excesseris
aut si respexis, donicum ego te
iussero,
continuo hercle ego te dedam
discipulam cruci.

Why, what did you push me out of
the house for now?

Eucl.

I give my reasons to you, you,—
you patch of beats, you? Over
there with you, (*pointing*) away
from the door! (*Staphyla hobbles
to place indicated*) Just look at her,
will you,—how she creeps along!
See here, do you know what'll
happen to you? Now by heaven,
only let me lay my hand on a club
or a stick and I'll accelerate that
tortoise crawl for you!

Staph.

(*aside*) Oh, I wish Heaven would
make me hang myself, I do! Better
that than slaving it for you at this
rate, I'm sure.

Eucl.

(*aside*) Hear the old criminal
mumbling away to herself, though!
(*aloud*) Ah! those eyes of yours,
you old sinner! By heaven, I'll dig
'em out for you. I will, so that you
can't keep watching me whatever I
do. Get farther off still! still
farther! still—Whoa!

Stand there! You budge a finger's
breadth a nail's breadth from that
spot; you so much as turn your
head till I say the word, and by the
Almighty, the next minute I'll send
you to the gallows for a lesson, so
I will.

60 scelestiorem me hac anu certo scio
vidisse numquam, nimisque ego hanc
metuo male,
ne mi ex insidiis verba imprudent
duit
neu persentiscat aurum ubi est
absconditum,
quae in occipitio quoque habet
oculos pessima.
nunc ibo ut visam sitne ita aurum ut
condidi,
quod me sollicitat plurimis miserum
modis.

Staph.

Noenum mecastor quid ego ero
dicam meo
malae rei evenisse quamve insaniam,
queo comminisci; ita me miseram ad
hunc modum
70 decies die uno saepe extrudit
aedibus.
nescio pol quae illunc hominem
intemperiae tenent;
pervigilat noctes totas, tum autem
interdius
quasi claudus sutor domi sedet totos
dies.

neque iam quo pacto celem erilis
filiae
probrum, propinqua partitudo cui
appetit,
queo comminisci; neque quicquam
meliust mihi,
ut opinor, quam ex me ut unam
faciam litteram

(*aside*) A worse reprobate than this
old crone I never did see, no,
never. Oh, but how horribly scared
I am she'll come some sly dodge
on me when I'm not expecting it,
and smell out the place where the
gold is hidden. She has eyes in the
very back of her head, the hell-cat.
Now I'll just go see if the gold is
where I hid it. Dear, dear, it
worries the life out of me! [EXIT
Euclio INTO HOUSE.

Staph.

Mercy me! What's come over
master, what crazy streak he's got,
I can't imagine,—driving a poor
woman out of the house this way
ten times a day, often. Goodness
gracious, what whim-whams the
man's got into his head I don't see.
Never shuts his eyes all night: yes,
and then in the daytime he's sitting
around the house the whole
livelong day, for all the world like
a lame cobbler.

How I'm going to hide the young
mistress's disgrace now is beyond
me, and she with her time so near.
There's nothing better for me to
do, as I see, than tie a rope round
my neck and dangle myself out
into one long capital I.

longam, meum laqueo collum
quando obstrinxero.

I. 2.

Eucl.

Nunc defaecato demum animo
egredior domo,
80 postquam perspexi salva esse intus
omnia.
redi nunciam intro atque intus serva.

Staph.

Quippini?
ego intus servem? an ne quis aedes
auferat?
nam hic apud nos nihil est aliud
quaesti furibus,
ita inaniis sunt oppletae atque
araneis.

Eucl.

Mirum quin tua me causa faciat
Iuppiter
Philippum regem aut Dareum,
trivenefica
araneas mihi ego illas servari volo.
pauper sum, fateor, patior, quod di
dant fero.

abi intro, occlude ianuam. iam ego
hic ero
90 cave quemquam alienum in aedis
intro miseris
quod quispiam ignem quaerat,
extingui volo,

Scene 2.

RE-ENTER *Euclio* FROM HOUSE.

Eucl.

(*aside*) At last I can feel easy about
leaving the house, now I have
made certain everything is all right
inside. (*to Staphyla*) Go back in
there this instant, you, and keep
watch inside.

Staph.

(*tartly*) I suppose so! So I'm to
keep watch inside, am I? You
aren't afraid anyone'll walk away
with the house, are you? I vow
we've got nothing else there for
thieves to take—all full of
emptiness as it is, and cobwebs.

Eucl.

It is surprising Providence
wouldn't make a King Philip or
Darius of me for your benefit, you
viper, you! (*threateningly*) I want
those cobwebs watched! I'm poor,
poor; I admit it, I put up with it; I
take what the gods give me.

In with you, bolt the door. I shall
be back soon. No outsider is to be
let in, mind you. And in case
anyone should be looking for a
light, see you put the fire out so
that no one will have any reason to

ne causae quid sit quod te quisquam
quaeritet
nam si ignis vivet, ut extinguere
extempulo.

tum aquam aufugisse dicito, si quis
petet.
cultrum, securim, pistillum,
mortarium,
quae utenda vasa semper vicini
rogant,
fures venisse atque abstulisse dicito
profecto in aedis meas me absente
neminem
volo intro mitti. atque etiam hoc
praedico tibi
100 si Bona Fortuna veniat, ne intro
miseris

Staph.

Pol ea ipsa credo ne intro mittatur
cavet,
nam ad aedis nostras numquam adit,
quamquam prope est.

Eucl.

Tace atque abi intro.

Staph.

Taceo atque abeo.

Eucl.

Occlude
sis
fores ambobus pessulis. iam ego hic
ero.

come to you for it. Mark my
words, if that fire stays alive, I'll
extinguish you instantly.

And then water—if anyone asks
for water, tell him it's all run out.
As for a knife, or an axe, or a
pestle, or a mortar,—things the
neighbours are all the time
wanting to borrow—tell 'em
burglars got in and stole the whole
lot. I won't have a living soul let
into my house while I'm gone—
there! Yes, and what's more, listen
here, if Dame Fortune herself
comes along, don't you let her in.

Staph.

Goodness me, she won't get in:
she'll see to that herself, I fancy.
Why, she never comes to our
house at all, no matter how near
she is.

Eucl.

Keep still and go inside. (*advances
on her*)

Staph.

(*hurrying out of reach*) I'm still,
sir, I'm going!

Eucl.

Mind you lock the door, both
bolts. I'll soon be back.

[EXIT *Staphyla* INTO HOUSE.]

discrucior animi, quia ab domo
 abeundum est mihi.
 nimis hercle invitus abeo. sed quid
 agam scio.
 nam noster nostrae qui est magister
 curiae
 dividere argenti dixit nummos in
 viros,
 id si relinquo ac non peto, omnes
 ilico
 110 me suspicentur, credo habere
 aurum domi
 nam non est veri simile, hominem
 pauperem
 pauxillum parvi facere quin
 nummum petat.
 nam nunc cum celo sedulo omnis, ne
 sciant,
 omnes videntur scire et me benignius
 omnes salutant quam salutabant
 prius;
 adeunt, consistunt, copulantur
 dexteras,
 rogitant me ut valeam, quid agam,
 quid rerum geram.
 nunc quo profectus sum ibo; postidea
 domum
 me rursum quantum potero tantum
 recipiam.

ACTVS II

Eun.

It's agony having to leave the
 house, downright agony. Oh my
 God, how I do hate to go! But I
 have my reasons. The director of
 our ward gave notice he was going
 to make us a present of two
 shillings a man; and the minute I
 let it pass without putting in my
 claim, they'd all be suspecting I
 had gold at home, I'm sure they
 would. No, it doesn't look natural
 for a poor man to think so little of
 even a tiny bit of money as not to
 go ask for his two shillings.

Why, even now, hard as I try to
 keep every one from finding out, it
 seems as if every one knew: it
 seems as if every one has a
 heartier way of saying good day
 than they used to. Up they come,
 and stop, and shake hands, and
 keep asking me how I'm feeling,
 and how I'm getting on, and what
 I'm doing. Well, I must get along
 to where I'm bound; and then I'll
 come back home just as fast as I
 possibly can.
 [EXIT *Euclio*.]

ACT II

ENTER *Eunomia* AND *Megadorus*
 FROM LATTER'S HOUSE.

Eun.

120 Velim te arbitrari med haec verba,
frater,
meai fidei tuaque rei
causa facere, ut aequom est germanam
sororem.
quamquam haud falsa sum nos odiosas
haberi;
nam multum loquaces merito omnes
habemur,
nec mutam profecto repertam ullam
esse
aut hodie dicunt mulierem aut ullo in
saeclo.

verum hoc, frater, unum tamen cogitato,
tibi proximam me mihique esse item te;
ita aequom est quod in rem esse utrique
arbitremur

130 et mihi te et tibi me consulere et
monere;
neque occultum id haberi neque per
metum mussari,
quin participem pariter ego te et tu me
ut facias,
eo nunc ego secreto ted huc foras
seduxi,
ut tuam rem ego tecum hic loquerer
familiarem.

Mega.

Da mi, optuma femina, manum.

Eun.

Ubi ea est? quis ea est nam optuma?

Brother, I do hope you'll believe
I say this out of my loyalty to
you and for your welfare, as a
true sister should. Of course I'm
well enough aware you men
think us women are a bother;
yes, awful chatterboxes—that's
the name we all have, and
(*ruefully*) it fits. And then that
common saying, "Never now,
nor through the ages, never any
woman dumb."

But just the same, do remember
this one thing, brother,—that I
am closer to you and you to me
than anyone else in the whole
world. So both of us ought to
advise and counsel each other as
to what we feel is to either's
advantage, not keep such things
back or be afraid to speak out
openly, we ought to confide in
one another fully, you and I.
This is why I've taken you aside
out here now—so that we can
have a quiet talk on a matter that
concerns you intimately.

Mega.

(*warmly*) Let's have your hand,
you best of women!

Eun.

(*pretending to look about*)
Where is she? Who on earth is
that best of women?

Mega.

Tu.

Eun.

Tune ais?

Mega.

Si negas, nego.

Eun.

Decet te equidem vera proloqui;
nam optuma nulla potest eligi:
alia alia peior, frater, est.

Mega.

140 Idem ego

arbitror,
nec tibi advorsari certum est de istac re
umquam, soror.

Eun.

Da mihi operam amabo.

Mega.

Tuast, utere atque
impera, si quid vis.

Eun.

Id quod in rem tuam optimum esse
arbitror, ted id monitum advento.

Mega.

Soror, more tuo facis.

Eun.

Mega.

Yourself.

Eun.

You say that—you?

Mega.

(banteringly) Oh well, if you
deny it—

Eun.

Really now, you ought to be
truthful. There's no such thing,
you know, as picking out the
best woman; it's only a question
of comparative badness, brother.

Mega.

My own opinion precisely. I'll
never differ with you there,
sister, you may count on that.

Eun.

Now do give me your attention,
there's a dear.

Mega.

It is all your own; use me,
command me—anything you
wish.

Eun.

I'm going to advise you to do
something that I think will be
the very best thing in the world
for you.

Mega.

Quite like you, sister.

Eun.

Factum volo.

Mega.

Quid est id, soror?

Eun.

Quod tibi sempiternum
salutare sit: liberis procreandis—
ita di faxint—volo te uxorem
domum ducere.

Mega.

Ei occidi.

Eun.

150 Quid ita?

Mega.

Quia mihi misero cerebrum excutiunt
tua dicta, soror: lapides loqueris.

Eun.

Heia, hoc face quod te iubet soror.

Mega.

Si lubeat, faciam.

Eun.

In rem hoc tuam est.

Mega.

Ut quidem emoriar prius
quam ducam.
sed his legibus si quam dare vis ducam:
quae cras veniat, perendie foras feratur;

I certainly hope so.

Mega.

And what is this something, my
dear?

Eun.

Something that will make for
your everlasting welfare. You
should have children. God grant
you may!—and I want you to
marry.

Mega.

Oh-h-h, murder!

Eun.

How so?

Mega.

Well, you're knocking my poor
brains out with such a
proposition, my dear girl: you're
talking cobble-stones.

Eun.

Now, now, do what your sister
tells you.

Mega.

I would, if it appealed to me.

Eun.

It would be a good thing for
you.

Mega.

Yes—to die before marrying.
(pause) All right. I'll marry
anyone you please, on this
condition, though: her wedding
to-morrow, and her wake the

his legibus dare vis? cedo: nuptias
adorna.

Eun.

Cum maxima possum tibi, frater, dare
dote;
sed est grandior natu: media est
mulieris aetas.
160 eam si iubes, frater, tibi me poscere,
poscam.

Mega.

Num non vis me interrogare te?

Eun.

Immo, si
quid vis, roga.

Mega.

Post mediam aetatem qui media ducit
uxorem domum,
si eam senex anum praegnatem fortuito
fecerit,
quid dubitas, quin sit paratum nomen
puero Postumus?

nunc ego istum, soror, laborem demam
et deminuam tibi.
ego virtute deum et maiorum nostrum
dives sum satis.
istas magnas factiones, animos, dotes
dapsiles,
clamores, imperia, eburata vehicla,
pallas, purpuram,

day after. Still wish it, on this
condition? Produce her! Arrange
for the festivities!

Eun.

I can get you one with ever so
big a dowry, dear. To be sure,
she's not a young girl—middle-
aged, as a matter of fact. I'll see
about it for you, brother, if you
want.

Mega.

You don't mind my asking you a
question, I dare say?

Eun.

Why, of course not; anything
you like.

Mega.

Now supposing a man pretty
well on in life marries a lady of
maturity and this aged female
should happen to show
intentions of making the old
fellow a father—can you doubt
but that the name in store for
that youngster is Postumus?^A

See here, sister, I'll relieve you
of all this and save you trouble.
I'm rich enough, thanks be to
heaven and our forbears. And I
have no fancy at all for those
ladies of high station and
hauteur and fat dowries, with
their shouting and their ordering
and their ivory trimmed
carriages and their purple and

nil moror quae in servitutem sumptibus
redigunt viros.

Eun.

Dic mihi, quaeso, quis ea est quam vis
ducere uxorem?

Mega.

Eloquar.
nostin hunc senem Euclionem ex
proximo pauperculum?

Eun.

Novi, hominem haud malum mecastor.

Mega.

Eius cupio
filiam
virginem mihi desponderi. verba ne
facias, soror.
scio quid dictura es: hanc esse
pauperem. haec pauper placet.

Eun.

Di bene vortant.

Mega.

Idem ego spero.

Eun.

Quid me? num
quid vis?

Mega.

Vale.

Eun.

fine linen that cost a husband his
liberty.

Eun.

For mercy's sake tell me who
you do want to marry, then!

Mega.

170 I'm going to. You know the old
gentleman—rather hard up, poor
fellow,—that lives next door,
Euclio?

Eun.

Yes indeed. Why, he seems
quite nice.

Mega.

It's his daughter—there's the
engagement I'm eager for. Now
don't make a fuss, sister. I know
what you're about to say—that
she's poor. But this particular
poor girl suits me.

Eun.

God's blessing on your choice,
dear!

Mega.

I trust so.

Eun.

(*about to leave*) Well, there's
nothing I can do?

Mega.

Yes—take good care of
yourself.

Eun.

Et tu, frater.

Mega.

Ego conveniam Euclionem,
si domi est.
sed eccum video. nescio unde sese
homo recipit domum.

II. 2.

Eucl.

Praesagibat mi animus frustra me ire,
quom exhibam domo;
itaque abibam invitus; nam neque
quisquam curialium
180 venit neque magister quem dividere
argentum oportuit.
nunc domum properare propero, nam
egomet sum hic, animus domi est.

Mega.

Salvos atque fortunatus, Euclio, semper
sies.

Eucl.

Di te ament, Megadore.

Mega.

You too, brother.

[EXIT *Eunomia*.]

Mega.

Now for an interview with
Euclio, if he's at home. (*looking
down street*) Hullo, though! here
he is! Just getting back from
somewhere or other.

Scene 2.

ENTER *Euclio*.

Eucl.

(*without seeing Megadorus*)
I knew it! Something told me
I was going on a fool's
errand when I left the house;
that's why I hated to go.
Why, there wasn't a single
man of our ward there, or the
director either, who ought to
have distributed the money.
Now I'll hurry up and hurry
home: I'm here in the body,
but that's where my mind is.

Mega.

(*advancing with outstretched
hand*) Good day to you,
Euclio, yes, and the best of
everything to you always!

Eucl.

(*taking hand gingerly*) God
bless you, Megadorus.

Mega.

Quid tu? recten atque ut vis
vales?

Eucl.

Non temerarium est, ubi dives blande
appellat pauperem.
iam illic homo aurum scit me habere, eo
me salutat blandius.

Mega.

Ain tu te valere?

Eucl.

Pol ego haud perbene a
pecunia.

Mega.

Pol si est animus aequos tibi. sat habes qui
bene vitam colas.

Eucl.

Anus hercle huic indicium fecit de auro,
perspicue palam est.
cui ego iam linguam praecidam atque
oculos effodiam domi.

Mega.

Quid tu solus tecum loquere?

Eucl.

How goes it? All right, are
you? Feeling as well as you
could wish?

Eucl.

(*aside*) There's something
behind it when a rich man
puts on that smooth air with
a poor one. Now that fellow
knows I've got gold: that's
why he's so uncommon
smooth with his salutations.

Mega.

You say you are well?

Eucl.

Heavens, no: I feel low, very
low—in funds.

Mega.

(*cheerily*) Well, well, man, if
you have a contented mind,
you've got enough to enjoy
life with.

Eucl.

(*aside, frightened*) Oh, good
Lord! The old woman has let
on to him about the gold! It's
discovered, clear as can be!
I'll cut her tongue out, I'll
tear her eyes out, the minute
I get at her in the house!

Mega.

What is that you're saying to
yourself?

Eucl.

190 Meam pauperiem
conqueror.
virginem habeo grandem, dote cassam
atque inlocabilem,
neque eam queo locare cuiquam.

Mega.

Tace, bonum habe
animum, Euclio.
dabitur, adiuvabere a me. dic, si quid
opust, impera.

Eucl.

Nunc petit, cum pollicetur; inhiat aurum ut
devoret.
altera manu fert lapidem, panem ostentat
altera.
nemini credo qui large blandust dives
pauperi
ubi manum inicit benigne, ibi onerat aliqua
zamia
ego istos novi polypos, qui ubi quidquid
tetigerunt tenent.

Mega.

Da mi operam parumper. paucis, Euclio,
est quod te volo
de communi re appellare mea et tua.

Eucl.

(*startled*) Just ... how awful
it is to be poor. And I with a
grown-up girl, without a
penny of dowry, that I can't
get off my hands or find a
husband for.

Mega.

(*clapping him on the back*)
There, there, Euclio! Cheer
up. She shall be married: I'll
help you out. Come now, call
on me, if you need anything.

Eucl.

(*aside*) When he agrees to
give he wants to grab! Mouth
wide open to gobble down
my gold! Holds up a bit of
bread in one hand and has a
stone in the other! I don't
trust one of these rich
fellows when he's so
monstrous civil to a poor
man. They give you a cordial
handshake, and squeeze
something out of you at the
same time. I know all about
those octopuses that touch a
thing and then—stick.

Mega.

I should be glad to have a
moment of your time,
Euclio. I want to have a brief
talk with you on a matter that
concerns us both.

Eucl.

200 Ei misero

mihi,
aurum mi intus harpagatum est. nunc hic
eam rem volt scio,
mecum adire ad pactionem. verum
intervisam domum.

Mega.

Quo abis?

Eucl.

Iam ad te revortar. nunc est quod
visam domum.

Mega.

Credo edepol, ubi mentionem ego fecero
de filia
mi ut despondeat, sese a me derideri
rebitur,
neque illo quisquam est alter hodie ex
paupertate parciore.

Eucl.

Di me servant, salva res est. salvom est si
quid non perit
nimis male timui. prius quam intro redii,
exanimatus fui.
redeo ad te, Megadore, si quid me vis.

Mega.

Habeo gratiam.

210 quaeso, quod te percontabor, ne id te
pigeat pro loqui.

(*aside*) Oh, God save us! My
gold's been hooked, and now
he wants to make a deal with
me! I see it all! But I'll go in
and look. (*hurries toward
house*)

Mega.

Where are you off to?

Eucl.

Just a moment!... I'll be back
... the fact is ... I must see to
something at home.

[EXIT INTO HOUSE.]

Mega.

By Jove! I suppose he'll
think I'm making fun of him
when I speak about his
giving me his daughter;
poverty never made a fellow
closer-fisted.

RE-ENTER *Euclio*.

Eucl.

(*aside*) Thank the Lord, I'm
saved! It's safe—that is, if it's
all there. Ah, but that was a
dreadful moment! I nearly
expired before I got in the
house. (*to Megadorus*) Here
I am, Megadorus, if you
want anything of me.

Mega.

Thanks. Now I trust you
won't mind answering the
questions I'm going to ask.

Eucl.

Dum quidem ne quid perconteris quod non
lubeat proloqui.

Mega.

Dic mihi. quali me arbitrare genere
prognatum?

Eucl.

Mega.

Quid fide?

Eucl.

Bona.

Mega.

Quid factis?

Eucl.

Neque malis neque
improbis.

Mega.

Aetatem meam scis?

Eucl.

Scio esse grandem, item
ut pecuniam.

Mega.

Certe edepol equidem te civem sine mala
omni malitia
semper sum arbitratus et nunc arbitror.

Eucl.

Eucl.

(cautiously) No-no—that is,
if you don't ask any I don't
like to answer.

Mega.

Frankly now, what do you
think of my family
connections?

Eucl.

Bono. (grudgingly) Good.

Mega.

And my sense of honour?

Eucl.

Good.

Mega.

And my general conduct?

Eucl.

Not bad, not disreputable.

Mega.

You know my age?

Eucl.

Getting on, getting on, I
know that—(aside)
financially, too.

Mega.

Now Euclio, I've always
considered you a citizen of
the true, trusty type, by Jove,
I certainly have, and I do
still.

Eucl.

Aurum

huic olet.
quid nunc me vis?

Mega.

Quoniam tu me et ego te
qualis sis scio.
quae res recte vortat mihique tibi
tuaeque filiae,
filiam tuam mi uxorem posco. promitte hoc
fore.

Eucl.

220 Heia, Megadore, haud decorum facinus
tuis factis facis,
ut inopem atque innoxium abs te atque abs
tuis me inrideas.
nam de te neque re neque verbis merui ut
faceres quod facis.

Mega.

Neque edepol ego te derisum venio neque
derideo,
neque dignum arbitror.

Eucl.

Cur igitur poscis meam
gnatam tibi?

Mega.

Ut propter me tibi sit melius mihique
propter te et tuos.

Eucl.

(*aside*) He's got a whiff of
my gold. (*aloud*) Well, what
do you want?

Mega.

Now that we appreciate each
other, I'm going to ask you—
and may it turn out happily
for you and your girl and me
—to give me your daughter
in marriage. Promise you
will.

Eucl.

(*whining*) Now, now,
Megadorus! This is unlike
you, unworthy of you,
making fun of a poor man
like me that never harmed
you or yours. Why, I never
said or did a thing to you to
deserve being treated so.

Mega.

Good Lord, man! I didn't
come here to make fun of
you, and I'm not making fun
of you: I couldn't think of
such a thing.

Eucl.

Then why are you asking for
my daughter?

Mega.

Why? So that we may all of
us make life pleasanter for
one another.

Eucl.

Venit hoc mihi, Megadore, in mentem, ted
esse hominem divitem,
factiosum, me autem esse hominem
pauperum pauperrimum;
nunc si filiam locassim meam tibi, in
mentem venit
te bovem esse et me esse asellum: ubi
tecum coniunctus siem,
230 ubi onus nequeam ferre pariter, iaceam
ego asinus in luto,
tu me bos magis haud respicias, gnatus
quasi numquam siem.

et te utar iniquiore et meus me ordo
inrideat,
neutrubi habeam stabile stabulum, si quid
divorti fuat:
asini me mordicibus scindant, boves
incursent cornibus.
hoc magnum est periculum, ab asinis ad
boves transcendere.

Mega.

Quam ad probos propinquitatem proxime te
adiunxeris.
tam optimum est. tu condicionem hanc
accipe, ausculta mihi,
atque eam desponde mi.

Now here's the way it strikes
me, Megadurus,—you're a
rich man, a man of position:
but as for me, I'm poor,
awfully poor, dreadfully
poor. Now if I was to marry
off my daughter to you, it
strikes me you'd be the ox
and I'd be the donkey. When
I was hitched up with you
and couldn't pull my share of
the load, down I'd drop, I, the
donkey, in the mud; and you,
the ox, wouldn't pay any
more attention to me than if
I'd never been born at all.

You would be too much for
me: and my own kind would
haw-haw at me: and if there
should be a falling out,
neither party would let me
have stable quarters: the
donkeys would chew me up
and the oxen would run me
through. It is a very
hazardous business for
donkeys to climb into the ox
set.

Mega.

But honourable human
beings—the more closely
connected you are with them,
the better. Come, come,
accept my offer: listen to
what I say and promise her
to me.

Eucl.

At nihil est dotis
quod dem.

Mega.

Ne
duas.
dum modo morata recte veniat, dotata est
satis.

Eucl.

²⁴⁰ Eo dico, ne me thensauros repperisse
censeas.

Mega.

Novi, ne doceas. desponde.

Eucl.

Fiat. sed pro Iuppiter,
num ego disperii?

Mega.

Quid tibi est?

Eucl.

Quid crepuit quasi
ferrum modo?

Mega.

Hic apud me hortum confodere iussi. sed
ubi hic est homo?
abiit neque me certiozem fecit. fastidit mei,
quia videt me suam amicitiam velle. more
hominum facit;

Eucl.

But not one penny of dowry
can I give.

Mega.

Don't. Only let me have a
girl that's good, and she has
dowry enough.

Eucl.

(*forcing a laugh*) I mention
this just so that you mayn't
think I've found some
treasure.

Mega.

Yes, yes, I understand.
Promise.

Eucl.

So be it. (*aside, starting at
noise*) Oh, my God! Can it
be I'm ruined, ruined?

Mega.

What's the matter?

Eucl.

That noise? What was it—a
sort of clinking sound?

[EXIT INTO HOUSE HURRIEDLY.]

Mega.

(*not noticing his departure*) I
told them to do some digging
in my garden here. (*looking
around*) But where is the
man? Gone away and left me
—without a word! Scorns
me, now he sees I desire his

nam si opulentus it petitum pauperioris
gratiam,
pauper metuit congregari, per metum male
rem gerit.
idem, quando occasio illaec periit, post
sero cupit.

Eucl.

250 Si hercle ego te non elinguendam
dedero usque ab radicibus,
impero auctorque ego sum, ut tu me cuivis
castrandum loces.

Mega.

Video hercle ego te me arbitrari, Euclio,
hominem idoneum,
quem senecta aetate ludos facias, haud
merito meo.

Eucl.

Neque edepol, Megadore, facio, neque. si
cupiam, copia est.

Mega.

Quid nunc? etiam mihi despondes filiam?

friendship! Quite the usual
thing, that. Yes, let a wealthy
man try to get the regard of a
poorer one, and the poor one
is afraid to meet him half-
way: his timidity makes him
injure his own interests.
Then when it's too late and
the opportunity is gone he
longs to have it again.

RE-ENTER *Euclio*.

Eucl.

(*to Staphyla within*) By
heaven, if I don't have your
tongue torn out by the very
roots, I give you orders, give
you full authority, to hand
me over to anyone you
please to be skinned alive.
(*approaches Megadorus*)

Mega.

Upon my word, Euclio! So
you think I am the proper
sort of man to make a fool
of, at my time of life, and
without the slightest reason.

Eucl.

Bless my soul! I'm not
making a fool of you,
Megadorus: I couldn't if I
would.

Mega.

(*doubtfully*) Well now, do
you mean I am to have your
daughter?

Eucl.

Illis legibus,
cum illa dote quam tibi dixi.

Mega.

Sponden ergo?

Eucl.

Spondeo.

Mega.

Di bene vertant.

Eucl.

Ita di faxint. illud facito ut
memineris
convenisse ut ne quid dotis mea ad te
afferret filia.

Mega.

Memini.

Eucl.

At scio quo vos soleatis pacto
perplexarier.
260 pactum non pactum est, non pactum
pactum est, quod vobis lubet.

Mega.

Nulla controversia mihi tecum erit. sed
nuptias
num quae causa est quin faciamus hodie?

Eucl.

Immo edepol

optuma.

Mega.

Eucl.

On the understanding she
goes with the dowry I
mentioned.

Mega.

You consent, then?

Eucl.

I consent.

Mega.

And may God prosper us!

Eucl.

Yes, yes,—and mind you
remember our agreement
about the dowry: she doesn't
bring you a single penny.

Mega.

I remember.

Eucl.

But I know the way you
folks have of juggling things:
now it's on and now it's off,
now it's off and now it's on,
just as you like.

Mega.

You shall have no occasion
to quarrel with me. But about
the marriage—there's no
reason for not having it to-
day, is there?

Eucl.

Dear, dear, no! The very
thing, the very thing!

Mega.

Ibo igitur, parabo. numquid me vis?

Eucl.

Istuc. ei et vale.

Mega.

Heus, Pythodice, sequere propere me ad
macellum strenue.

Eucl.

Illic hinc abiit. di immortales, obsecro,
aurum quid valet.¹ (265)
(267) id inhiat, ea affinitatem hanc
obstinavit gratia.
Ubi tu es, quae deblateravisti iam vicinis
omnibus,
meae me filiae daturum dotem? heus,
Staphyla, te voco.
ecquid audis?

I'll go and make
arrangements, then, (*turning
to leave*) Anything else I can
do?

Eucl.

Only that. Go along. Good-
bye.

Mega.

(*calling at the door of his
house*) Hey, Pythodicus!
quick! [ENTER *Pythodicus*]
Down to the market with me
—come, look alive!
[EXEUNT.]

Eucl.

(*looking after them*) He's
gone! Ah, ye immortal gods,
doesn't money count! That is
what he's gaping after. That
is why he's so set on being
my son-in-law. (*goes to the
door and calls*) Where are
you, you blabber, telling the
whole neighbourhood I'm
going to give my daughter a
dowry! Hi-i! Staphyla! It's
you I'm calling. Can't you
hear!

II. 3.

Eucl.

270 Vascula intus pure
propere atque elue:
filiam despondi ego: hodie huic
nuptum Megadoro dabo.

Staph.

Di bene vortant. verum ecastor non
potest, subitum est nimis.

Eucl.

Tace atque abi. curata fac sint cum a
foro redeam domum;
atque aedis occlude; iam ego hic
adero.

Staph.

Quid ego
nunc agam?
nunc nobis prope adest exitium, mi
atque erili filiae,
nunc probrum atque partitudo prope
adest ut fiat palam;
quod celatum atque occultatum est
usque adhuc, nunc non potest.
ibo intro, ut erus quae imperavit
facta, cum veniat, sient.
nam ecastor malum maerore metuo
ne mixtum bibam.

II. 4.

Scene 3.

Eucl.

Hurry up with the dishes inside
there and give them a good
scouring. I have betrothed my
daughter: she marries Megadorus
here to-day.

Staph.

God bless them! (*hastily*)
Goodness, though! It can't be
done. This is too sudden.

Eucl.

Silence! Off with you! Have things
ready by the time I get back from
the forum. And lock the door,
mind; I shall be here soon.

[EXIT *Euclio*.

Staph.

What shall I do now? Now we're
all but ruined, the young mistress
and me: now it's all but public
property about her being disgraced
and brought to bed. We can't
conceal it, we can't keep it dark
any longer now. But I must go in
and do what master ordered me
before he gets back. Oh deary me!
I'm afraid I've got to take a drink
of trouble and tribulation mixed.

[EXIT *Staphyla* INTO HOUSE.]

Scene 4.

Pyth.

280 Postquam obsonavit erus et
conduxit coquos
tibicinasque hasce apud forum, edixit
mihi
ut dispertirem obsonium hic
bifariam.

Anthr.

Me quidem hercle, dicam tibi palam,
non divides.
si quo tu totum me ire vis, operam
dabo.

Cong.

Bellum et pudicum vero prostibulum
popli.
post si quis vellet, te hand non velles
dividi.

Pyth.

Atque ego istuc, Anthrax, alio
vorsum dixeram,
non istuc quo tu insimulas. sed erus
nuptias
meus hodie faciet.

Anthr.

Cuius ducit filiam?

(*An hour has elapsed.*)

ENTER *Pythodicus* BRINGING COOKS,
Anthrax AND *Congrio*, MUSIC GIRLS,
Phrygia AND *Eleusium* AND
ATTENDANTS, WITH PROVISIONS FROM
THE MARKET AND TWO LAMBS.

Pyth.

(*importantly*) After master did the
marketing and hired the cooks and
these music girls at the forum, he
told me to take and divide all he'd
got into two parts.

Anthr.

By Jupiter, you shan't make two
parts of me, let me tell you that
plainly! If you'd like to have the
whole of me anywhere, why, I'll
accommodate you.

Cong.

(*to Anthrax*) You pretty boy, yes,
you nice little everybody's darling,
you! Why, if anyone wanted to
make two parts of a real man out
of you, you oughtn't to be cut up
about it.

Pyth.

Now, now, Anthrax, I mean that
otherwise from what you make
out. Look here, my master's
marrying to-day.

Anthr.

Who's the lady?

Pyth.

290 Vicini huius Euclionis senis e
proximo.
ei adeo obsoni hinc iussit dimidium
dari,
cocum alterum itidemque alteram
tibicinam.

Anthr.

Nempe huc dimidium dicis,
dimidium domum?

Pyth.

Nempe sicut dicis.

Anthr.

Quid? hic non
poterat de suo
senex obsonari filiai nuptiis?

Pyth.

Vah.

Anthr.

Quid negotist?

Pyth.

Quid negoti sit
rogas?
pumex non aequè est aridus atque hic
est senex.

Anthr.

Ain tandem?

Pyth.

Ita esse ut dixi. tute
existuma:
quin divom atque hominum clamat
continue fidem,²

Pyth.

Daughter of old Euclio that lives
next door here. Yes sir, and what's
more, he's to have half this stuff
here, and one cook and one music
girl, too, so master said.

Anthr.

You mean to say half goes to him
and half to you folks?

Pyth.

Just what I do mean.

Anthr.

I say, couldn't the old boy pay for
the catering for his daughter's
wedding his own self?

Pyth.

(*scornfully*) Pooh!

Anthr.

What's the matter?

Pyth.

The matter, eh? You couldn't
squeeze as much out of that old
chap as you could out of a pumice
stone.

Anthr.

(*incredulously*) Oh, really now!

Pyth.

That's a fact. Judge for yourself.
Why, I tell you he begins bawling
for heaven and earth to witness
that he's bankrupt, gone to

300 suam rem periisse seque
eradicarier,
de suo tigillo fumus si qua exit foras.
quin cum it dormitum, follem
obstringit ob gulam.

Anthr.

Cur?

Pyth.

Ne quid animae forte amittat
dormiens.

Anthr.

Etiamue obturat inferiorem gutturem,
ne quid animai forte amittat
dormiens?

Pyth.

Haec mihi te ut tibi med aequom est,
credo, credere.

Anthr.

Immo equidem credo.

Pyth.

At scin etiam
quomodo?
aquam hercle plorat, cum lavat,
profundere.

Anthr.

Censen talentum magnum exorari
pote
310 ab istoc sene ut det, qui fiamus
liberi?

Pyth.

everlasting smash, the moment a
puff of smoke from his beggarly
fire manages to get out of his
house. Why, when he goes to bed
he strings a bag over his jaws.

Anthr.

What for?

Pyth.

So as not to chance losing any
breath when he's asleep.

Anthr.

Oh yes! And he puts a stopper on
his lower windpipe, doesn't he, so
as not to chance losing any breath
while he's asleep?

Pyth.

(*ingenuously*) You should believe
me, I believe, just as I should
believe you.

Anthr.

(*hurriedly*) Oh, no, no! I do
believe, of course!

Pyth.

But listen to this, will you? Upon
my word, after he takes a bath it
just breaks him all up to throw
away the water.

Anthr.

D'ye think the old buck could be
induced to make us a present of a
couple of hundred pounds to buy
ourselves off with?

Pyth.

Famem hercle utendam si roges,
numquam dabit.
quin ipsi pridem tonsor unguis
dempserat:
collegit, omnia abstulit praesegmina.

Anthr.

Edepol mortalem parce parcum
praedicas.

Pyth.

Censen vero adeo esse parcum et
miserum vivere?
pulmentum pridem ei eripuit milvos:
homo ad praetorem plorabundus
devenit;
infit ibi postulare plorans, eiulans,
ut sibi liceret milvom vadarier.
320 sescenta sunt quae memorem, si
sit otium.
sed uter vestrorum est celerior?
memora mihi.

Anthr.

Ego, et multo melior.

Pyth.

Cocum ego, non furem
rogo.

Anthr.

Cocum ergo dico.

Pyth.

Quid tu ais?

Cong.

Lord! He wouldn't make you a
loan of his hunger, no sir, not if
you begged him for it. Why, the
other day when a barber cut his
nails for him he collected all the
clippings and took 'em home.

Anthr.

My goodness, he's quite a tight
one, from what you say.

Pyth.

Honest now, would you believe a
man could be so tight and live so
wretched? Once a kite flew off
with a bit of food of his: down
goes the fellow to the magistrate's,
blubbering all the way, and there
he begins, howling and yowling,
demanding to have the kite bound
over for trial. Oh, I could tell
hundreds of stories about him if I
had time. (*to both cooks*) But
which of you is the quicker? Tell
me that.

Anthr.

I am, and a whole lot better, too.

Pyth.

At cooking I mean, not thieving.

Anthr.

Well, I mean cooking.

Pyth.

(*to Congrio*) And how about you?

Cong.

Sic sum
 ut vides.
Anthr.
 Cocus ille nundinalest, in nonum
 diem
 solet ire coctum.
Cong.
 Tun, trium litterarum
 homo
 me vituperas? fur.
Anthr.
 Etiam fur,
 trifurcifer.

II. 5.

Pyth.
 Tace nunciam tu, atque agnum hinc
 uter est pinguior
 cape atque abi intro ad nos.
Anthr.
 Licet.
Pyth.
 Tu, Congrio,
 quem illic reliquit agnum, eum sume
 atque abi
³intro illuc, et vos illum sequimini.
 vos ceteri ite huc ad nos.

(*with a meaning glance at Anthrax*) I'm what I look.
Anthr.
 He's nothing but a market-day
 cook, that chap: he only gets a job
 once a week.
Cong.
 You running me down, you? You
 five letter man, you! You T-H-I-E-
 F!
Anthr.
 Five letter man yourself! Yes, and
 five times—penned!

Scene 5.

Pyth.
 (*to Anthrax*) Come, come, shut up,
 you: and this fittest lamb here,
 (*pointing*) take it and go over to
 our house.
Anthr.
 (*grinning triumphantly at Congrio*) Aye, aye, sir.
 [EXIT *Anthrax* INTO HOUSE OF
Megadorus LEADING LAMB.
Pyth.
 Congrio, you take this one he's left
 (*pointing*) and go into that house
 there, (*pointing to Euclio's*) and as
 for you, (*indicating some of the*
attendants) you follow him. The
 rest of you come over to our
 house.

Cong.

330 Hercle iniuria
dispertivisti: pinguiorem agnum isti
habent.

Pyth.

At nunc tibi dabitur pinguior tibicina.
i sane cum illo, Phrugia. tu autem,
Eleusium,
huc intro abi ad nos.

Cong.

O Pythodice
subdole,
hucine detrusti me ad senem
parcissimum?
ubi si quid poscam, usque ad ravim
poscam prius
quam quicquam detur.

Pyth.

Stultus et sine gratia es.
4 tibi recte facere, quando quod facias
perit.

Cong.

Qui vero?

Pyth.

Rogitas? iam principio in
aedibus
340 turba istic nulla tibi erit: siquid uti
voles,
domo abs te adfero, ne operam
perdas poscere.

Cong.

Hang it! That's no way to divide:
they've got the fattest lamb.

Pyth.

Oh well, I'll give you the fattest
music girl. (*turning to girls*) That
means you, Phrygia: you go with
him. As for you, Eleusium, you
step over to our place.

[EXEUNT *Eleusium* AND OTHERS INTO
HOUSE OF *Megadorus*.

Cong.

Oh, you're a wily one, Pythodicus!
Shoving me off on this old screw,
eh? If I ask for anything there, I
can ask myself hoarse before I get
a thing.

Pyth.

An ungrateful blockhead is what
you are. The idea of doing you a
favour, when it's only thrown
away!

Cong.

Eh? How so?

Pyth.

How so? Well, in the first place
there won't be an uproarious gang
in that house to get in your way: if
you need anything, just you fetch
it from home so as not to waste
time asking for it. Here at our

his autem apud nos magna turba ac
familia est
supellex, aurum, vestis, vasa
argentea:

ibi si perierit quippiam—quod te scio
facile abstinere posse, si nihil obviam
est—
dicant: coqui abstulerunt,
comprehendite,
vincite, verberate, in puteum condite.
horum tibi istic nihil eveniet: quippe
qui
ubi quid subripias nihil est. sequere
hac me.

Cong.

Sequor.

II. 6.

Pyth.
Heus, Staphyla, prodi atque ostium
aperi.

Staph.

350 Qui vocat?

Pyth.
Pythodicus.

Staph.

Quid vis?

Pyth.

establishment, though, we do have
a great big uproarious gang of
servants, and knick-knackery and
jewellery and clothes and silver
plate lying about.

Now if anything was missing,—of
course it's easy for you to keep
your hands off, provided there's
nothing in reach,—they'd say:
"The cooks got away with it!
Collar 'em! Tie 'em up! Thrash
'em! Throw 'em in the dungeon!"
Now over there (*pointing to
Euclio's*) nothing like this will
happen to you—as there's nothing
at all about for you to filch. (*going
toward Euclio's house*) Come
along.

Cong.

(*sulkily*) Coming. (*he and the rest
follow*)

Scene 6.

Pyth.
(*knocking at door*) Hey! Staphyla!
Come here and open the door.

Staph.

(*within*) Who is it?

Pyth.
Pythodicus.

Staph.

(*sticking her head out*) What do
you want?

Pyth.

Hos ut accipias
coquos
tibicinamque obsoniumque in
nuptias.

Megadorus iussit Euclioni haec
mittere.

Staph.

Cererin, Pythodice, has sunt facturi
nuptias?

Pyth.

Qui?

Staph.

Quia temeti nihil allatum
intellego.

Pyth.

At iam afferetur, si a foro ipse
redierit.

Staph.

Ligna hic apud nos nulla sunt.

Cong.

Sunt asseres?

Staph.

Sunt pol.

Cong.

Sunt igitur ligna, ne quaeras
foris.

Staph.

Quid, impurate? quamquam Volcano
studes,

Take these cooks and the music
girl and the supplies for the
wedding festival. Megadorus told
us to take 'em over to Euclio's.

Staph.

(examining the provisions
disappointedly) Whose festival are
they going to celebrate,
Pythodicus? Ceres'?

Pyth.

Why hers?

Staph.

Well, no tipples ^B been brought, as
I notice.

Pyth.

But there'll be some all right when
the old gent gets back from the
forum.

Staph.

We haven't got any firewood in the
house.

Cong.

Any rafters in it?

Staph.

Mercy, yes.

Cong.

There's firewood in it, then: never
mind going for any.

Staph.

Hey? You godless thing! even
though you are a devotee of

360 cenaene causa aut tuae mercedis
gratia
nos nostras aedis postulas
comburare?

Cong.

Haud postulo.

Pyth.

Duc istos intro.

Staph.

Sequimini.

Vulcan, do you want us to burn our
house down, all for your dinner or
your pay? (*advances on him*)

Cong.

(*shrinking back*) I don't, I don't!

Pyth.

Take 'em inside.

Staph.

(*brusquely*) This way with you.

[EXEUNT *Congrio* AND OTHERS INTO
Euclio's HOUSE.]

II. 7.

Pyth.

Curate. ego intervisam quid faciant
coqui;
quos pol ut ego hodie servem, cura
maxuma est.
nisi unum hoc faciam, ut in puteo
cenam coquant:
inde coctam sursum subducemus
corbulis.

si autem deorsum comedent, si quid
coxerint,
superi incenati sunt et cenati inferi.
sed verba hic facio, quasi negoti nil
siet,
370 rapacidarum ubi tantum sit in
aedibus.

Scene 7.

Pyth.

(*as they leave*) Look out for things.
(*starting for Megadorus's house*)
I'll go see what the cooks are at.
By gad, it's the devil's own job
keeping an eye on those chaps.
The only way is to make 'em cook
dinner in the dungeon and then
haul it up in baskets when it's
done.

Even so, though, if they're down
there gobbling up all they cook, it's
a case of starve in heaven and stuff
in hell. But here I am gabbling
away just as if there wasn't
anything to do, and the house all
full of those young Grabbits.
[EXIT *Pythodicus*.]

II. 8.

Eucl.

Volui animum tandem confirmare
hodie meum,
ut bene me haberem filiai nuptiis.
venio ad macellum, rogito pisces:
indicant
caros; agninam caram, caram
bubulam,
vitulinam, cetum, porcina: cara
omnia.
atque eo fuerunt cariora, aes non erat.
abeo iratus illinc, quoniam nihil est
qui emam.

ita illis impuris omnibus adii manum.
deinde egomet mecum cogitare
intervias
380 occepi: festo die si quid
prodegeris,
profesto egere liceat, nisi peperceris.
postquam, hanc rationem ventri
cordique edidi,
accessit animus ad meam sententiam,
quam minimo sumptu filiam ut
nuptum darem.

nunc tusculum emi hoc et coronas
floreas:
haec imponentur in foco nostro Lari,
ut fortunatas faciat gnatae nuptias.
sed quid ego apertas aedis nostras
conspicor?

Scene 8.

ENTER *Euclio* FROM FORUM CARRYING
A SMALL PACKAGE AND A FEW
FORLORN FLOWERS.

Eucl.

Now I did want to be hearty to-
day, and do the handsome thing for
daughter's wedding, yes I did. Off
I go to the market—ask for fish!
Very dear! And lamb dear... and
beef dear... and veal and tunny and
pork... everything dear,
everything! Yes, and all the dearer
for my not having any money! It
just made me furious, and seeing I
couldn't buy anything, I up and
left.

That's how I circumvented 'em, the
whole dirty pack of 'em. Then I
began to reason things out with
myself as I walked along.

"Holiday feasting makes everyday
fasting," says I to myself, "unless
you economize." After I'd put the
case this way to my stomach and
heart, my mind supported my
motion to cut down daughter's
wedding expenses just as much as
possible.

Now I've bought a little
frankincense here and some
wreaths of flowers: we'll put 'em
on the hearth in honour of our
Household God, so that he may
bless daughter's marriage. (*looking*

et strepitust intus. numnam ego
compilor miser?

Cong.

390 Aulam maiorem, si pote, ex
vicinia
pete: haec est parva, capere non quit.

Eucl.

Ei mihi,
perii hercle. aurum rapitur, aula
quaeritur.⁵ (392)
(394) Apollo, quaeso, subveni mi
atque adiuva,
confige sagittis fures thesaurarios,
si cui in re tali iam subvenisti
antidhac.
sed cesso prius quam prorsus perii
currere?

II. 9.

Anthr.

Dromo, desquama piscis. tu,
Machaerio,
congrum, murenā exdorsua
quantum potest.
400 ego hinc artoptam ex proximo
utendam peto
a Congrione. tu istum gallum, si
sapis,

toward house) Eh! What's my door
open for? A clattering inside, too!
Oh. mercy on us! It can't be
burglars, can it?

Cong.

(within, to an attendant) See if you
can't get a bigger pot from one of
the neighbours: this here's a little
one: it won't hold it all.

Eucl.

Oh, my God! my God! I'm ruined!
They're taking my gold! They're
after my pot! Oh, oh, Apollo, help
me, save me! Shoot your arrows
through them, the treasure thieves,
if you've ever helped a man in
such a pinch before! But I must
rush in before they ruin me
entirely!
[EXIT *Euclio*.

Scene 9.

ENTER *Anthrax* FROM HOUSE OF
Megadorus.

Anthr.

(to servants inside) Dromo, scale
the fish. As for you, Machaerio,
you bone the conger and lamprey
as fast as you know how. I'm going
over next door to ask Congrio for
the loan of a bread pan. And you
there! if you know what's good for
you, you won't hand me back that
rooster till it's plucked cleaner than
a ballet dancer.

glabriorem reddes mihi quam volsus
ludiust.

sed quid hoc clamoris oritur hinc ex
proximo?
coqui hercle, credo, faciunt officium
suom.
fugiam intro, ne quid turbae hic
itidem fuat.

ACTVS III

Cong.

Attatae! cives,⁶ populares, incolae,
accolae, advenae omnes,
date viam qua fugere liceat. facite
totae plateae pateant.
neque ego umquam nisi hodie ad
Bacchas veni in Bacchanal
coquinatum,
ita me miserum et meos discipulos
fustibus male contuderunt.
410 totus doleo atque oppido perii, ita
me iste habuit senex gymnasium;

attat, perii hercle ego miser,
411a aperit bacchanal. adest,
sequitur. scio quam rem geram:
hoc

412a ipse magister me docuit.
neque ligna ego usquam gentium
praeberi vidi pulchrius,

(*sound of scuffle in Euclio's house*)
Hallo, though! What's the row in
the house next door? Hm! the
cooks settling down to business, I
reckon! I'll hustle back, or we'll be
having a rumpus at our place, too.
[EXIT.]

ACT III

ENTER *Congrio* AND HIS ASSOCIATES
TUMBLING OUT OF *Euclio's* HOUSE,
SLAMMING DOOR BEHIND THEM.

Cong.

(*in burlesque panic*) Hi—i—i!
Citizens, natives, inhabitants,
neighbours, foreigners, every one
—give me room to run! Open up!
Clear the street! (*stopping at some
distance from the house*) This is
the first time I ever came to cook
for Bacchantes at a Bacchante den.
Oh dear, what an awful clubbing I
and my disciples did get! I'm one
big ache! I'm dead and gone! The
way that old codger took me for a
gymnasium!

(*Euclio's door opens and he
appears, cudgel in hand*) Oh—ow
—ow! Good Lord be merciful! I'm
done for! He's opening the den;
he's at the door; he's after me! I
know what I'll do: (*retires*) he's
taught me my lesson, my master
has. I never in all my life saw a

itaque omnis exegit foras, me atque
hos, onustos fustibus.

place where they were freer
handed with their wood: (*rubbing
his shoulders*) why, when he drove
the lot of us out he let us have big
sticks of it, all we could stagger
under.

III. 2.

Eucl.

Redi. quo fugis nunc? tene, tene.

Cong.

Quid, stolide,
clamas?

Eucl.

Quia ad tris viros iam ego deferam
nomen tuom.

Cong.

Quam
ob rem?

Eucl.

Quia cultrum habes.

Cong.

Cocum decet.

Eucl.

Quid
comminatu's
mihi?

Cong.

Istud male factum arbitror,
quia non latus fodi.

Scene 2.

Eucl.

(*going into street*) Come back!
Where are you running to now?
Stop him, stop him!

Cong.

What are you yelling for, stupid?

Eucl.

Because I am going to report your
name to the police this instant.

Cong.

Why?

Eucl.

Well, you carry a knife.

Cong.

And so a cook should.

Eucl.

And how about your threatening
me?

Cong.

It's a pity I didn't jab it through
you, I'm thinking.

Eucl.

Homo nullus te scelestior qui vivat
hodie
420 neque quoui ego de industria
amplius male plus libens faxim.

Cong.

Pol etsi taceas, palam id quidem est:
res ipsa testist;
ita fustibus sum mollior magis quam
ullus cinaedus.
sed quid tibi nos tactiost, mendice
homo?

Eucl.

res? Quae
etiam rogitas? an quia minus quam
aequom erat feci?

Cong.

Sine, at hercle cum magno malo tuo,
si hoc caput sentit.

Eucl.

Pol ego haud scio quid post fuat: tuom
nunc caput sentit.
sed in aedibus quid tibi meis nam erat
negoti
me absente, nisi ego iusseram? volo
scire.

Cong.

ergo. Tace

Eucl.

There isn't a more abandoned
villain than you on the face of the
earth, or one I'd be gladder to go
out of my way to punish more,
either.

Cong.

Good Lord! That's evident
enough, even if you didn't say so:
the facts speak for themselves.
I've been clubbed till I'm looser
than any fancy dancer. Now what
did you mean by laying hands on
me, you beggar?

Eucl.

What's that? You dare ask me?
Didn't I do my duty by you—is
that it? (*lifts cudgel*)

Cong.

(*backing away*) All right: but by
gad, you'll pay heavy for it, or I'm
a numskull.

Eucl.

Hm! I don't know anything about
the future of your skull, but
(*chuckling and tapping his
cudgel*) it must be numb now.
(*savagely*) See here, what the
devil were you doing in my house
without my orders while I was
gone? That's what I want to know.

Cong.

Well then, shut up. We came to
cook for the wedding, that's all.

ibi ubi tibi erat negotium, ad focum si
adesses,

440 non fissile auferres caput: merito
id tibi factum est.

adeo ut tu meam sententiam iam
noscere possis
si ad ianuam huc accesseris, nisi
iussero, propius,
ego te faciam miserrimus mortalis uti
sis.
scis iam meam sententiam.

Cong.

Quo abis? redi

 rursum.

ita me bene amet Laverna, uti te iam,
nisi reddi
mihi vasa iubes, pipulo te his differam
ante aedis.
quid ego nunc agam? ne ego edepol
veni huc auspicio malo.
nummo sum conductus: plus iam
medico merce dest opus.

III. 3.

Eucl.

Hoc quidem hercle, quoquo ibo,
mecum erit, mecum feram,

carrying that cloven pate: it serves
you right.

(*with forced composure*) Now
further, just to acquaint you with
my sentiments in the matter,—
you come any nearer this door
without my permission, and I will
make you the most forlorn
creature in God's world. Now you
know my sentiments.

[EXIT INTO HOUSE.]

Cong.

(*calling after him*) Where are you
off to? Come back! So help me
holy Mother of Thieves, but I'll
soon make it warm for you, the
way I'll rip up your reputation in
front of the house here, if you
don't have my dishes brought
back! (*as Euclio closes the door*)
Now what? Oh, hell! It certainly
was an unlucky day when I came
here! Two shillings for the job,
and now it'll take more than that
to pay the doctor's bill.

Scene 3.

RE-ENTER *Euclio* FROM HOUSE WITH
OBJECT UNDER HIS CLOAK.

Eucl.

(*aside*) By heaven, wherever I go
this goes (*peering under cloak*)
too: I won't leave it there to run

450 neque isti id in tantis periclis
umquam committam ut siet.
ite sane nunciam omnes, et coqui et
tibicinae,
etiam intro duce, si vis, vel gregem
venalium,
coquite, facite, festinate nunciam,
quantum libet.

Cong.

Temperi, postquam implevisti fusti
fissorum caput.

Eucl.

Intro abite, opera huc conducta est
vostra, non oratio.

Cong.

Heus, senex, pro vapulando hercle
ego abs te mercedem petam.
coctum ego, non vapulatum, dudum
conductus fui.

Eucl.

Lege agito mecum. molestus ne sis. i
et cenam coque,
aut abi in malum cruciatum ab
aedibus.

Cong.

tu modo.

Abi

such risks, never. (*to Congrio and others*) Very well, come now, in with you, cooks, music girls, every one! (*to Congrio*) Go on, take your under-strappers inside if you like, the whole hireling herd of 'em. Cook away, work away, scurry around to your hearts' content now.

Cong.

A nice time for it, after you've clubbed my head till it's all cracks!

Eucl.

In with you. You were engaged to get up a dinner here, not a declamation.

Cong.

I say, old boy, I'll come to you with my bill for that basting, by the Lord I will. I was hired a while ago to be cook, not to be thumped.

Eucl.

Well, go to law about it. Don't bother me. Away with you: get dinner, or else get to the devil out of here.

Cong.

You just get to—(*mildly, as he pushes in past him*) one side, then.

[EXEUNT *Congrio* AND HIS ASSOCIATES INTO HOUSE.]

III. 4.

Eucl.

Scene 4.

Eucl.

460 Illic hinc abiit. di immortales,
facinus audax incipit
qui cum opulento pauper homine
coepit rem habere aut negotium.⁷
veluti Megadorus temptat me
omnibus miserum modis,
qui simulavit mei honoris mittere huc
causa coquos:
is ea causa misit, hoc qui surriperent
misero mihi.

condigne etiam meus med intus
gallus gallinacius,
qui erat anu peculiaris, perdidit
paenissime.
ubi erat haec defossa, occepit ibi
scalpurrire ungulis
circum circa. quid opust verbis? ita
mihi pectus peracuit:
capiō fustem, obtrunco gallum, furem
manufestarium.

470 credo edepol ego illi mercedem
gallo pollicitos coquos,
si id palam fecisset. exemi ex manu⁸
manubrium.⁹
(473) sed Megadorus meus affinis
eccum incedit a foro.
iam hunc non ausim praeterire, quin
consistam et conloquar.

(*looking after them*) He's
disappeared. My Lord, my Lord!
It's an awful chance a poor man
takes when he begins to have
dealings or business with a
wealthy man. Here's Megadorus
now, trying to catch me—oh, dear,
dear!—in all sorts of ways.
Sending cooks over here and
pretending it's because of regard
for me! Sent 'em to steal this
(*looking under cloak*) from a poor
old man—that's what his sending
'em was because of!

And then of course that dunghill
cock of mine in there, that used to
belong to the old woman, had to
come within an inch of ruining me,
beginning to scratch and claw
around where this (*looking under
cloak*) was buried. Enough said. It
just got me so worked up I took a
club and annihilated that cock, the
thief, the redhanded thief!

By heaven, I do believe the cooks
offered that cock a reward to show
them where this (*looking under
cloak*) was. I took the handle
(*looking under cloak*) out of their
hands! (*looking down street*) Ah,
but there is son-in-law Megadorus
swaggering back from the forum. I
suppose it would hardly do for me
to pass him without stopping for a
word or two, now.

III. 5.

Mega.

Narravi amicis multis consilium
meum
de condicione hac. Euclionis filiam
laudant. sapienter factum et consilio
bono.

nam meo quidem animo si idem
faciant ceteri
opulentiores, pauperiorum filias
480 ut indotatas ducant uxores
domum,
et multo fiat civitas concordior,
et invidia nos minore utamur quam
utimur,
et illae malam rem metuant quam
metuont magis,
et nos minore sumptu simus quam
sumus.

in maximam illuc populi partem est
optimum;
in pauciores avidos altercatio est,
quorum animis avidis atque
insatietatibus
neque lex neque sutor capere est qui
possit modum.
namque hoc qui dicat "quo illae
nubent divites
490 dotatae, si istud ius pauperibus
ponitur?"

quo lubeant, nubant, dum dos ne fiat
comes.

Scene 5.

ENTER *Megadorus*.

Mega.

(*not seeing Euclio*) Well, I've told
a number of friends of my
intentions regarding this match.
They were full of praise for
Euclio's daughter. Say it's the
sensible thing to do, a fine idea.

Yes, for my part I'm convinced that
if the rest of our well-to-do
citizens would follow my example
and marry poor men's daughters
and let the dowries go, there would
be a great deal more unity in our
city, and people would be less
bitter against us men of means
than they are, and our wives would
stand in greater awe of marital
authority than they do, and the cost
of living would be lower for us
than it is.

It's just the thing for the vast
majority of the people; the fight
comes with a handful of greedy
fellows so stingy and grasping that
neither law nor cobbler can take
their measure. And now supposing
some one should ask: "Who are
the rich girls with dowries going to
marry, if you make this rule for the
poor ones?"

Why, anyone they please, let 'em
marry, provided their dowry

hoc si ita fiat, mores meliores sibi
parent, pro dote quos ferant, quam
nunc ferunt,
ego faxim muli, pretio qui superant
equos,
sint viliores Gallicis cantheriis.

Eucl.

Ita me di amabunt ut ego hunc
ausculto lubens.
nimis lepidè fecit verba ad
parsimoniam.

Mega.

Nulla igitur dicat "equidem dotem ad
te adtuli
maiores multo quam tibi erat
pecunia;
500 enim mihi quidem aequomst
purpuram atque aurum dari,
ancillas, mulos, muliones,
pedisequos,
salutigerulos pueros, vehicla qui
vehar."

Eucl.

Ut matronarum hic facta pernovit
probe.
moribus praefectum mulierum hunc
factum velim.

Mega.

Nunc quoquo venias plus
plaustrorum in aedibus

doesn't go along with 'em. In that
case, instead of bringing their
husbands money, they'd bring
them better behaved wives than
they do at present. Those mules of
theirs that cost more than horses
do now—they'd be cheaper than
Gallic geldings by the time I got
through.

Eucl.

(*aside*) God bless my soul, how I
do love to hear him talk! Those
thoughts of his about economizing
—beautiful, beautiful!

Mega.

Then you wouldn't hear them
saying: "Well, sir, you never had
anything like the money I brought
you, and you know it. Fine clothes
and jewellery, indeed! And maids
and mules and coachmen and
footmen and pages and private
carriages—well, if I haven't a right
to them!"

Eucl.

(*aside*) Ah, he knows 'em, knows
'em through and through, these
society dames! Oh, if he could
only be appointed supervisor of
public morals—the women's!

Mega.

Wherever you go nowadays you
see more wagons in front of a city
mansion than you can find around

videas quam ruri, quando ad villam
veneris.

sed hoc etiam pulchrum est
praequam ubi sumptus petunt.

stat fullo, phyrigio, aurifex, lanarius;
caupones patagiarii, indusiarii,
510 flammarii, volarii, carinarii;

stant manulearii, stant¹⁰

murobatharii,
propolae linteones, calceolarii;
sedentarii sutores diabathrarii,
solearii astant, astant molocinarii;¹¹

(514)

(516) stropharii astant, astant semul
sonarii.

iam hosce absolutes censeas: cedunt,
petunt

treceni, cum stant thylacistae in atriis
textores limbularii, arcularii.

520 ducuntur, datur aes. iam absolutos
censeas,

cum incedunt infectores corcotarii,
aut aliqua mala crux semper est, quae
aliquid petat.

Eucl.

Compellarem ego illum, ni metuam
ne desinat
memorare mores mulierum: nunc sic
sinam.

a farmyard. That's a perfectly
glorious sight, though, compared
with the time when the tradesmen
come for their money.

The cleanser, the ladies' tailor, the
jeweller, the woollen worker—
they're all hanging round. And
there are the dealers in flounces
and underclothes and bridal veils,
in violet dyes and yellow dyes, or
muffs, or balsam scented foot-
gear; and then the lingerie people
drop in on you, along with
shoemakers and squatting cobblers
and slipper and sandal merchants
and dealers in mallow dyes; and
the belt makers flock around, and
the girdle makers along with 'em.

And now you may think you've
got them all paid off. Then up
come weavers and lace men and
cabinet-makers—hundreds of 'em
—who plant themselves like jailers
in your halls and want you to settle
up. You bring 'em in and square
accounts. "All paid off now,
anyway," you may be thinking,
when in march the fellows who do
the saffron dyeing—some damned
pest or other, anyhow, eternally
after something.

Eucl.

(*aside*) I'd hail him, only I'm afraid
he'd stop talking about how the
women go on. No, no, I'll let him
be.

Mega.

Ubi nugivendis res soluta est
omnibus,
ibi ad postremum cedit miles, aes
petit.
itur, putatur ratio cum argentario,
miles inpransus astat, aes censet dari.
ubi disputata est ratio cum argentario,
530 etiam ipsus ultro debet argentario.
spes prorogatur militi in alium diem.

haec sunt atque aliae multae in
magnis dotibus.
incommoditates sumptusque
intolerabiles
nam quae indotata est, ea in potestate
est viri;
dotatae mactant et malo et damno
viros
sed eccum adfinem ante aedes. quid
agis, Euclio?

III. 6.

Eucl.

Nimum lubenter edi sermonem
tuom.

Mega.

An audivisti?

Eucl.

Mega.

When you've got all these fellows
of fluff and ruffles satisfied, along
comes a military man, bringing up
the rear, and wants to collect the
army tax. You go and have a
reckoning with your banker, your
military gentleman standing by
and missing his lunch in the
expectation of getting some cash.
After you and the banker have
done figuring, you find you owe
him money too, and the military
man has his hopes postponed till
another day.

These are some of the nuisances
and intolerable expenses that big
dowries let you in for, and there
are plenty more. Now a wife that
doesn't bring you a penny—a
husband has some control over
her; it's the dowered ones that
pester the life out of their husbands
with the way they cut up and
squander. (*seeing Euclio*) But
there's my new relative in front of
the house! How are you, Euclio?

Scene 6.

Eucl.

Gratified, highly gratified with
your discourse—I devoured it.

Mega.

Eh? you heard?

Eucl.

Usque a principio omnia.

Mega.

Tamen meo quidem animo aliquanto
facias rectius,
540 si nitidior sis filiai nuptus.

Eucl.

Pro re nitorem et gloriam pro copia
qui habent, meminerunt sese unde
oriundi sient.
neque pol, Megadore, mihi neque
quoiquam pauperi
opinione melius res structa est domi.

Mega.

Immo est quod satis est, et di faciant
ut siet
plus plusque et istuc sospitent quod
nunc habes.

Eucl.

Illud mihi verbum non placet "quod
nunc habes."
tam hoc scit me habere quam
egomet. anus fecit palam.

Mega.

Quid tu te solus e senatu sevocas?

Eucl.

Every word of it.

Mega.

(*looking him over*) But I say,
though, I do think it would be a
little more in keeping, if you were
to spruce up a bit for your
daughter's wedding.

Eucl.

(*whining*) Folks with the
wherewithal and means to let 'em
spruce up and look smart
remember who they are. My
goodness, Megadorus! I haven't
got a fortune piled up at home
(*peers slyly under cloak*) any more
than people think, and no other
poor man has, either.

Mega.

(*genially*) Ah well, you've got
enough, and heaven make it more
and more, and bless you in what
you have now.

Eucl.

(*turning away with a start*) "What
you have now!" I don't like that
phrase! He knows I have this
money just as well as I do! The old
hag's been blabbing!

Mega.

(*pleasantly*) Why that secret
session over there?

Eucl.

Pol ego ut te accusem merito
meditabar.

Mega.

550 Quid est?

Eucl.

Quid sit me rogitas? qui mihi omnis
angulos
furum implevisti in aedibus misero
mihi,
qui mi intro misti in aedis quingentos
coquos,
cum senis manibus, genere
Geryonaceo;
quos si Argus servet qui oculus totus
fuit,
quem quondam Ioni Iuno custodem
addidit,
is numquam servet. praeterea
tibicinam,
quae mi interbibere sola, si vino
scatat,
Corinthiensem fontem Pirenam
potest.
tum obsonium autem—

Mega.

560 Pol vel legioni

sat est.
etiam agnum misi.

Eucl.

Quo quidem agno sat
scio
magis curiosam¹² nusquam esse
ullam beluam.

(*taken aback*) I was—damme sir,
—I was framing the complaint
against you that you deserve.

Mega.

What for?

Eucl.

What for, eh? When you've filled
every corner of my house with
thieves, confound it! When you've
sent cooks into my house by the
hundred and every one of 'em a
Geryonian^C with six hands apiece!

Why, Argus, who had eyes all over
him and was set to guarding Io
once by Juno, couldn't ever keep
watch on those fellows, not if he
tried. And that music girl besides!
She could take the fountain of
Pirene at Corinth and drink it dry,
all by herself, she could,—if it ran
wine. Then as for the provisions—

Mega.

Bless my soul! Why, there's
enough for a regiment. I sent you a
lamb, too.

Eucl.

Yes, and a more shearable beast
than that same lamb doesn't exist, I
know that.

Mega.

Volo ego ex te scire qui sit agnus
curio.

Eucl.

Quia ossa ac pellis totust, ita cura
macet.
quin exta inspicere in sole ei vivo
licet:
ita is pellucet quasi lanterna Punica.

Mega.

Caedundum conduxī ego illum.

Eucl.

Tum tu idem

optumumst
loces efferendum; nam iam, credo,
mortuost.

Mega.

Potare ego hodie, Euclio, tecum volo.

Eucl.

Non potem ego quidem hercle.

Mega.

570 At ego

iussero
cadum unum vini veteris a me
adferrier.

Eucl.

Nolo hercle, nam mihi bibere
decretum est aquam.

Mega.

I wish you would tell me how the
lamb is shearable.

Eucl.

Because it's mere skin and bones,
wasted away till it's perfectly—
(*tittering*) sheer. Why, why, you
put that lamb in the sun and you
can watch its inwards work: it's as
transparent as a Punic^D lantern.

Mega.

(*protestingly*) I got that lamb in
myself to be slaughtered.

Eucl.

(*dryly*) Then you'd best put it out
yourself to be buried, for I do
believe it's dead already.

Mega.

(*laughing and clapping him on the
shoulder*) Euclio, we must have a
little carouse to-day, you and I.

Eucl.

(*frightened*) None for me, sir, none
for me! Carouse! Oh my Lord!

Mega.

But see here, I'll just have a cask
of good old wine brought over
from my cellars.

Eucl.

No, no! I don't care for any! The
fact is I am resolved to drink
nothing but water.

ibo ad te fretus tua, Fides, fiducia.

on your faithfulness.
[EXIT *Euclio*.]

ACTVS IV

Strob.

Hoc est servi facinus frugi, facere
quod ego persequor,
ne morae molestiaeque imperium
erile habeat sibi.
nam qui ero ex sententia servire
servos postulat,
590 in erum matura, in se sera
condecet capessere.
sin dormitet, ita dormitet, servom
sese ut cogitet.¹³ (591)

erile¹⁴ imperium ediscat, ut quod
frons velit oculi sciant; (599)
600 quod iubeat citis quadrigis citius
properet persequi.
qui ea curabit, abstinebit censione
bubula,
nec sua opera rediget umquam in
splendorem compedes.

nunc erus meus amat filiam huius
Euclionis pauperis;
eam ero nunc renuntiatum est
nuptum huic Megadoro dari.
is speculatum huc misit me, ut quae
fierent fieret particeps.
nunc sine omni suspicione in ara hic
adsidam sacra;

ACT IV

ENTER *Strobilus*.

Strob.

(*self-complacently*) This is the way
for a good servant to act, the way I
do: no thinking master's orders are
a botheration and nuisance. I tell
you what, if a servant wants to
give satisfaction, he'd just better
make it a case of master first and
man second. Even if he should fall
asleep, he ought to do it with an
eye on the fact that he's a
servant.¹³

He's got to know his master's
inclinations like a book, so that he
can read his wishes in his face.
And as for orders, he must push
'em through faster than a fast four-
in-hand. If a chap minds all this,
he won't be paying taxes on
rawhide, or ever spend his time
polishing a ball and chain with his
ankles.

Now the fact is, master's in love
with the daughter of poor old
Euclio here; and he's just got word
she's going to be married to
Megadorus there. So he's sent me
over to keep my eyes peeled and
report on operations. I'll just settle
down alongside this sacred altar
(*does so*) and no one'll suspect me.

hinc ego et huc et illuc potero quid
agant arbitrarier.

IV. 2.

Eucl.

Tu modo cave quoiquam indicassis
aurum meum esse istic, Fides:
non metuo ne quisquam inveniatur, ita
probe in latebris situmst.
610 edepol ne illic pulchram praedam
agat, si quis illam invenerit
aulam onustam auri; verum id te
quaeso ut prohibeas, Fides.

nunc lavabo, ut rem divinam faciam,
ne affinem morer
quin ubi accersat meam extemplo
filiam ducat domum.
vide, Fides, etiam atque etiam nunc,
salvam ut aulam abs te auferam:
tuae fide concredidi aurum, in tuo
loco et fano est situm.

Strob.

Di immortales, quod ego hunc
hominem facinus audivi loqui:
se aulam onustam auri abstrusisse hic
intus in fano Fide.

I can inspect proceedings at both
houses from here.

Scene 2.

ENTER *Euclio* WITHOUT SEEING
Strobilus.

Eucl.

(*plaintively*) Only be sure you
don't let anyone know my gold is
there. Faith: no fear of anyone
finding it, not after the lovely way
I tucked it in that dark nook,
(*pauses*) Oh my God, what a
beautiful haul he would get, if
anyone should find it—a pot just
crammed with gold! For mercy's
sake, though, Faith, don't let him!

(*walks slowly toward house*) Now
I'll have a bath, so that I may
sacrifice and not hinder my
prospective son-in-law from
marrying my girl the moment he
claims her. (*looking down street
toward temple*) Take care now,
Faith, do, do, do take care I get my
pot back from you safe. I've
trusted my gold to your good faith,
laid it away in your grove and
shrine.

[EXIT *Euclio* INTO HOUSE.]

Strob.

(*jumping up*) Ye immortal gods!
What's all this I heard the fellow
tell of! A pot just crammed with
gold hidden in the shrine of Faith
here! For the love of heaven, Faith,

cave tu illi fidelis, quaeso, potius
fueris, quam mihi.

atque hic pater est, ut ego opinor,
huius erus quam amat, virginis.

620 ibo hinc intro, perscrutabor
fanum, si inveniam uspiam
aurum, dum his est occupatus. sed si
repperero, o Fides,
mulsi congialem plenam faciam tibi
fideliam.
id adeo tibi faciam; verum ego mihi
bibam, ubi id fecero.

IV. 3.

Eucl.

Non temere est quod corvos cantat
mihi nunc ab laeva manu;
semul radebat pedibus terram et voce
croccibat sua:
continuo meum cor coepit artem
facere ludicram
atque in pectus emicare. sed ego
cesso currere?

IV. 4.

Eucl.

don't be more faithful to him than
to me. Yes, and he's the father of
the girl that is master's sweetheart,
or I'm mistaken.

I'm going in there: I'll search that
shrine from top to bottom and see
if I can't find the gold somewhere
while he's busy here. But if I come
across it—oh, Faith, I'll pour you
out a five pint pot of wine and
honey! There now! that's what I'll
do for you; and when I've done
that for you, why, I'll drink it up
for myself.

[EXIT TO TEMPLE AT A RUN.]

Scene 3.

RE-ENTER *Euclio* FROM HOUSE.

Eucl.

(*excitedly*) It means something—
that raven cawing on my left just
now! And all the time a-clawing
the ground, croaking away,
croaking away! The minute I heard
him my heart began to dance a jig
and jumped up into my throat. But
I must run, run!

[EXIT TO TEMPLE.]

Scene 4.

A FEW MOMENTS ELAPSE. THEN
THE SOUND OF A SCUFFLE
DOWN THE STREET. RE-ENTER
Euclio DRAGGING *Strobilus*.
Eucl.

I foras, lumbrice, qui sub terra erepsisti
modo,
qui modo nusquam comparebas, nunc, cum
compares, peris,
630 ego pol te, praestrigiator, miseris iam
accipiam modis.

Strob.

Quae te mala crux agitat? quid tibi mecum
est commercii, senex?
quid me adflictas? quid me raptas? qua me
causa verberas?

Eucl.

Verberabilissime, etiam rogitas, non fur, sed
trifur?

Strob.

Quid tibi surrupui?

Eucl.

Redde huc sis.

Strob.

reddam?

Eucl.

Rogas?

Come! out, you worm!
crawling up from under-
ground just now! A minute
ago you weren't to be found
anywhere, and (*grimly*)
now you're found you're
finished! Oh-h-h-h, you
felon! I'm going to give it to
you, this very instant!
(*beats him*)

Strob.

What the devil's got into
you? What business have
you got with me, old
fellow? What are you
pounding me for? What are
you jerking me along for?
What do you mean by
battering me?

Eucl.

(*still pummelling him*)
Mean, eh? You
batterissimo. You're not a
thief: you're three thieves.

Strob.

What did I steal from you?

Eucl.

(*threateningly*) You kindly
give it back.

Strob.

Back? What back?

Eucl.

A nice question!

Strob.

Nil equidem tibi abstuli.

Eucl.

At illud quod tibi
abstuleras cedo.
ecquid agis?

Strob.

Quid agam?

Eucl.

Auferre non potes.

Strob.

Quid vis

tibi?

Eucl.

Pone.

Strob.

Id quidem pol te datare credo
consuetum, senex.

Eucl.

Pone hoc sis, aufer cavillam, non ego nunc
nugas ago.

Strob.

Quid ego ponam? quin tu eloquere quidquid
est suo nomine.
non hercle equidem quicquam sumpsi nec
tetigi.

Strob.

I didn't take a thing from
you, honestly.

Eucl.

Well, what you took
dishonestly, then! Hand it
over! Come, come, will
you!

Strob.

Come, come, what?

Eucl.

You shan't get away with it.

Strob.

What is it you want?

Eucl.

Down with it!

Strob.

Down with it, eh! Looks as
if you'd downed too much
of it yourself already, old
boy.

Eucl.

Down with it, I tell you!
None of your repartee! I'm
not in the humour for
trifling now.

Strob.

Down with what? Come
along, speak out and give it
its name, whatever it is.
Hang it all, I never took a

		thing nor touched a thing, and that's flat.
<i>Eucl.</i>		<i>Eucl.</i>
	640 Ostende	Show me your hands.
huc manus.		
<i>Strob.</i>		<i>Strob.</i>
Em tibi, ostendi, eccas.		(<i>stretching them out</i>) All right—there they are: have a look.
<i>Eucl.</i>		<i>Eucl.</i>
	Video. age ostende etiam	(<i>dryly</i>) I see. Come now,
tertiam.		the third one: out with it.
<i>Strob.</i>		<i>Strob.</i>
Laruae hunc atque intemperiae insaniaeque		(<i>aside</i>) He's got 'em! The
agitant senem		old chap's mad, stark,
facisne iniuriam mihi?		staring mad! (<i>to Euclio,</i> <i>virtuously</i>) Now aren't you doing me an injury?
<i>Eucl.</i>		<i>Eucl.</i>
	Fateor, quia non pendes,	I am, a hideous injury—in
maximam		not hanging you. And I'll
atque id quoque iam fiet, nisi fatere.		soon do that, too, if you don't confess.
<i>Strob.</i>		<i>Strob.</i>
	Quid fatear tibi?	Confess what?
<i>Eucl.</i>		<i>Eucl.</i>
Quid abstulisti hinc?		What did you carry off from here? (<i>pointing</i> <i>toward temple</i>)
<i>Strob.</i>		<i>Strob.</i>
	Di me perdant, si ego tui	(<i>solemnly</i>) May I be
quicquam abstuli		damned, if I carried off a
nive adeo abstulisse vellem.		thing of yours. (<i>aside</i>) Likewise if I didn't want to.

<i>Eucl.</i>		<i>Eucl.</i>
	Agedum, excutedum	Come on, shake out your cloak.
pallium.		
<i>Strob.</i>		<i>Strob.</i>
Tuo arbitrato.		(<i>doing so</i>) Anything you say.
<i>Eucl.</i>		<i>Eucl.</i>
	Ne inter tunicas habeas.	Um! probably under your tunic.
<i>Strob.</i>		<i>Strob.</i>
	Tempta qua	(<i>cheerfully</i>) Feel anywhere you please.
lubet.		
<i>Eucl.</i>		<i>Eucl.</i>
Vah, scelestus quam benigne: ut ne abstulisse intellegam.		Ugh! you rascal! How obliging you are! That I may think you didn't take it! I'm up to your dodges.
novi sycophantias. age rusum ostende huc manum		(<i>searches him</i>) Once more now—out with your hand, the right one.
dexteram.		
<i>Strob.</i>		<i>Strob.</i>
Em.		(<i>obeying</i>) There you are.
<i>Eucl.</i>		<i>Eucl.</i>
	Nunc laevam ostende.	Now the left one.
<i>Strob.</i>		<i>Strob.</i>
	650 Quin	(<i>obeying</i>) Why, certainly: here's the both of 'em.
equidem ambas profero.		
<i>Eucl.</i>		<i>Eucl.</i>
Iam scrutari mitto. redde huc.		Enough of this searching. Now give it here.
<i>Strob.</i>		<i>Strob.</i>
	Quid reddam?	What?

Eucl.

agis,
certe habes.

Strob.

Habeo ego? quid habeo?

Eucl.

Non dico, audire
expetis.
id meum, quidquid habes, redde.

Strob.

Insanis: perscrutatus
es
tuo arbitrato, neque tui me quicquam
invenisti penes.

Eucl.

Mane, mane. quis illic est? quis hic intus
alter erat tecum simul?
perii hercle: ille nunc intus turbat, hunc si
amitto hic abierit.
postremo hunc iam perscrutavi, his nihil
habet. abi quo lubet.

Strob.

Eucl.

Oh-h! Bosh! You must have
it!

Strob.

I have it? Have what?

Eucl.

I won't say: you're too
anxious to know. Anything
of mine you've got, hand it
over.

Strob.

Crazy! You went all
through me as much as you
liked without finding a
solitary thing of yours on
me.

Eucl.

(excitedly) Wait, wait!
*(turns toward temple and
listens)* Who's in there?
Who was that other fellow
in there along with you?
(aside) My Lord! this is
awful, awful! There's
another one at work in there
all this time. And if I let go
of this one, he'll skip off.
(pauses) But then I've
searched him already: he
hasn't anything. *(aloud)* Off
with you, anywhere!
*(releases him with a final
cuff)*

Strob.

Iuppiter te dique perdant.

Eucl.

Haud male egit
gratias.
ibo intro atque illi socienno tuo iam
interstringam gulam.
fugin hinc ab oculis? abin an non.

Strob.

Abeo.

Eucl.

660 Cave sis¹⁵ te
videam.

(*from a safe distance*) You
be everlastingly damned!

Eucl.

(*aside, dryly*) Nice way he
has of showing his
gratitude. (*aloud, sternly*)
I'll go in there, and that
accomplice of yours—I'll
strangle him on the spot.
Are you going to vanish?
Are you going to get out, or
not? (*advances*)

Strob.

(*retreating*) I am, I am!

Eucl.

And kindly see I don't set
eyes on you again.

[EXIT *Euclio* TOWARD TEMPLE.]

IV. 5.

Strob.

Emortuom ego me mavelim leto
malo
quam non ego illi dem hodie insidias
seni.
nam hic iam non audebit aurum
abstrudere:
credo ecferet iam secum et mutabit
locum.
attat, foris crepuit. senex eccum
aurum ecfert foras.
tantisper huc ego ad ianuam
concessero.

Scene 5.

Strob.

I'd sooner be tortured to death than
not give that old fellow a surprise
to-day. (*reflecting*) Well, after this
he won't dare hide his gold here.
What he'll most likely do is bring
it out with him and put it
somewhere else. (*listening*) Hm-
m-m! There goes the door! Aha!
the old boy's coming out with it.
I'll just back up by the doorway for
a while. (*hides by Megadorus's
house*)

IV. 6.

Eucl.

Fide censebam maxumam multo
fidem
esse, ea sublevit os mihi paenissimum:
ni subvenisset corvos, periissem
miser.

670 nimis hercle ego illum corvom ad
me veniat velim.

qui indicium fecit, ut ego illi aliquid
boni

dicam; nam quod edit tam diu
quam perduim.

nunc hoc ubi abstrudam cogito solum
locum.

Silvani lucus extra murum est avius,
crebro salicto oppletus. ibi sumam
locum.

certumst, Silvano potius credam
quam Fide.

Strob.

Euge, euge, di me salvom et
servatum volunt.

iam ego illuc praecurram atque
inscendam aliquam in arborem
indeque observabo, aurum ubi
abstrudat senex.

680 quamquam hic manere me erus
sese iusserat;

Scene 6.

RE-ENTER *Euclio* WITH POT.

Eucl.

I used to fancy Faith, of all deities,
was absolutely faithful, and here
she's just missed making a
downright ass of me. If that raven
hadn't stood by me, I'd be a poor,
poor ruined man. By heavens, I'd
just like that raven to come and see
me, the one that warned me, I
certainly should, so that I might
pay him a handsome—
compliment. As for tossing him a
bite to eat, why, that would amount
to throwing it away.

(*meditating*) Let me think now,
where is some lonely spot to hide
this in? (*after a moment*) There's
that grove of Silvanus outside the
wall, solitary, willow thickets all
around. There's where I'll pick my
place. I'd sooner trust Silvanus
than Faith, and that's settled.

[EXIT *Euclio*.

Strob.

Good! Good! The gods are with
me. I'm a made man! Now I'll run
on ahead and climb some tree
there so as to sight the place where
the old fellow hides it. What if
master did tell me to wait here! I'd
sooner look for a thrashing along
with the cash, and that's settled.

[EXIT *Strobilus*.

certum est, malam rem potius
quaeram cum lucro.

IV. 7.

Lyc.

Dixi tibi, mater, iuxta rem mecum
tenes.
super Euchoms filia. nunc te obsecro
resecroque, mater, quod dudum
obsecraueram:
fac mentionem cum avonculo, mater
mea.

Eun.

Scis tute facta velle me quae tu velis,
et istuc confido a fratre me
impetrassere;
et causa iusta est, siquidem ita est ut
praedicas,
te eam compressisse vinulentum
virginem.

Lyc.

Egone ut te advorsum mentiar, mater
mea?

Phaed.

Perii, mea nutrix. obsecro te, uterum
dolet.

Iuno Lucina, tuam fidem!

Lyc.

Em, mater
mea,
tibi rem potiolem verbo: clamat,
parturit.

Scene 7.

ENTER *Lyconides* AND *Eunomia*.

Lyc.

That's the whole story, mother: you
see how it is with me and Euclio's
daughter as well as I do. And now,
mother, I beg you, beg you again
and again, as I did before: do tell
my uncle about it, mother dear.

Eun.

Your wishes are mine, dear; you
know that yourself: and I feel sure
your uncle will not refuse me. It's
a perfectly reasonable request, too,
if it's all as you say and you
actually did get intoxicated and
treat the poor girl so.

Lyc.

Is it like me to look you in the face
and lie, my dear mother?

Phaed.

(*within Euclio's house*) Oh—oh!
Nurse! Nurse dear! Oh, God help
me! The pain!

Lyc.

There, mother! There's better proof
than words gives. Her cries! The
child!

Eun.

Ei hac intro mecum, gnate mi, ad
fratrem meum,
ut istuc quod me oras impetratum ab
eo auferam.

Lyc.

I, iam sequar te, mater. sed servom
meum
Strobilum miror ubi sit, quem ego me
iusseram
hic opperiri. nunc ego mecum cogito:
si mihi dat operam, me illi irasci
iniurium est.
ibo intro, ubi de capite meo sunt
comitia.

IV. 8.

Strob.

Picis divitiis, qui aureos montes
colunt,
ego solus supero. nam istos reges
ceteros
memorare nolo, hominum
mendicabula:
ego sum ille rex Philippus. o lepidum
diem,
nam ut dudum hinc abii, multo illo
adveni prior

Eun.

(*agitated*) Come, darling, come in
to your uncle with me, so that I
may persuade him to let it be as
you urge.

Lyc.

You go, mother: I'll follow you in
a moment.

[EXIT *Eunomia* INTO *Megadorus's*
HOUSE.]

I wonder (*looking around*) where
that fellow Strobilus of mine is
that I told to wait for me here.
(*pauses*) Well, on thinking it over,
if he's doing something for me, it's
all wrong my finding fault with
him. (*turning toward Megadorus's*
door) Now for the session that
decides my fate.
[EXIT.]

Scene 8.

ENTER *Strobilus* WITH POT.

Strob.

(*elated*) Woodpeckers that haunt
the Hills of Gold, eh! I can buy
'em up my own single self. As for
the rest of your big kings—not
worth mentioning, poor
beggarlets! I am the great King
Philip. Oh, this is a grand day!
Why, after I left here a while ago I
got there long before him and was
up in a tree long before he came:

multoque prius me conlocavi in
arborem
indeque spectabam aurum ubi
abstrudebat senex.

ubi ille abiit, ego me dorsum duco de
arbore,
exfodio aulam auri plenam. inde ex
eo loco
710 video recipere se senem; ille me
non videt,
nam ego declinavi paululum me extra
viam.
attat, eccum ipsum. ibo ut hoc
condam domum.

IV. 9.

Eucl.

Perii interii occidi. quo curram? quo
non curram? tene, tene. quem?
quis?
nescio, nil video, caecus eo atque
equidem quo eam aut ubi sim aut
qui sim
nequeo cum animo certum
investigare. obsecro vos ego, mi
auxilio,
oro obtestor, sitis et hominem
demonstretis, quis eam abstulerit.

quid est? quid ridetis? novi omnes,
scio fures esse hic complures,
qui vestitu et creta occultant sese
atque sedent quasi sint frugi.

and from there I spotted where the
old chap hid the stuff.

After he'd gone I scrabbled down,
dug up the pot full of gold! Then I
saw him coming back from the
place; he didn't see me, though. I
slipped off a bit to one side of the
road (*looking down street*) Aha!
there he comes! I'll home and tuck
this out of sight.
[EXIT *Strobilus*.

Scene 9.

ENTER *Euclio* FRANTIC.

Eucl.

(*running wildly back and forth*)
I'm ruined, I'm killed, I'm
murdered! Where shall I run?
Where shan't I run? Stop thief!
Stop thief! What thief? Who? I
don't know! I can't see! I'm all in
the dark! Yes, yes, and where I'm
going, or where I am, or who I am
—oh, I can't tell, I can't think! (*to
audience*) Help, help, for heaven's
sake, I beg you, I implore you!
Show the man that took it.

Eh, what's that? What are you
grinning for? I know you, the
whole lot of you! I know there are
thieves here, plenty of 'em, that
cover themselves up in dapper

quid ais tu? tibi credere certum est,
nam esse bonum ex voltu
cognosco.

720 hem, nemo habet horum?
occidisti. dic igitur, quis habet?
nescis?

heu me miserum, misere
perii,
male perditus, pessime
ornatus eo:
tantum gemitu et mali
maestitiaequae
hic dies mi optulit, famem
et pauperiem.

perditissimus ego sum
omnium in terra;
nam quid mi opus vita, qui
tantum auri
perdidi, quod concustodivi
sedulo? egomet me
defraudavi
animumque meum
geniumque meum;
nunc eo alii laetificantur
meo malo et damno.
pati nequeo.

Lyc.

Quinam homo hic ante aedis nostras
eiulans conqueritur maerens?
atque hic quidem Euclio est, ut
opinor. oppido ego interii: palamst
res,

clothes and sit still as if they were
honest men. (*to a spectator*) You,
sir, what do you say? I'll trust you,
I will, I will. Yes, you're a worthy
gentleman, I can tell it from your
face. Ha! none of them has it? Oh,
you've killed me! Tell me, who has
got it, then? You don't know?

Oh dear, oh dear, oh dear! I'm a
ruined man! I'm lost, lost! Oh,
what a plight! Oh, such a cruel,
disastrous, dismal day—it's made a
starveling of me, a pauper!

I'm the forlornest wretch on earth!
Ah, what is there in life for me
when I've lost all that gold I
guarded, oh, so carefully! I've
denied myself, denied my own self
comforts and pleasures; yes, and
now others are making merry over
my misery and loss! Oh, it's
unendurable!

ENTER *Lyconides* FROM HOUSE OF
Megadorus.

Lyc.

Who in the world is raising all this
howling, groaning hullabaloo
before our house here? (*looking
round*) Upon my word, it's Euclio,
I do believe. (*drawing back*) My
time has certainly come: it's all

scit peperisse iam, ut ego opinor,
filiam suam. nunc mi incertumst
730 abeam an maneam, an adeam an
fugiam quid agam edepol nescio.

out. He's just learned about his
daughter's child, I suppose. Now I
can't decide whether to leave or
stay, advance or retreat. By Jove, I
don't know what to do!

IV. 10.

Eucl.

Quis homo hic loquitur?

Lyc.

Ego sum miser.

Eucl.

Immo ego sum, et
misere perditus,
cui tanta mala maestitudoque optigit.

Lyc.

Animo
bono es.

Eucl.

Quo, obsecro, pacto esse possum?

Lyc.

Quia istuc facinus,
quod tuom
sollicitat animum, id ego feci et fateor.

Eucl.

Quid ego ex te
audio?

Lyc.

Scene 10.

Eucl.

(hearing sound of voice
only) Who's that talking
here?

Lyc.

(stepping forward) I'm the
poor wretch, sir.

Eucl.

No, no, I'm the poor wretch,
a poor ruined wretch, with
all this trouble and
tribulation.

Lyc.

Keep your courage up, sir.

Eucl.

For heaven's sake how can
I?

Lyc.

Well, sir, that outrage that
distresses you—
(hesitantly) I'm to blame,
and I confess it, sir.

Eucl.

Hey? What's that?

Lyc.

Id quod verumst.

Eucl.

Quid ego de te commerui,
adulescens, mali.
quam ob rem ita faceres meque meosque
perditum ires liberos?

Lyc.

Deus impulsor mihi fuit, is me ad illam
inlexit.

Eucl.

Quo
modo?

Lyc.

Fateor peccavisse et me culpam
commeritum scio;
id adeo te oratum advenio ut animo aequo
ignoscas mihi.

Eucl.

740 Cur id ausu's facere, ut id quod non tuum
esset tangeres?

Lyc.

Quid vis fieri? factum est illud: fieri
infectum non potest.
deos credo voluisse; nam ni vellent, nori
fieret, scio.

Eucl.

At ego deos credo voluisse ut apud me te in
nervo enicem.

The truth.

Eucl.

How have I ever harmed
you, young man, for you to
act like this and try to ruin
me and my children?

Lyc.

It was some demon got
hold of me, sir, and led me
on.

Eucl.

How is this?

Lyc.

I admit I've done wrong,
sir; I deserve your
reproaches, and I know it;
more than that, I've come to
beg you to be patient and
forgive me.

Eucl.

How did you dare do it,
dare touch what didn't
belong to you?

Lyc.

(*penitently*) Well, well, sir,
—it's done, and it can't be
undone. I think it must have
been fated; otherwise it
wouldn't have happened,
I'm sure of that.

Eucl.

Yes, and I think it must
have been fated that I'm to

Lyc.
Ne istuc dixis.

Eucl.
Quid tibi ergo meam me invito
tactiost?

Lyc.
Quia vini vitio atque amoris feci.

Eucl.
Homo audacissime,
cum istacin te oratione huc ad me adire
ausum, impudens!
nam si istuc ius est ut tu istuc excusare
possies,
luci claro deripiamus aurum matronis palam,
post id si prehensi simus, excusemus ebrios
750 nos fecisse amoris causa. nimis vilest
vinum atque amor,
si ebrio atque amanti impune facere quod
lubeat licet.

Lyc.
Quin tibi ultro supplicatum venio
obstultitiam meam.

Eucl.

shackle you at my house
and murder you!

Lyc.
Don't say that, sir.

Eucl.
Then why did you lay
hands on what was mine,
without my permission?

Lyc.
It was all because of drink...
and... love, sir.

Eucl.
The colossal impudence of
it! To dare to come to me
with a tale like that, you
shameless rascal! Why, if
it's legal to clear yourself
that way, we should be
stripping ladies of their
jewellery on the public
highways in broad daylight!
And then when we were
caught we'd excuse
ourselves on the score that
we were drunk, and did it
out of love. Drink and love
are altogether too cheap, if
your drunken lover can do
what he likes and not suffer
for it.

Lyc.
Yes, but I've come of my
own accord sir, to entreat
you to pardon my madness.

Eucl.

Non mi homines placent qui quando male
fecerunt purigant.
tu illam scibas non tuam esse. non attactam
oportuit.

Lyc.

Ergo quia sum tangere ausus, haud
causificor quin eam
ego habeam potissimum.

Eucl.

Tun habeas me invito
meam?

Lyc.

Haud te invito postulo, sed meam esse
oportere arbitror.
quin tu iam invenies, inquam, meam illam
esse oportere, Euclio.

Eucl.

Iam quidem hercle te ad praetorem rapiam
et tibi scribam dicam,
nisi refers.

Lyc.

Quid tibi ego referam?

Eucl.

760 Quod
surripuisti meum.

Lyc.

Surripui ego tuom? unde? aut quid id est?

I have no patience with
men who do wrong and
then try to explain it away.
You knew you had no right
to act so: you should have
kept hands off.

Lyc.

Well, now that I did venture
to act so, I have no
objection to holding to it,
sir,—I ask nothing better.

Eucl.

(*more angry*) Hold to it?
Against my will?

Lyc.

I won't insist on it against
your will, sir, but I do think
my claim is just. Why,
you'll soon come to realize
the justice of it yourself, sir,
I assure you.

Eucl.

I'll march you off to court
and sue you, by heaven I
will, this minute, unless you
bring it back.

Lyc.

I? Bring what back?

Eucl.

What you stole from me.

Lyc.

I stole something of yours?
Where from? What?

Eucl.

Ita te amabit

Iuppiter
ut tu nescis.

Lyc.

Nisi quidem tu mihi quid
quaeras dixeris.

Eucl.

Aulam auri, inquam, te resposco, quam tu
confessu's mihi
te abstulisse.

Lyc.

Neque edepol ego dixi neque
feci.

Eucl.

Negas?

Lyc.

Pernego immo. nam neque ego aurum neque
istaec aula quae siet
scio nec novi.

Eucl.

Illam, ex Silvani luco quam
abstuleras, cedo.
i, refer. dimidiam tecum potius partem
dividam.
tam etsi fur mihi es, molestus non ero. i
vero, refer.

Lyc.

Eucl.

(*ironically*) God bless your
innocence—you don't
know!

Lyc.

Not unless you say what
you're looking for.

Eucl.

The pot of gold, I tell you; I
want back the pot of gold
you owned up to taking.

Lyc.

Great heavens, man! I
never said that or did it,
either.

Eucl.

You deny it?

Lyc.

Deny it? Absolutely. Why, I
don't know, haven't any
idea, about your gold, or
what that pot is.

Eucl.

The one you took from the
grove of Silvanus—give it
me. Go, bring it back.
(*pleadingly*) You can have
half of it, yes, yes, I'll
divide. Even though you
are such a thief, I won't
make any trouble for you.
Do, do go and bring it back,
oh do!

Lyc.

Sanus tu non es qui furem me voces. ego te,
Euclio,
770 de alia re rescivisse censui, quod ad me
attinet;
16 magna est res quam ego tecum otiose, si
otium est, cupio loqui.

Eucl.

Dic bona fide: tu id aurum non surripuisti?

Lyc.

Bona.

Eucl.

Neque eum scis qui abstulerit?

Lyc.

Istuc quoque bona.

Eucl.

Atque id si

scies
qui abstulerit, mihi indicabis?

Lyc.

Faciam.

Eucl.

Neque partem
tibi
ab eo qui habet indispices neque furem
excipies?

Man alive, you're out of
your senses, calling me a
thief. I supposed you had
found out about something
else that does concern me,
Euclio. There's an
important matter I'm
anxious to talk over quietly
with you, sir, if you're at
leisure.

Eucl.

Give me your word of
honour: you didn't steal that
gold?

Lyc.

(*shaking his head*) On my
honour.

Eucl.

And you don't know the
man that did take it?

Lyc.

Nor that, either, on my
honour.

Eucl.

And if you learn who took
it, you'll inform me?

Lyc.

I will.

Eucl.

And you won't go shares
with the man that has it, or
shield the thief?

Lyc.

Ita.

Eucl.

Quid si fallis?

Lyc.

Tum me faciat quod volt
magnus Iuppiter.

Eucl.

Sat habeo. age nunc loquere quid vis.

Lyc.

Si me novisti

minus,
genere quo sim gnatus: hic mihi est
Megadorus avonculus,
meus pater fuit Antimachus, ego vocor
Lyconides.
mater est Eunomia.

Eucl.

780 Novi genus. nunc quid
vis? id volo
noscere.

Lyc.

Filiam ex te tu habes.

Eucl.

Immo eccillam

domi.

Lyc.

Eam tu despondisti, opinor, meo avonculo?

Eucl.

Lyc.

No.

Eucl.

What if you deceive me?

Lyc.

Then, sir, may I be dealt
with as great God sees fit.

Eucl.

That will suffice. All right
now, say what you want.

Lyc.

In case you're not
acquainted with my family
connections, sir,—
Megadorus here is my
uncle: my father was
Antimachus, and my own
name is Lyconides:
Eunomia is my mother.

Eucl.

I know who you are. Now
what do you want? That's
what I wish to know.

Lyc.

You have a daughter.

Eucl.

Yes, yes, at home there!

Lyc.

You have betrothed her to
my uncle, I understand.

Eucl.

Omnem rem

tenes.

Lyc.

Is me nunc renuntiare repudium iussit tibi.

Eucl.

Repudium rebus paratis, exornatis nuptiis?
ut illum di immortales omnes deaeque
quantum est perduint,
quem propter hodie auri tantum perdidisti
infelix, miser.

Lyc.

Bono animo es, bene dice. nunc quae res tibi
et gnatae tuae
bene feliciterque vortat—ita di faxint,
inquito.

Eucl.

Ita di faciant.

Lyc.

Et mihi ita di faciant. audi
nunciam.
790 qui homo culpam admisit in se, nullus
tam parvi preti,
quom pudeat, quin purget sese. nunc te
obtestor, Euclio,

Precisely, precisely.

Lyc.

He has asked me to inform
you now that he breaks the
engagement.

Eucl.

(*furious*) Breaks the
engagement, with
everything ready, the
wedding prepared for? May
all the everlasting powers
above consume that villain
that's to blame for my
losing my gold, all that
gold, poor God forsaken
creature that I am!

Lyc.

Brace up, sir: don't curse.
And now for some thing
that I pray will turn out well
and happily for yourself
and your daughter—"God
grant it may!" Say that.

Eucl.

(*doubtfully*) God grant it
may!

Lyc.

And God grant it may for
me, too! Now listen, sir.
There isn't a man alive so
worthless but what he
wants to clear himself when
he's done wrong and is
ashamed. Now, sir, if I've

ut si quid ego erga te imprudens peccavi aut
gnatam tuam,
ut mi ignoscas eamque uxorem mihi des, ut
leges iubent.
ego me iniuriam fecisse filiae fateor tuae,
Cereris vigiliis, per vinum atque impulsu
adulescentiae.

Eucl.

Ei mihi, quod ego facinus ex te audio?

Lyc.

Cur eiulas,
quem ego avom feci iam ut esses filiai
nuptus?
nam tua gnata peperit, decumo mense post:
numerus cape;
ea re repudium remisit avonculus causa
mea.
i intro, exquaere, sitne ita ut ego praedico.

Eucl.

800 Perii

oppido,
ita mihi ad malum malae res plurimae se
adglutinant.
ibo intro, ut quid huius verum sit sciam.

injured you or your
daughter without realizing
what I was doing, I implore
you to forgive me and let
me marry her as I'm legally
bound to. (*nervously*) It was
the night of Ceres' festival...
and what with wine and... a
young fellow's natural
impulses together... I
wronged her, I confess it.

Eucl.

Oh, oh, my God! What
villainy am I hearing of?

Lyc.

(*patting his shoulder*)
Lamenting, sir, lamenting,
when you're a grandfather,
and this your daughter's
wedding day? You see it's
the tenth month since the
festival—reckon it up—and
we have a child, sir. This
explains my uncle's
breaking the engagement:
he did it for my sake. Go in
and inquire if it isn't just as
I tell you.

Eucl.

Oh, my life is wrecked,
wrecked! The way
calamities swarm down and
settle on me one after
another! Go in I will, and
have the truth of it!

[EXIT INTO HIS HOUSE.]

Lyc.

Iam te

sequor
haec propemodum iam esse in vado salutis
res videtur
nunc servom esse ubi dicam meum
Strobilum non reperio;
nisi etiam hic opperiar tamen paulisper,
postea intro
hunc subsequar. nunc interim spatium ei
dabo exquirendi
meum factum ex gnatae pedisequa nutrice
anu. ea rem novit.

Lyc.

(*as he disappears*) I'll soon
be with you, sir. (*after a
pause, contentedly*) It does
look as if we were pretty
nearly safe in the shallows
now. (*looking around*)
Where in the world my
fellow Strobilus is I can't
imagine. Well, the only
thing to do is to wait here a
bit longer; then I'll join
father-in-law inside.
Meanwhile I'll let him have
an opportunity to inquire
into the case from the old
nurse that's been his
daughter's maid: she knows
about it all. (*waits in
doorway*)

ACTVS V

Strob.

Di immortales quibus et quantis me donatis
gaudiis.
quadrilibrem aulam auro onustam habeo.
quis me est ditior?
810 quis me Athenis nunc magis quisquam
est homo cui di sint propitii?

Lyc.

Certo enim ego vocem hic loquentis modo
mi audire visus sum.

ACT V

ENTER *Strobilus*.

Strob.

Ye immortal gods, what joy,
what bliss, ye bless me with!
I have a four pound pot of
gold, chock full of gold!
Show me a man that's
richer! Who's the chap in all
Athens now that Heaven's
kinder to than me?

Lyc.

Why, it surely seemed as if I
heard some one's voice just
then. (*catches a glimpse of*

Strob.
 erumne ego aspicio meum?
Lyc.
 Videon ego hunc
 servom meum?
Strob.
 Ipsus est.
Lyc.
 Haud alius est.
Strob.
 Congrediar.
Lyc.
 Contollam
 gradum.
 credo ego illum, ut iussi, eampse anum
 adisse, huius nutricem virginis.
Strob.
 Quin ego illi me invenisse dico hanc
 praedam¹⁷?
 igitur orabo ut manu me emittat. ibo atque
 eloquar.
 repperi—
Lyc.
 Quid repperisti?
Strob.

*Strobilus's face, the latter
 wheeling around as he sees
 Lyconides)*

Strob.
(aside) Hm! Is that master
 there?
Lyc.
(aside) My servant, is it?
Strob.
(aside, after a quick glance)
 It's the governor.
Lyc.
(aside) Himself.
Strob.
(aside) Here goes. *(moves
 toward Lyconides)*
Lyc.
(aside) I'll go meet him. No
 doubt he's followed
 instructions and been to see
 that old woman I mentioned,
 my girl's nurse.
Strob.
(aside) Why not tell him I've
 found this prize? Then I'll
 beg him to set me free. I'll
 up and let him have the
 whole story. *(to Lyconides,
 as they meet)* I've found—
Lyc.
(scoffingly) Found what?
Strob.

Non quod pueri
clamitant
in faba se repperisse.

Lyc.

Iamne autem, ut soles?
deludis.

Strob.

Ere, mane, eloquar iam, ausculta.

Lyc.

Age ergo loquere.

Strob.

hodie,
ere, divitias nimias.

Lyc.

Ubinam?

Strob.

Quadrilibrem,
inquam, aulam auri plenam.

Lyc.

Quod ego facinus audio ex te? Euclioni hic
seni subripuit.
ubi id est aurum?

Strob.

In arca apud me. nunc volo me
emitti manu.

Lyc.

No such trifle as youngsters
hurrah over finding in a
bean.^E

Lyc.

At your old tricks? You're
chaffing. (*pretends to be
about to leave*)

Strob.

Hold on, sir: I'll tell you all
about it this minute. Listen.

Lyc.

Well, well, then, tell away.

Strob.

Sir, to-day I've found—
boundless riches!

Lyc.

(*interested*) You have?
Where?

Strob.

A four pound pot, sir, I tell
you, a four pound pot just
full of gold!

Lyc.

What's all this you've done?
He's the man that robbed old
Euclio. Where is this gold?

Strob.

In a box at home. Now I
want you to set me free.

Lyc.

Egone te emittam manu,
scelerum cumulatissime?

Strob.

Abi, ere, scio quam rem geras.
lepide hercle animum tuum temptavi. iam
ut eriperes apparabas:
quid faceres, si reperissem?

Lyc.

Non potes probasse
nugas.
i, redde aurum.

Strob.

Reddam ego aurum?

Lyc.

Redde, inquam, ut
huic reddatur.

Strob.

Unde?

Lyc.

Quod modo fassus esse in arca.

Strob.

830 Soleo hercle ego
garrere nugas.

Lyc.

18

Strob.

(*angrily*) I set you free, you,
you great lump of iniquity?

Strob.

(*crestfallen, then laughing heartily*) Go along with you,
sir! I know what you're after.
Gad! that was clever of me,
testing you in that way! And
you were just getting ready
to drop on it! Now what
would you be doing, if I
really had found it?

Lyc.

No, no, that won't pass. Off
with you: hand over the
gold.

Strob.

Hand over the gold? I?

Lyc.

Yes, hand it over, so that it
may be handed over to
Euclio.

Strob.

Gold? Where from?

Lyc.

The gold you just admitted
was in the box.

Strob.

Lyc.

Strob.

	Ita loquor.	That's what I say.
<i>Lyc.</i>		<i>Lyc.</i>
	At scin quomodo? ¹⁹	(seizing him) See here, do you know what you'll get?
<i>Strob.</i>		<i>Strob.</i>
	Vel hercle	By heaven, sir, you can even
enica,		kill me, but you won't have
numquam hinc feres a me.		it from me, never—

-

*The rest of the play is lost, save for a few fragments.
Apparently Lyconides, on returning the pot of gold,
was given permission to marry Euclio's daughter;
and Euclio, having a change of heart, or influenced
by his Household God, gave it to the young couple as
a wedding present.*

FRAGMENTA

I pro illis corcotis, strophiiis, sumptu
uxorio

II ut admemordit hominem

Eucl.

III ego ecfodiebam in die denos
scrobes.

Eucl.

IV nec

noctu nec diu

quietus umquam servabam eam: nunc
dormiam.

V qui mi holera cruda ponunt, hallec
adduint.

FRAGMENTS

Instead of those fine saffron
dresses, girdles, trousseau outlay

How he fleeced the man

Eucl.

I used to be digging ten ditches a
day.

Eucl.

I never had a bit of rest day or
night watching it: now I shall
sleep.

People that serve me raw
vegetables ought to add some
sauce.

-
-
- [1.](#) Leo brackets following v., 266: *credo ego illum iam inaudivisse mi esse thensaurum domi.*]
- [2.](#) 299, 300 inverted, Gulielmus: Leo, following Havet, assumes lacuna after 298.
- [3.](#) Leo notes lacuna here. *etiam tu* Leo.
- [4.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *stultu's et sine gratiast ibi* Gulielmus.
- [5.](#) Leo brackets following v., 393: *nimirum occidor, nisi ego intro huc propere propere currere.*
- [6.](#) *Attatae* Lindsay: *optate* MSS: *cives* V²: *vires* B: *vives* D V¹.
- [7.](#) Corrupt (Leo): Goetz deletes *coepit*.
- [8.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *manupretium* Leo for *manubrium*.
- [9.](#) Leo brackets following v., 472: *quid opust verbis? acta est pugna in gallo gallinacio.*
- [10.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *myrobaptarii* Leo.
- [11.](#) Leo brackets following v., 515: *petunt fullones, sorcinatores petunt.*
- [12.](#) *curiosam* MSS: *curionem* Gulielmus, followed by Leo and others.
- [13.](#) Leo brackets following v., 592-598:
- [A.](#) The last born, or born after the father's death.
- [B.](#) The use of wine was forbidden at the festival called the *Cereris nuptiae*.
- [C.](#) Geryon was a giant with three heads and bodies.
- [D.](#) Perhaps of glass, of which the Phoenicians were reputedly the inventors.
- [E.](#) It is uncertain what they did find.
- [13.](#) For when a slave's slaving it like I am for a master who is in love, if

*nam qui amanti ero servitutem servit,
quasi ego servio,
si erum videt superare amorem, hoc
servi est officium reor,
retinere ad salutem, non enim quo
incumbat eo impellere.*

(595) *quasi pueri qui nare discunt
scirpea induitur ratis,
qui laborent minus, facilius ut nent et
moveant manus,
eodem modo servom ratem esse
amanti ero aequom censeo,
ut eum toleret, ne pessum abeat
tamquam—*

[14.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *eri ille* Wagner.

[15.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *revideam*
Bothe.

[16.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *res* excised by
Hare.

[17.](#) *praedam atque eloquar* MSS:
Leo brackets *atque eloquar*.

[18.](#) Leo notes lacuna here: *Non te
habere dicis aurum* Leo.

[19.](#) Leo notes lacuna here:
*Verberibus caedere donec
reddideris* Leo.

he sees his master's heart is
running away with him, it's the
slave's duty, in my opinion, to hold
him in and save him and not hurry
him on the way he's headed.

It's like boys learning to swim:
they lie on a rush float so as not to
have to work so hard and so as to
swim more easily and use their
arms. In the same way I hold that a
slave ought to be his master's float,
if his master's in love, so as to
support him and not let him go to
the bottom like—

-

BACCHIDES

THE TWO BACCHISES

<u>Dramatis Personae</u>	<u>ACT IV</u>
<u>Summary of missing text</u>	<u>Scene 2</u>
<u>Fragments</u>	<u>Scene 3</u>
<u>(ACT I)</u>	<u>Scene 4</u>
<u>Scene 2</u>	<u>Scene 5</u>
<u>ACT II</u>	<u>Scene 6</u>
<u>Scene 2</u>	<u>Scene 7</u>
<u>Scene 3</u>	<u>Scene 8</u>
<u>ACT III</u>	<u>Scene 9</u>
<u>Scene 2</u>	<u>Scene 10</u>
<u>Scene 3</u>	<u>ACT V</u>
<u>Scene 4</u>	<u>Scene 2</u>
<u>Scene 5</u>	<u>Epilogue</u>
<u>Scene 6</u>	<u>Footnotes</u>

PERSONAE

PISTOCLERVS ADVLESCENS
BACCHIS - SOROR MERETRIX
BACCHIS - SOROR MERETRIX
LYDVS PAEDAGOGVS
CHRYSLVS SERVVS
NICOBVLVS SENEX
MNESILOCHVS ADVLESCENS

DRAMATIS PERSONAE

PISTOCLERUS, *son of Philoxenus.*
BACCHIS OF ATHENS, *courtesan.*
BACCHIS OF SAMOS, *her sister,*
courtesan.
LYDUS, *slave of Philoxenus and*
tutor of Pistoclerus.

PHILOXENVVS SENEX
PARASITVS
PVER
ARTAMO LORARIVS
CLEOMACHVS MILES

CHRYNALUS, *slave of Nicobulus
and Mnesilochus.*
NICOBULUS, *an old gentleman of
Athens.*
MNESILOCHUS, *his son.*
PHILOXENUS, *an old gentleman of
Athens.*
A PARASITE, *a retainer of the
Captain's.*
A PAGE *in the service of the
Captain.*
ARTAMO, *Nicobulus's slave
overseer.*
CLEOMACHUS, *a Captain.*

*Scene:—Athens. A street with the
houses of Bacchis and Nicobulus
side by side.*

-

*The first part of the play is lost, save for a few
fragments, together with the last part of THE POT
OF GOLD: Leo's summary of it follows:*

*Pistoclerus has received a letter from his friend
Mnesilochus at Ephesus asking for help in his love
affair. He has been captivated by a girl there named
Bacchis, who has been hired for a year by a certain
Captain Cleomachus and taken by him to Athens.
Mnesilochus wishes his friend to find Bacchis and
obtain her release from the Captain. A servant of
Bacchis of Athens has gone down to the harbour and
comes back to her mistress with the report that her
sister Bacchis has arrived. In charge of a slave of the
Captain's this sister appears. The sisters meet with*

*Pistoclerus, who is in search of his friend's
sweetheart, and determine to make him useful.*

FRAGMENTA

- I (IV G)
quibus ingenium in animo utibilest,
modicum et sine vernilitate
- II (V) vincla, virgae, molae: saevitudo
mala fit peior
- converrite¹ scopis, agite strenue III
(VI)
- IV (VII)
ecquis evocat
cum nassiterna et cum aqua istum
impurissimum?
- V (VIII) sicut lacte lactis similest
- Bacch.*
- VI (III) illa mi cognominis fuit
- VII (IX) latro suam qui auro vitam
venditat
- VIII (X) scio spiritum eius maiorem
esse multo
quam folles taurini habent, cum
liquescent
petrae, ferrum ubi fit.
- IX (XI)
Cuiatis tibi visust?
Praenestinum opino esse, ita erat
gloriosus.

FRAGMENTS

- Those with a mental make-up of
the right sort, modest and civil.
- Shackles, whips, work in the mill:
frightful cruelty gets to be more
frightful.
- Sweep (it) up with your brooms:
come, be lively.
- Some one call out that vile wretch
with a big pail and some water.
- As much alike as two drops of
milk are.
- Bacch.*
She had the same name as myself
A mercenary who sells his life for
gold.
- I'm sure his breathing's much
louder than the puffs from a bull's-
hide bellows when they're melting
rocks at the iron-works.
- Where does he come from, do you
think?
Praeneste, probably, to judge from
his boasting.
I don't think the town's fame is at
all supposititious.

neque id haud subditiva gloria
oppidum arbitror.

Puer.

X (XVII) ne a quoquam acciperes alio
mercedem annuam,
nisi ab sese, nec cum quiquam
limares caput.

XI (XVIII) limaces viri

XII (XIII) cor meum, spes mea,
mel meum, suavitudo, cibus,
gaudium.

XIII (XIV) sine te amem

XIV (XIX) Cupidon tecum saevust anne
Amor?

XV (I) Vlixem audivi fuisse
aerumnosissimum,
qui annis viginti errans a patria afit;
verum hic adulescens multo Vlixem
anteit²
qui ilico errat intra muros civicos.

XVI (II) quidquid est nomen sibi

Pistoc.

XVII quae sodalem atque me exercitos
habet

XVIII nam credo cuivis excantare cor
potes.

XIX sin lenocinium forte collibitum
est tibi,
videas mercedis quid tibi est aecum
dari,

30 ne istac aetate me sectere gratiis.

Page

Not to let you take a yearly fee
from anyone else but him, or rub
heads with anyone.

Slugs of men.

My heart, my hope, my honey,
sweetness, food delight.

Do let me love you

Is it Cupid, or Love, raging within
you?

They say Ulysses had an awfully
hard time of it, away from home as
he was for twenty years,
wandering round. But this young
gentleman is a long way ahead of
Ulysses with his wandering round
here inside the city walls.

Whatever her (his) name is

Pistoc.

A girl that has been keeping my
chum and me exercised

For I do believe you can witch the
heart out of anyone you please

But if pandering happens to have
caught your fancy, you should
consider what price ought to be
paid you, that you may not run
after me at that time of life for
nothing.

xx Arabus.

Arabian

-

Bacch.

Quid si hoc potis est ut tu taceas, ego
loquar?

Soror

Lepide,

licet.

Bacch.

Ubi me fugiet memoria, ibi tu facito ut
subvenias, soror.

Soror

Pol magis metuo, ne defuerit mi in
monendo oratio.

Bacch.

Pol ego metuo, lusciniolae ne defuerit
cantio.
sequere hac.

Pistoc.

Quid agunt duae germanae
meretrices cognomines?
quid in consilio consuistis?

Bacchis AND HER SISTER ARE
STANDING TOGETHER TALKING.
Pistoclerus APART.

Bacch.

How about your keeping a
quiet tongue yourself, if
possible, and my doing the
talking?

Soror

Charming! By all means.

Bacch.

In case my memory deserts
me, see you come to the
rescue, sister.

Soror

Goodness me! I'm more afraid
of sage suggestions failing
myself.

Bacch.

(*laughing*) Goodness me! And
I'm afraid of song failing the
little nightingale. Come on.
(*leads the way toward*
Pistoclerus)

Pistoc.

(*aside, nervously*) What are
those two up to, those harlot
sisters with the same name?
(*aloud, trying to assume the*
air of a man of the world)

Bacch.

Bene.

Pistoc.

40 Pol haud

meretricium est.

Bacch.

Miserius nihil est quam mulier.

Pistoc.

Quid esse dices dignius?

Bacch.

Haec ita me orat, sibi qui caveat aliquem
ut hominem reperiam,
ut istunc militem—ut, ubi emeritum sibi
sit, se revehat domum.
id, amabo te, huic caveas.

Pistoc.

Quid isti caveam?

Bacch.

Ut revehatur

domum,
ubi ei dediderit operas, ne hanc ille habeat
pro ancilla sibi;
nam si haec habeat aurum quod illi
renumeret, faciat lubens.

Pistoc.

Ubi nunc is homost?

What have you girls settled on
in that session?

Bacch.

Something nice.

Pistoc.

By Jove! Unusual in the
profession!

Bacch.

(*in apparent dejection*) Oh,
there's nothing more
miserable than a woman!

Pistoc.

And what ought to be more
so, in your opinion?

Bacch.

My sister here is imploring
me to find some one to stand
by her, so that our Captain—
so that he may carry her back
home when she's served her
time. Do stand by her in this,
there's a dear.

Pistoc.

Stand by her? How?

Bacch.

To have her carried back
home when she's finished her
service, so that he mayn't keep
her for his maid servant. Why,
if she only had the money to
pay him back, she'd be glad to
do it.

Pistoc.

Where is this man at present?

Bacch.

Iam hic credo aderit. sed hoc
idem apud nos rectius
poteris agere; atque is dum veniat, sedens
ibi opperibere.
eadem biberis, eadem dederō tibi, ubi
biberis, saviū.

Pistoc.

Viscus merus vostrast blanditia.

Bacch.

Quid iam?

Pistoc.

50 Quia enim
intellego,
duae unum expetitis palumbem,³ perii
harundo alas verberat.
non ego istuc facinus mihi, mulier,
conducibile esse arbitror.

Bacch.

Qui, amabo?

Pistoc.

Quia, Bacchis, bacchas
metuo et bacchanal tuom.

Bacch.

Quid est? quid metuis? ne tibi lectus
malitiam apud me suadeat?

Bacch.

He'll be here soon, I suppose.
But this is a matter you can
manage better at our house;
yes, you sit down and wait
there till he comes.
(*coaxingly*) You shall have
something to drink, too, and
after that I'll give you just the
nicest sort of kiss, too.

Pistoc.

Nothing but birdlime, these
honeyed words.

Bacch.

Oh now, why?

Pistoc.

Well, because here you are,
the pair of you, after one lone
pigeon. (*aside*) Damnation!
The limed twigs are brushing
my wings! (*aloud, stiffly*)
Madam, I consider this an
unprofitable business for me
to be in.

Bacch.

Bless your heart, why so?

Pistoc.

Well, Bacchis, I'm afraid of
Bacchantes and your
Bacchante resort.

Bacch.

How's that? What are you
afraid of? The couch's

Pistoc.

Magis illectum tuom quam lectum metuo.
mala tu es bestia.
nam huic aetati non conducit, mulier,
latebrosus locus.

Bacch.

Egomet, apud me si quid stulte facere
cupias, prohibeam.
sed ego apud me te esse ob eam rem,
miles cum veniat, volo,
quia, cum tu aderis, huic mihique haud
faciet quisquam iniuriam:
60 tu prohibebis, et eadem opera tuo sodali
operam dabis;
et ille adveniens tuam med esse amicam
suspiciabitur.
quid, amabo, opticuisti?

Pistoc.

Quia istaec lepida sunt
memoratui:
eadem in usu atque ubi periculum facias,
aculeata sunt,
animum fodicant, bona distimulant, facta
et famam sauciant.

Soror

Quid ab hac metuis?

tempting you to be naughty
with me?

Pistoc.

It's not so much the couch as
the couch's alluring occupant
I'm afraid of. You're a
dangerous animal. Why, dens
of darkness don't become a
young fellow like me.

Bacch.

(*quite artless*) If you felt like
doing anything silly there
with me, I'd stop you my own
self. But this is why I want
you to be at my house when
the Captain comes—because
no one will do her (*pointing to*
sister) or me any harm when
you're by. You'll prevent it,
and be helping along your
chum at the same time; and
when that military man
arrives, he'll take me for your
sweetheart. Now, now, my
dearie,—why so silent?

Pistoc.

Because those words of yours
have a pretty sound: but when
a fellow takes 'em up and tries
'em they're barbed—they pink
a heart, run a fortune through,
disable a character and
reputation.

Soror

Why are you afraid of her?

Pistoc.

Quid ego metuum rogitas?
adulescens homo
penetrem me huius modi in palaestram,
ubi damnis desudascitur?⁴ (66)

Bacch.

Lepide memoras.

Pistoc.

(68) Ubi ego capiam pro
machaera turturem,⁵
70 pro galea scaphium, pro insigni sit
corolla plectilis,
pro hasta talos, pro lorica malacum
capiam pallium,
ubi mihi pro equo lectus detur, scortum
pro scuto accubet?
apage a me, apage.

Bacch.

Ah, nimium ferus es.

Pistoc.

Mihi sum.

Bacch.

Malacissandus
es.
equidem tibi do hanc operam.

Pistoc.

Ah, nimium pretiosa es
operaria.

Pistoc.

Why am I afraid of her, eh? A
young fellow like me to enter
a physical training school of
this sort (*pointing to Bacchis's*
house) where a man only
sweats himself to insolvency?

Bacch.

(*with pretended admiration*)
You do say such clever
things!

Pistoc.

Where my sword would be a
turtle dove, my helmet a wine
bowl, my plume a woven
chaplet, my spear a dice box,
my corselet a downy robe;
where I'd be given a couch for
a horse, with a bad, bad girl
beside me for a buckler?
Hence! Avaunt!

Bacch.

Ah, you're too hard on us!

Pistoc.

I am hard on myself.

Bacch.

We'll have to soften you. Yes
indeed, I'll take you in hand
myself—(*fondling him*) this
way.

Pistoc.

(*submitting reluctantly*) Ah,
your handiwork is too
expensive.

Bacch.

Simulato me amare.

Pistoc.

Utrum ego istuc iocon
adsimulem an serio?

Bacch.

Heia, hoc agere meliust. miles quom huc
adveniat, te volo
me amplexari.

Pistoc.

Quid eo mi opus est?

Bacch.

Ut ille te
videat volo.
scio quid ago.

Pistoc.

Et pol ego scio quid metuo.
sed quid ais?

Bacch.

Quid
est?

Pistoc.

Quid si apud te eveniat desubito prandium
aut potatio
80 forte aut cena, ut solet in istis fieri
conciliabulis,
ubi ego tum accumbam?

Bacch.

Bacch.

Do make believe you love me.

Pistoc.

(*smiling*) Make believe in fun,
or as if I meant business?

Bacch.

(*reprovingly*) Now, now!
here's what we'd better do.
When the Captain arrives I
want you to hug me.

Pistoc.

What's the use of my doing
that?

Bacch.

I want him to see you. I know
what I'm doing.

Pistoc.

Gad! And I know what I'm
fearing. But, I say.

Bacch.

Well?

Pistoc.

What if there should happen
to be an impromptu luncheon
or drinking party at your
house, or a dinner party,
perhaps—the ordinary thing
at resorts like yours—where
would my place be then?

Bacch.

Apud me, mi anime, ut
lepidus cum lepida accubet.
locus hic apud nos, quamvis subito
venias, semper liber est.
ubi tu lepide voles esse tibi "mea rosa,"
mihi dicito
"dato qui bene sit": ego ubi bene sit tibi
locum lepidum dabo.

Pistoc.

Rapidus fluvius est hic, non hac temere
transiri potest.

Bacch.

Atque ecaster apud hunc fluvium aliquid
perdundumst tibi.
manum da et sequere.

Pistoc.

Aha, minime.

Bacch.

Quid ita?

Pistoc.

Quia istoc
inlecebrosius
fieri nil potest: nox mulier vinum homini
adulescentulo.

Bacch.

Age igitur, equidem pol nihili facio nisi
causa tua.

Next to me, darling; a nice
boy and a nice girl side by
side. This place at my house is
your very own always, no
matter how unexpectedly you
come. Whenever you want to
have a nice time just say,
"Give me a comfy place,
rosey dear," and I'll give you a
nice place to be comfy in.

Pistoc.

(half to himself) This is a
rapid stream: dangerous
crossing here!

Bacch.

(aside) My conscience, yes!
And a stream you're bound to
lose something in, young
man! *(aloud)* Give me your
hand and come along. *(tries to
take it)*

Pistoc.

(drawing back) Oh no, not a
bit of it!

Bacch.

Why not?

Pistoc.

Because a young fellow
couldn't be offered a more
enticing combination than that
—wine, woman, and evening
hours.

Bacch.

All right then. Dear me, I
don't mind at all except for

90 ille quidem hanc abducet; tu nullus
adfueris, si non lubet.

Pistoc.

Sumne autem nihili, qui nequeam ingenio
moderari meo?

Bacch.

Quid est quod metuas?

Pistoc.

Nihil est, nugae. mulier,
tibi me emancupo:
tuos sum, tibi dedo operam.

Bacch.

Lepidu's. nunc ego te facere
hoc volo.
ego sorori meae cenam hodie dare volo
viaticam:
eo tibi argentum iubebo iam intus efferri
foras;
tu facito opsonatum nobis sit opulentum
opsonium.

Pistoc.

Ego opsonabo, nam id flagitium meum
sit, mea te gratia
et operam dare mi et ad eam operam
facere sumptum de tuo.

your sake, indeed I don't. To
be sure he'll carry her off; but
don't you come near me if you
don't like to. (*looks at him
sadly and appealingly*)

Pistoc.

(*half aside*) So I've no mind at
all, eh—no power to control
myself?

Bacch.

What is it you're afraid of?

Pistoc.

(*pauses, then ardently*)
Nothing! Bagatelles! I
surrender myself to you, my
lady: I'm all your own;
command me.

Bacch.

That's a nice boy! (*petting
him*) Now this is what I want
you to do. I want to give my
sister a dinner to-day to
celebrate her coming. I'll tell
them to bring you out some
money at once, and you're to
see to provisioning us in
perfectly splendid style. (*turns
to call to servant hither*)

Pistoc.

(*eagerly*) I'll stand the
provisioning myself: why, it
wouldn't be decent of me to
let you give me a good time,
in your kindness, and pay the
bills for it too.

At ego nolo dare te quicquam.

Pistoc.

Sine.

Bacch.

lubet
propere, amabo.

Pistoc.

100 Prius hic adero quam te
amare desinam.

Soror

Bene me accipies advenientem, mea
soror.

Bacch.

obsecro? Quid ita,

Soror

Quia piscatus meo quidem animo hic tibi
hodie evenit bonus.

Bacch.

Meus ille quidemst. tibi nunc operam
dabo de Mnesilocho, soror,
ut hic accipias potius aurum, quam hinc
eas cum milite.

Bacch.

(glancing slyly at her sister)
But I don't want it to cost you
anything.

Pistoc.

Do let me.

Bacch.

Oh, very well, if you really want to. Hurry along, there's a dear.

Pistoc.

(*fondly*) I'll be back before
I've stopped loving you.

[EXIT *Pistoclerus*.

Soror

You're going to entertain me
finely on my arrival, sister
mine.

Bacch.

Indeed? Why do you say that?

Soror

Well, that's something fine in the fish line (*with a smile toward the retreating figure of Pistoclerus*) you've landed to-day, at least I think so.

Bacch.

Oh yes, I've caught him all right. Now I must help you out in regard to Mnesilochus, my dear, so that you may pick up some money here rather

Soror
Cupio.
Bacch.
Dabitur opera. aqua calet. eamus
hinc intro, ut laves.
nam uti navi vecta es, credo timida es.

Soror
(106) Aliquantum, soror.⁶
Bacch.
(108) Sequere hac igitur me intro in
lectum, ut sedes lassitudinem.

than go trooping off with the
Captain.

Soror
I do so wish you would.
Bacch.
We'll see to it. (*going toward
house*) The water's hot: let's
go inside so that you may
bathe. For after that sea trip of
yours I dare say you're feeling
shaky.

Soror
More or less, sister.
Bacch.
Come on in with me then, so
as to lie down and get rested.
[EXEUNT.]

I. 2.

Lydus

Iam dudum, Pistoclere, tacitus te
sequor,
110 expectans quas tu res hoc ornatu
geras.
namque ita me di ament, ut Lycurgus
mihi quidem
videtur posse hic ad nequitiam
adducier.
quo nunc capessis ted hinc adversa
via
cum tanta pompa?

Pistoc.

Huc.

Lydus

Quid huc? quis
istic habet?

Pistoc.

Amor, Voluptas, Venus, Venustas,
Gaudium,
Iocus, Ludus, Sermo, Suavisaviatio.

Lydus

Quid tibi commercist cum dis
damnosissimis?

Pistoc.

Scene 2.

(An hour has elapsed.)

ENTER *Pistoclerus* PRECEDED BY
SLAVES CARRYING PROVISIONS,
FLOWERS, ETC. *Lydus* FOLLOWS.

Lydus

(magisterially) I have been
following you in silence for some
time, Pistoclerus, waiting to see
what you were about with this
gear. *(pointing to slaves and their
hampers)* Why, Lord love me, I do
believe Lycurgus^A himself could
be led astray here. Where are you
betaking yourself now, going away
up the street with such a train?

Pistoc.

(pointing to Bacchis's door) Here.

Lydus

What do you mean by "here"?
Who lives there?

Pistoc.

(rapturously) Love, Delight,
Venus, Grace, Joy, Jest, Jollity,
Chitchat, Kissykissysweetkins!

Lydus

(shocked) What commerce have
you with such pernicious,
pernicious deities?

Pistoc.

Mali sunt homines, qui bonis dicunt
male;
tu dis nec recte dicis: non aequom
facis.

Lydus

120 An deus est ullus Sauvisaviatio?

Pistoc.

An non putasti esse umquam? o
Lyde, es barbarus;
quem ego sapere nimio censui plus
quam Thalem,
is stultior es barbaro poticio,
qui tantus natu deorum nescis
nomina.

Lydus

Non hic placet mi ornatus.

Pistoc.

Nemo

ergo tibi
haec apparavit: mihi paratum est quoi
placet.

Lydus

Etiam me advorsus exordire argutias?
qui si decem habeas linguas, mutum
esse addecet.

Pistoc.

Non omnis aetas, Lyde, ludo
convenit.

130 magis unum in mentemst mihi
nunc, satis ut commode

It takes a bad man to say bad
things of the good; you're
blaspheming the gods: it's wrong.

Lydus

You mean to say there is a god
Kissykissysweetkins?

Pistoc.

You mean to say you didn't ever
suppose there was? Oh, Lydus,
you are a barbarian! I fancied you
were ever so much wiser than
Thales and here you are, sillier
than a barbarian babe in arms—
your age, and not knowing the
names of the gods!

Lydus

I do not like this paraphernalia.

Pistoc.

Well, nobody got it together for
you: it was got for me, and I do
like it.

Lydus

Are you actually commencing to
make smart replies to me? You
whom it befits to be mute, even if
you had ten tongues?

Pistoc.

We aren't schoolboys for ever,
Lydus. The one thing uppermost in
my mind just now is that the cook
may do as creditable a job on these

pro dignitate opsoni haec concuret
cocus.

Lydus

Iam perdidisti te atque me atque
operam meam,
qui tibi nequiquam saepe monstravi
bene.

Pistoc.

Ibidem ego meam operam perdidici,
ubi tu tuam:
tua disciplina nec mihi prodest nec
tibi.

Lydus

O praeligatum pectus.

Pistoc.

Odiosus mihi es.
tace atque sequere, Lyde, me.

Lydus

Illuc sis
vide,
non paedagogum iam me, sed Lydum
vocat.

Pistoc.

Non par videtur neque sit
consentaneum,
140 cum haec qui emit intus sit et cum
amica accubet
cumque osculetur et convivae alii
accubent,
praesentibus illis paedagogus una ut
siet.

Lydus

edibles as their excellence calls
for.

Lydus

Ah, now you have thrown yourself
away, and me, and my labour,—
me, who many a time gave you
good advice, all in vain!

Pistoc.

I threw away my own labour at the
same place you did yours: your
system of instruction is no good to
either of us.

Lydus

Oh, what an obdurate breast!

Pistoc.

You're a bore! Keep still and come
along, Lydus.

Lydus

Now kindly look at that! He no
longer calls me "Tutor," merely
Lydus.

Pistoc.

It's not the proper thing, it would
be out of place, when the man who
bought all this is inside there, and
on a couch with his mistress,
kissing her—and other guests
about—to have his "Tutor" there in
their presence.

Lydus

An hoc ad eas res opsonatumst,
obsecro?

Pistoc.

Sperat quidem animus: quo evenat
dis in manust.

Lydus

Tu amicam habebis?

Pistoc.

Cum videbis, tum
scies.

Lydus

Immo neque habebis neque sinam; i
prorsum domum.

Pistoc.

Omitte, Lyde, ac cave malo.

Lydus

Quid? cave
malo?

Pistoc.

Iam excessit mi aetas ex magisterio
tuo.

Lydus

O barathrum, ubi nunc es? ut ego te
usurpem lubens.⁷ 149

(151) vixisse nimio satiust iam quam
vivere.

(*horrified*) In the name of heaven!
These provisions bought for such
an orgy?

Pistoc.

(*flippantly*) Well, of course man
proposes and God disposes.

Lydus

You to have a mistress, you?

Pistoc.

(*enthusiastically*) Once you see
her, then you'll know!

Lydus

Never! You shall not have one; I
will not allow it. (*taking*
Pistoclerus by the arm and trying
to lead him back) Go home this
instant.

Pistoc.

(*pulling away*) Leave me alone,
Lydus, and (*threateningly*) look
out for trouble.

Lydus

What? "Look out for trouble?"

Pistoc.

I'm too old for you to play the
teacher these days.

Lydus

(*_tragically_*) Oh, pit, where art
thou now? How gladly would I
take thee for mine own! Far better
that I had died than lived for this!
A pupil to threaten his teacher?⁸

magistron quemquam discipulum
minitarier?⁸

Pistoc.

(155) Fiam, ut ego opinor, Hercules, tu
autem Linus.

Lydus

Pol metuo magis, ne Phoenix tuis
factis fuam
teque ad patrem esse mortuom
renuntiem.

Pistoc.

Satis historiarumst.

Lydus

Hic vereri perdidit.
compendium edepol haud aetati
optabile
160 fecisti, cum istanc nactu's
inpuidentiam.
occisus hic homo est. ecquid in
mentem est tibi
patrem tibi esse?

Pistoc.

Tibi ego an tu mihi
servos es?

Lydus

Peior magister te istaec docuit, non
ego.
nimio es tu ad istas res discipulus
docilior,
quam ad illa quae te docui, ubi
operam perdidisti.⁹ (165)

Pistoc.

Pistoc.

It's a Hercules I'll be, I'm thinking,
and you a Linus.^B

Lydus

Great heavens! I have more fear of
your actions forcing me to be a
Phoenix^C and to convey to your
father the news of your death.

Pistoc.

(*impatiently*) Enough of your tales!

Lydus

He is lost to shame! Great
heavens! You gained nothing that
does credit to your years in
acquiring this impudence. The
creature is past redemption! Does
it ever occur to you that you have a
father?

Pistoc.

Am I your servant, or you mine?

Lydus

It was a wicked, wicked teacher
gave you these lessons, not I! You
are a much apter pupil in matters
of this sort than in the subjects I
lost my labour teaching you.⁹

Pistoc.

(168) Istactenus tibi, Lyde, libertas
datast
orationis. satis est. sequere hac me ac
tace.

ACTVS II

Chrys.

170 Erilis patria, salve, quam ego
biennio,
postquam hinc in Ephesum abii
conspicio lubens.
saluto te, vicine Apollo, qui aedibus
propinquos nostris accolis, veneroque
te,
ne Nicobulum me sinas nostrum
senem
prius convenire quam sodalem
viderim
Mnesilochi Pistoclerum, quem ad
epistulam
Mnesilochus misit super amica
Bacchide.

II. 2.

Pistoc.

Mirumst me ut redeam te opere tanto
quaesere,
qui abire hinc nullo pacto possim, si
velim

(*coolly*) I've let you rant to your
heart's content, so far, Lydus. Now
drop it. Follow me this way and
keep your mouth shut.

[EXEUNT INTO THE HOUSE OF *Bacchis*,
Lydus RELUCTANTLY.]

ACT II

ENTER *Chrysalus*.

Chrys.

(*jauntily*) Greetings, land of my—
master! Land that I behold with
joy after departing hence to
Ephesus two years ago! (*turning
toward altar of Apollo in front of
house*) Thee I greet, neighbour
Apollo, who dost dwell adjacent to
our house, and I do implore thee
not to let our old man Nicobulus
fall in with me ere I see
Pistoclerus, the chum of
Mnesilochus, to whom
Mnesilochus hath sent a letter
about his mistress, Bacchis.

Scene 2.

ENTER *Pistoclerus* FROM HOUSE OF
Bacchis.

Pistoc.

(*to Bacchis within*) It seems
curious, your begging me so hard
to come back, when I couldn't
possibly leave you if I wanted,

180 ita me vadatum amore
vinctumque adtines.

Chrys.

Pro di immortales, Pistoclerum
conspicor.
o Pistoclere, salve.

Pistoc.

Salve, Chrysale.

Chrys.

Compendi verba multa iam faciam
tibi
venire tu me gaudes: ego credo tibi,
hospitium et cenam pollicere, ut
convenit
peregre advenienti: ego autem
venturum adnuc
salutem tibi ab sodali solidam nuntio
rogabis me ubi sit: vivit.

Pistoc.

Nempe recte

valet?

Chrys.

Istuc volebam ego ex te percontarier.

Pistoc.

Qui scire possum?

Chrys.

Nullus plus.

Pistoc.

190 Quemnam

ad modum?

Chrys.

when you've got me so bound over
to you, held fast in the fetters of
love.

Chrys.

Ye everlasting gods! It's
Pistoclerus. What ho, sir! How are
you?

Pistoc.

And yourself, Chrysalus?

Chrys.

Here's for saving you the trouble
of a long speech, sir. You're glad
I've come: I believe you. You
promise to do the honours and dine
me, the stranger from afar, and so
you should: for my part, I accept. I
bring you cordial greetings from
your chum. You'll ask me where he
is: alive.

Pistoc.

(eagerly) And well, well, of
course?

Chrys.

That's what I wanted to ask you.

Pistoc.

How can I know?

Chrys.

None better.

Pistoc.

Why, how so?

Chrys.

Quia si illa inventa est, quam ille
amat, recte valet,
si non inventa est, minus valet
moribundusque est
animast amica amanti. si abest,
nullus est;
si adest, res nullast. ipse est—
nequam et miser,
sed tu quid factitasti mandatis super?

Pistoc.

Egon ut, quod ab illo attigisset
nuntius,
non impetratum id advenienti ei
redderem?
regiones colere mavellem
Acherunticas.

Chrys.

Eho, an invenisti Bacchidem?

Pistoc.

199, 200

Samiam quidem.

Chrys.

Vide quaeso, ne quis tractet illam
indiligens;
scis tu ut confringi vas cito Samium
solet.

Pistoc.

Iamne ut soles?

Chrys.

Dic ubi ea nunc est,
obsecro.

Pistoc.

Because if his ladylove has been
discovered, he's perfectly well: if
she's not discovered, he's not so
well; he's at death's door. His love
is life to a lover: if she's away, he's
lost; if she's there, his cash is lost,
he himself being—a poor good-
for-nothing fool. But you—what
have you been doing about his
commission?

Pistoc.

I? Am I the man to let him arrive
and find the request his messenger
mentioned unattended to? I'd
sooner pass my days in the lower
regions.

Chrys.

Hullo! You haven't found Bacchis?

Pistoc.

Yes, the Samian one.

Chrys.

(*affecting terror*) Heavens! do see
that no one handles that one
carelessly; you know that Samian^D
ware, how precious brittle it is.

Pistoc.

The same old wag, eh?

Chrys.

Tell me where she is now, for
heaven's sake.

Pistoc.

Hic, exeuntem me unde aspexisti
modo.

Chrys.

Ut istuc est lepidum: proximae
viciniae
habitat, ecquidnam meminit
Mnesilochi?

Pistoc.

Rogas?
immo unice unum plurimi pendit.

Chrys.

Papae.

Pistoc.

Immo ut eam credis? misera amans
desiderat.

Chrys.

Scitum istuc.

Pistoc.

Immo, Chrysale, em,
non tantulum
210 umquam intermittit tempus quin
eum nominet.

Chrys.

Tanto hercle melior.

Pistoc.

Immo—

Chrys.

Immo hercle
abiero
potius.

Here in the house you just saw me
coming out of.

Chrys.

Here's a go! Residing in the
immediate neighbourhood! Well,
well! does she remember
Mnesilochus?

Pistoc.

Remember him? More than that,
she thinks he's the one and only
man on earth.

Chrys.

Oh pshaw!

Pistoc.

More than that, what do you
suppose her feelings are? The poor
affectionate thing is dying for him.

Chrys.

Quite charming!

Pistoc.

More than that, Chrysalus—look!
—she doesn't let even so much
(*illustrating*) time pass without
mentioning his name.

Chrys.

Humph! So much the better of her.

Pistoc.

More than that—

Chrys.

(*bored*) More than that, by gad, I'd
rather get out of range!

Pistoc.

Num invitus rem bene gestam
audis eri?

Chrys.

Non res, sed actor mihi cor odio
sauciat.
etiam Epidicum, quam ego fabulam
aeque ac me ipsum amo,
nullam aeque invitus specto, si agit
Pellio.
sed Bacchis etiam fortis tibi visast?

Pistoc.

Rogas?
ni nactus Venerem essem, hanc
Iunonem dicerem.

Chrys.

Edepol, Mnesiloche, ut hanc rem
natam intellego,
quod ames paratumst: quod des
inventost opus.
nam istic fortasse auro est opus.

Pistoc.

220

Philippeo quidem.

Chrys.

Atque eo fortasse iam opust.

Pistoc.

Pistoc.

You don't object to hearing that
your master is in a prosperous
situation, do you?

Chrys.

It's not the situations that make me
sick unto death; it's your
confounding acting. Even the
Epidicus^E—a comedy I love as
well as my own self—well, there's
not a one I so object to seeing, if
Pellio's playing in it. But you
really consider Bacchis a fine
lively one, do you?

Pistoc.

Do you ask me that? If^F I hadn't
lighted on Venus myself, I'd call
her Juno.

Chrys.

(*half aside*) Well, by gad,
Mnesilochus, as far as I can
understand the present situation,
you've got your love: the
wherewithal is what you need to
find. (*to Pistoclerus*) For I dare say
there is need of gold in the affair.

Pistoc.

Yes, and good coin of the realm.

Chrys.

And furthermore, I dare say it's
needed soon.

Pistoc.

etiam prius:
nam iam huc adveniet miles.

Chrys.

Et miles
quidem?

Pistoc.

Qui de amittenda Bacchide aurum
hic exiget.

Chrys.

Veniat quando volt, atque ita ne mihi
sit morae.
domist: non metuo nec ego quoiquam
supplico,
dum quidem hoc valebit pectus
perfidia meum.
abi intro, ego hic curabo. tu intus
dicito
Mnesilochum adesse Bacchidi.

Pistoc.

Faciam ut
iubes.

Chrys.

No, before that, even: for a
Captain's due here soon.

Chrys.

Indeed? A Captain, too?

Pistoc.

Who'll be after money for letting
Bacchis go.

Chrys.

(*airily*) Let him come when he
wants, yes, and let him take care
not to keep me waiting. I'm
provided: I fear no man and
supplicate no man, not I,—at least
as long as this heart of mine can
prompt a good stiff lie. Inside with
you: (*grandly waving Pistoclerus*
in) I'll take charge here myself.
You tell Bacchis in there that she
may expect Mnesilochus at once.

Pistoc.

Very well.
[EXIT.]

Chrys.

Negotium hoc ad me adinet
aurarium.
230 mille et ducentos Philippum
attulimus aureos
Epheso, quos hospes debuit nostro
seni.
inde ego hodie aliquam machinabor
machinam,
unde aurum efficiam amanti erili
filio.
sed foris concrepuit nostra: quinam
exit foras?

II. 3.

Nic.

Ibo in Piraeum, visam ecquae
advenerit
in portum ex Epheso navis
mercatoria.
nam meus formidat animus, nostrum
tam diu
ibi desiderare neque redire filium.

Chrys.

Extexam ego illum pulchre iam, si di
volunt.
240 haud dormitandumst: opus est
chryso Chrysalo.
adibo hunc, quem quidem ego hodie
faciam hic arietem
Phrxi, itaque tondebo auro usque ad
vivam cutem.
servos salutat Nicobulum Chrysalus.

It's my look out, this business of
the exchequer. We've brought
twelve hundred sovereigns from
Ephesus, money a friend there
owed our old man. I'll machinate
some machinations to-day for
transferring part of said gold to my
lovesick young master. (*listening*)
But there goes our door! Wonder
who's coming out. (*steps aside*)

Scene 3.

ENTER *Nicobulus* FROM HIS HOUSE.

Nic.

I'll walk down to the Piraeus and
see if any merchantman has come
in from Ephesus. It worries me to
have my son dilly-dallying there
so long and not returning.

Chrys.

(*aside*) I'll unravel him
handsomely now, God willing. No
sleepyheadedness allowed:
Chrysalus, you must be a golden
chrysalis! Here's at him—the man
I'll certainly make a GPhrixus's
ram here to-day, and by the same
token shear off his gold right down
to the quick! (*aloud,*
ceremoniously) Greetings to

Nic.
Pro di immortales, Chrysale, ubi mist
filius?

Chrys.
Quin tu salutem primum reddis quam
dedi?

Nic.
Salve. sed ubinamst Mnesilochus?

Chrys.
Vivit, valet.

Nic.
Venitne?

Chrys.
Venit.

Nic.
Euax, aspersisti
aquam.
benene usque valuit?

Chrys.
Pancratice atque
athletice.

Nic.
Quid hoc? qua causa eum in
Ephesum miseram,
250 accepitne aurum ab hospite
Archidemide?

Chrys.

Nicobulus from servant Chrysalus,
sir.

Nic.
Chrysalus! for the love of heaven
where is my son?

Chrys.
(*affecting pique*) Why don't you
return my greeting first, sir?

Nic.
How d'ye do. (*more animatedly*)
But where on earth is
Mnesilochus?

Chrys.
Alive and well.

Nic.
Has he come?

Chrys.
He has.

Nic.
(*fervently*) Oh, good, good! That
news is like a dash of water! Has
he been well all this time?

Chrys.
In fighting trim, a perfect athlete.

Nic.
How about it? The business I sent
him to Ephesus for? Did he get the
gold from my friend
Archidemides?

Chrys.

Heu, cor meum et cerebrum,
Nicobule, finditur,
istius hominis ubi fit quomque
mentio.
tun hospitem illum nominas hostem
tuom?

Nic.

Quid ita, obsecro hercle?

Chrys.

Quia edepol certo
scio,
Volcanus, Luna, Sol, Dies, dei
quattuor,
scelestiorem nullum inluxere
alterum.

Nic.

Quamne Archidemidem?

Chrys.

Quam, inquam,
Archidemidem.

Nic.

Quid fecit?

Chrys.

Quid non fecit? quin tu
id me rogas?
primumdum infitias ire coepit filio,
260 negare se debere tibi triobolum.
continuo antiquom hospitem nostrum
sibi
Mnesilochus advocavit, Pelagonem
senem;

(*disgustedly*) Ugh! My heart and
head fairly split, sir, whenever I
hear that fellow mentioned. Call
that friend of yours fiend, won't
you?

Nic.

Bless my soul! Why, for heaven's
sake?

Chrys.

Good Lord! Because I'm positive
the four gods, Fire, Moon, Sun,
and Day, never shone on a more
abandoned villain.

Nic.

Than Archidemides?

Chrys.

Yes, than Archidemides.

Nic.

What has he done?

Chrys.

What hasn't he done? Why don't
you ask me that? Well, in the first
place he began lying to your son
and disclaimed owing you a single
sixpence. Immediately
Mnesilochus summoned that old
gentleman, Pelagon, that's been
our friend so long; in his presence
he promptly shows the fellow the

eo praesente homini extemplo
ostendit symbolum.
quem tute dederas, ad eum ut ferret,
filio.

Nic.

Quid ubi ei ostendit symbolum?

Chrys.

Infit dicere

adulterinum et non eum esse
symbolum.
quotque innocenti ei dixit
contumelias!
adulterare eum aibat rebus ceteris.

Nic.

Habetin aurum? id mihi dici volo.

Chrys.

270 Postquam quidem praetor
recuperatores dedit.
damnatus demum, vi coactus reddidit
ducentos et mille Philippum.

Nic.

Tantum debuit.

Chrys.

Porro etiam ausculta pugnam quam
voluit dare.

Nic.

Etiamnest quid porro?

Chrys.

token, the one you gave your son
yourself to carry to him.

Nic.

(*anxiously*) And what when he
showed him the token?

Chrys.

(*indignantly*) He cries out it's a
counterfeit and not the right token
at all. And how he did heap insults
on your innocent boy! Said he was
an old hand at counterfeiting.

Nic.

Have you got the money? Do tell
me that.

Chrys.

To be sure, after the judge had
appointed arbitrators, he was
finally convicted, and, under
compulsion, he handed over
twelve hundred pounds.

Nic.

(*with a sigh of relief*) That was all
he owed.

Chrys.

There's more still, sir,—listen how
he wanted to knock us out.

Nic.

More still?

Chrys.

Em, accipitrina
haec nunc erit.

Nic.

Deceptus sum. Autolyco hospiti
aurum credidi.

Chrys.

Quin tu audi.

Nic.

Immo ingenium avari
haud pernorum hospitis.

Chrys.

Postquam aurum abstulimus, in
navem conscendimus,
domi cupientes. forte ut adsedi in
stega,
dum circumspecto, atque ego
lembum conspicio
280 longum. strigorem maleficum
exornarier.

Nic.

Perii hercle, lembus ille mihi laedit
latus.

Chrys.

Is erat communis cum hospite et
praedonibus.

Nic.

Adeon me fuisse fungum, ut qui illi
crederem,
cum mi ipsum nomen eius
Archidemides

Now then! (*aside*) This'll be a
regular hawk swoop.

Nic.

(*hotly*) I've been deceived! I've
trusted my gold to an Autolycus^H
of a friend!

Chrys.

Come, come, listen.

Nic.

Ah, no, I didn't fathom his greedy
soul.

Chrys.

After we got the gold we
embarked, eager for home. I was
sitting on deck, and while I was
looking around, my eye just
happened to fall on a long,
staunch, wicked-looking galley
being fitted out for sea.

Nic.

Hell and fury! That galley is
ramming me amidships!

Chrys.

(*with emphasis*) It was owned
between your friend and some
pirates.

Nic.

(*agonized*) Could I have been such
an imbecile as to trust the fellow
when his very name,
Archidemides, fairly bawled out

clamaret dempturum esse, si quid
crederem?

Chrys.

Is lembus nostrae navi insidias dabat.
occepi ego observare eos quam rem
gerant.

interea e portu nostra navis solvitur.
ubi portu eximus, homines remigio
sequi,

290 neque aves neque venti citius.

quoniam sentio

quae res gereretur, navem extemplo
statuimus.

quoniam vident nos stare, occeperunt
ratem

tardare¹⁰ in portu.

Nic.

Edepol mortalis malos.
quid denique agitis?

Chrys.

Rursum in portum
recipimus.

Nic.

Sapienter factum a vobis. quid illi
postea?

Chrys.

Revorsionem ad terram faciunt
vesperi.

Nic.

Aurum hercle auferre voluere: ei rei
operam dabant.

Chrys.

that I'd be damned easy, if I did
trust him with anything?

Chrys.

(*warming up*) This galley was
lying in wait for our ship. I began
to keep an eye on their operations
aboard her. Meanwhile our ship
weighs anchor and moves out of
the harbour. When we get outside
they row after us fast as a bird, fast
as the wind. Now that I noticed
what was up, we brought to at
once. Now that they saw us lying
to they began to slow down there
in the harbour.

Nic.

God bless me, what rascals! What
did you do then?

Chrys.

We put back to the harbour.

Nic.

That was wise. What did they do
after that?

Chrys.

Toward evening they went ashore.

Nic.

By the Lord! They wanted to make
off with the gold: that was their
aim!

Chrys.

Non me fefellit, sensi, eo exanimatus
fui.

quoniam videmus auro insidias fieri,
300 capimus consilium continuo;
postridie
auferimus aurum omne illis
praesentibus
palam atque aperte, ut illi id factum
sciscerent.

Nic.

Scite hercle. cedo quid illi?

Chrys.

Tristes ilico,
quom extemplo a portu ire nos cum
auro vident,
subducunt lembum capitibus
quassantibus.
nos apud Theotimum omne aurum
deposivimus,
qui illic sacerdos est Dianae
Ephesiae.

Nic.

Quis istic Theotimust?

Chrys.

Megalobuli filius,
qui nunc in Ephesost Ephesiis
carissimus.

Nic.

310 Ne ille hercle mihi sit multo tanto
carior,
si me illo auro tanto circumduxerit.

I knew that well enough: I saw
through it. That drove me frantic.
Now that we perceived that they
had designs on the gold, we laid
our plans at once; the next day we
carried it all ashore publicly and
openly while they were by, to let
them know it was done.

Nic.

By Jove, a neat idea! Come, come,
what did they do?

Chrys.

Looked doleful on the spot, and as
soon as they see us go away from
the harbour with the gold there's a
shaking of heads and they beach
their galley. As for us, we
deposited all the gold with
Theotimus, the priest of Diana
there at Ephesus.

Nic.

(*suspiciously*) Who is that
Theotimus?

Chrys.

(*reassuringly*) Megalobulus's son,
sir, and quite the dearest man in all
Ephesus to the Ephesians.

Nic.

Good Lord! He certainly would be
a very, very much dearer man to
me, if he should swindle me out of
so much gold.

Chrys.

Quin in eapse aede Dianai
conditumst.
ibidem publicitus servant.

Nic.

Occidistis me;
nimio hic privatim servaretur rectius.
sed nilne attulistis inde auri domum?

Chrys.

Immo etiam. verum quantum attulerit
nescio.

Nic.

Quid? nescis?

Chrys.

Quia Mnesilochus noctu
clanculum
devenit ad Theotimum, nec mihi
credere
nec cuiquam in navi voluit: eo ego
nescio
320 quantillum attulerit; verum haud
permultum attulit.

Nic.

Etiam dimidium censes?

Chrys.

Non edepol scio;
verum haud opinor.

Nic.

Fertne

partem tertiam?

Chrys.

Chrys.

Oh, but it's stored in the temple of
Diana itself. It's in public keeping
there.

Nic.

Yes, worse luck! It would be a
great deal safer in private keeping
here. But you didn't bring any of it
home, not any?

Chrys.

To be sure, we did. Just how much
we brought, though, I don't know.

Nic.

What? Don't know?

Chrys.

You see Mnesilochus visited
Theotimus on the sly, by night, and
he didn't care to confide in me or
anyone else aboard: so I don't
know just what trifle he did bring
along; not very much, though.

Nic.

As much as half, do you think?

Chrys.

Upon my soul, I don't know; but I
don't believe so.

Nic.

A third, eh?

Chrys.

Non hercle opinor; verum verum
nescio.
profecto de auro nil scio nisi nescio.
nunc tibimet illuc navi capiundumst
iter,
ut illud reportes aurum ab Theotimo
domum.
atque heus tu.

Nic.

Quid vis?

Chrys.

Anulum gnati tui
facito ut memineris ferre.

Nic.

Quid opust
anulo?

Chrys.

Quia id signumst cum Theotimo, qui
eum illi adferet,
ei aurum ut reddat.

Nic.

330 Meminero, et recte
mones.
sed divesne est istic Theotimus?

Chrys.

Etiam rogas?
quin auro habeat soccis subpactum
solum?

Nic.

Cur ita fastidit?

Chrys.

Bless my soul, I don't believe so;
however, I don't know. In fact, all I
know about the money is that I
don't know. Now you'll have to
make a voyage there yourself, sir,
so as to get it from Theotimus and
bring it back home. And, oh, I say!

Nic.

Well?

Chrys.

See you remember to take your
son's ring along.

Nic.

Ring? What for?

Chrys.

Because we arranged with
Theotimus that he's to give the
gold to the man that brings him
that ring.

Nic.

I shall remember; well you
mentioned it, too. But is that
Theotimus wealthy?

Chrys.

Wealthy, eh? Wealthy? And he
with gold soles on his shoes!

Nic.

What makes him so high and
mighty?

Chrys.

Tantas divitias
habet;
nescit quid faciat auro.

Nic.

Mihi dederit
velim.
sed qui praesente id aurum Theotimo
datumst?

Chrys.

Populo praesente: nullus Ephesi quin
sciat.

Nic.

Istuc sapienter saltem fecit filius,
cum diviti homini id aurum
servandum dedit;
ab eo licebit quamvis subito sumere.

Chrys.

340 Immo em tantisper numquam te
morabitur
quin habeas illud quo die illuc
veneris.

Nic.

Censebam me effugisse a vita
marituma,
ne navigarem tandem hoc aetatis
senex;
id mi haud, utrum velim, licere
intellego:
ita bellus hospes fecit Archidemides.
ubi nunc est ergo meus Mnesilochus
filius?

Chrys.

He's so rich; he doesn't know what
to do with gold.

Nic.

(*sighing*) Wish he'd give it to me!
But who was there when this
money was given to Theotimus?

Chrys.

The whole population, sir: there's
not a soul in Ephesus but knows
about it.

Nic.

My son showed sense in that, at
any rate,—giving it to a wealthy
man to keep for him. You can get it
from such a man at a moment's
notice.

Chrys.

Oh no, he'll never keep you
waiting, not—see here—
(*illustrating*) not so long: he'll let
you have it the day you arrive.

Nic.

I thought I had escaped from the
seafaring life, that an old man of
my age might really be done with
voyaging. But no choice is left me,
I perceive, in this case—thanks to
the tactics of my charming friend
Archidemides. Where is my son
Mnesilochus at present, then?

Chrys.

Deos atque amicos iit salutatum ad
forum.

Nic.

At ego hinc eo ad illum, ut convenam
quantum potest.

Chrys.

Ille est oneratus recte et plus iusto
vehit.
350 exorsa haec tela non male omnino
mihi est:
ut amantem erilem copem facerem
filium,
ita feci, ut auri quantum vellet
sumeret,
quantum autem lubeat reddere ut
reddat patri.

senex in Ephesum ibit aurum
arcessere,
hic nostra agetur aetas in malacum
modum,
siquidem hic relinquet neque secum
abducet senex
med et Mnesilochum. quas ego hic
turbas dabo!
sed quid futurumst, cum hoc senex
resciverit,
cum se excucurisse illuc frustra
sciverit
360 nosque aurum abusos? quid mihi
fiet postea?

credo hercle adveniens nomen
mutabit mihi

Gone to the forum to pay his
respects to the gods and his
friends.

Nic.

Well, I shall go and try to find him
as soon as possible.

[EXIT TO FORUM]

Chrys.

(*gleefully*) He's nicely freighted, he
is, in fact, overfrighted. Not a half
bad sort of web I've woven here!
To set up the young master in
funds for his love affair, I've fixed
things so that he can take as much
of the gold as he wants himself,
yes, and pass on to his father as
much as he likes to pass on.

The old man will go to Ephesus to
fetch the gold and we'll be living a
downy life of it here, that is, if the
old chap leaves us here and doesn't
drag me and Mnesilochus along
with him. Oh, won't I turn things
upside down here! (*pauses*) But
what'll happen when the old man
discovers it? When he finds out
he's gone on a wild goose chase
and we've used up the cash? What
will happen to me then?

Gad! I suppose he'll change my
name for me the minute he gets
back, and transform me from

facietque extemplo Crucisalum me
ex Chrysalo.
aufugero hercle, si magis usus
venerit.
si ero reprehensus, macto ego ilium
infortunio:
si illi sunt virgae ruri, at mihi tergum
domist.
nunc ibo, erili filio hanc fabricam
dabo
super auro amicaque eius inventa
Bacchide.

ACTVS III

Lydus

Pandite atque aperite propere ianuam
hanc Orci, obsecro.

nam equidem haud aliter esse duco,
quippe quo nemo advenit,
370 nisi quem spes reliquere omnes,
esse ut frugi possiet.
Bacchides non Bacchides, sed
bacchae sunt acerrumae.
apage istas a me sorores, quae
hominum sorbent sanguinem.
omnis ad perniciem instructa domus
opime atque opipare—
quae ut aspexi, me continuo contuli
protinam in pedes.

egone ut haec conclusa gestem
clanculum? ut celem patrem,
Pistoclere, tua flagitia aut damna aut
desidiabula?¹¹ (376)

Chrysalus to Crossalus on the spot.
Oh, well, I'll run for it, if it looks
advisable. If I am caught, he'll
have his fill of discomfort: if he's
got rods on the farm, well, I've got
a back on my person. Now I'll be
off and let the young master know
about this gold trick and his
mistress Bacchis being found.
[EXIT *Chrysalus*.]

ACT III

Lydus

(*wildly, inside Bacchis's house*)
Quick, quick, open up, I beseech
you, uncloset this door of hell!
ENTER *Lydus* HURRIEDLY.

For I verily believe it is nothing
else, a place where no man enters
save him who has lost all hopes of
his capacity for good. Bacchises!
No Bacchises these, but the
wildest of Bacchantes. Avaunt,
avaunt, ye sisters who suck the
blood of men! Their whole abode
is tricked out as a gilded, gorgeous
lure to ruin—as soon as I
perceived the nature of my
surroundings I fled, fled forthwith.

(*violently to those within*) Am I the
man to carry this shut up within
me, to keep it secret? To conceal
from your father, Pistoclerus, your

(379) neque mei neque te tui intus
 pudistis factis quae facis,
 380 quibus tuum patrem meque una,
 amicos, ad finis tuos
 tua infamia fecisti gerulifugos
 flagiti.¹²
 (383) de me hanc culpam demolibor
 iam et seni faciam palam,
 ut eum ex luto caeno propere
 hinc eliciat foras.

III. 2.

Mnes.

Multimodis meditatus egomet
 mecum sum, et ita esse arbitror
 homini amico, qui est amicus ita uti
 nomen possidet,
 nisi deos ei nil praestare, id opera
 expertus sum esse ita
 nam ut in Ephesum hinc abii—hoc
 factumst ferme abhinc biennium—
 ex Epheso huc ad Pistoclerum meum
 sodalem litteras
 390 misi, amicam ut mi inveniret
 Bacchidem. illum intellego
 invenisse, ut servos meus mi
 nuntiavit Chrysalus.

enormities, your extravagances,
 your horrid resorts?¹¹ Neither in
 my sight, nor your own, did you
 feel any shame at your actions,
 actions, you infamous creature,
 that make your father, and me too,
 and your friends and relatives
 accessories to your disgrace.
(making off) I am going to clear
 myself of blame in the matter this
 very minute and inform his poor
 old father of it all, so that he may
 hurry and draw him forth from this
 filthy slough.

Scene 2.

ENTER *Mnesilochus*, FOLLOWED AT
 SOME DISTANCE BY SLAVES CARRYING
 HIS LUGGAGE.

Mnes.

I've given the question careful
 consideration, and what I believe
 is this: nothing but Heaven itself
 excels a friend who is a friend in
 the full sense of the term; I've
 found this is so from my own
 experience. After I went away
 from here to Ephesus—almost two
 years ago, that was—I sent a letter
 from there to my chum Pistoclerus
 asking him to find my mistress,
 Bacchis, for me. And find her he
 did, it seems, according to that
 fellow Chrysalus of mine.

condigne is quam techinam de auro
advorsum meum fecit patrem,
ut mi amanti copia esset¹³
nam pol quidem meo animo ingrato
homine nihil inpeniust,
malefactorem amitti satius quam
relinqui beneficum;
nimio inpendiosum praestat te quam
ingratum dicier;
illum laudabunt boni, hunc etiam ipsi
culpabunt mali.

qua me causa magis cum cura esse
aecum, obvigilatost opus.
nunc, Mnesiloche, specimen specitur,
nunc certamen cernitur,
400 sisne necne ut esse oportet,
malus, bonus quoivis modi,
iustus iniustus, malignus largus,
comis incommodus.
cave sis te superare servom siris
faciundo bene
utut eris, moneo, haud celabis. sed
eccos video incedere
patrem sodalis et magistrum. hinc
auscultabo quam rem agant.

(*pauses*) Quite worthy of
Chrysalus, that scheme of his
against my father to get the money,
so that my amorous self might
have supplies. (*pauses*) Well, well,
to my own mind there's nothing
more expensive than being an
ingrate. Letting a malefactor off is
better than turning your back on a
benefactor. The name of being too
extravagant is a great deal better
for you than that of being
ungrateful. Good men will speak
well of the first sort of fellow:
even rascals themselves will blame
the second.

I must take all the more care, then,
how I act and keep my eyes open.
Here's where you show a sample
of yourself, Mnesilochus; here's
where you're put to the test
whether you're the man you should
be or not—bad or good, whatever
you are—just or unjust—mean or
generous—gentleman or cad.
Mind you look out not to let your
servant be your better in doing the
kindly thing. No matter what you'll
be, I warn you you can't conceal it.
(*looking down street*) Hullo,
though! Here come my chum's
father and tutor ambling along. I'll
listen to what they're up to from
over here. (*withdraws*)

III. 3.

Scene 3.

Lydus

Nunc experiar, sitne aceto tibi cor acre in
pectore.
sequere.

Phil.

Quo sequar? quo ducis nunc me?

Lydus

Ad illam quae
tuom
perdidit, pessum dedit tibi filium unice
unicum

Phil.

Heia, Lyde, leniter qui saeviunt sapiunt
magis.
minus mirandumst, illaec aetas si quid
illorum facit,
quam si non faciat. feci ego istaec itidem in
adulescentia.

Lydus

Ei mihi, ei mihi, istaec illum perdidit
assentatio
nam absque te esset, ego illum haberem
rectum ad ingenium bonum
nunc propter te tuamque pravos factus est
fiduciam
Pistoclerus.

ENTER *Lydus* AND
Philoxenus.

Lydus

(*struggling to control himself*) Now we shall see
whether or no you have a
heart of fiery feeling within
you. Follow me!

Phil.

(*calmly*) Follow you
where? Where are you
taking me to now?

Lydus

To the woman who has
depraved, destroyed your
one and only son!

Phil.

Gently, gently, *Lydus*! "Ire
restrained is wisdom
gained." It's less surprising
to have a youngster up to
something of that kind than
not. I've done the same sort
of thing myself in my
younger days.

Lydus

Oh-h-h dear, oh dear! It is
that very tolerance that has
been his undoing. Why, but
for you, I should have
made a good moral man of
him: as it is, you and your
support have made a
debauchee of *Pistoclerus*.

Mnes.

Di immortales, meum sodalem
hic nominat.
quid hoc negoti est, Pistoclerum Lydus quod
erum tam ciet?

Phil.

Paulisper, Lyde est libido homini suo animo
obsequi;
iam aderit tempus, cum sese etiam ipse
oderit. morem geras;
dum caveatur, praeter aequom ne quid
delinquat, sine.

Lydus

Non sino, neque equidem illum me vivo
corrumpi sinam.
420 sed tu, qui pro tam corrupto dicis causam
filio,
eademne erat haec disciplina tibi, cum tu
adulescens eras?
nego tibi hoc annis viginti fuisse primis
copiae,
digitum longe a paedagogo pedem ut
efferres aedibus.

ante solem exorientem nisi in palaestram
veneras,
gymnasi praefecto haud mediocris poenas
penderes.

Mnes.

(*aside*) Good God! My
chum's name! What does
this mean—Lydus running
down his master Pistoclerus
so?

Phil.

A man's eager to have his
fling for a little while,
Lydus; the time will soon
come when he'll actually
loathe himself for it. Give
him rein; so long as he's
careful not to go too far in
his indiscretions, why, let
him be.

Lydus

I will not let him be, no,
nor let him be corrupted
and live to see it, never!
But you—with your pleas
for a son so corrupted—
was your own training of
this same sort when you
were a young man? I say
no, I say you never had a
chance during the first
twenty years of your life to
stir a single finger's breadth
from the house without
your tutor.

Unless you had arrived at
the athletic grounds before
sunrise, it was no slight
penalty the Gymnasium
Director imposed on you.

id quom optigerat, hoc etiam ad malum
 accersebatur malum:
et discipulus et magister perhibebantur
 improbi.
ibi cursu luctando hasta disco pugilatu pila
saliendo sese exercebant magis quam scorto
 aut saviis:
430 ibi suam aetatem extendebant, non in
 latebrosis locis.

inde de hippodromo et palaestra ubi
 revenisses domum,
cincticulo praecinctus in sella apud
 magistrum adsideres
cum libro: cum legeres, si unam peccavisses
 syllabam,
fieret corium tam maculosum quam est
 nutricis pallium.

Mnes.

Propter me haec nunc meo sodali dici
 discrucior miser;
innocens suspicionem hanc sustinet causa
 mea.

Phil.

Alii, Lyde, nunc sunt mores.

Lydus

When this had happened,
this further trouble was
added, that pupil and
teacher too were held to be
disgraced. There it was by
running, wrestling,
throwing the spear and
discus, boxing, ball,
jumping, they used to get
their exercise, rather than
by means of wenchies, or
kisses: it was there they
used to spend their lives,
not in dark dens of vice.

Then when you had
returned home from the
track and field, all neat and
trim you would sit on your
chair before your teacher
with your book: and while
you were reading, if you
had missed a single
syllable, your hide would
be made as spotted as a
nurse's gown.

Mnes.

(*aside* It's torment, hang it,
to have my chum coming in
for all this on my account;
it's for my sake he's
shouldering this suspicion,
poor innocent.

Phil.

(*soothingly* The customs of
to-day are different, Lydus.

Lydus

Id equidem ego certo
scio.
nam olim populi prius honorem capiebat
suffragio,
quam magistro desinebat esse dicto
oboediens;
440 at nunc, prius quam septuennis est, si
attingas eum manu,
extemplo puer paedagogo tabula dirumpit
caput.

cum patrem adeas postulatum, puero sic
dicit pater:
"noster esto, dum te poteris defensare
iniuria."
provocatur paedagogus: "eho senex minimi
preti,
ne attigas puerum istac causa, quando fecit
strenue."¹⁴ (445)
(447) itur illinc iure dicto. hocine hic pacto
potest
inhibere imperium magister, si ipso primus
vapulet?

Mnes.
Acris postulatio haec est. cum huius dicta
intellego,
450 mira sunt ni Pistoclerus Lydum pugnis
contudit.

Indeed they are! I realize
the truth of that. Why, in
the old days a young man
would be holding office, by
popular vote, before he had
ceased to hearken to his
teacher's precepts. But
nowadays, before a
youngster is seven years
old, if you lay a finger on
him, he promptly takes his
writing tablet and smashes
his tutor's head with it.

When you go to his father
with a protest, he talks to
the youngster in this strain:
(*mimicking*) "You're
father's own boy so long as
you can defend yourself
against abuse." Then the
tutor is summoned: "Hey,
you worthless old baggage,
don't you touch my boy
merely for acting like a lad
of spirit!" Judgment
pronounced, the court
adjourns. Can a teacher
exert authority here under
such conditions, if he is
beaten first himself?

Mnes.
(*aside*) Here's a warm
protest! Judging from his
remarks, it's a wonder if
Pistoclerus hasn't been
punching Lydus's head.

Lydus

Sed quis hic est, quem astantem video ante
ostium? o Philoxene,
deos propitios me videre quam illum haud
mavellem mihi.

Phil.

Quis illic est?

Lydus

Mnesilochus, gnati tui sodalis.¹⁵
haud consimili ingenio atque ille est qui in
lupanari accubat.
fortunatum Nicobulum, qui illum produxit
sibi.

Phil.

Salvos sis, Mnesiloche, salvom te advenire
gaudeo.

Mnes.

Di te ament, Philoxene.

Lydus

Hic enim rite productust
patri:
in mare it, rem familiarem curat, custodit
domum,
obsequens oboediensque est mori atque
imperiis patris.
460 hic sodalis Pistoclero iam puer puero
fuit;

Lydus

(*looking in the direction of
Mnesilochus*) But who is
this I see standing in front
of the door? (*recognizing
him*) Ah, Philoxenus, that is
a man whose support I
should value no less than
that of the gods!

Phil.

Who is it?

Lydus

Mnesilochus, your son's
chum. And a youth so, so
different from the one
lolling in that vile house!
(*pointing to Bacchis's*)
Happy, happy Nicobulus to
have brought up such a lad!

Phil.

(*stepping forward*) How are
you, Mnesilochus? I'm glad
to see you safely back.

Mnes.

(*heartily shaking hands*)
God bless you, Philoxenus!

Lydus

Ah, yes, here is a son to
rejoice a father's heart: goes
to sea, attends to family
affairs, is the bulwark of
the home, observes and
obeys his father's every
wish and word. He was
Pistoclerus's chum even

triduom non interest aetatis uter maior siet:
verum ingenium plus triginta annis maiust
quam alteri.

Phil.

Cave malo et compesce in illum dicere
iniuste.

Lydus

Tace.

stultus es qui illi male aegre patere dici qui
facit. ¹⁶ (464)

Mnes.

(467) Quid sodalem meum castigas, Lyde,
discipulum tuom?

Lydus

Periit tibi sodalis.

Mnes.

Ne di sirint.

Lydus

Sic est ut

loquor.

quin ego cum peribat vidi, non ex audito
arguo.

Mnes.

Quid factum est?

Lydus

when they were boys—not
three days' difference
between them so far as age
is concerned, but this lad is
more than thirty years his
senior in native sense.

Phil.

(*angrily*) Look out for
yourself, and stop speaking
about the lad unfairly!

Lydus

Peace! fool that you are to
be pained at hearing him
badly spoken of, when he is
bad! ¹⁶

Mnes.

(*innocently*) Why are you
finding fault with my
chum, Lydus, your own
pupil?

Lydus

(*tragically*) Your chum has
perished!

Mnes.

God forbid!

Lydus

It's just as I tell you. Ah
yes, I myself beheld him in
the act: I am not accusing
him on hearsay.

Mnes.

What has happened?

Lydus

Meretricem indigne deperit.

Mnes.

470 Non tu

taces?

Lydus

Atque acerrume aestuosam: absorbet ubi
quemque attigit.

Mnes.

Ubi ea mulier habitat?

Lydus

Hic.

Mnes.

Unde esse eam aiunt?

Lydus

Ex

Samo.

Mnes.

Quae vocatur?

Lydus

Bacchis.

Mnes.

Erras, Lyde: ego omnem

rem scio

quem ad modumst. tu Pistoclerum falso
atque insontem arguis.

nam ille amico et benevolenti suo sodali
sedulo

He is shockingly infatuated
with a courtesan.

Mnes.

(apparently scandalized)
Oh, don't say such a thing!

Lydus

Yes, and a perfect
maelstrom of a woman: she
sucks down every man who
comes within her reach.

Mnes.

Where does this woman
live?

Lydus

(pointing) Here.

Mnes.

Where do they say she is
from?

Lydus

Samos.

Mnes.

What is her name?

Lydus

Bacchis.

Mnes.

(with an air of relief) You're
mistaken, Lydus: I know all
about the matter, just how it
stands. That's a false charge
of yours, and Pistoclerus is
innocent. Why, he's
fulfilling a commission for

rem mandatam exsequitur. ipse neque amat
nec tu credas.

Lydus

Itane oportet rem mandatam gerere amici
sedulo,
ut ipse in gremio osculantem mulierem
teneat sedens?
nullo pacto res mandata potest agi, nisi
identidem
480 manus ferat ei ad papillas, labra a labris
nusquam auferat?

nam alia memorare quae illum facere vidi
disputet:
cum manum sub vestimenta ad corpus tetulit
Bacchidi
me praesente, neque pudere quicquam. quid
verbis opus?
mini discipulus, tibi sodalis periit, huic
filius;
nam ego illum periisse dico quod quidem
periit pudor.¹⁷ (485)

Mnes.

(489) Perdidisti me, sodalis. egone ut illam
mulierem
490 capitis non perdam? perire me malis
malim modis.

a friend and well-wisher of
his, a chum, and doing it
zealously. He doesn't love
her himself, and you
mustn't think he does.

Lydus

(*sharply*) Does executing
this commission for his
friend, and doing it
zealously, call for his
sitting down and holding
the girl in his lap while she
kisses him? Is there no way
of his carrying out this
commission save by his
embracing her time and
again in unseemly fashion
and never taking his lips an
inch from hers?

Why, I feel ashamed to
mention other things I saw
him do, dreadful, dreadful
things, in my presence—
and never a trace of shame
about him. Why say more?
My pupil, your chum, this
father's son, has perished;
for perished I say he has,
when his sense of shame
has perished.¹⁷

Mnes.

You've wrecked my life,
(*with special acrimony*)
chum! Oh, won't I wreck
that woman's! I'd rather die
a dog's death than not get

satin ut quem tu habeas fidelem tibi aut cui
credas nescias?

Lydus

Viden ut aegre patitur gnatum esse
corruptum tuom,
suom sodalem, ut ipse sese cruciat
aegritudine?

Phil.

Mnesiloche, hoc tecum oro, ut illius animum
atque ingenium regas;
serva tibi sodalem et mihi filium.

Mnes.

Factum volo.

Lydus

Melius esset, me quoque una si cum illo
relinqueres.

Phil.

Adfatim est.

Lydus

Mnesiloche, cura, ei, concastiga
hominem probe,
qui dedecorat te, me amicosque alios
flagitiis suis.

Phil.

In te ego hoc onus omne impono. Lyde,
sequere hac me.

even with her! Can it really
be you don't know whom to
think loyal to you, whom to
trust?

Lydus

(*to Philoxenus*) Do you see
how he suffers at your son,
his chum, being corrupted;
how his very soul is
tormented?

Phil.

Mnesilochus, try to control
the lad's impulses and
disposition, I beg you. Save
your chum for yourself and
my son for me.

Mnes.

(*vehemently*) I wish I
might!

Lydus

(*to Philoxenus*) It would be
better for you to leave me
with him, too.

Phil.

No, no, he'll manage.

Lydus

Mnesilochus, take charge
of him! Go, rate him well
—for degrading you, and
me and his other friends
with his enormities.

Phil.

I put the whole load on
your shoulders. (*turns to*

Lydus

go) This way, *Lydus*; come.

Lydus

Sequor. (*gloomily*) Very well.

[*EXEUNT Philoxenus AND*

Lydus.

III. 4.

Mnes.

500 Inimiciorem nunc utrum credam
magis
sodalemne esse an Bacchidem,
incertum admodumst.
ilium exoptavit potius? habeat.
optumest.
ne illa illud hercle cum malo fecit
suo;
nam mihi divini numquam quisquam
creduat,
ni ego illam exemplis plurumis
planeque—amo.
ego faxo hau dicet nactam quem
derideat.

nam iam domum ibo atque—aliquid
surrupiam patri.
id isti dabo. ego istanc multis ulciscar
modis.
adeo ego illam cogam usque ut
mendicet—meus pater.
sed satine ego animum mente sincera
gero,
510 qui ad hunc modum haec his quae
futura fabulor?
amo hercle opinor, ut pote quod pro
certo sciam.

Scene 4.

Mnes.

(*tempestuously*) I absolutely can't
tell which is my worse enemy
now, my chum or Bacchis.
Hankered for him instead of me,
did she? Let her have him! All
right, all right! By heaven, she'll
certainly pay for this; for may no
one ever believe my sacred word
again, if I don't thoroughly and
utterly—(*wryly*) love her. She
shan't say she's lighted on a man
she can laugh to scorn, I promise
you.

For I'll home this minute, and—
steal something from my father
and give it to her. I'll be revenged
on her in all sorts of ways. Yes
indeed, I'll bring her to such a pass
that—my father will have to beg
his bread. But can I really be in
possession of my senses, babbling
here in this fashion about these
futures? Good Lord! I do believe
I love her—seeing I know it for
certain.

verum quam illa umquam de mea
pecunia
ramenta fiat plumea propensior,
mendicum malim mendicando
vincere.
numquam edepol viva me inridebit.
nam mihi
decretumst renumerare iam omne
aurum patri.

igitur mi inani atque inopi
subblandibitur
tum quom blandiri nihilo pluris
referet
quam si ad sepulcrum mortuo narres
logos.¹⁸ (519)
520 profecto stabilest me patri aurum
reddere.

eadem exorabo, Chrysalo causa mea
pater ne noceat, neu quid ei
suscenseat
mea causa de auro quod eum
ludificatus est;
nam illi aequomst me consulere, qui
causa mea
mendacium ei dixit. vos me
sequimini.

III. 5.

Pistoc.

Rebus aliis antevortar, Bacchis, quae
mandas mihi:

But sooner than let any cash of
mine make her a fraction of a
feather-weight the heavier, I'd
outbeggar a beggar. By gad, she
shan't give me the laugh in this
world, never! My mind's made up
—I'll count out every bit of that
gold to my father this moment.

Then let her try her pretty wiles on
me when I'm poverty stricken and
penniless, when it won't do any
more good to coax than if you
were to prattle to a dead man at his
tomb.¹⁸ The money goes to my
father, that's final, absolutely final.

At the same time I'll persuade him
to let Chrysalus off for my sake
and not to be at all angry with him
on account of his fooling him, for
my sake, about the gold. Yes, it is
only right I should look out for the
fellow that lied to him for my sake.
(*to slaves with luggage*) Follow
me, you.

[EXEUNT INTO HOUSE OF *Nicobulus*.]

Scene 5.

Fifteen minutes have elapsed)

ENTER *Pistoclerus* FROM *Bacchis's*
HOUSE.

Pistoc.

(*to Bacchis within*) Everything else
shall come second to your

Mnesilochum ut requiram atque ut
eum mecum ad te adducam simul.
nam illud animus meus miratur, si a
me tetigit nuntius,
quid remoretur. ibo ut visam huc ad
eum, si forte est domi.

commission, Bacchis,—to hunt up
Mnesilochus and bring him back
with me. Why, I don't know what
to make of his delay, if my
message reached him. I'll go look
him up at the house here, in case
he happens to be at home.

III. 6.

Mnes.

530 Reddidi patri omne aurum. nunc ego
illam me velim
convenire, postquam inanis sum,
contemptricem meam.
sed veniam mihi quam gravate pater dedit de
Chrysalo;
verum postremo impetravi, ut ne quid ei
suscenseat.

Pistoc.

Estne hic meus sodalis?

Mnes.

Estne hic hostis, quem
aspicio, meus?

Pistoc.

Certe is est.

Mnes.

Is est.

Pistoc.

Scene 6.

ENTER *Mnesilochus* FROM
HOUSE.

Mnes.

I've handed over the whole
sum to my father. Now's
the time I should like her to
meet me, now that I haven't
a sou—my Lady Disdain!
(*pausing*) But how father
did hate to pardon
Chrysalus for me!
However, I finally induced
him to swallow his wrath.

Pistoc.

(*approaching Nicobulus's
house*) Isn't that my chum?

Mnes.

Isn't that my enemy I see?

Pistoc.

(*beaming*) It certainly is.

Mnes.

(*glowering*) It is.

Pistoc.

Adibo contra et contollam
gradum.
salvos sis, Mnesiloche.

Mnes.

Salve.

Pistoc.

Salvos quom peregre
advenis,
cena detur.

Mnes.

Non placet mi cena quae bilem
movet.

Pistoc.

Numquae advenienti aegritudo obiecta est?

Mnes.

Atque

acerruma.

Pistoc.

Unde?

Mnes.

Ab homine quem mi amicum esse
arbitratus sum antidhac.

Pistoc.

540 Multi more isto atque exemplo vivont,
quos cum censeas
esse amicos, reperiuntur falsi falsimoniis,
lingua factiosi, inertes opera, sublesta fide.
nullus est quoi non invideant rem secundam
optingere;
sibi ne invideatur, ipsi ignavia recte cavent.

I'll step up and meet him.
(hurries to him)
Mnesilochus! bless you!

Mnes.

(gruffly) Same to you.

Pistoc.

(enthusiastically) We must
have a dinner, now you're
safe back from abroad.

Mnes.

I have no desire for a
dinner that stirs my bile.

Pistoc.

(wonderingly) You haven't
met with any trouble on
your return, have you?

Mnes.

Yes, of the worst sort.

Pistoc.

What caused it?

Mnes.

A man I always took for a
friend till now.

Pistoc.

(indignantly) There are
plenty of fellows amongst
us of that character and
description, fellows you
regard as friends only to
find 'em treacherous traitors
—energetic talkers, lazy
doers, and ready deserters.

Mnes.

Edepol ne tu illorum mores perquam
meditate tenes.
sed etiam unum hoc: ex ingenio malo malum
inveniunt suo:
nulli amici sunt, inimicos ipsi in sese omnis
habent.
ei se cum frustrantur, frustrari alios stolidi
existumant.
sicut est his, quem esse amicum ratus sum
atque ipsum sum mihi:
550 ille, quod in se fuit, accuratum habuit
quod posset mali
faceret in me, inconciliaret copias omnis
meas.

Pistoc.

Improbum istunc esse oportet hominem.

Mnes.

arbitror.

Pistoc.

Ego ita esse

There's no one they don't
envy his good luck. As for
themselves, they take
proper care no one envies
them—their own inertness
looks out for that.

Mnes.

(dryly) Well, well! You
certainly have a very
intimate acquaintance with
their characteristics. But
there's this one thing to
add: they're cursed by their
own cursed dispositions:
friends to no man as they
are, they themselves have
foes in all men. When
they're deceiving
themselves the fools fancy
they are deceiving others.
That's the way with this
man I thought was as good
a friend to me as I am to
myself: as far as in him lay
he took pains to do me all
the harm he could, to
defraud me of all I had.

Pistoc.

The fellow must be a
perfect villain!

Mnes.

Precisely my own opinion.

Pistoc.

Obsecro hercle loquere, quis is est?

Mnes.

Benevolens vivit tibi.
nam ni ita esset, tecum orarem ut ei quod
posses mali
facere faceres.

Pistoc.

Dic modo hominem qui sit
sit: non fecero
ei male aliquo pacto, me esse dicito
ignavissimum.

Mnes.

Nequam homost, verum hercle amicus est
tibi.

Pistoc.

Tanto magis
dic quis est; nequam hominis ego parvi
pendo gratiam.

Mnes.

Video non potesse quin tibi eius nomen
eloquar.
560 Pistoclere, perdidisti me sodalem
funditus.

Pistoc.

Quid istuc est?

Mnes.

Quid est? misine ego ad te ex
Epheso epistulam

(*more indignantly*) By
Jove, now! Who is he? Tell
me, tell me.

Mnes.

A man on good terms with
you. Yes, but for that, I'd
beg you to do him any
damage you could.

Pistoc.

Only tell me who the
fellow is: if I don't damage
him somehow, you can call
me the most spiritless
wretch on earth.

Mnes.

He's a scoundrel, but good
Lord, he is a friend of
yours!

Pistoc.

All the more reason for
telling me who he is; it's
little I care for the favour of
a scoundrel.

Mnes.

I see there is nothing for
me to do but give you his
name. Pistoclerus, (*bitterly*)
you have ruined me, your
chum, ruined me utterly.

Pistoc.

(*aghast*) Eh? What's that?

Mnes.

What's that? Didn't I send
you a letter from Ephesus

super amica, ut mi invenires?

Pistoc.

Fateor factum, et
repperi.

Mnes.

Quid? tibi non erat meretricum aliarum
Athenis copia
quibuscum haberes rem, nisi cum illa quam
ego mandassem tibi
occiperes tute¹⁹ amare et mi ires consultum
male?

Pistoc.

Sanum es?

Mnes.

Rem repperi omnem ex tuo
magistro. ne nega.
perdidisti me.

Pistoc.

Etiamne ultro tuis me
prolectas probris?

Mnes.

Quid? amas Bacchidem?

Pistoc.

Duas ergo his intus eccas
Bacchides.

Mnes.

Quid? duas?

about my mistress, asking
you to find her for me?

Pistoc.

To be sure you did—and I
did find her.

Mnes.

What? Weren't there
enough other women in
Athens for you to philander
with, without beginning to
make love to her, the girl I
had entrusted to you, and
trying this underhand trick
on me?

Pistoc.

Are you sane?

Mnes.

I have the whole story from
your tutor. You needn't
deny it. You have ruined
me.

Pistoc.

(*getting irritated*) Can it be
you're bent on provoking
me with this uncalled for
abuse of yours?

Mnes.

Eh? You do love Bacchis?

Pistoc.

Well, but look you, there
are two Bacchises in here.

Mnes.

(*astonished*) What? Two?

Pistoc.

Atque ambas sorores.

Mnes.

Loqueris nunc
nugas sciens.

Pistoc.

570 Postremo, si pergis parvam mihi fidem
arbitrarier,
tollam ego ted in collum atque intro hinc
auferam.

Mnes.

Immo ibo, mane.

Pistoc.

Non maneo, neque tu me habebis falso
suspectum.

Mnes.

Sequor.

Pistoc.

And sisters, too.

Mnes.

Now you're talking rot, and
you know it.

Pistoc.

See here now, if you go on
making light of my word,
I'll perch you up on my
neck and carry you off
inside. (*seizes him*)

Mnes.

No, no, I'll go: wait.

Pistoc.

I won't wait, and I won't
have you suspecting me
falsely, either. (*pulls him
toward door*)

Mnes.

I'm coming.

[EXEUNT INTO HOUSE.]

ACTVS IV

Par.

Parasitus ego sum hominis nequam
atque improbi,
militis, qui amicam secum avexit ex
Samo.
nunc me ire iussit ad eam et
percontarier,

ACT IV

ENTER *Parasite* WITH *Cleomachus's*
PAGE.

Par.

The parasite of a worthless
reprobate is what I am, the parasite
of the Captain that carried the
wench off from Samos with him.
Now he has ordered me to call on
her and inquire whether she
intends to pay him back his
money, or go along with him.

utrum aurum reddat anne eat secum
 semul.
 tu dudum, puere, cum illae usque isti
 semul:
 quae harum sunt aedes, pulta. adi
 actutum ad fores.
 recede hinc diirecte. ut pulsat
 propudium!
 580 comesse panem tris pedes latum
 potes,
 fores pultare nescis. ecquis in
 aedibust?
 heus, ecquis his est? ecquis hoc
 aperit ostium?
 ecquis exit?

IV. 2.

Pistoc.

Quid istuc? quae istaec
 est pulsatio?
 20 quae te mala crux agitat, qui ad
 istunc modum
 alieno viris tuas extentes ostio?
 fores paene exfregisti. quid nunc vis
 tibi?

Par.

Adulescens, salve.

Pistoc.

Salve, sed quem
 quaeritas?

Par.

(*scanning the houses*) Boy, you
 came along to the place with her a
 short time ago: whichever house it
 is here, knock. Up to the door with
 you directly: (*page obeys,*
knocking timidly)

Get out and be hanged to you!
 How the imp knocks! You can
 devour a loaf of bread three feet
 wide: as for knocking at a door,
 you don't know how. (*pounds*
vigorously himself, and shouts)
 Anyone at home? Hi! Anyone
 here? Anyone minding this door?
 Anyone coming?

Scene 2.

ENTER *Pistoclerus* INTO DOORWAY.

Pistoc.

(*angrily*) What's all this? What do
 you mean by pounding so? What
 the devil ails you, to test your
 strength on other people's doors
 this way? You've nearly smashed it
 off. Now what are you after?

Par.

(*somewhat cowed*) Good day,
 young gentleman.

Pistoc.

Good day. But who is it you're
 looking for?

Par.

Bacchidem.

Pistoc.

Utram ergo?

Par.

Nil scio nisi

Bacchidem.

paucis: me misit miles ad eam

Cleomachus,

590 vel ut ducentos Philippos reddat
aureos

vel ut hinc in Elatiam hodie eat
secum semul.

Pistoc.

Non it. negat se ituram. abi et
renuntia.

alium illa amat, non illum. due te ab
aedibus.

Par.

Nimis iracunde.

Pistoc.

At scin quam

iracundus siem?

ne tibi hercle haud longe est os ab
infortunio,

ita dentifrangibula haec meis
manibus gestiunt.

Par.

Cum ego huius verba interpretor,
mihi cautios,

ne nucifrangibula excussit ex malis
meis.

tuo ego istaec igitur dicam illi
periculo.

Bacchis.

Pistoc.

Well, which?

Par.

Bacchis—that's all I know. Briefly:
Captain Cleomachus sent me to
say she must either pay him back
two hundred golden sovereigns, or
else go along with him to-day to
Elatea.

Pistoc.

She is not going. She refuses to go.
Away with you and report! It's
another man she loves, not him.
March yourself off!

Par.

(*soothingly*) You're too irritable.

Pistoc.

(*roaring*) But d'ye know how
irritable? By the Lord, that face of
yours is precious close to a
calamity, the way these (*shaking
his fists at parasite, who retreats*)
tooth-crackers here are itching!

Par.

(*aside, wryly*) To judge from his
remarks, I must take care he
doesn't knock the nutcrackers out
of my jaws. (*aloud*) All right, I'll
tell him about this, and it will be at
your risk. (*turns to go*)

Pistoc.
Quid ais tu?
Par.
Ego istuc illi dicam.
Pistoc.
600 Dic mihi,
quis tu es?
Par.
Illius sum integumentum
corporis.
Pistoc.
Nequam esse oportet cui tu
integumentum improbu's.
Par.
Sufflatus ille huc veniet.
Pistoc.
Dirruptum
velim.
Par.
Numquid vis?
Pistoc.
Abeas. celeriter factost
opus.
Par.
Vale, dentifrangibule.
Pistoc.
Et tu,
integumentum, vale.

Pistoc.
See here! (*advancing*)
Par.
(*backing away*) I'll tell him what
you say.
Pistoc.
Tell me this, who are you?
Par.
(*impressively*) I am the Captain's
corporal integument.
Pistoc.
A sorry specimen he must be to
have a rascal like you for an
integument!
Par.
He'll be coming here swelling with
rage.
Pistoc.
I hope he bursts.
Par.
(*going*) Anything more I can do?
Pistoc.
Yes, get out! And you need to be
quick about it. (*advancing*)
Par.
(*running*) Farewell, Sir
Toothcracker.
Pistoc.
The same to yourself, Sir
Integument [EXIT *Parasite*.] Now

in eum nunc haec res venit locum, ut
quid consili
dem meo sodali super amica
nesciam,
qui iratus renumeravit omne aurum
patri,
neque nummus ullust qui reddatur
militi.
610 sed huc concedam, nam
concrepuerunt fores.
Mnesilochus eccum maestus
progreditur foras.

IV. 3.

Mnes.

Petulans, protervo iracundo animo,
indomito incogitato,
sine modo et modestia sum, sine bono iure
atque honore,
incredibilis imposque animi, inamabilis
inlepidus vivo,
malevolente ingenio natus. postremo id mi
est quod volo
ego esse aliis. credibile hoc est?
nequior nemost neque indignior
quoi
di bene faciant neque quem
quisquam
homo aut amet aut adeat.

matters have come to the point
where I don't know how to advise
my chum about his mistress, what
with his getting angry and
counting out all the gold to his
father, and not a penny left to pay
the Captain. (*listening*) But I'll step
aside here: (*does so*) the door
creaked. Ah, there's our
woebegone Mnesilochus coming
out.

Scene 3.

ENTER *Mnesilochus* FROM
Bacchis's HOUSE.

Mnes.

A hasty fool, a reckless,
passionate, uncontrollable,
unthinking fool without
method and moderation, that's
what I am—a creature
without any sense of right and
honour, distrustful,
hotheaded, loveless,
graceless, crabbed and born
crabbed! Yes, yes, I'm
everything that I wish some
one else was! Is this credible?
There's not a viler man alive,
a man more unworthy of
heaven's kindness, of having
a mortal soul love him or
come near him!

inimicos quam amicos aequomst
med habere,
malos quam bonos par magis me
iuvare.
omnibus probris, quae improbis
viris
620 digna sunt, dignior nullus est
homo;
qui patri reddidi omne aurum amans, mihi
quod fuit prae manu. sumne ego homo
miser?
perdidi me simulque operam Chrysali.

Pistoc.

Consolandus his mist, ibo ad eum.
Mnesiloche, quid fit?

Mnes.

Perii.

Pistoc.

Di melius faciant.

Mnes.

Perii.

Pistoc.

Non taces, insipiens?

Mnes.

Taceam?

Pistoc.

Sanus satis non est.

Mnes.

Enemies are what I ought to
have, not friends; rascals are
the right people to help me,
not honest men. Not a man on
earth has a better title to all
the infamy of an infamous
scoundrel! I to give all that
gold to my father, and I in
love—gold I had in hand! If
I'm not a poor, poor fool! I've
thrown away my own life
together with all Chrysalus
did for me.

Pistoc.

(*aside*) I must console him:
I'll up to him. (*aloud,*
approaching) How are things,
Mnesilochus?

Mnes.

I'm done for.

Pistoc.

God forbid!

Mnes.

(*still more dejectedly*) I'm
done for.

Pistoc.

Won't you shut up, you silly
fellow?

Mnes.

Shut up?

Pistoc.

You've lost your wits.

Mnes.

Perii.
multa mala mi in pectore nunc acria atque
acerba eveniunt.
criminin me habuisse fidem? immerito tibi
iratus fui.

Pistoc.

Heia, bonum habe animum.

Mnes.

630 Unde habeam?
mortuos pluris pretist
quam ego sum.

Pistoc.

Militis parasitus venerat
modo aurum petere hinc,
eum ego meis dictis malis his foribus
atque hac platea abegi;
reppuli, reieci hominem.

Mnes.

Quid mi id prodest?
quom ipse veniet,
quid faciam? nil habeo miser. ille quidem
hanc abducet, scio.

Pistoc.

Si mihi sit, non pollicear.

Mnes.

Scio, dares, novi
tuom.

I'm done for. Oh, the
confounded thoughts that
crowd in on me now,
exasperating, excruciating!
To have credited that
accusation! I had no reason to
be angry with you.

Pistoc.

Oh well, cheer up.

Mnes.

Where can I get cheer? A
corpse is worth more than I
am.

Pistoc.

(*encouragingly*) The
Captain's parasite has just
been here after the money: I
let him have a volley of abuse
and drove him away up the
street here. I fought him off,
flung him back.

Mnes.

(*disconsolate*) What's the
good of that to me? When he
comes himself, what shall I
do? I haven't a penny, wretch
that I am! Of course he'll
carry her off, I know that.

Pistoc.

If I had any money myself, I
wouldn't promise it to you.

Mnes.

I know, you'd give it to me: I
know your way. If you
weren't in love yourself,

sed nisi ames, non habeam tibi fidem
tantam; eo quod amas tamen
nunc agitas sat tute tuarum rerum; sin liber
sies
egone ut opem mi ferre posse putem
inopem te? non potest.

Pistoc.

Tace modo: deus respiciet nos aliquis.

Mnes.

vale.

Pistoc.

Mane.

Mnes.

Quid est?

Pistoc.

Tuam copiam eccam
Chrysalum video. tace.

IV. 4.

Chrys.

640 Hunc hominem decet auro expendi,
huic decet statuam statui ex auro;
nam duplex hodie facinus feci,
duplicibus spoliis sum adfectus.
erum maiorem meum ut ego hodie
lusi lepide, ut ludificatust.

though, I shouldn't have such
confidence in you. Being in
love, however, you have
troubles enough of your own
as it is. But even if you were
fancy free, could I think you
able to supply me, unsupplied
as you are yourself?
Impossible!

Pistoc.

Oh, do shut up: some god will
look out for us.

Mnes.

Rubbish! (*despairingly,*
moving off) Farewell!

Pistoc.

(*looking down street*) Wait.

Mnes.

What's the matter?

Pistoc.

(*pointing*) Look! I see your
supply station, Chrysalus. Sh
—h! (*they withdraw*).

Scene 4.

ENTER *Chrysalus* IN HIGH SPIRITS.

Chrys.

Here is a man (*patting his*
chest) that is worth his weight
in gold: here is a man who
ought to have a gold statue set
up for him. Why, I've done a
double deed to-day, been
graced with double spoils. The

callidum senem callidis dolis
compuli et perpuli, mi omnia ut
crederet.

nunc amanti ero filio senis,
quicum ego bibo, quicum
edo et amo,
regias copias aureasque optuli,
ut domo sumeret neu foris
quaereret.
non mihi isti placent
Parmenones, Syri,
650 qui duas aut tris minas
auferunt eris.

nequius nil est quam egens consili
servos, nisi habet multipotens pectus:
ubicumque usus siet, pectore expromat
suo.
nullus frugi esse potest homo,
nisi qui et bene et male facere tenet.

improbis cum improbus sit, harpaget,
furibus
furetur quod queat,
vorsipellem frugi convenit esse
hominem,
659-660 pectus quoi sapit: bonus sit
bonis, malus sit malis;

old master—how cleverly I did
take him in to-day, how he was
fooled! Wily as the old chap is,
my wily arts impelled him and
compelled him to believe me
in everything.

And now the young master
that's in love, the old one's son,
that I drink with and eat with
and go a-courting with—I've
furnished him out with regal
supplies, golden supplies, so
that he can go to himself for
cash and not look for it
outside. I haven't any use for
those Parmenos,^I those
Syruses^I that do their masters
out of two or three gold pieces.

There's nothing more worthless
than a servant without brains:
he's got to have a precious
powerful intellect: whenever a
scheme is needed, let him
produce it from his own
intellect. Not a soul can be
worth anything, unless he
knows how to be good and bad
both.

He must be a rascal among
rascals, rob robbers, steal what
he can. A chap that's worth
anything, a chap with a fine
intellect, has to be able to
change his skin. He must be
good with the good and bad
with the bad; whatever the

utcumque res sit, ita animum
habeat.

sed lubet scire quantum aurum
erus sibi
dempsit et quid suo reddidit
patri.
si frugi est, Herculem fecit ex
patre:
decimam partem ei dedit, sibi
novem abstulit.
sed quem quaero optume
eccum obviam mihi est.

num qui nummi exciderunt, ere,
tibi,
quod sic terram optuere?
quid vos maestos tam tristesque esse
conspicor?
670 non placet nec temere est etiam. quin
mihi respondetis?

Mnes.

Chrysale, occidi.

Chrys.

Fortassis tu auri dempsisti
parum?

Mnes.

Quam, malum, parum? immo vero nimio
minus multo parum.

Chrys.

Quid igitur, stulte? an tu, quoniam
occasio ad eam rem fuit

situation calls for, that he's got
to be.

(*pausing*) But I should like to
know how much money master
took for himself and what he
passed on to his father. If he is
worth anything, he has let his
father play Hercules—given
him a tithe and made off with
nine parts for his own use.

(*sees Mnesilochus and
Pistoclerus*) Hullo, though!
Here's a lucky meeting with
the man I'm looking for!

(*to Mnesilochus*) You haven't
dropped any of the coin, have
you, sir,—gazing at the ground
that way? (*waits for answer*)
What makes you two look so
sad and gloomy? (*waits again*)
I don't like it: no indeed, it's
not for nothing. (*waits again*)
Why don't you answer me?

Mnes.

Chrysalus, I'm a lost man.

Chrys.

You took too little of the gold,
perhaps?

Mnes.

Too little, eh, curse it! No
indeed,—much too much less
than too little!

Chrys.

Well, how's that, you
blockhead? After my ability

mea virtute parta, ut quantum velles
tantum sumeres,
sic hoc digitulis duobus sumebas
primoribus?
an nescibas quam eius modi homini raro
tempus se daret?

Mnes.

Erras.

Chrys.

At quidem tute errasti, cum
parum immersti ampliter.

Mnes.

Pol tu quam nunc me accusas magis, si
magis rem noveris.
occidi.

Chrys.

Animus iam istoc dicto plus
praesagitur mali.

Mnes.

Perii.

Chrys.

Quid ita?

Mnes.

680 Quia patri omne cum
ramento reddidi.

Chrys.

Reddidisti?

Mnes.

won you this opportunity to
help yourself to just as much
as you pleased, you surely
didn't pick it up this way
(*illustrating*) with a couple of
finger tips? Didn't you know
how seldom a man is offered
such a chance?

Mnes.

You're making a mistake.

Chrys.

Well, you made another
yourself, by not dipping into it
deep enough.

Mnes.

(*moodily*) Good Lord! You'd
lecture me more than you do
now, if you knew more of the
facts. I'm a lost man!

Chrys.

Now I foresee more trouble
coming, after that remark.

Mnes.

I'm done for.

Chrys.

Why so?

Mnes.

Because I've handed over
every scrap of it to my father.

Chrys.

(*dumbfounded*) Handed it
over?

Mnes.

Reddidi.

Chrys.

Omnene?

Mnes.

Oppido.

Chrys.

Occisi
sumus.
qui in mentem venit tibi istuc facinus
facere tam malum?

Mnes.
Bacchidem atque hunc suspicabar
propter crimen, Chrysale,
mi male consuluisse: ob eam rem omne
aurum, iratus reddidi
meo patri.

Chrys.

Quid, ubi reddebas aurum,
dixisti patri?

Mnes.
Me id aurum accepisse extemplo ab
hospite Archidemide.

Chrys.

Em,
istoc dicto dedisti hodie in cruciatum
Chrysalum;
nam ubi me aspiciet, ad carnificem
rapiet continuo senex.

Mnes.

Handed it over.

Chrys.
Every bit?

Mnes.
Absolutely.

Chrys.
We're both lost men! What
made it enter your head to do
such a thing, such an awful
thing?

Mnes.
(*awkwardly*) I heard a charge
made, Chrysalus, and
suspected Bacchis and
Pistoclerus here of plotting
against me: so I got angry and
handed all the money over to
my father.

Chrys.
What did you tell your father
when you handed it over?

Mnes.
That I had received it on
demand from his friend
Archidemides.

Chrys.
(*grimly*) Aha! And gave
Chrysalus over to torment by
the statement; for when he sets
eyes on me the old man will
promptly hale me off to the
public torturer.

Mnes.

Ego patrem exoravi.

Chrys.

Nempe ergo hoc ut
faceret quod loquor?

Mnes.

690 Immo tibi ne noceat neu quid ob eam
rem suscenseat;
atque aegre impetravi. nunc hoc tibi
curandumst, Chrysale.

Chrys.

Quid vis curem?

Mnes.

Ut ad senem etiam alteram
facias viam.
compara, fabricare finge quod lubet,
conglutina,
ut senem hodie doctum docte fallas
aurumque auferas.

Chrys.

Vix videtur fieri posse.

Mnes.

Perge, ac facile
ecfeceris.

Chrys.

Quam, malum, facile, quem mendaci
prendit manifesto modo?
quem si orem ut mihi nil credat, id non
ausit credere.

(hurriedly I persuaded him.

Chrys.

(dryly) Indeed? To do what I'm
saying, I take it?

Mnes.

No, no, not to harm you, or be
at all angry with you for what
you did; and a hard time I had
getting it out of him, too.
(pauses, then in flattering
manner) Here's what you must
see to now, Chrysalus.

Chrys.

(sourly) What do you want me
to see to?

Mnes.

To making another march still
against the old man. Use your
ideas, your devices, your craft,
any way you please, stick
together some clever scheme
to fool the clever old fellow to-
day and get away with the
gold.

Chrys.

It hardly looks possible to me.

Mnes.

You go ahead, and you'll carry
it through easily.

Chrys.

Easily, eh, curse it? A man that
has caught me in a barefaced
lie? A man that, if I should beg
him not to believe me in a

Mnes.

Immo si audias quae dicta dixit me
adversum tibi.

Chrys.

Quid dixit?

Mnes.

Si tu illum solem sibi solem
esse diceres,
700 se illum lunam credere esse et noctem
qui nunc est dies.

Chrys.

Emungam hercle hominem probe hodie,
ne id nequiquam dixerit.

Mnes.

Nunc quid nos vis facere?

Chrys.

Enim nil nisi ut ametis
impero.
ceterum quantum lubet me poscitote
aurum: ego dabo.
quid mihi refert Chrysalo esse nomen,
nisi factis probō?
sed nunc quantillum usust auri tibi,
Mnesilochē? dic mihi.

Mnes.

thing, wouldn't dare to believe
even that!

Mnes.

(*smiling feebly*) Worse still—if
you had only heard what he
said to me about you.

Chrys.

What did he say?

Mnes.

That if you told him the sun
there was the sun, he'd believe
it was the moon, and that it
was night now, not day.

Chrys.

(*thinking a moment, then
jubilantly*) By Jupiter! I'll clean
the man up in glorious shape
to-day, that he mayn't say that
for nothing!

Mnes.

What do you want us to do
now?

Chrys.

Oh, make love—that's all I
order. But just apply to me for
gold, as much as you like: I'm
your man. What's the
advantage of my being named
Chrysalus, unless I live up to
it? Well now, Mnesilochus,
what's the paltry sum you
need? Tell me.

Mnes.

Militi nummis ducentis iam usus est pro
Bacchide.

Chrys.

Ego dabo.

Mnes.

Tum nobis opus est sumptu.

Chrys.

Ah,

placide volo
unum quidque agamus: hoc ubi egero,
tum istuc agam.
de ducentis nummis primum intendam
ballistam in senem;
710 ea ballista si pervortam turrim et
propugnacula,
recta porta invadam extemplo in
oppidum anticum et vetus:
si id capso, geritote amicis vestris aurum
corbibus,
sicut animus sperat.

Pistoc.

Apud test animus
noster, Chrysale.

Chrys.

Nunc tu abi intro, Pistoclere, ad
Bacchidem, atque ecfer cito.

Pistoc.

Quid?

Chrys.

(*eagerly*) I need two hundred
pounds at once to pay the
Captain for Bacchis.

Chrys.

I'm your man.

Mnes.

Then we must have something
for running expenses.

Chrys.

Oh, I say, let's go gently and
attend to things one by one:
after I've attended to this, then
I'll attend to that: I'll train my
catapult on the old fellow for
the two hundred first. If I
shatter the tower and outworks
with the said catapult, the next
minute I'll plunge straight
through the gate into the
ancient and time-worn town; in
case I capture it, you two can
carry off gold to your lady
friends by the basketful, and
gratify the hope of your soul.

Pistoc.

Our soul is in your keeping,
Chrysalus.

Chrys.

(*obviously the manager*) Now,
Pistoclerus, inside with you to
Bacchis and hurry back with—

Pistoc.

With what?

Chrys.

Stilum, ceram et tabellas, linum.

Pistoc.

Iam faxo his

erunt.

Mnes.

Quid nunc es factururus? id mihi dice.

Chrys.

Coctumst

prandium?

vos duo eritis atque amica tua erit tecum
tertia?

Mnes.

Sicut dicis.

Chrys.

Pistoclero nulla amica est?

Mnes.

Immo

adest.

alteram ille amat sororem, ego alteram,
ambas Bacchides.

Chrys.

Quid tu loquere?

Mnes.

Hoc, ut futuri sumus.

Chrys.

720 Ubist

biclinium
vobis stratum?

Mnes.

—a stylus, wax and tablets,
some tape.

Pistoc.

I'll have them here at once.

[EXIT INTO HOUSE.]

Mnes.

What are you going to do
now? Tell me that.

Chrys.

Is lunch cooked? You two, and
your girl with you for a third,
—is that the plan?

Mnes.

Just so.

Chrys.

No girl for Pistoclerus?

Mnes.

Oh, yes there is! He loves one
sister and I the other, both of
them Bacchises.

Chrys.

(surprised) What's that you tell
me?

Mnes.

Merely our arrangements.

Chrys.

Where is this duplex dining-
couch of yours set?

Mnes.

Quid id exquaeris?

Chrys.

Res itast, dici

volo.

nescis quid ego acturus sim nec facinus
quantum exordiar.

Mnes.

Cedo manum ac subsequere propius me
ad fores. intro inspice.

Chrys.

Euax, nimis bellus atque ut esse maxume
optabam locus.

Pistoc.

Quae imperavisti. imperatum bene bonis
factum ilicost.

Chrys.

Quid parasti?

Pistoc.

Quae parari tu iussisti
omnia.

Chrys.

Cape stilum propere et tabellas tu has
tibi.

Mnes.

What do you ask that for?

Chrys.

The case calls for it. I want to
be told. You don't know what
I'm up to, what a monster of a
scheme I'm going to get under
way.

Mnes.

(slyly) Give me your hand and
follow me closer to the door.
(leads *Chrysalus* to the house
of *Bacchis* and pushes the door
open) Cast your eyes in there!

Chrys.

(looking in) Hurray! Perfectly
delicious, yes, just the sort of
place I longed for it to be!

RE-ENTER *Pistoclerus*.

Pistoc.

(to *Chrysalus*, with mock
deference) Orders followed,
sir! Good orders to good men
instantly executed.

Chrys.

What have you got?

Pistoc.

Everything your mandate
called for. (showing writing
materials)

Chrys.

(to *Mnesilochus*) Quick! Take
the stylus and these tablets,
you.

Mnes.

	Quid	(<i>obeying</i>) And then?
postea?		
<i>Chrys.</i>		<i>Chrys.</i>
Quod iubebo scribito istic. nam propterea		Write down there what I
te volo		dictate. I want you to do the
720 scribere, ut pater cognoscat litteras		writing, you see, so that your
quando legat.		father will recognize your hand
scribe.		when he reads it. Write.
<i>Mnes.</i>		<i>Mnes.</i>
Quid scribam?		Write what?
<i>Chrys.</i>		<i>Chrys.</i>
Salutem tuo patri verbis		Oh, some wish—use your own
tuis.		words—for your father's
		health. (<i>Mnesilochus writes</i>)
<i>Pistoc.</i>		<i>Pistoc.</i>
Quid si potius morbum mortem scribat?		Hadn't he better write sickness
id erit rectius.		and death? That will be more
		to the point.
<i>Chrys.</i>		<i>Chrys.</i>
Ne interturba.		(<i>to Pistoclerus</i>) Don't muddle
		him.
<i>Mnes.</i>		<i>Mnes.</i>
Iam imperatum in cera inest.		That's down now according to
		orders.
<i>Chrys.</i>		<i>Chrys.</i>
	Dic	Let's hear how you've put it.
quem ad modum.		
<i>Mnes.</i>		<i>Mnes.</i>
"Mnesilochus salutem dicit suo patri."		(<i>reading</i>) "Mnesilochus sends
		best wishes to his father."
<i>Chrys.</i>		<i>Chrys.</i>
Adscribe hoc		Hurry up, add this: "Chrysalus
cito:		keeps talking away at me

"Chrysalus mihi usque quaque loquitur
nec recte, pater,
quia tibi aurum reddidi et quia non te
fraudaverim."

Pistoc.

Mane dum scribit.

Chrys.

Celerem oportet esse
amatoris manum.

Pistoc.

²¹At quidem hercle est ad perdundum
magis quam ad scribundum cita.

Mnes.

Loquere. hoc scriptumst.

Chrys.

"Nunc, pater mi, proin
tu ab eo ut caveas tibi,
740 sycophantias componit, aurum ut abs
ted auferat;
et profecto se ablaturum dixit." plane
adscribito.

Mnes.

Dic modo.

Chrys.

"Atque id pollicetur se
datum aurum mihi,
quod dem scortis quodque in lustris
comedim congraecem, pater,
sed, pater, vide ne tibi hodie verba det:
quaeso cave."

everywhere, father, and talking
harshly, because I handed the
gold over to you and did not
defraud you."

Pistoc.

Give him time to write.

Chrys.

A lover's hand ought to be
nimble.

Pistoc.

Gad, yes! but it makes shorter
work of cash than
correspondence.

Mnes.

Go on. That's written.

Chrys.

"Now then, father dear, do be
on your guard against him—he
is laying a rascally scheme to
take the gold from you; and he
vows he will take it." Write
that down plain.

Mnes.

(*after a moment*) Yes, yes, go
on.

Chrys.

"And besides, he promises he
will give it to me to spend on
women and to squander in
riotous living in low resorts,
father. But, father, do see that
he doesn't impose upon you to-
day: for mercy's sake, take
care."

Mnes.

Loquere porro.

Chrys.

Adscribe dum etiam—

Mnes.

Loquere quid
scribam modo.

Chrys.

"Sed, pater, quod promisisti mihi, te
quaeso ut memineris,
ne illum verberes; verum apud te
vinctum adservato domi."
cedo tu ceram ac linum actutum. age
obliga, obsigna cito.

Mnes.

Obsecro, quid istis ad istunc usust
conscriptis modum,
750 ut tibi ne quid credat atque ut vinctum
te adservet domi?

Chrys.

Quia mi ita lubet. potin ut cures te atque
ut ne parcas mihi?
mea fiducia opus conduxī et meo periculo
rem gero.

Mnes.

Mnes.

(*finishing*) All right, some
more.

Chrys.

Just go on and add—(*thinking*)

Mnes.

Well, say what.

Chrys.

"However, I beg you to
remember what you promised
me, father: don't beat him; but
tie him up and keep watch on
him at home." (*to Pistoclerus*)
The wax and tape, you, look
sharp! (*Pistoclerus obeys. To*
Mnesilochus) Come on, fasten
it, seal it, quick!

Mnes.

(*obeying*) For heaven's sake,
what's the use of a document
like this, telling him not to
believe you at all, to tie you up
and keep watch on you at
home?

Chrys.

Because it suits me. Can't you
mind your own business and
not bother about me?

(*arrogantly*) I was relying on
myself when I contracted for
this job, and I'll take the risk
myself in doing it.

Mnes.

Aequom dicis.

Chrys.

Cedo tabellas.

Mnes.

Accipe.

Chrys.

Animum

advortite.

Mnesiloche et tu, Pistoclere, iam facite in
biclinio

cum amica sua uterque accubitus eatis,
ita negotiumst,
atque ibidem ubi nunc sunt lecti strati
potetis cito.

Pistoc.

Numquid aliud?

Chrys.

Hoc, atque etiam: ubi erit
accubitus semel,
ne quoquam exurgatis, donec a me erit
signum datum.

Pistoc.

O imperatorem probum!

Chrys.

Iam bis bibisse
oportuit.

Mnes.

Fugimus.

Chrys.

Fairly spoken.

Chrys.

Hand over the tablets.

Mnes.

(*doing so*) Here they are.

Chrys.

Attention now! Mnesilochus,
and you too, Pistoclerus, go at
once and take your places on
your duplex dining-couch,
each of you beside his girl—
that's the thing to do—and
right there where the couches
are set at present you hurry up
and begin drinking.

Pistoc.

(*turning to go*) Nothing else?

Chrys.

Just this—and one thing more:
when you've once taken your
places, don't move an inch off
the couches until you get the
signal from me.

Pistoc.

O peerless leader!

Chrys.

(*bustling them off*) You should
have put down two drinks
already.

Mnes.

(*in mock terror*) We're running
away.

Chrys.

760 Vos vostrum curate officium,
ego efficiam meum.

(grinning) You two do your
duty and I'll attend to mine.

[EXEUNT *Pistoclerus* AND
Mnesilochus INTO HOUSE OF
Bacchis.

IV. 5.

Chrys.

insanum magnum molior negotium,
metuoque ut hodie possiem emolirier.
sed nunc truculento mi atque saevo
usus senest;
nam non conducit huic sycophantiae
senem tranquillum esse ubi me
aspexerit.

versabo ego illum hodie, si vivo,
probe.
tam frictum ego illum reddam quam
frictum est cicer.
adambulabo ad ostium, ut, quando
exeat,
extemplo advenienti ei tabellas dem
in manum.

IV. 6.

Nic.

770 Nimium illaec res est magnae dividiae
mihi,
supterfugisse sic mihi hodie Chrysalum.

Chrys.

Salvos sum, iratus est senex. nunc est mihi
adeundi ad hominem tempus.

Scene 5.

Chrys.

(doubtfully) It's some wild, wild
work I've got in hand, and what
I'm afraid of is that I can't carry it
out. (pauses) But now I must make
the old man feel fierce and savage.
For it won't suit this swindle of
mine, to have him peaceful when
he sets eyes on me.

I'll turn him other end up to-day,
handsomely, on my life, I will. I'll
see he's roasted like a roasted pea.
I'll saunter up to the door so that
when he comes out I can hand him
the letter the minute he appears.
(withdraws as door opens)

Scene 6.

ENTER *Nicobulus* FROM HOUSE.

Nic.

Ugh! how it does rankle to
have let Chrysalus get out of
my reach as he has to-day.

Chrys.

(in low tone) Saved! The old
fellow's angry. Now is the

Nic.

Quis loquitur prope?
atque his quidem, opinor, Chrysalust.

Chrys.

Accessero.

Nic.

Bone serve, salve. quid fit? quam mox
navigo
in Ephesum, ut aurum repetam ab
Theotimo domum?
taces? per omnis deos adiuro, ut ni meum
gnatum tam amem atque ei facta cupiam
quae is velit,
779-780 ut tua iam virgis latera lacerentur
probe
ferratusque in pistrino aetatem conteras.
omnia rescivi scelera ex Mnesilocho tua.

Chrys.

Men criminatust? optimest: ego sum
malus,
ego sum sacer, scelestus. specta rem modo;
ego verbum faciam nullum.

Nic.

time to approach him.

Nic.

(*aside*) Who's that speaking
near here? (*seeing*
Chrysalus) Yes, it's actually
Chrysalus, I do believe.

Chrys.

(*aside*) At him now!
(*approaches*)

Nic.

Ah! my good servant, how
goes it? How soon shall I sail
to Ephesus to bring home the
gold from Theotimus? Silent,
eh? (*more savagely*) I swear
to heaven if I didn't love my
son so, if I wasn't anxious to
gratify his wishes, those
flanks of yours would be torn
to ribbons with rods this
instant and you should wear
out your days in fetters in the
mill. I have heard about your
rascality from Mnesilochus
—everything.

Chrys.

(*affecting indignation*) He's
accused me, me? Very fine
indeed! I'm the one that's
bad, I'm the cursed criminal!
(*significantly*) You just keep
your eyes open; that's all I
have to say.

Nic.

Etiam, carnufex,
minutare?

Chrys.

Nosces tu illum actutum
qualis sit.
nunc has tabellas ferre me iussit tibi.
orabat, quod istic esset scriptum ut fieret.

Nic.

Cedo.

Chrys.

Nosce signum.

Nic.

Novi. ubi ipse est?

Chrys.

Nescio.

790 nil iam me oportet scire. oblitus sum
omnia.
scio me esse servom. nescio etiam id quod
scio.
nunc ab trasenna his turdus lumbricum
petit;
pendebit hodie pulcre, ita intendi tenus.

Nic.

Mane dum parumper; iam exeo ad te,
Chrysale.

Chrys.

What? Threatening, you
hangdog?

Chrys.

You'll shortly know what sort
he is. He ordered me to bring
this letter to you now.
Begged you to do what's
written there.

Nic.

Give it here.

Chrys.

(*obeying*) Take notice of the
seal.

Nic.

(*seeing it is intact*) Yes, yes.
Where is my son himself?

Chrys.

(*surlily*) Don't know. The
proper thing for me now is to
know nothing. I've forgotten
everything. I know I'm a
slave. I don't even know
what I do know. (*aside*) Now
our thrush here is after the
worm in my trap; he'll soon
be hung up handsomely, the
way I've set the noose.

Nic.

(*having read letter*) Just wait
a moment; (*goes toward
house*) I'll soon be back with
you, Chrysalus.

[EXIT INTO HOUSE.]

Chrys.

Ut verba mihi dat, ut nescio quam rem
gerat.
servos arcessit intus qui me vinciant.
bene navis agitur, pulcre haec confertur
ratis.
sed conticiscam, nam audio aperiri fores.

(*elated*) Oh, isn't he bluffing
me! Oh, isn't it mysterious
what he's at! He's fetching
servants from inside to tie me
up. A lovely shake-up the
galleon there is getting: the
little bark here is putting up a
fine fight! (*listening*) But not
a word! I hear the door
opening.

IV. 7.

Nic.
Constringe tu illi, Artamo, actutum
manus.

Chrys.
Quid feci?

Nic.
800 Impinge pugnum, si
muttiverit.
quid hae locuntur litterae?

Chrys.
Quid me
rogas?
ut ab illo accepi, ad te obsignatas
attuli.

Nic.
Eho tu,²² loquitatusne es gnato meo
male per sermonem, quia mi id
aurum reddidit,

Scene 7.

ENTER *Nicobulus* BRINGING SLAVE
OVERSEER AND OTHER SLAVES.

Nic.
(*to overseer*) Quick, Artamo,
fasten his hands there!

Chrys.
(*as Artamo obeys*) What have I
done?

Nic.
(*to Artamo*) Plant your fists in his
face, if he breathes a word. (*to*
Chrysalus) What does this letter
say?

Chrys.
What are you asking me for? I
took it from him and brought it to
you just as it was, all sealed.

Nic.
Oho, you! So you have been
giving my son the rough side of
your tongue, because he handed

et te dixisti id aurum ablaturum
tamen
per sycophantiam?

Chrys.

Egone istuc dixi?

Nic.

Ita.

Chrys.

Quis homost qui dicat me dixisse
istuc?

Nic.

Tace,

nullus homo dicit: hae tabellae te
arguont,
quas tu attulisti. em hae te vinciri
iubent.

Chrys.

⁸¹⁰ Aha, Bellerophonem tuos me
fecit filius:
egomet tabellas tetuli ut vincirer.
sine.

Nic.

Propterea hoc facio, ut suadeas gnato
meo
ut pergraecetur tecum, tervenefice.

Chrys.

O stulte, stulte, nescis nunc venire te;
atque in eopse adstas lapide, ut
praeco praedicat.

over that gold to me? Said you'd
take it from me just the same by
some rascally scheme, eh?

Chrys.

I said that, I?

Nic.

Just so.

Chrys.

Who's the man says I said that?

Nic.

Silence! No man says it: this letter
indicts you, the one you brought
yourself. (*showing it*) There! This
orders you to be tied up.

Chrys.

(*resignedly*) Aha! Your son has
made a Bellerophon^J of me: I
myself brought the letter to have
myself tied up. (*dangerously*) Very
well!

Nic.

(*ironically*)) I do this merely to
make you persuade my son to join
you in riotous living, you soulless
villain.

Chrys.

Oh, you poor poor fool, you don't
know you're being sold this
moment; and here you are standing
on the very block with the crier
crying you!

Nic.

Responde: quis me vendit?

Chrys.

Quem di diligunt
adulescens moritur, dum valet sentit
sapit.
hunc si ullus deus amaret, plus annis
decem,
plus iam viginti mortuom esse
oportuit:
820 terrai odium ambulat, iam nil
sapit
nec sentit, tantist quantist fungus
putidus.

Nic.

Tun terrae me odium esse autumas?
abducite hunc
intro atque adstringite ad columnam
fortiter.
numquam auferes hinc aurum.

Chrys.

At qui iam
dabis.

Nic.

Dabo?

Chrys.

Atque orabis me quidem ultro
ut auferam,
cum illum rescisces criminatorem
meum
quanto in periculo et quanta in
perniciie siet.

Nic.

(*mystified*) Answer! Who is selling
me?

Chrys.

(*sneeringly*) He whom the gods
love dies young, while he has his
strength and senses and wits. If
any god loved this fellow,
(*indicating Nicobulus*) it's more
than ten years, more than twenty
years ago, he ought to have died.
He ambles along encumbering the
earth, absolutely witless and
senseless already, worth about as
much as a mushroom—a rotten
one.

Nic.

(*furious*) So I encumber the earth,
do I, according to you? (*to Artamo
and slaves*) March him off inside!
yes, and tie him to a pillar—tight!
(*to Chrysalus*) You shall never take
that gold away from me.

Chrys.

(*mysteriously*) However, you'll
soon give it away.

Nic.

I give it away?

Chrys.

Yes, and beg me, beg me of your
own accord, to take it away, when
you learn about that accuser of
mine and what danger, what
deadly danger, he's in. Then you'll

tum libertatem Chrysalo largibere;
ego adeo numquam accipiam.

Nic.

Dic, scelerum
caput,
830 dic, quo in periculo est meus
Mnesilochus filius?

Chrys.

Sequere hac me, faxo iam scies.

Nic.

Quo gentium?

Chrys.

Tres unos passus.

Nic.

Vel decem.

Chrys.

Agedum tu,
Artamo,
forem hanc pauxillum aperi; placide,
ne crepa;
sat est. accede huc tu. viden
convivium?

Nic.

Video exadvorsum Pistoclerum et
Bacchidem.

Chrys.

Qui sunt in lecto illo altero?

Nic.

be all for liberating Chrysalus; but
not for me, I won't be liberated.

Nic.

Speak, you fount of iniquity, speak
—what danger is my son
Mnesilochus in?

Chrys.

(going toward Bacchis's house)
This way; follow me: I'll soon let
you know.

Nic.

(following) Where on earth are you
taking me?

Chrys.

Three steps merely.

Nic.

Ten, for that matter.

Chrys.

Come on now, you, Artamo; open
this door a tiny bit; easy, don't
make it creak. (*Artamo obeys*)
That will do. (*to Nicobulus*) Step
up here, you. See that jovial party?
(pointing inside)

Nic.

(peeking in) I see Pistoclerus and
Bacchis right opposite.

Chrys.

Who are on that other couch?

Nic.

	Interii miser.	(<i>peeking again, then with a start</i>) Death and damnation!
Chrys.		Chrys.
Novistine hominem?		Do you recognize the gentleman?
Nic.		Nic.
	Novi.	I do.
Chrys.		Chrys.
	Dic sodes	Kindly give me your opinion—
mihi,		good-looking female, eh?
bellan videtur specie mulier?		
Nic.		Nic.
	Admodum.	(<i>angrily</i>) Quite so!
Chrys.		Chrys.
Quid illam, meretricemne esse		Well, do you think she's a harlot?
censes?		
Nic.		Nic.
	Quippini?	Naturally.
Chrys.		Chrys.
Frustra es.		You're mistaken.
Nic.		Nic.
	Quis igitur obsecrost?	For heaven's sake, who is she, then?
Chrys.		Chrys.
	840	(<i>again mysterious</i>) You'll soon
Inveneris.		discover. But you'll never get the
ex me quidem hodie numquam fies		information from me to-day.
certior.		

IV. 8.

Cleom.

Scene 8.

ENTER *Cleomachus*, APPARENTLY
NOT SEEING GROUP AT DOORWAY.

Cleom.

Meamne hic Mnesilochus, Nicobuli
filius,
per vim ut retineat mulierem? quae haec
factiost?

Nic.

Quis illest?

Chrys.

Per tempus hic venit miles
mihi.

Cleom.

Non me arbitratur militem, sed
mulierem,
qui me meosque non queam defendere.
nam neque Bellona mi umquam neque
Mars creduat,
ni illum exanimalem faxo, si convenero,
nive exheredem fecero vitae suae.

Nic.

850 Chrysale, quis ille est qui minitatur
filio?

Chrys.

Vir hic est illius mulieris quacum
accubat.

Nic.

Quid, vir?

Chrys.

Vir, inquam.

Nic.

(blustering) Mnesilochus,
Nicobulus's son, keep her here
by force—my woman? What
sort of conduct is this?

Nic.

Who is that?

Chrys.

(aside) The Captain has come
just in the nick of time for me.
*(draws Nicobulus farther
away)*

Cleom.

He takes me for a woman, not a
soldier, a woman unable to
defend myself and mine! Now
never may Bellona^K and Mars
trust me more, unless I
extinguish his vital spark, once
I come upon him, and unless I
disinherit him of his existence!

Nic.

(anxiously) Chrysalus! who's
that threatening my son?

Chrys.

(coolly) He is the husband of
that woman beside your son on
the couch.

Nic.

(in terror) What? The husband?

Chrys.

That is what I say, the husband.

Nic.

Nuptanest illa,
 obsecro?
Chrys.
 Scies haud multo post.
Nic.
 Oppido interii miser.

Chrys.
 Quid nunc? scelestus tibi videtur
 Chrysalus?
 age nunc vincito me, auscultato filio.
 dixin tibi ego illum inventurum te qualis
 sit?
Nic.
 Quid nunc ego faciam?
Chrys.
 Iube sis me exsolvi
 cito;
 nam ni ego exsolvor, iam manifesto
 hominem opprimet.
Cleom.
 Nihil est lucri quod me hodie facere
 mavelim,
 860 quam illum cubantem cum illa
 opprimere, ambo ut necem.

Chrys.
 Audin quae loquitur? quin tu me exsolvi
 iubes?

Nic.
 Exsolvite istum. perii, pertimui miser.

For heaven's sake, is she
 married?
Chrys.
 You'll see a little later.
Nic.
 Oh! This is perfectly
 agonizing!
Chrys.
 What now? Do you think
 Chrysalus is the criminal? Go
 ahead now, tie me up and listen
 to your son. Didn't I tell you
 you'd find out what sort he is?
Nic.
 What shall I do now?
Chrys.
 Kindly have me loosed, and
 quickly; for if I'm not loosed,
 he'll soon be surprising our
 gentleman red-handed.
Cleom.
 There is no amount of money I
 had rather make to-day than
 surprise him with her in his
 arms, so that I may slay them
 both!
Chrys.
 You hear what he's saying?
 Why don't you have me
 loosed?
Nic.
 (to slaves) Loose him. (they
 obey) This is awful! Dear, dear,

Cleom.

Tum illam, quae corpus publicat volgo
suom,
faxo se haud dicat nactam quem
derideat.

Chrys.

Pacisci cum illo paulula pecunia
potes.

Nic.

Pacisce ergo, obsecro, quid tibi
lubet,
dum ne manifesto hominem opprimat
neve enicet.

Cleom.

Nunc nisi ducenti Philippi redduntur
mihi,
iam illorum ego animam amborum
exsorbebo oppido.

Nic.

870 Em illuc pacisce, si potes; perge
obsecro,
pacisce quid vis.

Chrys.

Ibo et faciam sedulo.
quid clamas?

Cleom.

Ubi erus tuos est?

Chrys.

I'm frightened through and
through!

Cleom.

Then that woman who makes a
common prostitute of herself—
I warrant she'll not say she has
lit on a man she can laugh to
scorn!

Chrys.

You can buy him off for a bit of
cash.

Nic.

(*beside himself*) Buy him off,
then, for heaven's sake—
anything you like—if only he
doesn't surprise the lad red-
handed and slay him!

Cleom.

Unless two hundred pounds are
given me at once, I'll drain
them dry, the both of them, of
the breath of life this moment.

Nic.

There! Buy him off for that, if
you can. At him, for heaven's
sake: buy him off at any price.

Chrys.

I'll go and do my best,
(*approaching Cleomachus*)
What are you bawling at?

Cleom.

Where is your master?

Chrys.

Nusquam.
nescio
vis tibi ducentos nummos iam promittier,
ut ne clamorem hie facias neu
convicium?

Cleom.
Nihil est quod malim.

Chrys.
Atque ut tibi mala multa
ingeram?

Cleom.
Tuo arbitrato.

Nic.
Ut subblanditur carnufex.

Chrys.
Pater hic Mnesilochi est; sequere, is
promittet tibi.
tu aurum rogato; ceterum verbum sat est.

Nic.
Quid fit?

Chrys.
Ducentis Philippis rem pepigi.

Nic.

(loudly) Nowhere. I don't
know. (*gets him farther from
Nicobulus*) Do you want to
have two hundred pounds
promised you instantly, on
condition you don't come
bawling or bellowing here?

Cleom.
(calming down) Nothing I
should like better.

Chrys.
(in low tone) Yes, and on
condition you take plenty of
hard words from me?

Cleom.
At your own discretion.

Nic.
(hearing only last words) How
the hangdog is wheedling him!

Chrys.
Here is (*pointing*)
Mnesilochus's father; come on;
he'll promise it to you. You ask
for the money; (*meaningly*) as
for the rest, a word will suffice.
(*Cleomachus nods his
understanding: they join
Nicobulus*)

Nic.
Well? Well?

Chrys.
I've settled for two hundred
pounds.

Nic.

salus
880 mea, servavisti me. quam mox dico
"dabo"?

Chrys.
Roga hunc tu, tu promitte huic.

Nic.
Promitto, roga.

Cleom.
Ducentos nummos aureos Philippos
probos
dabin?

Chrys.
"Dabuntur" inque. responde.

Nic.
Dabo.

Chrys.
Quid nunc, impure? numquid debetur
tibi?
quid illi molestus? quid illum morte
territus?
et ego te et ille mactamus infortunio.
si tibi est machaera, at nobis veruinast
domi:
qua quidem te faciam, si tu me
inritaveris,
confossiores soricina nenia.
890 iam dudum hercle equidem sentio,
suspicio

Ah, (ecstatic) Ah, my salvation!
you've saved me! How long
before I say "I'll pay"?

Chrys.
(to *Cleomachus*) You make
your demand of him: (to
Nicobulus) you promise him.

Nic.
(eagerly) I promise: make your
demand.

Cleom.
Will you pay me two hundred
good honest gold sovereigns?

Chrys.
(to *Nicobulus*) "I will": say
that. Answer him.

Nic.
I will.

Chrys.
(to *Cleomachus*) What now,
you beast? Is anything owed
you? What are you annoying
that gentleman for? What are
you scaring him with
murderous threats for? We'll
give you a horrible time of it,
he and I together. You may
have a sword, but we've got a
little spit at home: if you get
me roused, I'll up with it and
stick you fuller of holes than a
squealing shrewmouse. Good

quae te sollicitet: eum esse cum illa muliere.

Cleom.

Immo est quoque.

Chrys.

Ita me Iuppiter Iuno Ceres
Minerva²³ Latona Spes Opis Virtus
Venus
Castor Polluces Mars Mercurius
Hercules
Summanus Sol Saturnus dique omnes
ament,
ut ille cum illa neque cubat neque
ambulat
neque osculatur neque illud quod dici
solet.

Nic.

Ut iurat! servat me ille suis periuriis.

Cleom.

Ubi nunc Mnesilochus ergost?

Chrys.

Rus misit pater,
900 illa autem in arcem abiit aedem
visere
Minervae. nunc apertast. i, vise estne ibi.

Cleom.

Lord! Why, I saw it all long ago—how you're suffering from the suspicion that he's with the lady there.

Cleom.

Suspicion? He is there, too.

Chrys.

(with unction) So help me Jupiter, Juno, Ceres, Minerva, Latona, Spes, Ops, Virtus, Venus, Castor, Pollux, Mars, Mercury, Hercules, Summanus, Sol, Saturn, and all the gods, he is neither lying with her, nor walking with her, nor kissing her, nor anything else he has the name of doing.

Nic.

(aside) What an oath! The man is saving me by perjuring himself.

Cleom.

Where is Mnesilochus at present, then?

Chrys.

His father has sent him out to the farm. As for the lady, she has gone to the Acropolis to visit Minerva's temple. It's open now. Go and see if she isn't there.

Cleom.

Abeo ad forum igitur.

Chrys.

Vel hercle in malam
crucem.

Cleom.

Hodie exigam aurum hoc?

Chrys.

Exige, ac suspende te:
ne supplicare hunc censeas tibi, nihili
homo,
ille est amotus. sine me—per te, ere,
opsecro
deos immortales—ire huc intro ad
filium.

Nic.

Quid eo intro ibis?

Chrys.

Ut eum dictis plurumis
castigem, cum haec sic facta ad hunc
faciat modum.

Nic.

Immo oro ut facias, Chrysale, et ted
opsecro,
cave parsis in eum dicere.

Chrys.

910 Etiam me
mones?
satin est si plura ex me audiet hodie
mala,

In that case, I'll be off to the
forum.

Chrys.

Or to blazes, if you like, by
gad!

Cleom.

Shall I get the money out of
him to-day?

Chrys.

Get it, and be hanged to you!
You needn't think he will sue
for favours from you, you
riffraff.

[EXIT *Cleomachus*.]

He's sent packing. (*fervently*) In
the name of heaven, sir, do let
me go in here and see your son,
I beseech you.

Nic.

Go in this house? Why?

Chrys.

So that I may reprove him
roundly for acting in such a
way as this.

Nic.

Let you? I beg you to,
Chrysalus, and I beseech you,
don't spare him in the slightest!

Chrys.

(*virtuously indignant*) D'ye
warn me of that, me? Is it
enough, if he hears more hard
words from me this day than
ever Clinia^L heard from

quam audivit umquam Clinia ex
Demetrio?

Nic.

Lippi illic oculi servos est simillimus:
si non est, nolis esse neque desideres;
si est, abstinere quin attingas non queas.
nam ni illic hodie forte fortuna his foret,
miles Mnesilochum cum uxore
opprimeret sua
atque obtruncaret moechum
manifestarium.

nunc quasi decentis Philippis emi filium,
920 quos dare promisi militi: quos non
dabo
temere etiam prius quam filium
convenero.
numquam edepol quicquam temere
credam Chrysalo;
verum lubet etiam ni has perlegere
denuo:
aequomst tabellis consignatis credere.

Demetrius^L?

[EXIT *Chrysalus* INTO HOUSE OF
Bacchis.]

Nic.

(ruefully) That servant of mine
is very much like a sore eye: if
you haven't got one, you don't
want one and don't miss it; if
you have, you can't keep your
hands off it. Why, if he hadn't
happened by good luck to be
here to- day, the Captain would
have surprised Mnesilochus
with his wife and cut him to
pieces for an adulterer caught
in the act.

As it is, I have bought my son,
so to speak, for the two
hundred pounds I promised to
pay the Captain—two hundred
I won't be rash enough to pay
him yet, before I have met the
boy. I'll put no rash confidence
in Chrysalus, never, by heaven!
But I've a mind to read this
over *(looking at letter)* once
more still: a man ought to have
confidence in a sealed letter.

[EXIT INTO HOUSE.]

IV. 9.

Chrys.

Atridae duo frates eluent fecisse facinus
maximum,
quom Priami patriam Pergamum divina
moenitum manu
armis, equis, exercitu atque eximiis
bellatoribus
mille cum numero navium decumo anno post
subegerunt.

non pedibus termento fuit praeut ego erum
expugnabo meum
sine classe sineque exercitu et tanto numero
militum.²⁴ 930

(932) nunc prius quam huc senex venit, libet
lamentari dum exeat.

o Troia, o patria, o Pergamum, o Priame
periisti senex,
qui misere male mulcabere quadringentis
Philippis aureis.
nam ego has tabellas obsignatas consignatas
quas fero
non sunt tabellae, sed equos quem misere
Achivi ligneum.²⁵ (936)

941 tum quae his sunt scriptae litterae, hoc in
equo insunt milites
armati atque animati probe. ita res successit
mi usque adhuc.
atque hic equos non in arcem, verum in
arcem faciet impetum;
exitium excidium exlecebra fiet hic equos
hodie auro senis.

nostro seni huic stolido, ei profecto nomen
facio ego Ilio;
miles Menelaust, ego Agamemno, idem
Vlixes Lartius,

Scene 9.

(Fifteen minutes have elapsed.)

ENTER *Chrysalus* FROM *Bacchis's* HOUSE.

Chrys.

(*bumptiously*) The two sons of Atreus
have the name of having done a mighty
deed when Priam's paternal city,
Pergamum, "fortified by hand divine,"
was laid low by 'em after ten years, and
they with weapons, horses, and army
and warriors of renown and a thousand
ships to help 'em. That wasn't enough to
raise a blister on their feet, compared
with the way I'll take my master by
storm, without a fleet and without an
army and all that host of soldiers. Now
before the old chap appears, I feel like
raising a dirge for him till he comes out.

(wailing) O Troy, O paternal city, O
Pergamum! O ancient Priam, thy day is
past! Thou shalt be badly, badly beaten
—out of four hundred golden
sovereigns. Ah yes, these tablets here,
(*showing them*) sealed and signed,
which I bear, are no tablets, but a horse
sent by the Greeks—a wooden horse.²⁵

Moreover, the words herein inscribed
are the soldiers within this horse,
soldiers armed to the teeth and full of
fight. Thus has my scheme progressed
up till now. Aye, and this horse will
proceed to assail not a stronghold, but a
strongbox. The wreck, ruin, and rape of
the old man's gold will this horse prove
to-day.

This silly old man of ours—I dub him
Ilium, I certainly do. The Captain is
Menelaus, I Agamemnon: I am likewise
Laertian Ulysses: Mnesilochus is
Alexander,^M who will be the destruction

Mnesilochust Alexander, qui erit exitio rei
patriae suae;
is Helenam avexit, cuia causa nunc facio
obsidium Ilio.

nam illi itidem Vlixem audiui, ut ego sum,
fuisse et audacem et malum:
950 in dolis ego pressus sum, ille mendicans
paene inventus interiit,
dum ibi exquirat fata Iliorum; adsimiliter
mi hodie optigit.
vinctus sum. sed dolis me exemi: item
se ille servavit dolis.

Ilio tria fuisse audiui fata quae illi forent
exitio:
signum ex arce si periisset; alterum etiamst
Troili mors;
tertium, cum portae Phrygiae limen superum
scinderetur:
paria item tria eis tribus sunt fata nostro huic
Ilio.

nam dudum primo ut dixeram nostro seni
mendacium
et de hospite et de auro et de lembo, ibi
signum ex arce iam abstuli.
iam duo restabant fata tunc, nec magis id
ceperam oppidum.
960 post ubi tabellas ad senem detuli, ibi
occidi Troilum,
cum censuit Mnesilochum cum uxore esse
dudum militis.²⁶ (961)

(966) post cum magnifico milite, urbes verbis
qui mermus capit,
conflixit atque hominem reppuli; dein
pugnam conserui seni:
eum ego adeo uno mendacio devici, uno ictu
extempulo
cepi spolia. is nunc ducentos nummos
Philippos militi,
970 quos dare se promisit, dabit,

of his native city; he is the one that
carried off Helen, on account of whom I
now besiege Ilium.

At that Ilium Ulysses, so they say, was a
bold, bad man, just as I am now. I was
caught in my wiles; he was found
begging and almost perished, while he
was seeking to learn there the destinies
of the Ilians. What befell me to-day was
quite similar. I was bound, but released
myself by wiles: by wiles he likewise
saved himself.

In the case of that Ilium, so they say,
there were three fateful events which
would prove her downfall: if the image^N
disappeared from the citadel; still a
second, the death of Troilus^O; the third,
when the upper lintel of the Phrygian
gate should be torn away. Counterparts
of these three are three fateful events,
too, in the case of this Ilium of ours.

For a little while ago when I first told
our old man that lie about his friend and
the gold and the galley, I there and then
stole the image from the citadel. Even
then two fateful events were yet to
come, and the town was still untaken.
Later, on carrying the letter to the old
man, I then slew my Troilus, when he
thought Mnesilochus a short time ago
was with the Captain's wife.²⁶

Still later I closed with the noble Captain
—who captures cities with no weapon
save his mighty tongue—and hurled him
back. Next I joined battle with the old
man: aye, and him I struck down with a
single lie; a single blow, and the spoils
were mine. He now will give the
Captain the two hundred pounds he
promised him. And now there is need of
another two hundred still, to be

(972) nunc alteris etiam ducentis usus est, qui
dispensentur
Ilio capto, ut sit mulsum qui triumphant
milites.²⁷

(978) sed Priamum adstantem eccum ante
portam video. adibo atque adloquar.

Nic.

Quoianam vox prope me sonat?

Chrys.

O Nicobule.

Nic.

Quid fit?
quid quod te misi, ecquid egisti?

Chrys.

Rogas? congregere.

Nic.

980 Gradior.

Chrys.

Optumus sum orator. ad lacrimas coegi
hominem castigando
maleque dictis, quae quidem quivi
comminisci.

Nic.

Quid ait?

Chrys.

Verbum
nullum fecit: lacrumans tacitus auscultabat
quae ego loquebar;
tacitus conscripsit tabellas, obsignatas
mi has dedit.
tibi me iussit dare, sed metuo, ne idem
cantent quod priores.
nosce signum. estne eius?

Nic.

disbursed, on Ilium's capture, that the
soldiery may have wine and honey to
celebrate their victory.²⁷

[ENTER *Nicobulus* FROM HIS HOUSE.] Aha,
though! I see Priam standing before the
gate. I'll up and address him.

Nic.

(*looking round*) Whose voice is that I
hear near me?

Chrys.

(*approaching*) Oh, sir!

Nic.

(*eagerly*) How goes it? What about your
mission—have you accomplished
anything?

Chrys.

Do you ask that? Come here, close.

Nic.

(*doing so*) I am.

Chrys.

(*enthusiastic*) I'm the orator for you! I
fairly brought our man to tears, by
saying all the harsh, bitter things I could
think of.

Nic.

What did he say?

Chrys.

Not a word; just wept in silence and paid
attention to what I was telling him. Still
silent, he wrote a letter, sealed it, and
gave it to me. He ordered me to give it
to you. But I'm afraid it sings the same
song as the other one (*hands tablets to
Nicobulus*) Take notice of the seal. Is it
his?

Nic.

Novi. libet
 perlegere has.
Chrys.
 Perlege.
 nunc superum limen scinditur, nunc adest
 exitium Ilio,
 turbat equos lepide ligneus.
Nic.
 Chrysale, ades, dum ego
 has perlego.
Chrys.
 Quid me tibi adesse opus est?
Nic.
 Volo,²⁸
 ut scias quae his scripta sient.
Chrys.
 Nil moror neque scire volo.
Nic.
 Tamen ades.
Chrys.
 Quid opust?
Nic.
 Taceas:
 quod iubeo id facias.
Chrys.
 990A Adero.
Nic.
 Euge litteras minutas.
Chrys.
 Qui quidem videat
 parum;
 verum, qui satis videat, grandes satis sunt.
Nic.
 990 Animum
 advortito igitur.
Chrys.

(examining seal) Yes, yes; I'm anxious to
 read this over.
Chrys.
 Do. *(aside)* Now the upper lintel is being
 torn away; now Ilium's fall is nigh. The
 wooden horse is making a beautiful
 mess of things.
Nic.
 Chrysalus, stay here while I read this
 over.
Chrys.
 What's the use of my staying with you?
Nic.
 I wish it, so that you may know what is
 written here.
Chrys.
 Not for me—I don't wish to know.
Nic.
 Never mind, stay here.
Chrys.
 What's the use?
Nic.
(angry) Silence! do what I tell you.
Chrys.
(apparently reluctant) Stay I will.
Nic.
(opening tablets) Well, well! What tiny
 letters.
Chrys.
(innocently) Yes, for a man with poor
 eyes; they're big enough, if your sight is
 good enough, though.
Nic.
 Well then, pay attention.
Chrys.

Nolo inquam.

Nic.

At volo inquam.

Chrys.

Quid opust?

Nic.

At enim id quod te iubeo facias.

Chrys.

Iustumst ut tuos tibi servos tuo arbitrato
serviat.

Nic.

Hoc age sis nunciam.

Chrys.

Ubi lubet, recita: aurium
operam tibi dico.

Nic.

Cerae quidem haud parsit neque stilo;
sed quidquid est, pellegere certumst.
"Pater, ducentos Philippos quaeso Chrysalo
da, si esse salvom vis me aut vitalem tibi."
malum quidem hercle magnum.

Chrys.

Tibi dico.

Nic.

Quid est?

Chrys.

Non prius salutem scripsit?

Nic.

1000 Nusquam sentio.

Chrys.

Non dabis, si sapies; verum si das maxume,
ne ille alium gerulum quaerat, si sapiet, sibi:
nam ego non laturus sum, si iubeas maxume.

I don't want to, I tell you.

Nic.

But I want you to, I tell you.

Chrys.

What's the use?

Nic.

See here now, you do what I order.

Chrys.

(after reflection, impartially) It's right
for your own servant to serve you as you
see fit, sir.

Nic.

Now kindly attend to this at once.

Chrys.

Read when you like, sir: I promise you
my ears.

Nic.

(looking tablets over with a sigh) He
hasn't been sparing of wax or stylus, it
seems. But whatever it is, I'm resolved
to read it through, (reading) "Father, do
for mercy's sake give Chrysalus two
hundred pounds, if you wish to have
your son safe, or alive." Give him a
good sound thrashing, by heaven!

Chrys.

I say.

Nic.

Well?

Chrys.

Didn't he write a word of greeting first?

Nic.

(looking) Not a sign of it.

Chrys.

(indignant) You won't do it, if you're
wise; but no matter how much you do do
it, let him look up another porter, if he's
wise: for I won't carry it, no matter how

sat sic suspectus sum, cum careo noxia.

Nic.

Ausculda porro, dum hoc quod scriptumst
perlego.

Chrys.

Inde a principio iam inpu^dens epistula est.

Nic.

"Pudet prodire me ad te in conspectum,
pater:

tantum flagitium te scire audi^vi meum,
quod cum peregrini cubui uxore militis."

1010 pol haud derides; nam ducentis aureis
Philippis redemi vitam ex flagitio tuam.

Chrys.

Nihil est illorum quin ego illi dixerim.

Nic.

"Stulte fecisse fateor, sed q^aeso, pater,
ne me, in stultitia si deliqui, deseras.
ego animo cupido atque oculis indomitis fui;
persuasumst facere quoui^s me nunc facti
pudet."

prius te cavis^se ergo quam pudere aequom
fuit.

Chrys.

Eadem istaec verba dudum illi dixi omnia.

Nic.

"Quaeso ut sat habeas id, pater, quod
Chrysalus

1020 me obiurⁱgavit plurumis verbis malis,
et me meliorem fecit praeceptis suis,
ut te ei habere gratiam aequom sit bonam."

Chrys.

much you order me. I am suspected
enough as it is, when I'm perfectly
blameless.

Nic.

Listen, further, while I read through
what is written here.

Chrys.

That's an impudent letter, impudent from
the very beginning!

Nic.

(*continuing*) "I'm ashamed to come into
your sight, father. I have heard that you
know of my wicked intrigue with the
foreign Captain's wife." Gad! That is no
joke! Two hundred golden sovereigns it
cost me to save your life after that piece
of wickedness!

Chrys.

There's nothing of that I didn't say to
him, sir.

Nic.

"I admit that I acted foolishly. But for
mercy's sake, father, don't desert me, if I
have done wrong in my folly. Wanton
desires possessed me, and I couldn't
control my eyes, I was induced to do
what I am now ashamed of doing." Well,
prudence then, rather than shame now,
would have been the proper thing for
you!

Chrys.

Just the very same words I said to him a
while ago, sir.

Nic.

"Do, please, consider it enough, father,
that Chrysalus has scolded me very very
harshly and has made me a better man
by his precepts, so that you ought to be
deeply grateful to him."

Chrys.

Estne istuc istic scriptum?

Nic.

Em specta, tum scies.

Chrys.

Ut qui deliquit supplex est ultro omnibus.

Nic.

"Nunc si me fas est obsecrare abs te, pater,
da mihi ducentos nummos Philippos, te
obsecro."

Chrys.

Ne unum quidem hercle, si sapis.

Nic.

Sine perlegam.

"ego ius iurandum verbis conceptis dedi,
datum id me hodie mulieri ante vesperum,
1030 prius quam a me abiret. nunc, pater, ne
perierem
cura atque abduce me hinc ab hac quantum
potest,
quam propter tantum damni feci et flagiti.
cave tibi ducenti nummi dividiæ fiant;
sescenta tanta reddam, si vivo, tibi.
vale atque haec cura." quid nunc censes,
Chrysale?

Chrys.

Nihil ego tibi hodie consili quicquam dabo,
neque ego haud committam ut, si quid
peccatum siet,
fecisse dicas de mea sententia.
verum, ut ego opinor, si ego in istoc sim
loco,
1040 dem potius aurum quam illum corrumpi
sinam.
duae condiciones sunt: utram tu accipias
vide:
vel ut aurum perdas vel ut amator perieret.

Is that written there?

Nic.

(*showing him the place*) There! look,
then you'll know.

Chrys.

(*piously*) How the wrongdoer does bend
the knee to every one, of his own
accord!

Nic.

"Now if I have a moral right to beseech
you, father, I do beseech you to give me
two hundred pounds."

Chrys.

Not even one, by heaven, if you're wise!

Nic.

Let me read it through. "I took an oath in
express terms to give the woman this
sum before evening comes and she
leaves me. Now, father, do see to it that I
don't forswear myself, and do rescue me
just as soon as you can from this
creature on account of whom I have
been so wasteful and wicked. See you
don't let a matter of two hundred pounds
vex you; I will pay it back to you a
thousand times over, if I live. Good-bye
and do look out for this." What do you
recommend now, Chrysalus?

Chrys.

(*vehemently*) Never a bit of advice will I
give you this day! I'll take no chance of
your saying, if anything goes wrong,
that you did it at my suggestion.

However, in my opinion, if I was in your
place, I should rather give up the money
than let him be debauched. There are
two alternatives: see for yourself which
to choose: you must either lose the
money, or let our lover be forsworn. I do
not order you, or forbid you, or urge
you, either, not I.

ego neque te iubeo neque veto, neque
suadeo.

Nic.

Miseret me illius.

Chrys.

Tuos est, non mirum facis.
si plus perdundum sit, periisse suavius,
quam illud flagitium volgo dispalescere.

Nic.

Ne ille edepol Ephesi multo mavellem foret,
dum salvos esset, quam revenisset domum.
quid ego istic? quod perdundumst properem
perdere.
1050 binos ducentos Philippos iam intus
ecferam.
et militi quos dudum promisi miser
et istos. mane istic, iam exeo ad te, Chrysale.

Chrys.

Fit vasta Troia, scindunt proceres Pergamum.
scivi ego iam dudum fore me exitio
Pergamo.
edepol qui me esse dicat cruciatu malo
dignum, ne ego cum illo pignus haud ausim
dare;
tantas turbellas facio. sed crepuit foris:
ecfertur praeda ex Troia. taceam nunciam.

Nic.

Cape hoc tibi aurum, Chrysale. i, fer filio.
1060 ego ad forum autem hinc ibo, ut solvam
militi.

Chrys.

Nic.

(earnestly) I'm sorry for the lad.

Chrys.

Nothing strange in that, your own flesh
and blood as he is. (*casually*) If more
must be lost, that's pleasanter than
having such a piece of wickedness come
to be the common talk.

Nic.

Good Lord! I should certainly much
rather have him at Ephesus, provided he
was safe, than back home. (*pauses*)
What am I to do in the matter? (*another
pause, then irritably*) Let me hurry up
and lose what has to be lost. I'll go in
and get four hundred pounds at once—
the two hundred I promised the Captain
a while ago, poor wretch that I am, and
this last. Wait where you are: I'll be with
you again in a moment, Chrysalus.
[EXIT INTO HOUSE.]

Chrys.

(*hilarious*). Troy is being made a waste;
the chieftains are laying Pergamum low!
I knew long ago I'd be the downfall of
Pergamum! By gad, the man that says I
deserve to be punished damnably—I
surely wouldn't dare bet him I don't. Oh,
the lovely rumpus I'm raising! (*listening*)
But the door creaked: the booty is being
carried out from Troy. Time for me to
keep still!

RE-ENTER *Nicobulus* WITH TWO BAGS OF
GOLD.

Nic.

Take this money, Chrysalus: go, carry it
to my son. As for me, I am going to the
forum to settle with the Captain.

Chrys.

Non equidem accipiam. proin tu quaeras qui
ferat.
nolo ego mihi credi.

Nic.

Cape vero, odiose facis.

Chrys.

Non equidem capiam.

Nic.

At quaeso.

Chrys.

Dico ut res se habet.

Nic.

Morare.

Chrys.

Nolo, inquam, aurum concredi mihi,
vel da aliquem qui servet me.

Nic.

Ohe, odiose facis.

Chrys.

Cedo, si necesse est.

Nic.

Cura hoc. iam ego huc
revenero.

Chrys.

Curatum est—esse te senem miserrimum.
hoc est incepta efficere pulcre: bellule
mi evenit, ut ovans praeda onustus
incederem;
1070 salute nostra atque urbe capta per dolum
domum reduco integrum omnem exercitum.

sed, spectatores, vos nunc ne miremini

(drawing back) No indeed, I won't take
it. So you can look further for some one
to carry it. I don't want it trusted to me.

Nic.

Come, come, now, take it: you annoy
me.

Chrys.

Indeed I won't take it.

Nic.

But I beg you.

Chrys.

(firmly) I tell you just how I stand.

Nic.

(impatiently) You're delaying me.

Chrys.

I don't want money put in my charge, I
say. (pause) At least, appoint some one
to watch me.

Nic.

Pshaw! You annoy me.

Chrys.

(reluctant) Give it here, if I must.

Nic.

(handing him bag of gold) Look out for
this. I shall be back here soon

[EXIT TOWARD FORUM.]

Chrys.

(as Nicobulus disappears) It has been
looked out for—your being the poorest
old wretch alive. Here's the way to carry
out your attempts in style! Ah, this is
beautiful luck—to be marching along in
jubilation, laden with booty. Safe
myself, the city captured by guile. I am
leading my whole army back home
intact.

But, spectators, don't be surprised now
that I don't have a triumph: they're too

quod non triumpho: pervolgatum est, nil
moror;
verum tamen accipientur inulso milites.
nunc hanc praedam omnem iam ad
quaestorem deferam.

IV. 10.

Phil.

Quam magis in pectore meo foveo quas
meus filius turbas turbet,
quam se ad vitam et quos ad mores
praecipitem inscitus capessat,
magis curae est magisque adformido, ne is
pereat neu corrumpatur.
scio, fui ego illa aetate et feci illa
omnia, sed more modesto;
neque placitant mores quibus video volgo in
gnatos esse parentes:²⁹ 1080

(1082) ego dare me meo gnato institui, ut
animo obsequium sumere possit;
aequom esse puto, sed nimis nolo
desidiaei dare ludum.
nunc Mnesilochum, quod
mandavi,
viso ecquid eum ad virtutem aut
ad
frugem opera sua compulerit, sic
ut eum, si convenit, scio fecisse:
cost ingenio natus.

ACTVS V

Nic.

Quicumque ubi ubi sunt, qui fuerunt quique
futuri sunt posthac

common: none of them for me. But the
soldiers shall be entertained with wine
and honey just the same. (*turning toward
Bacchis's door*) Now I'll convey all this
booty to the quartermaster-general at
once.

[EXIT INTO HOUSE.]

Scene 10.

(*Half an hour has elapsed*)

ENTER *Philoxenus*.

Phil.

The more I ponder over the capers my
son is cutting, and the life and habits the
thoughtless lad is plunging headlong into,
the more worried, and the more fearful I
get at the danger of his becoming an
irreclaimable rake. I know, I was young
once myself, and did all those things, but
I showed some self-restraint. The attitude
I see in the general run of parents toward
their sons doesn't suit me.

I've made a practice of being liberal to
my son, so that he may follow his
inclinations; I think it's the fair way; at
the same time, I don't want to give too
much play to his dawdling. Now I'm
going to see Mnesilochus about that
commission of mine, and find out if he
has driven the boy over to the path of
virtue and sobriety by his efforts—as I
know he has, if he found occasion: that is
his natural disposition. (*goes toward
Bacchis's door*)

ACT V

ENTER *Nicobulus* IN A RAGE, WITHOUT
SEEING *Philoxenus*.

Nic.

Of all the silly, stupid, fatuous, fungus-
grown, doddering, drivelling dolts

stulti, stolidi, fatui, fungi, bardi, blenni,
buccones,

solus ego omnis longe antideo
stultitia et moribus indoctis.
perii, pudet: hocine me aetatis
1090 ludos bis factum esse indigne?
magis quam id reputo, tam magis
uror
quae meus filius turbavit.
perditus sum atque eradicatus
sum, omnibus exemplis excrucior.
omnia me mala consecantur,
omnibus exitiis interii.

Chrysalus med hodie laceravit,
Chrysalus me miserum spoliavit:
is me scelus auro usque attondit
dolus doctis indoctum, ut
lubitumst.

ita miles memorat meretricem
esse
eam quam ille uxorem esse aiebat,
omniaque ut quidque actum est
memoravit,
eam sibi hunc annum
conductam,
relicuom id auri factum quod ego
ei
stultissimus homo promissem:
hoc,
hoc est quo cor peracescit:

hoc est demum quod percrucior,
(1099) me hoc aetatis ludificari,³⁰
cano capite atque alba barba
1101 miserum me auro esse
emunctum.

perii, hoc servom meum non nauci facere
esse ausum! atque ego, si alibi
plus perdiderim. minus aegre habeam
minusque id mihi damno ducam.

Phil.

anywhere, past or future, I alone am far
and away ahead of the whole lot of 'em in
silliness and absurd behaviour!

Damnation! I'm ashamed! The idea of my
being made a fool of twice at my time of
life in this outrageous fashion!

The more I think it over, the hotter I get
at my son's devilry! I'm ruined,
eradicated, tortured every way! Every
kind of trouble is upon me: I've died
every kind of death!

I've been mangled to-day by Chrysalus,
stripped, poor wretch, by Chrysalus! He
has sheared me clean of my gold, the
villain, sheared me to suit his taste by his
wily arts, artless innocent that I am!

The Captain tells me that the woman that
rascal said was his wife is a courtesan,
and he's given me the full history of the
case—how he'd hired her for this year,
how the money I'd promised him, like an
utter idiot, was the sum due him for the
months yet to run. This, this, is what galls
me;

this is the crowning torment—for me to
be gulled at my time of life, for me, poor
fool, with my hoary hairs and white beard
to be cleaned out of my gold! Oh,
damnation! My own servant dares to hold
me cheaper than dirt in this fashion! Yes,
yes, if I lost more money some other way,
I should mind it less and regard the loss
as less.

Phil.

Certo hic prope me mihi nescio quis loqui
visust; sed quem video?
hic quidemst pater Mnesilochi.

Nic.

Euge, socium aerumnae et mei mali video.
Philoxene, salve.

Phil.

Et tu. unde agis?

Nic.

Unde homo
miser atque infortunatus.

Phil.

At pol ego ibi sum, esse ubi miserum
hominem decet atque infortunatum.

Nic.

Igitur pari fortuna, aetate ut sumus, utimur.

Phil.

Sic est. sed
tu,
quid tibist?

Nic.

Pol mihi par, idem est quod
tibi.

Phil.

1110 Numquid nam ad filium haec aegritudo
attinet?

Nic.

Admodum.

Phil.

Idem mihi morbus in pectorest.

Nic.

At mihi Chrysalus optumus homo
perdidit filium, me atque rem omnem
meam.

Phil.

It surely seemed as if some one was
speaking here near me. (*sees Nicobulus*)
But who's this I see? Mnesilochus's
father, upon my word! (*approaches*)

Nic.

(*grimly*) Splendid! I see my partner in toil
and woe. Good day to you, Philoxenus.

Phil.

And to you. Where are you coming from?

Nic.

Where a wretched, unlucky man should
come from.

Phil.

Gad! but I'm on the very spot where a
wretched, unlucky man should be.

Nic.

Then we're alike in luck as we are in
years.

Phil.

So it seems. But you—what is your
trouble?

Nic.

Good Lord! The same as yours.

Phil.

This dolefulness of yours has something
to do with your son, eh?

Nic.

(*morosely*) Rather!

Phil.

The same ailment is worrying me.

Nic.

Well, but Chrysalus—that pattern of
excellence—has ruined my boy and me
and all that's mine!

Phil.

Quid tibi ex filio nam, obsecro, aegrest?

Nic.

Scies:

id, perit cum tuo: ambo aequae amicas
habent.

Phil.

Qui scis?

Nic.

Vidi.

Phil.

Ei mihi, disperii.

Nic.

Quid dubitamus pultare atque hue evocare
ambos foras?

Phil.

Haud moror.

Nic.

Heus Bacchis, iube sic actutum
aperiri fores,
nisi mavoltis fores et postes comminui
securibus.

V. 2.

Bacch.

1120 Quis sonitu ac tumultu tanto nominat
me atque pultat aedes?

Nic.

Ego atque hic.

Bacch.

Quid hoc est negoti nam,
amabo?
quis has huc ovis adegit?

Nic.

What in the world has your son done to
vex you, pray?

Nic.

You shall know: this—he's going to the
dogs along with yours: the both of them
alike have mistresses.

Phil.

How do you know?

Nic.

I saw.

Phil.

(*with apparent conviction*) Oh dear me!
Terrible, terrible!

Nic.

Why don't we go straight up and knock;
and call them both out here?

Phil.

(*lukewarm*) I have no objection.

Nic.

(*pounding on Bacchis's door*) Hi!
Bacchis! Be so good as to have the door
opened this instant, unless you prefer to
have door and doorposts smashed in with
axes!

Scene 2.

Bacch.

(*within*) Who's raising such a din and
uproar, calling me and beating on the
house?

ENTER THE TWO *Bacchises* INTO DOORWAY.

Nic.

This gentleman and I.

Bacch.

(*to sister after surveying them*) Mercy
me, dear, what does this mean? Who
drove these sheep here?

Nic.

Ovis nos vocant pessumae.

Soror

Pastor harum
dormit, quom haec eunt sic a pecu
balitantes.

Bacch.

At pol nitent, haud sordidae videntur ambae.

Soror

Attonsae hae quidem ambae usque sunt.

Phil.

Ut videntur
deridere nos.

Nic.

Sine suo usque arbitrato.

Bacch.

Rerin ter in anno tu has tonsitari?

Soror

Pol hodie altera iam bis detonsa certo est.

Bacch.

Vetulae sunt minae ambae.^{[31](#)}

Soror

At bonas fuisse credo.

Bacch.

1130 Viden limulis, obsecro, ut intuentur?

Soror

Ecastor sine omni arbitror malitia esse.

Phil.

(*to Philoxenus*) They're calling us sheep,
the sluts!

Soror

Their shepherd must be taking a nap, to
let them straggle off from the flock this
way, bleating.

Bacch.

My goodness, though! They are sleek!
they seem to be quite spick and span,
both of them.

Soror

Yes, you see they've both been ever so
well shorn.

Phil.

(*to Nicobulus*) Hm! They seem to be
making fun of us.

Nic.

(*sourly*) Let them go as far as they like.

Bacch.

Do you suppose they are generally
sheared three times a year?

Soror

Goodness me! that other one (*indicating
Nicobulus*) has been shorn twice this very
day for certain.

Bacch.

They're both rather woolless old—(*with a
sly glance at her sister*) customers.

Soror

But they used to be good ones, I do
believe.

Bacch.

For heaven's sake, do you see the little
sidelong glances they're casting at us?

Soror

Oh well, I don't think they mean anything
naughty by it.

Phil.

Merito hoc nobis fit, qui quidem huc
venerimus.

Bacch.

Cogantur quidem intro.

Soror

Haud scio quid eo opus sit,
quae nec lac nec lanam ullam habent. sic
sine astent.

exsolvere quanti fuere, omnis fructus
iam illis decedit. non vides, ut palantes solae
liberae
grassentur? quin aetate credo esse mutas:
ne balant quidem, quomodo a pecu cetero
absunt.

stultae atque haud malae videntur.
revortamur intro, soror.

Nic.

1140 Ilico ambae
manete: haec oves volunt vos.

Soror

Prodigium hoc quidemst: humana nos voce
appellant oves.

Nic.

Haec oves vobis malam rem magnam, quam
debent, dabunt

Bacch.

Si quam debes, te condono: tibi habe,
numquam abs te petam.
sed quid est quapropter nobis vos malum
minitamini?

Phil.

Quia nostros agnos conclusos istic esse
aiunt duos.

Nic.

Et praeter eos agnos meus est istic clam
mordax canis:
qui nisi nobis producuntur iam atque
emittuntur foras,

(to *Nicobulus*) This serves us right for
coming here!

Bacch.

They really ought to be pushed inside.

Soror

I don't see any use in that, they haven't
any milk, or wool either. Let them stand
still as they are. They've been worked to
their full value; all the fruit has dropped
off of them already. Don't you see how
they straggle along aimlessly, alone,
untended? Why, I do believe they're
dumb with age; they don't even bleat at
being away from the rest of the flock.
They seem perfectly harmless—just silly.
Let's go back inside, sister.

Nic.

Stay where you are, both of you: these
sheep want you.

Soror

Dear, dear, miraculous! The sheep are
addressing us, quite as if they were
human!

Nic.

These sheep are going to give you all the
trouble they owe you.

Bacch.

If you owe anything, I'll forgive it you:
keep it yourself—I'll never come to you
for it. But what's the reason for your
threatening us with trouble?

Phil.

Because they say our lambs are shut up in
there, (*pointing to house*) two of them.

Nic.

And besides those lambs, there's a dog of
mine, a biter, skulking in there: unless
these beasts are produced for us
immediately and let out of doors, we'll

arietes truces nos erimus, iam in vos
incursabimus.

Bacch.

Soror, est quod te volo secreto.

Soror

Eho, amabo.

Nic.

Quo illaec

abeunt?

Bacch.

1150 Senem illum tibi dedo ultenorem, lepide
ut lenitum reddas;
ego ad hunc iratum adgrediar, si possumus
nos hos intro illicere huc.

Soror

Meum pensum ego lepide accurabo,
quamquam odiosam mortem amplexari.

Bacch.

Facito ut facias.

Soror

Taceas. tu tuum facito: ego
quod dixi haud mutabo.

Nic.

Quid illaec illic in consilio duae secreto
consultant?

Phil.

Quid ais tu, homo?

Nic.

Quid me vis?

Phil.

Pudet dicere me tibi quiddam.

Nic.

Quid est quod pudeat?

Phil.

turn into ferocious rams, and immediately
butt you.

Bacch.

Sister, I want a word with you in private,
(*takes her aside*)

Soror

(*inquiringly*) Well, well, there's a dear!

Nic.

Where are they off to?

Bacch.

I give that further old fellow (*pointing to
Philoxenus*) over to you to get nicely
pacified; I'll make up to this bear,
(*indicating Nicobulus*) and we'll see if we
can't lure them inside here.

Soror

(*without enthusiasm*) I'll take care of my
stint nicely enough, even though it is
sickening to hug a death's-head.

Bacch.

See you do it.

Soror

Hush! You do your share, and I won't fail
to keep my word.

Nic.

What are they scheming, those two, in
that secret session?

Phil.

(*awkwardly*) I say, old fellow.

Nic.

What do you want?

Phil.

There's something I'm ashamed to tell
you.

Nic.

What is it you are ashamed of?

Phil.

Sed amico homini tibi quod
volo credere certumst.
nihili sum.

Nic.

Istuc iam pridem scio. sed qui
nihili es? id memora.

Phil.

Tactus sum vehementer visco;
cor stimulo foditur.

Nic.

Pol tibi multo aequius
est coxendicem.
1160 sed quid istuc est? etsi iam ego ipse
quid sit probe scire puto me;
verum audire etiam ex te studeo.

Phil.

Viden hanc?

Nic.

Video.

Phil.

Haud mala
est mulier.

Nic.

Pol vero ista mala et tu nihili.

Phil.

Quid multa? ego
amo.

Nic.

An amas?

Phil.

ναὶ
γάρ.

Nic.

Tun, homo putide, amator istac fieri aetate
audes?

But to a good friend like you—yes, I'm
going to own up to what I want. (*pauses*)
I'm an ass.

Nic.

I have known that for some time. But
why are you an ass? Explain that.

Phil.

(*with a wry smile*) I'm most confoundedly
caught in bird-lime; my heart's pierced by
a goad.

Nic.

Jove! much more to the point, if it were
your nether portions! But what do you
mean? And yet I think I have a pretty fair
notion myself what it is already; however,
I'm anxious to have it from your own lips.

Phil.

Do you see this girl? (*pointing to the
Sister*)

Nic.

I do.

Phil.

(*approvingly*) Not a bad one!

Nic.

(*indignantly*) Good Lord! She certainly is
a bad one, and you are an ass.

Phil.

(*not listening*) In short, I'm in love with
her.

Nic.

You in love?

Phil.

Bien sûr!

Nic.

You, you disgusting creature? You
venture to turn lover at your age?

Phil.
non?
Nic.
Quia flagitium est.
Phil.
Quid opust verbis? meo filio
non sum iratus,
neque te tuost aequom esse iratum: si
amant, sapienter faciunt.
Bacch.
Sequere hac.
Nic.
Eunt eccas
tandem
probri perlecebrae et
persuastrices,
quid nunc? etiam redditis nobis
filios et servom? an ego experior
tecum vim maiorem?
Phil.
Abin
hinc?
non homo tu quidem es, qui istoc pacto tam
lepidam inlepide appelles.
Bacch.
1170 Senex optime quantumst in terra, sine
me hoc exorare abs te,
ut istuc delictum desistas tanto opere ire
oppugnatum.
Nic.
Ni abeas, quamquam tu bella es,
malum tibi magnum dabo iam.
Bacch.

Phil.
Why not?
Nic.
Because it's infamous.
Phil.
(*gathering courage rapidly*) Tut, tut! I'm
not angry at my son, and you oughtn't to
be angry at yours: if they're in love,
they're acting wisely.
Bacch.
(*to sister*) Come along.
Nic.
Ah, there they come at last, the seductive,
persuasive pests! (*to sisters*) Well now?
See here, are you going to give us back
our sons and servant? Or shall I try more
vigorous measures with you? (*to
Nicobulus, protestingly*) Get out, will
you? There's no red blood in you,
addressing a sweet little girl (*leering at
Bacchus*) in that sour fashion.
Phil.
(*to Nicobulus, protestingly*) Get out, will
you? There's no red blood in you,
addressing a sweet little girl (*leering at
Bacchus*) in that sour fashion.
Bacch.
(*to Nicobulus, as she tries to fondle him*)
You nicest old man in all the world, do let
me persuade you not to be so awfully
opposed to your son's naughtiness.
Nic.
(*struggling to be very stern*) Unless you
get away from me—no matter if you are
pretty—I'll give you a good sound slap
this minute.
Bacch.

	Patiar,	(softly, still fondling him) I'll take it. I'm not afraid of your striking me so as to hurt at all.
	non metuo, ne quid mihi doleat quod ferias.	
Nic.		Nic.
	Ut	(aside) What a coaxer she is! Oh, dear me! I'm afraid!
	blandiloquast! ei mihi, metuo.	
Soror		Soror
	Hic	(caressing Philoxenus to his high satisfaction) This one is more peaceful.
	magis tranquillust.	
Bacch.		Bacch.
	I hac mecum intro atque ibi, si quid vis, filium concastigato.	Do come inside here with me: yes, and punish your son ever so, in there, if you like.
Nic.		Nic.
Abin a me, scelus?		Get away from me, you hussy!
Bacch.		Bacch.
	Sine, mea pietas, te exorem.	Let me persuade you, that's a love! (tries to draw him toward house)
Nic.		Nic.
	Exores tu	You persuade me?
	me?	
Soror		Soror
Ego quidem ab hoc certe exorabo.		I'll certainly persuade my man, at any rate.
Phil.		Phil.
	Immo ego te oro, ut me intro abducas.	(returning her embrace with vigour) No you won't: I myself beg you to take me inside.
Soror		Soror
Lepidum te.		Oh, you delightful man!
Phil.		Phil.
	At scin quo pacto me ad te intro abducas?	But do you know on what condition you can take me inside.
Soror		Soror
	Mecum ut	Yes, your being with me.
	sis.	
Phil.		Phil.

	Omnia quae cupio commemoras.		The sum total of my desires!
Nic.	Vidi ego nequam homines, verum te neminem deteriolem.		Nic. (pulling himself together) I have seen worthless men, but never a worse one than you.
Phil.			Phil. (cheerfully) So I am.
	sum.	1180 Ita	
Bacch.	I hac mecum intro, ubi tibi sit lepide victibus, vino atque unguentis.		Bacch. (to Nicobulus) Do come along inside with me: you'll have a lovely time—things to eat, and wine and perfumes.
Nic.	Satis, satis iam vostrist convivi: me nil paenitet ut sim acceptus: quadringentis Philippis filius me et Chrysalus circumduxerunt. quem quidem ego ut non excruciem, alterum tantum auri non meream.		Nic. Enough, enough of your banqueting already—it makes no difference to me how I'm entertained! Four hundred pounds I've been tricked out of by my son and Chrysalus. And I wouldn't forgo making that slave bleed for it, not for another four hundred.
Bacch.	Quid tandem, si dimidium auri redditur, in hac mecum intro? atque ut eis delicta ignoscas.		Bacch. Well, but supposing half of it is given back, won't you come in with me, then? Yes, and pardon their offences?
Phil.			Phil. He'll do it.
Nic.	Minime, nolo. nil moror, sine sic. malo illos ulcisci ambo.		Nic. (with all his remaining resolution) Not a bit of it. I don't want to. None of this for me: leave me alone. I prefer to take vengeance on that pair.
Phil.	Etiam tu homo nihili? quod di dant boni cave culpa tua amissis dimidium auri datur. accipias, potesque et scortum aecumbas.		Phil. (aside to Nicobulus) See here, you—ass! Look out you don't lose the blessings the gods give you, and have yourself to blame for it. Here's half the money given

Nic.
 Egon ubi filius corrumpatur meus, ibi
 potem?
Phil.
 Potandumst.
Nic.
 Age iam, id ut ut est, etsi est dedecori patiar,
 facere inducam animum
 egon, cum haec cum illo accubet,
 inspectem?
Bacch.
 Immo equidem
 pol tecum accumbam, te amabo et te
 amplexabor.
Nic.
 Caput prurit, perii, vix negito.
Bacch.
 Non tibi venit in mentem, amabo,
 si dum vivas tibi bene facias
 tam pol id quidem esse haud
 perlonginquom,
 neque, si hoc hodie amissis, post in
 morte eventurum esse umquam?
Nic.
 Quid ago?
Phil.
 Quid agas? rogitas etiam?
Nic.
 Libet et metuo.
Bacch.
 Quid
 metuis?
Nic.

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you: take it, and drink and have a good
 time with the wench.
Nic.
 (*very feebly*) I drink in the house where
 my son is being debauched?
Phil.
 (*clapping him on the shoulder*) Drink you
 must.
Nic.
 (*giving way temporarily*) Come on then,
 no matter what it is, disgraceful though it
 be, I'll stand it, I'll bring myself to it.
 (*after a pause, doubtfully*) Am I to look
 on while she's on the couch beside him?
Bacch.
 Goodness me, no indeed! I'll be on the
 couch beside you, loving you and
 hugging you. (*snuggles up to him*)
Nic.
 (*aside*) My head does itch! Dear, dear,
 dear! It is hard to keep on saying no!
Bacch.
 My dear man, doesn't it occur to you that,
 supposing you do enjoy yourself all your
 life, this life is very, very short, after all,
 —good gracious, yes!—and that if you
 let this chance slip, it won't come again
 when you're dead, ever?
Nic.
 (*nearly helpless*) What am I to do?
Phil.
 To do? The idea of asking that!
Nic.
 I long to, and—I'm afraid.
Bacch.
 Afraid of what?
Nic.

Ne obnoxius filio sim et servo.

Bacch.

Mel meum, amabo,
etsi haec fiunt,
tuost: unde illum sumere censes, nisi quod
tute illi dederis?
hanc veniam illis sine te exorem.

Nic.

Ut terebrat! satin
offirmatum
1200 quod mihi erat, id me exorat?
tua sum opera et propter te improbior.

Bacch.

Ne tis³² quam
mea mavellem.
satin ego istuc habeo firmatum?

Nic.

Quod semel dixi haud
mutabo

Bacch.

It dies, ite intro accubitum,
filii vos exspectant intus.

Nic.

Quam quidem
actutum emoriamur.

Soror

Vesper hic est, sequimini.

Nic.

Ducite nos quo lubet
tamquam quidem addictos.

Bacch.

Lepide ipsi hi sunt capti, suis qui filiis
fecere insidias.

Of humbling myself before my son and
servant.

Bacch.

Oh, honey, there's a dear, now! Even if
it's all so, he's your own boy: where do
you think he's to get money, except from
your own generous self? Do let me
persuade you to forgive them.

Nic.

(*half aside*) How she does drill through a
man! Is she actually persuading me
against my fixed intention? (*giving up the
struggle and yielding to Bacchis's
caresses*) I'm a reprobate now, and all
because of you and your efforts.

Bacch.

(*softly and tenderly*) Oh, I do wish it had
been your efforts rather than (*giving her
sister a dreary smile*) mine. So I'm
actually to take that as your fixed
intention?

Nic.

What I have once said I won't change.

Bacch.

The day is going: go inside and take your
places on the couches. Your sons are
within waiting for you.

Nic.

(*dryly*) Yes, waiting for us to breathe our
last with celerity.

Soror

It's evening: come along.

Nic.

Take us where you please, just as if we
were your veritable bond servants.

Bacch.

(*aside to spectators*) Here they are,
prettily caught themselves—after laying

GREX

Hi senes nisi fuissent nihili iam inde ab
adulescentia,
non hodie hoc tantum flagitium facerent
canis capitibus;
neque adeo haec faceremus, ni antehac
vidissemus fieri,
1210 ut apud lenones rivalet filii fierent
patres.
spectatores, vos valere volumus et clare
adplaudere.

traps for their sons.

[EXEUNT OMNES INTO HOUSE OF *Bacchis*.]

EPILOGUE

SPOKEN BY THE COMPANY.

Unless these old men had been worthless
from their very youth, they would not be
guilty of such an enormity as this to-day
when their heads are hoary; nor, indeed,
would we have presented such a comedy,
unless we had seen before now how
fathers become their sons' rivals at places
of unsavoury repute. Spectators, we wish
you health and—your loud applause.

1. Leo notes lacuna here: *aedis* Ritschl.

2. Leo notes lacuna here: *fide* Leo.

3. Corrupt (Leo): *perii* MSS: *prope*
Ritschl.

4. Leo brackets following v., 67:
ubi pro disco damnum capiam, pro cursura
dedecus?

5. Leo brackets following v., 69:
ubique imponat in manum alius mihi pro
cestu cantharum.

6. Leo brackets following v., 107:
simul huic nescio cui, turbare qui huc it,
decedamus.

7. Leo brackets following v., 150:
video nimio iam multo plus quam volueram.

8. Leo brackets following v., 153, 154:
nil moror discipulos mihi iam plenos
sanguinis.
valens afflicta me vacivom virium.

9. Leo brackets following v., 166, 167:
edepol fecisti furtum in aetatum malum

A. The Spartan reformer

B. Linus was killed by his pupil,
Hercules.

C. Phoenix, Achilles' preceptor, informed
Peleus, Achilles' father, of his son's death.

D. A fragile and (*The Captives* 291)
cheap kind of pottery.

E. One of Plautus's plays.

F. Venus and Juno not being sisters.

G. The owner of the ram with the golden
fleece.

8.
I have no liking for these full-blooded
pupils: the sturdy youngster is bullying
me, destitute of strength as I am.

9.
Good heavens! Such villainy in a lad of

cum istaec flagitia me celavisti et patrem.

[10.](#) *Tardare* Hauptius: *turbare* MSS.

[11.](#) Leo brackets following v., 377-378:
*quibus patrem et me teque amicosque
omnes affectas tuos
ad probrum, damnum, flagitium appellere
una et perdere.*

[12.](#) Leo brackets following v., 382:
*nunc prius quam malum istoc addis,
certumst iam dicam patri*

[13.](#) *sed eccum video incedere* follows in
MSS: Leo brackets.

[14.](#) Leo brackets following v., 446:
*it magister quasi lucerna uncto expretus
linto.*

[15.](#) *Pistocleri* follows in MSS: Leo
brackets.

[16.](#) Leo brackets following v., 465, 466:
*nam illum meum malum promptare malim
quam peculium.*

Phil.

Quidem?

Lydus

*Quia, malum si promptet, in dies
faciat minus.*

[17.](#) Leo brackets following v., 486-488:
*quid opust verbis? si opperiri vellem
paulisper modo,
ut opinor, illius inspectandi mi esset maior
copia,
plus viderem quam deceret, quam me atque
illo aequum foret.*

[18.](#) Leo brackets the following v., 519a-
519c:
*sed autem quam illa umquam meis
opulentiis
ramenta fiat gravior aut propensior,*

your age, concealing such atrocities from
me and from your father!

[H.](#) A noted thief, the grandfather of
Ulysses.

[11.](#)
You are doing your best by such conduct
to bring ignominy, loss, disgrace, upon
every one of us, your father and me and
yourself and all your friends, and ruin us.

[L.](#) Rascally slaves in Greek comedies.

[J.](#) Who carried a letter which was to be
his own death warrant.

[K.](#) The goddess of war.

[L.](#) Characters in some familiar play.

[16.](#)
Yes, yes, I should rather have him
administer my punishment than my
money.

Phil.

Why so?

Lydus

Because if he administered my
punishment, there would soon be none
left.

[17.](#)
Why say more? If I had wished to remain
but a little longer, I should have had
further opportunity to observe his
conduct, I suppose, and I should have
seen more than was proper, more than
became me and him.

[18.](#)
However, rather than have my money
make her a fraction the weightier or
heavier, I'd prefer to perish in the pangs
of want.

mori me malim excruciatum inopia.

[19.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *tute (etiam)* Seyffert: *tute (eam)* Lindsay.

[20.](#) Leo notes lacuna here: *Quae te (male) mala* Lindsay.

[21.](#) Corrupt (Leo). *At quidem hercle est ad perdundum magis quam ad scribundum cita* Camerarius: various readings MSS.

[22.](#) Leo notes lacuna here: *tu (scelus)* Ritschl.

[23.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *Latona Spes* MSS: *Luna Spes* Bergk: *Lato Spes* Ussing.

[24.](#) Leo brackets the following v., 931: *cepi expugnaui amanti erili filio aurum ab suo patre.*

[25.](#) Leo brackets the following v., 937-940:

Epiust Pistoclerus: ab eo haec sumptae; Mnesilochus Sino est relictus, ellum non in busto Achilli, sed in lecto accubat; Bacchidem habet secum: ille olim habuit ignem qui signum daret, hunc ipsum exurit; ego sum Vlixes, cuius consilio haec gerunt.

[26.](#) Leo brackets the following v., 962-965:

ibi vix me exsolvi: id periculum adsimilo, Vlixem ut praedicant cognitum ab Helena esse proditum Hecubae, sed ut olim ille se blanditiis exemit et persuasit se ut amitteret, item ego dolis me illo extuli e periculo et decepi senem

[27.](#) Leo brackets the following v., 973-977:

sed Priamus hic multo illi praestat: non quinquaginta modo,

[M.](#) Paris

[N.](#) The Palladium, a statue of Pallas.

[O.](#) A son of Priam, slain by Achilles.

[25.](#)

Our Epius is Pistoclerus: from his hands were they taken. Mnesilochus is Sinon the abandoned. Behold him! not lying at Achilles' tomb, but on a couch, he has a Bacchis with him, that one of old had a fire, to give the signal,—but this Sinon is burning himself. I am Ulysses whose counsel directs it all.

[26.](#)

Then it was I just managed to get free: this danger I liken to that they tell of when Ulysses was recognized by Helen and betrayed to Hecuba. But as he, in former days, got away by means of his honeyed words and persuaded her to let him go, so also I, by means of my wiles, got out of danger and deceived the old man.

[27.](#)

But this Priam is far superior to that one, not a mere fifty sons has he; he has four hundred, yes, and every one is unquestionably a choice and flawless

*quadringentos filios habet atque equidem
omnis lectos sine probro:
eos ego hodie omnis contruncabo duobus
solis ictibus.
nunc Priamo nostro si est quis emptor,
comptionalem senem
vendam ego, venalem quem habeo,
exemplo ubi oppidum ex pugnavero.*

[28.](#) *ut quod iubeo facias* follows in MSS:
Leo brackets.

[29.](#) Leo brackets the following v., 1081:
*duxi, habui scortum. potavi, dedi, donavi,
sed enim id raro.*

[30.](#) Leo brackets the following v., 1100:
immo edepol sic ludos factum

[31.](#) *Minae ambae Colerus: thimiame*
MSS.

[32.](#) *tis* Schroeder: *is* MSS.

specimen. This day I will annihilate 'em
all with just two blows. Now, if there is
anyone who cares to buy our Priam, I will
sell off the old gentleman I have on sale,
as a job lot, the moment I have taken the
town by storm.

-

CAPTIVI

THE CAPTIVES

[Argument](#)

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[ACT I](#)

[Scene 2](#)

[ACT II](#)

[ACT IV](#)

[Scene 2](#)

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[Scene 4](#)

[ACT V](#)

Scene 2	Scene 2
Scene 3	Scene 3
ACT III	Scene 4
Scene 2	Epilogue
Scene 3	Footnotes
Scene 4	
Scene 5	

ARGVMENTVM

Captust in pugna Hegionis filius;
Alium quadrimum fugiens servus vendidit.
Pater captivos commercatur Aleos,
Tantum studens ut natum captum recuperet;
Et inibi emit olim amissum filium.
In suo cum domino veste versa ac nomine
Vt amittatur fecit: ipse plectitur;
Et is reduxit captum, et fugitivum simul,
Indicio cuius alium agnoscit filium.

PERSONAE

ERGASILVS PARASITUS
 HEGIO SENEX
 LORARIVS
 PHILOCRACTES ADULESCENS
 TYNDARVS SERVVS
 ARISTOPHONTES ADULESCENS
 PVER
 PHILOPOLEMVS ADULESCENS
 STALAGMVS SERVVS

ARGUMENT OF THE PLAY

One of Hegio's sons has been taken prisoner in a battle with the Eleans; the other was stolen by a runaway slave and sold when he was four years old. The father, in his great anxiety to recover the captured boy, bought up Elean prisoners of war; and among those that he purchased was the son he had lost many years before. This son, having exchanged clothes and names with his Elean master, secured the latter's release, taking the consequences himself. This master of his returned, bringing Hegio's captive son, and along with him that runaway slave, whose disclosures led to the recognition of the other son.

DRAMATIS PERSONAE

ERGASILUS, *a parasite.*
 HEGIO, *an old gentleman.*
 SLAVE OVERSEER, *belonging to Hegio.*
 PHILOCRACTES, *a young Elean captive.*
 TYNDARUS, *his slave, captured with him.*
 ARISTOPHONTES, *a young Elean captive.*
 A PAGE, *in the service of Hegio.*
 PHILOPOLEMUS, *Hegio's son.*
 STALAGMUS, *Hegio's slave.*

PROLOGVS

Hos quos videtis stare his captives duos,
illi qui astant;¹ hi stant ambo, non sedent;
hoc vos mihi testes estis me verum loqui.
senex qui his habitat Hegio est huius pater.

sed is quo pacto serviat suo sibi patri,
id ego hic apud vos proloquar, si operam
datis.
seni huic fuerunt filii nati duo;
alterum quadrimum puerum servos surpuit
eumque hinc profugiens vendidit in Alide
patri huius. iam hoc tenetis?² optume est. 10

negat hercle ille ultimus. accedito.
si non ubi sedeas locus est, est ubi ambules,
quando histrionem cogis mendicari.
ego me tua causa, ne erres, non rupturus
sum.
vos qui potestis ope vestra censerier,
accipite relicuom: alieno uti nil moror.

fugitivos ille, ut dixeram ante, huius patri
domo quem profugiens dominum abstulerat
vendidit.

PROLOGUE

Tyndarus AND *Philocrates* ARE CHAINED, IN
AN UNCOMFORTABLE POSITION, TO A PILLAR IN
FRONT OF *Hegio's* HOUSE.

These two prisoners you see standing
here, well, both of those bystanders are
men who are—standing, not sitting down.
(*Prologue laughs uproariously at his
pleasantry*) I leave it to you if so much is
not true. The old man that lives yonder—
(*pointing to Hegio's house*) Hegio, by
name—is this man's (*pointing to
Tyndarus*) father.

But how it happens that he is the slave of
his own father I shall (*jauntily*) here in
your midst proclaim, with your kind
attention. This old gentleman had two
sons. One of them, when he was four
years old, was stolen by a slave who took
to his heels and sold the boy in Elis to the
father of this worthy (*pointing to
Philocrates*) here. Now you take me?
Very good!

Bless my soul! That gentleman at the
back says he does not. Let him step this
way—. (*no move in audience*) In case
there is no opportunity to take a seat, sir,
you can take a (*pointing to an exit*) stroll,
seeing you insist on making an actor turn
beggar. I have no intention of bursting
myself, merely to keep you from
misunderstanding the plot. (*to rest of
audience*) As for you gentlemen who do
own enough property to pay taxes on, let
me discharge my debt—none of the credit
system for me.

That runaway slave, as I said before, stole
his young master when he decamped and
sold him to this (*indicating Philocrates*)
man's father. This gentleman, on buying

is postquam hunc emit, dedit eum huic
gnato suo
20 peculiarem, quia quasi una aetas erat.
hic nunc domi servit suo patri, nec scit
pater;
enim vero di nos quasi pilas homines
habent.

rationem habetis, quo modo unum amiserit.
postquam belligerant Aetoli cum Aleis,
ut fit in bello, capitur alter filius:
medicus Menarchus emit ibidem in Alide.
coepit captives commercari hic Aleos,
si quem reperire possit qui mutet suum,
illum captivum: hunc suum esse nescit, qui
domist.

30 et quoniam heri indauidit, de summo
loco
summoque genere captum esse equitem
Aleum,
nil pretio parsit, filio dum parceret:
reconciliare ut facilius posset domum,
emit hosce e praeda ambos de quaestoribus.

hisce autem inter sese hunc confinxerunt
dolum.
quo pacto hic servos suum erum hinc
amittat domum.
itaque inter se commutant vestem et
nomina;
illic vocatur Philocrates, hic Tyndarus:
huius illic, hic illius hodie fert imaginem.

40 et hic hodie expediet hanc docte
fallaciam,
et suum erum faciet libertatis compotem,
eodemque pacto fratrem servabit suum

the boy, gave him to this son of his for his
very own, the two being of about the
same age. Now here he is, back home, his
own father's slave without his father
knowing it. Ah yes, the gods use us
mortals as footballs!

Well, you comprehend the way in which
he lost one son. Later, when war broke
out between the Aetolians and Eleans, the
other son was taken prisoner—a common
occurrence in times of war—and a doctor,
Menarchus, in that same Elis, bought the
young man. Hegio then began to buy up
Elean captives, hoping to get hold of one
that he could exchange for his son—the
captive son, that is: for he has no idea that
this man at his home is his own child.

And inasmuch as he heard it rumoured
yesterday that an Elean knight of the very
highest rank and family connections had
been captured, he had no thought of
saving money if only he could save his
son. So in the hope of getting that son
back home more readily he bought both
of these prisoners from the
commissioners who were disposing of the
spoils.

These same prisoners, however, have got
together and laid a scheme, as you can
see, to the end that the slave here
(*indicating Tyndarus*) may send his
master off home. Accordingly, they have
exchanged clothes and names with each
other. That one (*indicating Tyndarus*) is
calling himself Philocrates, and this one
(*indicating Philocrates*) Tyndarus: each is
posing as the other for the time being.

And Tyndarus here is going to work out
this trick to-day like an artist, and set his
master at liberty. By so doing he will
rescue his own brother, too, and enable
him to return home to his father a free

reducemque faciet liberum in patriam ad
 patrem,
 imprudens: itidem ut saepe iam in multis
 locis
 plus insciens quis fecit quam prudens boni.
 sed inscientes sua sibi fallacia
 ita compararunt et confinxerunt dolum
 itaque hi commenti, de sua sententia
 ut in servitute hic ad suum maneat patrem:
 50 ita nunc ignorans suo sibi servit patri;
 homunculi quanti sunt, quomodo recogito!
 haec res agatur nobis, vobis fabula.

sed etiam est, paucis vos quod monitos
 voluerim.
 profecto expediet fabulae huic operam dare.
 non pertractate facta est neque item ut
 ceterae:
 neque spurcidi insunt versus,
 immemorabiles;
 hic neque periurus leno est nec meretrix
 mala
 neque miles gloriosus; ne vereamini,
 quia bellum Aetolis esse dixi cum Aleis:
 60 foris illic extra scaenam fient proelia.

nam hoc paene iniquum est, comico choragio
 conari desubito agere nos tragoediam.
 proin si quis pugnam expectat, litis
 contrahat:
 valentiolem nactus adversarium
 si erit, ego faciam ut pugnam inspectet non
 bonam,
 adeo ut spectare postea omnis oderit.

ab eo. valete, iudices iustissimi
 domi duellique duellatores optimi.

ACTVS I

man, all quite unwittingly,—as in so many cases before now a man has often done more good unconsciously than wittingly.

But all unconsciously, in their trickery, they have so planned and contrived and schemed, acting upon their own ideas, that Tyndarus will stay here as his own father's slave. So now it is his father he is serving unawares. What helpless creatures we mortals be, when I stop to reflect! All this will be fact on the boards, fiction for the benches.

About one thing more, though, I should like to offer a word or two of suggestion. It will undeniably be to your profit to pay attention to this play. It is not composed in the hackneyed style, is quite unlike other plays; nor does it contain filthy lines that one must not repeat. In this comedy you will meet no perjured pimp, or unprincipled courtesan, or braggart captain. Let not my statement that the Aetolians and Eleans are at war alarm you: engagements will take place off the stage yonder.

It would almost amount to imposition, you know, for us, in our comedy get-up, to try to present a tragedy all of a sudden. So if anyone is looking for a battle scene, let him pick a quarrel: if he gets a good strong opponent, I promise him a glimpse of a battle scene so unpleasant that hereafter he will hate the very sight of one.

(*turning to go*) And so good-bye to you, most just of judges here at home and doughtiest of fighters in the field.
 [EXEUNT *Prologue* AND *Captives*.]

ACT I

Erg.

Iuventus nomen indidit Scorto mihi,
70 eo quia invocatus soleo esse in convivio.
scio absurde dictum hoc derisores dicere,
at ego aio recte. nam scortum in convivio
sibi amator, talos quom iacit, scortum
invocat.

estne invocatum an non est? est planissime;
verum hercle vero nos parasiti planius,
quos numquam quisquam neque vocat
neque invocat.

quasi mures semper edimus alienum cibum;
ubi res prolatae sunt, quom rus homines
eunt,
simul prolatae res sunt nostris dentibus.

80 quasi, cum caletur, cocleae in occulto
latent,
suo sibi suco vivont, ros si non cadit,
item parasiti rebus prolatis latent
in occulto miseri victitant suco suo,
dum ruri rurant homines quos ligurriant.

prolatis rebus parasiti venatici
sumus, quando res redierunt, molossici
odiosicique et multum incommodestici.
et hic quidem hercle, nisi qui colaphos
perpeti
potest parasitus frangique aulas in caput,
³ire extra portam Trigemina ad saccum
licet. 90
quod mihi ne eveniat, non nullum periculum
est.

ENTER *Ergasilus* LOOKING HUNGRY AND
FORLORN.

Erg.

The young fellows have dubbed me
Missy, on the ground that whenever
they're at their banquets I feel called upon
to be with 'em. To be sure, the
professional wags say it is an absurd
nickname, but I protest it's a good one.
For at banquets when the young sparks
are playing dice they call upon their
missies, yes, their missies, to be with 'em
as they make a throw.

Does missy feel called upon to be with
'em, or not? Most unmistakably. But by
heaven, I tell you we parasites feel the
call more unmistakably still, for no one
else ever feels for us or calls us, either.
Like mice, we're forever nibbling at some
one else's food. When the holidays come,
and men hie 'em to their country estates,
our grinders take a holiday, too.

It's the same as snails hiding in their
holes during the dog days and living on
their own juices when there's no dew
falling: that's the way with parasites
during the holidays—hide in their holes,
poor devils, and subsist on their own
juices while the people they could get
pickings from are in the rural regions
ruralizing.

So long as the holidays last we parasites
are greyhounds: when they're over we are
wolf-hounds and dear-hounds and bore-
hounds, very much so. And, by gad, in
this town, at least, if a parasite objects to
being banged about and having crockery
smashed on his cranium, he can betake
himself to the far side of Three Arch Gate
and a porter's bag. (*ruefully*) Which is
precious likely to be my own fate.

nam postquam meus rex est potitus hostium
—

ita nunc belligerant Aetoli cum Aleis;
nam Aetolia haec est, illic est captus in
Alide,
Philopolemus, huius Hegionis filius
senis, qui hie habitat, quae aedes
lamentariae
mihi sunt, quas quotienscumque conspicio
fleo;

nunc hic occepit quaestum hunc fili gratia
inhonestum et maxime alienum ingenio suo:
100 homines captives commercatur, si queat
aliquem invenire, suom qui mutet filium.
quod quidem ego nimis quam cupio⁴ ut
impetret:
nam ni illum recipit, nihil est quo me
recipiam.

nam nulla est spes iuventutis, sese omnis
amant;
ille demum antiquis est adulescens moribus,
cuius numquam voltum tranquillavi gratiis.
condigne pater est eius moratus moribus.
nunc ad eum pergam. sed aperitur ostium,
unde saturitate saepe ego exii ebrius.

I. 2.

Hegio

110 Advorte animum sis tu: istos captives
duos,
heri quos emi de praeda a quaestoribus,
eis indito catenas singulares
istas, maiores, quibus sunt iuncti, demito;
sinito ambulare, si foris si intus volent,
sed uti adserventur magna diligentia.

For after my patron fell in with the enemy
—the Aetolians, you see, are at war now
with the Eleans; this is Aetolia, you
understand, and it's there in Elis that
Philopolemus is a captive, Philopolemus
being the son of Hegio here, the old
gentleman that lives in (*pointing*) that
house (and a lamentatious house it is!
every time I look at it, it makes me
weep!)

—well, now Hegio has taken up his
present business, all for his son's sake,
ungentlemanly business as it is, and quite
beneath a man of his type. He's buying up
prisoners of war, to see if he can't come
across one to exchange for his boy. And
Lord! how I do yearn for him to succeed!
You see, it's a matter of his coming home,
or my going hungry.

For our young fellows are absolutely
unpromising—egoists, the whole lot of
'em! But he is a young gentleman of the
old school, that lad: I never smoothed the
wrinkles out of his brow without getting
more than a thankye for it. His father is
just such another perfect gentleman. Now
for a call on him. (*moves toward Hegio's
house*) But there goes his door, out of
which I've often come so full of food I
was fairly tipsy. (*withdraws*)

Scene 2.

ENTER *Hegio* WITH *Slave Overseer*.

Hegio

Attention, please, my man. Those two
captives that I bought yesterday from the
commissioners in charge of the spoils—
put the light irons on them and take off
the heavy ones they're coupled with.

Let them walk out here or inside,
whichever they please; but look after

liber captivos avis ferae consimilis est:
semel fugiendi si data est occasio,
satis est, numquam postilla possis prendere.

Lor.

Omnes profecto liberi lubentius
sumus quam servimus.

Hegio

120 Non videre ita tu
quidem.

Lor.

Si non est quod dem, mene vis dem ipse—
in pedes?

Hegio

Si dederis, erit extemplo mihi quod dem
tibi.

Lor.

Avis me ferae consimilem faciam, ut
praedicas.

Hegio

Ita ut dicis: nam si faxis, te in caveam dabo.
sed satis verborumst. cura quae iussi atque
abi.

ego ibo ad fratrem ad alios captives meos,
visam ne nocte hac quippiam turbaverint.
inde me continuo recipiam rursum domum.

Erg.

Aegre est mi, hunc facere quaestum
carcerarium

130 propter sui gnati miseriam miserum
senem.

sed si ullo pacto ille huc conciliari potest,
vel carnificinam hunc facere possum
perpeti.

Hegio

Quis hic loquitur?

Erg.

them sharp, mind you. A captive free is a
regular wild bird: once given a chance to
flit, that is enough—you can never get
hold of him again.

Over.

Well, of course sir, we'd all rather be free
than slaves.

Hegio

That seems untrue of you at any rate. [A](#)

Over.

In case I haven't anything else to give
you, how about my giving you—the slip?

Hegio

Give me that, and I shall shortly have
something to give you.

Over.

I'll copy that wild bird you speak of.

Hegio

Exactly—for then I'll cage you. But
enough of this. Mind my orders and be
off with you. I'll drop in at my brother's
for a look at my other prisoners, and see
if they made any disturbance last night.
Then I'll return home again at once.
[EXIT *Overseer* INTO HOUSE.]

Erg.

(*with a loud sigh*) It does grieve me to see
the poor old gentleman at this gaoler's job
for his poor son's sake. (*in lower tone*)
However, if he only manages to get the
lad back here somehow, let him turn
hangman, too,—I can stand it.

Hegio

(*looking round*) Who is that speaking
here?

Erg.

Ego, qui tuo maerore maceror,
macesco, consenesco et tabesco miser;
ossa atque pellis sum miser a macritudine;
neque umquam quicquam me iuvat quod
edo domi:
foris aliquantillum etiam quod gusto, id
beat.

Hegio

Ergasile, salve.

Erg.

Di te bene ament, Hegio.

Hegio

Ne fle.

Erg.

Egone illum non fleam? egon non
defleam
talem adulescentem?

Hegio

140 Semper sensi, filio
meo te esse amicum, et illum intellexi tibi.

Erg.

Tum denique homines nostra intellegimus
bona,
quom quae in potestate habuimus, ea
amisimus.
ego, postquam gnatus tuos potitust hostium,
expertus quanti fuerit nunc desidero.

Hegio

Alienus cum eius incommodum tam aegre
feras,
quid me patrem par facerest, cui ille est
unicus?

Erg.

Alienus ego? alienus illi? aha, Hegio,

(*stepping forward*) I—a man that am all
worn out by your woe, that am getting
thin, growing old, pining away in sorrow;
I'm nothing but skin and bones, I feel for
you so. Nothing I eat—at home—ever
does me any good, (*aside*) But how I do
relish the merest morsel when I'm dining
out!

Hegio

Ah, good day, Ergasilus.

Erg.

God bless you, Hegio, bless you
bounteously! (*grasps Hegio's hand
fervently and bursts into tears*)

Hegio

Don't cry.

Erg.

I not cry for him? I not cry my eyes out
for such a youth?

Hegio

(*somewhat moved*) I always did feel that
you were a friend to my son, and I
realized that he regarded you as one.

Erg.

Ah, we mortals realize the value of our
blessings only when we have lost them.
Myself now—after your son fell in with
the enemy, I have come to understand
how much he meant to me, and now I
long for him.

Hegio

When an outsider like you takes his
misfortune so bitterly, how must I feel,
his father, and he my only son?

Erg.

(*choking*) An outsider? I? An outsider to
that boy? Oh-h-h, Hegio! don't say a
thing like that, don't let such a thought

numquam istuc dixis neque animum induxis
tuom;
150 tibi ille unicust, mi etiam unico magis
unicus.

Hegio

Laudo, malum cum amici tuom ducis
malum,
nunc habe bonum animum.

Erg.

Eheu, huic illud dolet,
quia nunc remissus est edendi exercitus.

Hegio

Nullumne interea nactu's, qui posset tibi
remissum quem dixti imperare exercitum?

Erg.

Quid credis? fugitant omnes hanc
provinciam,
quoi optigerat postquam captust
Philopolemus tuos.

Hegio

Non pol mirandum est fugitare hanc
provinciam,
multis et multigeneribus opus est tibi
160 militibus: primumdum opus est
Pistorensibus:
eorum sunt aliquot genera Pistorensium:
opus Paniceis est, opus Placentinis quoque;
opus Turdetanis, opust Ficedulensibus;
iam maritumi omnes milites opus sunt tibi.

Erg.

Ut saepe summa ingenia in occulto latent;
hic qualis imperator nunc privatus est.

Hegio

enter your mind, ever! Your only son,
yes,—but he was even more than that to
me: he was my only only! (*sobs violently*)

Hegio

I appreciate this, that you consider your
friend's disaster your own. (*patting him*
on the back) Come now, take heart.

Erg.

Oh, dear! oh, dear! here's (*rubbing his*
stomach) where it hurts: my whole
commissary department has been
disbanded now, you see.

Hegio

(*smiling*) And meantime haven't you hit
upon anyone that could reorganize the
department you say is disbanded?

Erg.

Would you believe it? Every one keeps
fighting shy of the office ever since your
Philopolemus, its duly elected occupant,
was captured.

Hegio

Bless my soul! no wonder they fight shy
of it. You need many recruits, of many
sorts, too: why, in the first place you need
Pad-u-ans;^B and there are several kinds of
Paduans: you need the support of
Bologna, and you need Frankfurters too;
you need Leghorners and you need Pis-
ans, and furthermore you need every
fighter in fin land.

Erg.

(*appreciatively*) How often it does
happen that the greatest talents are
shrouded in obscurity! This man now—
what a generalissimo, and here he is only
a private citizen!

Hegio

Habe modo bonum animum, nam illum
confido domum
in his diebus me reconciliassere.
nam eccum hic captivom adolescentem
intus Aleum,
170 prognatum genere summo et summis
ditiis:
hoc illum me mutare confido pote.

Erg.

Ita di deaeque faxint. sed num quo foras
vocatus es ad cenam?

Hegio

Nusquam quod sciam
sed quid tu id quaeris?

Erg.

Quia mi est natalis dies;
propterea te vocari ad te ad cenam volo

Hegio

Facete dictum. sed si pauxillo potes,
contentus esse.

Erg.

Ne perpauxillum modo,
nam istoc me assiduo victu delecto domi,
age sis, roga emptum. nisi qui meliorem
adferet
180 quae mi atque amicis placeat condicio
magis,
quasi fundum vendam, meis me addicam
legibus

Hegio

Profundum vendis tu quidem, haud fundum,
mihi
sed si venturu's, temperi.

Erg.

Em, vel iam otium
est.

Well, well, now, take heart. As a matter of
fact, I trust we shall have the boy back
with us in a few days. For, look you
(*pointing to house*) I have a young Elean
prisoner inside here—splendid family,
quantities of money: I count on being
able to exchange him for my son.

Erg.

(*heartily*) The gods and goddesses be
with you! I say, though,—you haven't
been invited out to dinner anywhere?

Hegio

(*cautiously*) Nowhere, to my knowledge.
But why do you ask?

Erg.

Well, to-day is my birthday: so consider
yourself invited to take dinner at—your
house.

Hegio

(*laughing*) Well put! But only on
condition you can be content with very
little.

Erg.

Yes, only don't make it very, very, very
little, for that is what I regale myself on
constantly at home. Come on, come on,
do please say "Done!" (*after a pause,*
formally) In the event of no party making
a better offer, more satisfactory to myself
and associates, I'll knock myself down to
you—on my own terms—just as if I was
selling an estate by auction.

Hegio

An estate indeed! You mean an empty
state. But if you intend to come, come in
season.

Erg.

Oho! I'm at leisure this minute, for that
matter.

Hegio

I modo, venare leporem: nunc irim tenes;
nam meus scruposam victus commetat
viam.

Erg.

Numquam istoc vinces me, Hegio, ne
postules:
cum calceatis dentibus veniam tamen.

Hegio

Asper meus victus sane est.

Erg.

Sentisne essitas?

Hegio

Terrestris cena est.

Erg.

Sus terrestris bestia est.

Hegio

Multis holeribus.

Erg.

190 Curato aegrotos domi.

numquid vis?

Hegio

Venias temperi.

Erg.

Memorem mones.

Hegio

Ibo intro atque intus subducam ratiunculam,
quantillum argenti mi apud trapezitam siet.
ad fratrem, quo ire dixeram, mox ivero.

Hegio

No, no, go hunt your hare: you've got
only a hedge-hog so far. For it is a rocky
road my table travels.

Erg.

You'll never down me that way, Hegio,
and don't you think to do it: I'll be with
you just the same—with my teeth shod.

Hegio

My meals are perfect terrors, really.

Erg.

Tearers? Do you eat brambles?

Hegio

Well, things that root in the earth.

Erg.

A porker does that.

Hegio

Mostly vegetables, I mean.

Erg.

Open a sanitarium, then. (*turning to go*)
Anything else I can do for you?

Hegio

Come in season.

Erg.

(*cheerfully*) The suggestion is
superfluous.

[EXIT.]

Hegio

(*sighing as he looks at the back of his
prospective guest*) I must go in and
reckon up my bit of a bank balance, and
see how low it is. Then to my brother's,
where I spoke of going before.

[EXIT INTO HOUSE.]

ACTVS II

ACT II

ENTER FROM *Hegio's* HOUSE *Overseers* AND
Slaves WITH *Philocrates* AND *Tyndarus* IN

Lor.
Si di immortales id voluerunt, vos hanc
aerumnam exsequi,
debet id pati animo aequo: si id facietis,
levior labos erit.
domi fuistis, credo, liberi:
nunc servitus si evenit, ei vos morigerari
mos bonust
et erili imperio eamque ingeniis vestris
lenem reddere.
200 indigna digna habenda sunt, erus
quae facit.

Captivi

oh.

Lor.
Eiulatione haud opus est, oculis haud⁵
lacrimantibus:
in re mala animo si bono utare, adiuvat.

Tynd.
At nos pudet, quia cum catenis sumus.

Lor.
At pigeat postea
nostrum erum, si vos eximat vinculis,
aut solutos sinat, quos argento emerit.

Tynd.
Quid a nobis metuit? scimus nos
nostrum officium quod est, si solutos sinat.

Lor.
At fugam fingitis: sentio quam rem agitis.

Philocr.
Nos fugiamus? quo fugiamus?

Lor.

In patriam.

Philocr.

FETTERS: THE TWO HAVE EXCHANGED
CLOTHES.

Over.

(to captives, patronizingly) Seeing it's the
will of Heaven you're in this box, the
thing for you to do is to take it calmly: do
that, and you won't have such a hard time
of it. At home you were free men, I
suppose: since you happen to be slaves at
present, it's a good idea to accept the
situation and a master's orders gracefully,
and make things easy to bear by taking
'em the proper way. Anything a master
does is right, no matter how wrong it is.

Captivi

(protestingly) Oh-h-h-h!

Over.

There's no need of howling or crying. It
helps to take bad things well.

Tynd.

But to be in chains—we feel disgraced!

Over.

But it's disgusted our master would feel
later on, if he took the chains off, or let
you loose, when he's paid money for you.

Tynd.

What has he to fear from us? We realise
what our duty is, if he should let us loose.

Over.

Ah yes, you're planning to run for it! I see
what's afoot.

Philocr.

Run—we? Where should we run to?

Over.

Home.

Philocr.

haud nos id deceat.
 fugitivos imitari.
Lor.
 210 Immo edepol, si erit
 occasio, haud dehortor.
Tynd.
 Unum exorare vos sinite nos.

Lor.
 Quidnam id est?

Tynd.
 Ut sine hisce arbitris
 atque vobis nobis detis locum loquendi.

Lor.
 Fiat. abscedite hinc: nos concedamus huc.
 sed brevem orationem incipisse.

Tynd.
 Em istuc mihi certum erat. concede huc.

Lor.
 Abite ab istis.

Tynd.
 Obnoxii ambo
 vobis sumus propter hanc rem, quom quae
 volumus nos
 copia est; ea⁶ facitis nos compotes.
Philocr.
 Secede huc nunciam, si videtur, procul.
 220 ne arbitri dicta nostra arbitrari queant
 neu permanet palam haec nostra fallacia.
 nam doli non doli sunt, nisi astu colas,
 sed malum maxumum, si id palam provenit.

Get out! The idea of our acting like
 runaway slaves!

Over.
 Lord! why not? I'm not saying you
 shouldn't, if you get the chance.
Tynd.
 (with dignity) Be good enough to grant us
 one request.
Over.
 Well, what is it?
Tynd.
 Merely this—give us an opportunity to
 talk together without being overheard by
 these good fellows (*pointing to slaves*)
 and yourselves.
Over.
 All right. (*to slaves*) Away with you! (*to*
other overseer) Let's drop back here. (*to*
captives) Make it short, though.
Tynd.
 Oh yes, that was my intention. (*to*
Philocrates, drawing him farther from
slaves) Come this way.
Over.
 (*to slaves still hanging about*) Get out
 and leave 'em alone. (*slaves obey*)
Tynd.
 (*to overseers*) We are much obliged to
 you, both of us, for the privilege of doing
 as we wish; we owe it to you.

Philocr.
 (*to Tyndarus*) Step over here now, if you
 please, come over, so that no one may
 catch what we say and leave us with a
 scheme that has leaked out. (*they move*
still farther from the overseers) Shrewd
 management is what makes a trick a trick,

nam si erus mihi es tu atque ego me tuom
esse servom assimulo,
tamen viso opust, cauto est opus, ut hoc
sobrie sineque arbitris
accurate agatur, docte et diligenter;
tanta incepta res est: haud somniculose hoc
agendum est.

Tynd.

Ero ut me voles esse.

Philocr.

Spero.

Tynd.

Nam tu nunc vides pro tuo caro capite
230 carum offerre me meum caput vilitati.

Philocr.

Scio.

Tynd.

At scire memento, quando id quod
voles habebis;
nam fere maxima pars morem hunc homines
habent; quod sibi volunt,
dum id impetrant, boni sunt;
sed id ubi iam penes sese habent,
ex bonis pessimi et fraudulentissimi
fiunt: nunc ut mihi te volo esse autumo.⁷

(236)

Philocr.

Pol ego si te audeam, meum patrem
nominem: (238) nam secundum patrem tu
es pater proximus.

Tynd.

Audio.

Philocr.

240 Et propterea saepius te uti
memineris moneo:

you know: once it gets out, it becomes an
instrument of torture.

No matter if you are passing as my
master and I as your slave, even so we've
got to be wary, we've got to be cautious,
so that our plan may be worked out in a
clear-headed way, quietly and carefully,
with discretion and diligence. It's a big
job we've got in hand: we can't go to
sleep over it.

Tynd.

I will be all you wish me to be, sir.

Philocr.

I hope so.

Tynd.

For that matter, sir, you already see that
to save a man I love, I am holding my
own life cheap, much as I love it.

Philocr.

I realize it.

Tynd.

But remember to realize it when you get
what you want. For, generally speaking,
men have a habit of being fine fellows so
long as they are seeking some favour; but
when they have obtained it there's a
change, and your fine fellows turn into
villainous cheats of the worst description.
In all this, sir, I'm telling you how I wish
you to act toward me.

Philocr.

By heaven, I might call you my father, if
I chose: for next to my real father you are
the best one I have.

Tynd.

I know, I know.

Philocr.

And that's just why I keep reminding you
the oftener to remember what the

non ego erus tibi, sed servos sum; nunc
obsecro te hoc unum—
quoniam nobis di immortales animum
ostenderunt suum,
ut qui erum me tibi fuisse atque esse
conservom velint,
quom antehac pro iure imperitabam meo,
nunc te oro per precem—

Philocr.

per fortunam incertam et per mei te erga
bonitatem patris,
perque conservitium commune, quod
hostica evenit manu,
ne me secus honore honestes quam quom
servibas mihi,
atque ut qui fueris et qui nunc sis meminisse
ut memineris.

Scio quidem me te esse nunc et te esse me.

Philocr.

Em istuc si potes
250 memoriter meminisse, inest spes nobis
in hac astutia.

II. 2.

Hegio

Iam ego revertar intro, si ex his quae volo
exquisivero.
ubi sunt isti quos ante aedis iussi huc produci
foras?

Philocr.

Edepol tibi ne in quaestione essemus cautum
intellego,
ita vinclis custodiisque circum moeniti sumus.

Hegio

situation calls for: I'm not your master,
I'm a slave. Now I beg this one thing of
you—since we have unmistakable proof
that it's Heaven's will I should no longer
be your master but your fellow slave, I,
who used to have the right to command
you, now implore and entreat you—

Philocr.

by the common peril in which we stand
and by my father's kindness to you and
by the captivity which the chances of war
have brought upon us both, don't feel less
respect for my wishes than you did when
you were my slave, and remember,
remember carefully, both who you were
and who you are now.

Yes, yes, I know that I am you for the
time being and that you are I.

Philocr.

There! manage to remember to keep that
in mind, and this scheme of ours looks
likely.

Scene 2.

ENTER *Hegio* FROM HOUSE.

Hegio

(*to those within*) I shall be back
directly, if I find out what I want to
know from these fellows. (*to*
overseers) Where are those prisoners
I had brought out in front of the house
here?

Philocr.

(*advancing, pertly*) Gad! You guarded
against having to look for us far, I
perceive,—see how we're barricaded
with chains and watchmen.

Hegio

Qui cavet ne decipiatur, vix cavet, cum etiam
cavet;
etiam cum cavisce ratus est, saepe is cautor
captus est.
an vero non iusta causa est, ut vos servem
sedulo,
quos tam grandi sim mercatus praesenti
pecunia?

Philocr.

Neque pol tibi nos, quia nos servas, aequomst
vitio vortere,
260 neque te nobis, si abeamus hinc, si fuit
occasio.

Hegio

Ut vos hic, itidem illic apud vos meus servatur
filius.

Philocr.

Captus est?

Hegio

Ita.

Philocr.

Non igitur nos soli ignavi fuimus.

Hegio

Secede huc. nam sunt quae ex te solo scitari
volo.
quarum rerum te falsilocom mi esse nolo.

Philocr.

Non ero
quod sciam. si quid nescibo, id nescium tradam
tibi.

Tynd.

Nunc senex est in tostrina, nunc iam cultros
attinet.
ne id quidem, involucrum inicere, voluit, vestem
ut ne inquinet.
sed utrum strictimne adtonsurum dicam esse an
per pectinem,

The man on his guard against being
deceived is hardly on his guard even
when he is on his guard, even when
he supposed he was on his guard,
your guarder has often enough been
gulled. Really though, haven't I good
reason to take pains to keep you,
when I paid so high for you, cash
down?

Philocr.

Bless your heart, sir, we haven't any
right to find fault with you for trying
to keep us, or you with us, if we clear
out—if we get a chance.

Hegio

My son is kept prisoner there in your
country just as you are here.

Philocr.

Captured?

Hegio

Yes.

Philocr.

Then other folks besides us have been
cowards.

Hegio

(leading him farther from Tyndarus)
Step over here. There are some
matters I wish to ask you about in
private. No lying about them, mind.

Philocr.

Not I, sir, not if I know. If I don't
know about a thing, I'll (*innocently*)
tell you what I don't know.

Tynd.

(*aside, cheerfully*) Now the old fellow
is in the barber's chair, yes, now we
have the clippers on him. And master
not even willing to throw a towel over
him to keep his clothes clean! Is it
going to be a close crop, I wonder, or

nescio; verum, si frugist, usque admutilabit probe.

Hegio

270 Quid tu? servosne esse an liber mavelis, memora mihi.

Philocr.

Proximum quod sit bono quodque a malo longissime,
id volo; quamquam non multum fuit molesta servitus,
nec mihi secus erat quam si essem familiaris filius.

Tynd.

Eugepae, Thalem talento non emam Milesium, nam ad sapientiam huius⁸ nimius nugator fuit. ut facete orationem ad servitutem contulit.

Hegio

Quo de genere natust illic Philocrates?

Philocr.

Polyplusio:

quod genus illi est unum pollens atque honoratissimum.

Hegio

Quid ipse hic? quo honore est illic?

Philocr.

279 Summo, atque ab

summis viris.⁹

Hegio

Quid divitiae, suntne opimae?

Philocr.

just a trim?—that's the question. If he knows his business, though, he'll dock him handsomely.

Hegio

See here, would you prefer to be a slave or a free man, tell me that?

Philocr.

The maximum of pleasure and the minimum of pain, that's my preference, sir; but being a slave hasn't bothered me much, though: I wasn't treated any differently than if I'd been a son of the house.

Tynd.

(aside) Well done my boy! I wouldn't buy Milesian Thales at a thousand thalers: why, he was nothing but the veriest amateur of a wise man compared with master here. How cleverly he's dropped into the servant jargon!

Hegio

Who are Philocrates' people there in Elis?

Philocr.

The Goldfields, sir,—the most influential and respected family in those parts easily.

Hegio

And the young man himself? How does he stand?

Philocr.

Very high indeed, sir,—belongs to the highest circles.

Hegio

How about his property? Pretty fat one, eh?

Philocr.

(281) Unde excoquat
sebum senex.

Hegio
Quid pater, vivitne?
Philocr.
Vivom, cum inde abimus,
liquimus;
nunc vivatne necne, id Orcum scire oportet
scilicet.
Tynd.
Salva res est, philosophatur quoque iam, non
mendax modo est.
Hegio
Quid erat ei nomen?
Philocr.
Thensaurochrysonicochrysides.
Hegio
Videlicet propter divitias inditum id nomen
quasi est.
Philocr.
Immo edepol propter avaritiam ipsius atque
audaciam.¹⁰ (287)
Hegio
Quid tu ais? tenaxne pater est eius?
Philocr.
pertinax;
290 quin etiam ut magis noscas: Genio suo ubi
quando sacrificat,
ad rem divinam quibus est opus, Samiis vasis
utitur,
ne ipse Genius surripiat: proinde aliis ut credat
vide.
Hegio

Fat? Old Goldfields could get
dripping out of it.
Hegio
What about his father? Is he living?
Philocr.
He was when we left home, whether
he's alive now or not, of course you
had better inquire below as to that, sir.
Tynd.
(aside) The situation is saved! Now
he not only lies but moralizes.
Hegio
What was his name?
Philocr.
Ducatsdoubloonsandpiecesofeightson.
Hegio
A sort of name applied to him on
account of his money, I take it.
Philocr.
(apparently struck by a new idea)
Lord, no! on account of his being so
greedy and grasping, sir.
Hegio
What's that? His father's rather close,
is he?
Philocr.
Close? My word, sir! he's adhesive!
Why, really,—just so as to give you a
better notion of him—whenever he
sacrifices to his own Guardian Spirit
he won't use any dishes needed in the
service except ones made of Samian
earthenware, for fear his very
Guardian Spirit may steal 'em. You
can see from this what a confiding
character he is in general.
Hegio

Sequere hac me igitur. eadem ego ex hoc quae volo exquaesivero.

Philocrates, hic fecit, hominem frugi ut facere oportuit.

nam ego ex hoc quo genere gnatus sis scio, hic fassus mihi;

haec tu eadem si confiteri vis, tua ex re feceris: quae tamen scio scire me ex hoc.

Tynd.

Fecit officium hic suum,
cum tibi est confessus verum, quamquam volui sedulo
meam nobilitatem occultare et genus et divitias meas,
300 Hegio; nunc quando patriam et libertatem perdidisti,
non ego istunc me potius quam te metuere aequom censeo.
vis hostilis cum istoc fecit meas opes aequabiles;
memini, cum dicto haud audebat: facto nunc laedat licet.

sed viden? fortuna humana fingit artatque ut lubet:
me, qui liber fuero servom fecit, e summo infimum;
qui imperare insueram, nunc alterius imperio obsequor.
et quidem si, proinde ut ipse fui imperator familiae,
habeam dominum, non verear ne iniuste aut graviter mi imperet.
Hegio, hoc te monitum, nisi forte ipse non vis, voluerim.

Hegio

Loquere audacter.

Well, well, come this way with me.
(*aside, as they join Tyndarus*) I'll soon get the information I want out of the master here at the same time. (to *Tyndarus*) Philocrates, your servant has acted as a worthy fellow ought to act. Yes, I know from him about your family: he has admitted everything. If you choose to be equally open with me, it will be to your advantage: however, I have been completely informed already by him.

Tynd.

(*with dignified melancholy*) He has done his duty in admitting the truth to you, much as I did wish to keep you in the dark, Hegio, about my rank and birth and wealth; now that I am a man without a country, a prisoner, I suppose it is not to be expected that he should stand more in awe of me than of you. The chances of war have put master and man on an equal footing. I remember the time when he did not venture to offend me by a word: now he is at liberty to do me an actual injury.

But you see! fortune moulds us, pinches us, to suit her whims: here am I, the one-time free man, a slave—tossed from the heights to the depths. Accustomed to command, I am now at another's beck and call. And indeed, if I might have such a master as I myself was when I was the head of a household, I should have no fear of being treated unjustly or harshly. There is one thing I should like to impress upon you, Hegio,—unless you object, maybe.

Hegio

No, no, speak out.

Tynd.

310 Tam ego fui ante liber quam
gnatus tuos,
tam mihi quam illi libertatem hostilis eripuit
manus.
tam ille apud nos servit, quam ego nunc his apud
te servio.
est profecto deus, qui quae nos gerimus auditque
et videt:
is, uti tu me his habueris, proinde illum illic
curaverit;
bene merenti bene profuerit, male merenti par
erit.
quam tu filium tuom, tam pater me meus
desiderat.

Hegio

Memini ego istuc. sed faterin eadem quae hic
fassust mihi?

Tynd.

Ego patri meo esse fateor summas divitias domi
meque summo genere gnatum. sed te optestor,
Hegio,
320 ne tuom animum avariozem faxint divitiae
meae:
ne patri, tam etsi sum unicus, decere videatur
magis,
me saturum servire apud te sumptu et vestitu tuo
potius quam illi, ubi minime honestumst,
mendicantem vivere.¹¹ (323)

Hegio

(325) Non ego omnino lucrum omne esse utile
homini existimo
scio ego, multos iam lucrum lutulentos homines
reddidit,
est etiam ubi profecto damnum praestet facere
quam lucrum.
odi ego aurum: multa multis saepe suasit
perperam.

Tynd.

Once I was free as your son; an
enemy's success deprived me of my
liberty as he was deprived of his; he is
a slave in my country as I am here
with you. There surely is a God who
hears and sees what we do: and
according to your treatment of me
here, so will he look after your son
there. He will reward the deserving
and requite the undeserving. Just as
you long for your son, so does my
father long for me.

Hegio

I know all that—but do you admit the
truth of what this fellow has told me?

Tynd.

I do admit that my father is a very
wealthy man at home and that I do
come of very good family. But,
Hegio, I beseech you, don't let my
wealth make your demands too
exorbitant: for my father, even though
I am his only son, might feel that it
was better for me to remain your
slave, well fed and clothed at your
expense, than to come to beggary
there at home where it would disgrace
us most.

Hegio

I am not a man who regards each and
every acquisition of money as a
blessing: plenty of people have been
tainted before now by this money
getting, I know that. There are even
times when it certainly is more
profitable to lose money than to make
it. Gold! I despise it: it has led many a
man into many a wrong course.

nunc hoc animum advorte, ut ea quae sentio
pariter scias.
330 filius meus illic apud vos servit captus Alide:
eum si reddis mihi, praeterea unum nummum ne
duis;
et te et hunc amittam hinc. alio pacto abire non
potes.

Tynd.

Optimum atque aequissum oras optumusque
hominum es homo.
sed is privatam servitutem servit illi an
publicam?

Hegio

Privatam medici Menarchi.

Tynd.

Pol is quidem huius est cliens.
tam hoc quidem tibi in proclivi quam amber est
quando pluit.

Hegio

Fac is homo ut redimatur.

Tynd.

Faciam. sed te id oro, Hegio—

Hegio

Quid vis, dum ab re ne quid ores, faciam.

Tynd.

Ausculata, tum scies.
ego me amitti, donecum ille huc redierit, non
postulo
340 verum quaeso ut aestumatum bunc mihi des,
quem mittam ad patrem
ut is homo redimatur illi.

Now give me your attention. I want
you to understand thoroughly what I
have in mind. (*slowly and
emphatically*) My son is a prisoner in
Elis, a slave there among your
countrymen: get him back to me, and
without your giving me a single
penny in addition, I will let you go
home, and your servant, too. On no
other terms can you get off.

Tynd.

A very fair and reasonable
proposition, sir, and you are the very
fairest of men. Does he belong to
some private person, though, or to the
state?

Hegio

To a private person, a doctor named
Menarchus.

Tynd.

(*aside*) Jove! why, he's a client of
master's! (*aloud*) Why, this will be
just as easy for you as rain when it
pours.

Hegio

Have him ransomed.

Tynd.

I will. But thus much I beg of you
Hegio,—

Hegio

(*eagerly*) Anything you please,
provided my interests don't suffer by
it.

Tynd.

Listen, and you can see if they will. I
don't ask to be released myself until
my servant gets back. But I do urge
you to let me have him under a
forfeit, to send to father so that your
son there can be ransomed.

Hegio

Immo alium potius misero
hunc, ubi erant indutiae, illuc, tuom qui
conveniat patrem,
qui tua quae tu iusseris mandata ita ut velis
perferat.

Tynd.

At nihil est ignotum ad illum mittere: operam
luseris.
hunc mitte, hic transactum reddet omne, si illuc
venerit.
nec quemquam fideliozem neque cui plus credat
potes
mittere ad eum nec qui magis sit servos ex
sententia,
neque adeo cui suom concredat filium hodie
audacius.
ne vereare, meo periclo huius ego experiar
fidem,
350 fretus ingenio eius, quod me esse scit erga se
benevolum.

Hegio

Mittam equidem istunc aestumatum tua fide, si
vis.

Tynd.

Volo;
quam citissime potest, tam hoc cedere ad factum
volo.

Hegio

Num quae causa est quin, si ille huc non redeat,
viginti minas
mihi des pro illo?

Tynd.

Optuma immo.

Hegio

Solvite istum nunciam,
atque utrumque.

Hegio

Oh no, I'll send some one else instead
when we have an armistice; that will
be preferable: he shall confer with
your father and carry out your orders
to your satisfaction.

Tynd.

But it's no good sending a stranger to
him: you'll have frittered away your
time. Send him: (*pointing to*
Philocrates) he will transact the
whole affair, once he gets there. You
can't send him a more reliable man,
one he would trust more, a servant
that's more to his mind; I may go so
far as to say there is no one he would
be readier to entrust his own son to.
Never fear: I will be responsible for
his fidelity. I can depend on his
goodness of heart; he appreciates my
kindness to him.

Hegio

Very well, I'll send him under a
forfeit, on your guarantee, if you
wish.

Tynd.

I do wish it. And I wish to have all
this an accomplished fact just as
quickly as possible.

Hegio

Have you any objection to paying me
eighty pounds for him in case he
doesn't return?

Tynd.

Not the slightest—fair as can be.

Hegio

(*to overseers*) Take the chains off that
fellow at once, off both of them, in
fact.

Tynd.

Di tibi omnis omnia optata offerant,
cum me tanto honore honestas cumque ex
vinclis eximis.
hoc quidem haud molestumst, iam quod collus
collari caret.

Hegio

Quod bonis bene fit beneficium, gratia ea
gravida est bonis.
nunc tu illum si illo es missurus, dice monstra
praecipe
quae ad patrem vis nuntiari. vin vocem huc ad
te?

Tynd.

360 Voca.

Tynd.

(*as slaves obey*) God grant your every
wish, sir, for your highly considerate
conduct toward me and for releasing
me. (*aside, stretching himself*) I tell
you what, it's no unpleasant sensation,
having that necklet off one's neck.

Hegio

"A good deed done a good man yields
a large return of good." Now if you
intend to send that fellow home,
inform him, instruct him, give him
full particulars as to the message he's
to carry your father. Shall I call him
over here to you?

Tynd.

Do.

II. 3.

Hegio

Quae res bene vortat mihi meoque filio
vobisque, volt te novos erus operam dare
tuo veteri domino, quod is velit, fideliter.
nam ego te aestumatum huic dedi viginti
minis,
his autem te ait mittere hinc velle ad patrem,
meum ut illic redimat filium, mutatio
inter me atque illum ut nostris fiat filiis.

Philocr.

Utroque vorsum rectumst ingenium meum,
ad te atque ad illum; pro rota me uti licet:
370 vel ego huc vel illic vortar, quo
imperabitis.

Hegio

Tute tibi tuopte ingenio prodes plurimum,
cum servitutum ita fers ut ferri decet.
sequere. em tibi hominem.

Scene 3.

Hegio

(*going to Philocrates*) God bless us all in
this, me, and my son, and yourselves! My
man, your new master wishes you to do
something your old master wishes, and to
do it faithfully. The fact is, I have given
you over to him, under an eighty pound
forfeit, he saying he desires to send you
off to his father and let him ransom my
son there in Elis, so that he may exchange
my boy for his own.

Philocr.

I'm quite disposed to do both of you a
good turn, sirs, you and him both; you
can use me like a wheel, I'll turn your
way or his, either way, wherever you like.

Hegio

And you are acting very much to your
own advantage in being so disposed, and
in accepting your slavery as you should.
Follow me. (*leading way to Tyndarus*)
There's your man.

Tynd.

Gratiam habeo tibi,
quom copiam istam mi et potestatem facis,
ut ego ad parentes hunc remittam nuntium,
qui me quid rerum his agitem et quid fieri
velim
patri meo, ordine omnem rem, illuc perferat.
nunc ita convenit inter me atque hunc,
Tyndare.
ut te aestumatum in Alidem mittam ad
patrem,
380 si non rebitas huc, ut viginti minas
dem pro te.

Philocr.

Recte convenisse sentio.
nam pater expectat aut me aut aliquem
nuntium,
qui hinc ad se veniat.

Tynd.

Ergo animum advortas
volo
quae nuntiare hinc te volo in patriam ad
patrem.

Philocr.

Philocrates, ut adhuc locorum feci, faciam
sedulo,
ut potissimum quod in rem recte conducatur
tuam,
id petam idque persequar corde et animo
atque viribus.

Tynd.

Facis ita ut te facere oportet. nunc animum
advortas volo:
omnium primum salutem dicito matri et
patri
390 et cognatis et si quem alium
benevolentem videris;
me hic valere et servitutem servire huic
homini optumo,

Tynd.

(*sedately*) I thank you, sir, for affording
me this opportunity, of making him my
messenger to my parents, so that he may
carry to my father a full account of me
and my situation here, and what I wish
him to see to.

(*turning to Philocrates*) Tyndarus, this
gentleman and I have just arranged that I
send you to Elis to father, under a forfeit:
if you fail to return, I am to pay him
eighty pounds for you.

Philocr.

And a good arrangement, too, in my
opinion. For the old gentleman's
expecting either me or some messenger to
come to him from here.

Tynd.

Well then, I wish you to pay attention to
the message I wish you to take home to
him.

Philocr.

I'll do the best I can for you, sir, just as I
always have: anything that makes for
your good, sir, I'll work my hardest for,
and follow up with all my heart and soul
and strength.

Tynd.

The proper spirit. Now I wish you to pay
attention. First of all, remember me to my
father and mother and my relatives and
anyone else you may see who is
interested in my welfare; tell them I am in
good health here and a slave of this most
estimable gentleman who has always
accorded me the (*with emphasis*) very

qui me honore honestiorem semper fecit et facit.

Philocr.

Istuc ne praecipias, facile memoria memini tamen.

Tynd.

Nam equidem, nisi quod custodem habeo, liberum me esse arbitror.
dicito patri, quo pacto mihi cum hoc convenerit
de huius filio.

Philocr.

Quae memini, mora mera est monerier.

Tynd.

Ut eum redimat et remittat nostrum huc amborum vicem.

Philocr.

Meminero.

Hegio

At quamprimum pote: istuc in rem utriquest maxime.

Philocr.

Non tuom tu magis videre quam ille suom gnatum cupit.

Hegio

Meus mihi, suos cuique est carus.

Philocr.

400 Numquid aliud vis

patri
nuntiari?

Tynd.

Me hic valere et—tute audacter dicito,
Tyndare—inter nos fuisse ingenio haud discordabili,

extraordinary consideration which I still enjoy.

Philocr.

No instructions needed along that line, sir: I can remember to mind that easily enough, without.

Tynd.

For really, aside from the fact that I have a guard, I feel that I am a free man. Tell my father what arrangement this gentleman and I have made regarding his son.

Philocr.

Mere waste of time, sir, to remind me of what I remember.

Tynd.

That he is to ransom him and send him back here in exchange for us both.

Philocr.

I'll remember.

Hegio

Yes, but just as quickly as possible: that's of the highest importance to each of us.

Philocr.

You don't long to see your son any more than he does his, sir.

Hegio

My son is dear to me, as his own son is to every father.

Philocr.

No further message for him, eh?

Tynd.

(*somewhat at a loss*) Say I am in good health here, and—(*earnestly*) Tyndarus, speak up boldly to him, yourself,—say that we have never been at variance, that I have never had reason to find fault with

neque te commeruisse culpam—neque me
adversatum tibi—
beneque ero gessisse morem in tantis
aerumnis tamen;

neque med umquam deseruisse te neque
factis neque fide,
rebus in dubiis egenis. haec pater quando
sciet,
Tyndare, ut fueris animatus erga suum
gnatum atque se,
numquam erit tam avarus, quin te gratis
emittat manu¹²;
et mea opera, si hinc rebito, faciam ut faciat
facilius.

410 nam tua opera et comitate et virtute et
sapientia
fecisti ut redire liceat ad parentis denuo,
cum apud hunc confessus es et genus et
divitias meas:
quo pacto emisisti e vinclis tuorum tuam
sapientiam.

Philocr.

Feci ego ista ut commemoras, et te
meminisse id gratum est mihi.
merito tibi ea venerunt a me; nam nunc,
Philocrates,
si ego item memorem quae me erga multa
fecisti bene,
nox diem adimat; nam quasi servos meos
esses, nihilo setius
tu mihi obsequiosus semper fuisti.

Hegio

Di vostram
fidem,
hominum ingenium liberale. ut lacrimas
excutiunt mihi.
420 videas corde amare inter se. quantis
lautus laudibus
suum eorum servos collaudavit.

Tynd.

you (nor you to think me obstinate) and
that you have served your master to the
full even in such adversity.

Say that a treacherous act, a disloyal
thought were things undreamed of even
in the dark hours of distress. When my
father knows of this, Tyndarus, knows
what your spirit toward his son and
himself has been, he will never be so
niggardly as not to set you free at his own
expense; and if I return, I will put forth
my own efforts to make him the more
ready to do it.

For it is through your efforts and good
will and devotion and wisdom that I have
a chance to go back to my parents once
more, inasmuch as you informed this
gentleman of my family and wealth:
thanks to your wisdom in doing so, your
master's fetters have been removed.

Philocr.

Right you are, sir, so I did, and I'm glad
you remember it. You deserve anything
I've done for you, too; why, sir, if I was to
go on like that now and mention how
many good turns you've done me, it
would take all day and more; why, it was
just as if you had been my slave, not a bit
different, the deferential way you've
always treated me.

Hegio

(*half aside*) Bless my soul, what noble
natures! Dear, dear, it brings the tears to
my eyes! You can see they are simply
devoted to each other, The way that
splendid slave praised his own master—a
perfect panegyric!

Tynd.

Pol istic me haud
centesimam
partem laudat quam ipse meritust ut
laudetur laudibus.

Hegio

Ergo cum optume fecisti, nunc adest occasio
bene facta cumulare, ut erga hunc rem geras
fideliter.

Philocr.

Magis non factum possum velle, quam
opera experiar persequi;
id ut scias, Iovem supremum testem laudo,
Hegio.
me infidelem non futurum Philocrati.

Hegio

homo.

Philocr.

Nec me secus umquam ei facturum
quicquam quam memet mihi.

Tynd.

Istaec dicta te experiri et operis et factis
volo;
430 et, quo minus dixi quam volui de te,
animum advortas volo,
atque horunc verborum causa caveto mi
iratus fuas;
sed, te quaeso, cogitato hinc mea fide mitti
domum
te aestimatum, et meam esse vitam hic pro
te positam pignori,

ne tu me ignores, quom extemplo meo e
conspectu abscesseris,
quom me servom in servitute pro ted hic
reliqueris,
tuque te pro libero esse ducas, pignus
deseras

Heavens, sir, he doesn't praise me a
hundredth part as much as he deserves to
be praised himself.

Hegio

(to *Philocrates*) Well then, having been
such an excellent servant, here is an
opportunity to crown your services by
carrying through this business for him
faithfully.

Philocr.

I'll be just as keen in actually trying to do
it as I can be for wanting it done, sir; and
to prove it, sir, I swear by God Almighty
that I'll never be unfaithful to *Philocrates*
—

Hegio

(heartily) Worthy fellow!

Philocr.

—or ever act any differently by him than
I would by my own self.

Tynd.

(with increased earnestness) It is the
actual performance, the deed, I wish to
test those words by; and inasmuch as I
said less than I wished about your
conduct, I wish you to pay particular
attention,—yes, and be sure not to take
offence at what I say. But I beg you, do
bear in mind the fact that you are being
sent off home, sent home at my risk and
under a forfeit, and that I am staking my
life for you here:

so don't forget me the moment you are
out of sight, when you have left me here
in servitude, a slave, in your stead; and
don't consider yourself a free man and let
your promise go and fail to save me by
bringing back this gentleman's son. Be
faithful, I entreat you, to one who has

neque des operam pro me ut huius reducem
facias filium.¹³ (437)

(439) fac fidelis sis fideli, cave fidem fluxam
geras:

440 nam pater, scio, faciet quae illum facere
oportet omnia;

serva tibi in perpetuum amicum me, atque
hunc inventum inveni.

haec per dexteram tuam te dextera retinens
manu

opsecro, infidelior mihi ne fuas quam ego
sum tibi.

tu hoc age. tu mihi erus nunc es, tu
patronus, tu pater,

tibi commendo spes opesque meas.

Philocr.

Mandavisti satis

satin habes, mandata quae sunt facta si
refero?

Tynd.

Satis.

Philocr.

Et tua et tua huc ornatus reveniam ex
sententia.

numquid aliud?

Tynd.

Ut quam primum possis redeas.

Philocr.

Res

monet.

Hegio

Sequere me, viaticum ut dem a trapezita
tibi,

eadem opera a praetore sumam
syngraphum.

Tynd.

450 Quem

syngraphum?

shown his faith, and don't falter in that
faithfulness. As for my father, I am sure
he will do everything he should do. For
your part, keep me your friend for ever,
and do not lose this friend (*indicating
Hegio*) you have found.

This I beseech you by this hand (*grasping
Philocrates' right hand*), this hand I hold
in mine: don't be less true to me than I am
to you. (*after a pause*) Well, to the work!
You are my master now, my protector, my
father, you and you only: to you I
commend my hopes and my welfare.

Philocr.

Enough commands, sir. Will you be
satisfied, if I turn your commands to
accomplished facts?

Tynd.

Yes.

Philocr.

I'll come back here equipped to suit you
(*to Hegio*) sir, and you, (*to Tyndarus*) too.
Nothing else?

Tynd.

Return as soon as you can.

Philocr.

Naturally, sir.

Hegio

(*to Philocrates*) Follow me. I must go to
the banker's and give you some money
for travelling expenses: I'll get a passport
from the praetor at the same time.

Tynd.

What passport?

Hegio

Quem hic ferat secum ad legionem, hinc ire
huic ut liceat domum.
tu intro abi.

Tynd.

Ben ambulato.

Philocr.

Bene vale.

Hegio

Edepol rem
meam
constabilivi, quom illos emi de praeda a
quaestoribus;
expedivi ex servitute filium, si dis placet,
at etiam dubitavi, hos homines emerem an
non emerem, diu.
servate istum sultis intus, servi, ne quoquam
pedem
ecferat sine custodela. iam ego apparebo
domi;
ad fratrem modo captivos alios inviso meos,
eadem percontabor, ecquis hunc
adulescentem noverit.
460 sequere tu, te ut amittam; ei rei primum
praeverti volo.

Hegio

One to take to the army with him so that
he'll be allowed to go off home. As for
yourself, you go inside.

Tynd.

(*to Philocrates*) A good journey to you.

Philocr.

Good-bye, sir, good-bye!

[EXIT *Tyndarus* INTO *Hegio's* HOUSE.]

Hegio

(*aside, in high spirits*) Well, well, well, it
was the making of me when I bought
those two from the commissioners! I've
set my son at Liberty, God willing! And
to think I hesitated for a long time
whether to buy them or not!

(*to overseers*) Please keep an eye on that
prisoner inside there, my lads, and don't
let him set a foot out here anywhere
without a guard. I shall soon be home
myself. I'll just step over to my brother's
for a look at my other captives: at the
same time I'll inquire if any one of them
knows this young gentleman. (*to*
Philocrates) Come, my man, so that I
may send you off; I want to attend to that
first.

[EXEUNT *Hegio* AND *Philocrates*.]

ACTVS III

Erg.

Miser homo est, qui ipse sibi quod edit
quaerit et id aegre invenit,
sed ille est miserior, qui et aegre quaerit
et nihil invenit;
ille miserrimus, qui cum esse cupit, tum
quod edit non habet.
nam hercle ego huic die, si liceat, oculos
effodiam libens,
ita malignitate oneravit omnis mortalis
mihi;
neque ieiuniosorem neque magis
ecfertum fame
vidi nec quoi minus procedat quidquid
facere occeperit,
ita venter gutturque resident esurialis
ferias.
ilicet parasiticae arti maximam malam
crucem,
470 ita iuventus iam ridicules inopesque
ab se segregat.
nil morantur iam Lacones unisubsellii
viros,
plagipatidas, quibus sunt verba sine penu
et pecunia
eos requirunt, qui libenter, quom ederint,
reddant domi;
ipsi obsonant, quae parasitorum ante erat
provincia,
ipsi de foro tam aperto capite ad lenones
eunt
quam in tribu aperto capite sontes
condemnant reos;

ACT III

(An hour has elapsed.)

ENTER *Ergasilus*, MUCH DEPRESSED.

Erg.

It's sad when a man has to spend his
time looking for his food and has hard
work finding it. It's sadder, though,
when he has hard work looking for it
and doesn't find it. But it's saddest of
all when a man is pining to eat, and no
food in range. By gad, if I only could,
I'd like to dig the eyes out of this day,
it's made every living soul so
damnably mean to me!

A more hungriful day, a more bulged-
out-with-starvation day, a more
unprogressive day for every
undertaking, I never did see! Such a
famine feast as my inside is having!
Devil take the parasitical profession!
How the young fellows nowadays do
sheer off from impecunious wits!

Not a bit of use have they nowadays
for us Spartans, us valiant
benchenders, us descendants of old
Takesacuff, whose capital is talk
without cash and comestibles. The
guests they're after are the ones that
enjoy a dinner and then like to return
the compliment. They do their
marketing themselves, too,—that used
to be the parasites' province—and
away they go from the forum
themselves to interview the pimps, just
as barefaced as they are in court when

neque ridiculos iam terrunci faciunt, sese omnes amant.

nam uti dudum hinc abii, accessi ad adulescentes in foro.

"salvete" inquam. "quo imus una" inquam "ad prandium?" atque illi tacent.

480 "quid ait 'hoc' aut quis profitetur?" inquam. quasi muti silent, neque me rident. "ubi cenamus?" inquam. atque illi abnuont.

dico unum ridiculum dictum de dictis melioribus,
quibus solebam menstruales epulas ante adipiscier:
nemo ridet; scivi extemplo rem de compecto geri;
ne canem quidem irritatam voluit quisquam imitarier,
saltem, si non arriderent, dentes ut restringerent.

abeo ab illis, postquam video me sic ludificarier;
pergo ad alios, venio ad alios, deinde ad alios: una res.
omnes de compecto rem agunt, quasi in Velabro olearii.
490 nunc redeo inde, quoniam me ibi video ludificarier.
item alii parasiti frustra obambulabant in foro.

nunc barbarica lege certumst ius meum omne persequi:
qui consilium iniere, quo nos victu et vita prohibeant,
is diem dicam, inrogabo multam. ut mihi cenas decem

they condemn guilty defendants. They don't care a farthing for wits these days: they're egoists, every one.

Why, when I left here a little while ago, I went up to some young fellows in the forum. "Good day," says I. "Where are we going to lunch together?" says I. Sudden silence. "Who says: 'This way'? Who makes a bid?" says I. Dumb as mutes, didn't even give me a smile. "Where do we dine?" says I. A shaking of heads.

I told 'em a funny story—one of my best, that used to find me free board for a month. Nobody smiled. I saw in a moment it was a put-up job; not a one of 'em was even willing to act like a cross dog and at least show their teeth, no matter if they wouldn't laugh.

I left 'em after I saw I was being made a fool of this way, up I went to some others, and then to others, and to others still,—same story. They're all in a combination, just like the oil dealers in the Velabrum. [C](#) So here I am back again, seeing I was trifled with there. Some more parasites were prowling round the forum all for nothing, too.

Now I'm going to have the foreign law on those chaps and demand my full rights, I certainly am: it's conspiracy, conspiracy to deprive us of sustenance and life, and I'm going to summon 'em, fine 'em—make 'em give me ten dinners, at my discretion, and that will

meo arbitrato dent, cum cara annona sit.
sic egero.
nunc ibo ad portum hinc: est illic mi una
spes cenatica;
si ea decolabit, redibo huc ad senem ad
cenam asperam.

III. 2.

Hegio

Quid est suavius, quam bene
rem gerere,
bono publico, sic ut ego feci heri,
500 cum emi hosce homines:
ubi quisque vident,
eunt obviam gratulanturque eam
rem,
ita me miserum restitendo
retinendoque lassum
reddiderunt:
vix ex gratulando miser iam
eminebam.

tandem abii ad praetorem; ibi vix
requievi:
rogo syngraphum, datur mi ilico; dedi
Tyndaro: ille abiit domum.
inde ilico praevortor domum,
postquam id actum est;
eo protinus ad fratrem, mei ubi sunt alii
captivi.

rogo, Philocratem ex Alide ecquis
hominum
510 noverit: tandem his exclamat, eum
sibi esse sodalem;

be when food is dear. That's how I'll
catch them. (*turning to go*) Well, now
for the harbour. That's where my one
hope is, gastronomically speaking, if
that oozes away, I'll come back here to
the old man's terror of a meal.

[EXIT *Ergasilus*, LOOKING IN ALL
DIRECTIONS FOR A POSSIBLE HOST.]

Scene 2.

ENTER *Hegio* WITH *Aristophontes* AND
Slaves.

Hegio

(*highly pleased with himself*) Now
what makes you feel better than
managing your affairs properly and
contributing to the common good, just
as I did yesterday in buying these
prisoners? Whenever anyone sees me
up he comes and congratulates me on
it! Dear, dear! I was so worn out with
all their stopping and detaining me, it
got to be frightfully hard work
emerging from the flood of
felicitations.

At last I escaped to the praetor's.
Barely waiting to catch my breath, I
asked for a passport, got it on the spot,
gave it to Tyndarus: he's off for home.
After seeing to that, I first start straight
for home. Then I go on to my brother's
where the rest of my prisoners are.

Inquire if any one of 'em knows
Philocrates of Elis. Finally this fellow
(*pointing to Aristophontes*) calls out
that Philocrates is a particular friend of
his. I tell him he's at my house; the

dico eum esse apud me; hic extemplo
orat obsecratque,
eum sibi ut liceat videre:
iussi ilico hunc exsolvi. nunc tu
sequere me,
ut quod me oravisti impetres, eum
hominem uti convenias.

III. 3.

Tynd.

Nunc illud est, cum me fuisse quam esse
nimio mavelim:
nunc spes opes auxiliaque a me
segregant spernuntque se.
hic illest dies, cum nulla vitae meae salus
sperabilest,
neque exitium¹⁴ exitio est neque adeo
spes, quae mi hunc aspellat metum,
nec subdolis mendaciis mihi usquam
mantellum est meis,¹⁵ 520
(522) neque deprecatio perfidiis meis nec
male factis fuga est.
nec confidentiae usquam hospitium est
nec deverticulum dolis:
operta quae fuere aperta sunt, patent
praestigiae,
omnis res palam est, neque de hac re
negotium est,
quin male occidam oppetamque pestem
eri vicem meamque.
perdidit me Aristophontes hic qui venit
modo intro:¹⁶
is me novit, is sodalis Philocrati et
cognatus est.
neque iam Salus servare, si volt, me
potest, nec copia est,

next instant he's begging and
beseeching me for a chance to see
him. I had him unfettered at once. (to
Aristophontes) Now, sir, come this
way, so as to obtain your request and
meet your friend.

[EXEUNT INTO HOUSE: AS THEY GO IN
Tyndarus RUSHES OUT.]

Scene 3.

Tynd.

(*grimly*) Now's the time when I should
infinitely prefer to be underground
than on it! Hope, resources, help—all
deserting, all leaving me in the lurch
now! My day has come: I can never
hope to get out of this alive. Done for,
and nothing to be done for it! There's
no prospect of staving off the danger,
either, and not a thing to drape my
crafty lies with.

My falsehoods can't beg themselves
off, or my transgressions take to their
heels: no lodgings anywhere for brass:
guile can't find accommodations. The
covert's uncovered, our plot's
apparent, everything's out. There's
nothing to do about it: I must drop off
disagreeably, and come to a painful
end for master—also for myself.

He's been the ruin of me, this
Aristophontes that just went inside: he
knows me: he's a particular friend of
Philocrates, related to him, too.
Salvation herself can't save me now, if
she so desires: there's no chance
unless I can invent some clever

530 nisi si aliquam corde
machinor astutiam.
quam, malum? quid machiner?
quid comminiscar? maxumas
nugas ineptus incipisso. haereo.

III. 4.

Hegio

Quo illum nunc hominem proripuisse
foras se dicam ex aedibus?

Tynd.

Nunc enim vero ego occidi: eunt ad te
hostes, Tyndare.
quid loquar? quid fabulabor? quid negabo
aut quid fatebor?
mihi res omnis in incerto sita est. quid
rebus confidam meis?
utinam te di prius perderent, quam periisti
e patria tua,
Aristophontes, qui ex parata re imparatam
omnem facis.
occisa est haec res, nisi reperio atrocem
mi aliquam astutiam.

Hegio

Sequere. em tibi hominem. adi, atque
adloquere.

Tynd.

540 Quis homo est me
hominum miserior?

Arist.

Quid istuc est quod meos te dicam
fugitare oculos, Tyndare,

scheme. But what, curse it? What can I
invent? What can I devise? (*reflecting,*
then doubtfully) Oh, this is awful
nonsense I'm at, poor simpleton!
(*disgustedly*) Stuck!

Scene 4.

ENTER *Hegio, Aristophontes, AND*
Slaves.

Hegio

Where did that fellow bolt for out of
the house just now, I wonder?

Tynd.

(*aside*) It's all over with me, all over
with me now: the enemy are upon
you, Tyndarus! What shall I say?
What story shall I tell? What shall I
deny—or what admit? It's a shaky
business for me on every side! What
faith can I put in my luck? Oh, I wish
the gods had made away with you
before you made away from home,
Aristophontes,—upsetting my settled
plan completely! The game is up,
unless I hit upon some awfully clever
scheme.

Hegio

(*to Aristophontes, on seeing Tyndarus*)
Come along! There's your man! Go up
and speak to him!

Tynd.

(*aside, as Aristophontes approaches*)
What mortal man is in a more
confounded hole than this? (*pretends*
not to recognize him)

Arist.

I wonder what you mean by this,
Tyndarus,—avoiding my eye and

proque ignoto me aspernari, quasi me
numquam noveris?
equidem tam sum servos quam tu, etsi ego
domi liber fui,
tu usque a puero servitutem servivisti in
Alide.

Hegio

Edepol minime miror, si te fugitat aut
oculos tuos,
aut si te odit, qui istum appelles
Tyndarum pro Philocrate.

Tynd.

Hegio, hic homo rabiosus habitus est in
Alide,
ne tu quod istic fabuletur auris immittas
tuas.
nam istis hastis insectatus est domi
matrem et patrem,
550 et illic isti qui inspuitur morbus
interdum venit.
proin tu ab istoc procul recedas.

Hegio

Ultro istum a me.

Arist.

Ain,
verbero?
me rabiosum atque insectatum esse hastis
meum memoras patrem,
et eum morbum mi esse, ut qui me opus
sit inspuitarier?

Hegio

Ne verere, multos iste morbus homines
macerat,
quibus inspuitari saluti fuit atque is
profuit.

Arist.

snubbing me as a stranger, quite as if
you never knew me? I'm just as much
of a slave as you are, to be sure, but at
home I was free: as for you, you've
been slaving it in Elis from your
boyhood up.

Hegio

Bless my soul! I'm not a bit surprised
if he avoids you, or your eye, no, nor
if he detests you, when you call him
Tyndarus instead of Philocrates.

Tynd.

(*dragging Hegio aside*) Hegio, this
fellow was looked upon as a raving
maniac in Elis, so don't you let him fill
your ears with his babble. Why, at
home he chased his father and mother
about with a spear, and every once in a
while he has an attack of the disease
that people spit on.^D So get out of his
reach, then,—well away.

Hegio

(to slaves) Keep him off! Keep him
off!

Arist.

What's that, you rascal? I'm a raving
maniac and chased my own father
with a spear, you say? I have the
disease that calls for my being spat
upon?

Hegio

(*cheerily*) Never you mind! Many a
man's consumed by that disease of
yours, who's been helped by being
spat on, and it's brought him through.

Arist.

Quid tu autem? etiam huic credis?

Hegio

Quid ego credam huic?

Arist.

Insanum

esse me?

Tynd.

Viden tu hunc, quam inimico voltu
intuetur? concedi optumumst,
Hegio: fit quod tibi ego dixi, gliscit
rabies, cave tibi.

Hegio

Credidi esse insanum extemplo, ubi te
appellavit Tyndarum.

Tynd.

560 Quin suom ipse interdum ignorat
nomen neque scit qui siet.

Hegio

At etiam te suom sodalem esse aibat.

Tynd.

Haud vidi

magis.

et quidem Alcumeus atque Orestes et
Lycurgus postea
una opera mihi sunt sodales qua iste.

Arist.

At etiam,

furcifer,
male loqui mi audes? non ego te novi?

Hegio

Pol planum id

quidem est,

(*to Hegio, hotly*) How's this? You,
too? Do you actually believe him?

Hegio

Believe him in what?

Arist.

That I'm insane?

Tynd.

(*to Hegio*) Do you see him—that
angry glare of his? You'd better leave,
Hegio. It's just as I said: a fit's coming
on. Look out for yourself!

Hegio

(*hastily moving farther off*) I thought
so, I thought he was crazy, from the
moment he called you Tyndarus.

Tynd.

Why, at times he positively forgets his
own name and doesn't know who he
is.

Hegio

But he was even saying you were an
intimate friend of his.

Tynd.

(*dryly*) Quite so! And the fact is that
Alcumeus,^E in that case, and Orestes,^E
and Lycurgus^E too are intimate friends
of mine, just exactly as much.

Arist.

Ha! You scoundrel, do you dare go on
maligning me? Don't I know you?

Hegio

Good heavens! It's quite plain you
don't know him—calling him

non novisse, qui istum appelles Tyndarum
pro Philocrate.
quem vides, eum ignoras: illum nominas
quem non vides.

Arist.

Immo iste eum sese ait, qui non est, esse,
et qui vero est, negat.

Tynd.

Tu enim repertu's, Philocratem qui
superes veriverbio.

Arist.

Pol ego ut rem video, tu inventu's, vera
vanitudine
qui convincas. sed quaeso hercle, agedum
aspice ad me.

Tynd.

Em.

Arist.

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Dic modo:
tun negas te Tyndarum esse?

Tynd.

Nego, inquam.

Arist.

Tun te

Philocratem
esse ais?

Tynd.

Ego, inquam.

Arist.

Tune huic credis?

Hegio

Tyndarus instead of Philocrates! The
man you see you don't know: you
name the man you don't see.

Arist.

No, sir! This fellow says he's the man
he isn't, and says he isn't the man he
really is.

Tynd.

(to Aristophontes, meaningly) So you
have turned up to beat Philocrates in
stating facts!

Arist.

Good Lord! As I look at it, you have
been unearthed to browbeat facts by
stating falsehoods. But come now,
confound it, look me in the eye!

Tynd.

(doing so coolly) Well?

Arist.

Now tell me: do you deny that you are
Tyndarus?

Tynd.

I do, certainly.

Arist.

You claim to be Philocrates, you?

Tynd.

I certainly do.

Arist.

(to Hegio, exasperated) Do you
believe him?

Hegio

Plus quidem
quam tibi aut mihi.
nam ille quidem, quem tu hunc memoras
esse, hodie hinc abiit Alidem
ad patrem huius.

Arist.

Quem patrem, qui servos est?

Tynd.

Et tu
quidem
servos es, liber fuisti, et ego me confido
fore,
si huius huc reconciliasso in libertatem
filium.

Arist.

Quid ais, furcifer? tun te gnatum esse
memoras liberum?

Tynd.

Non equidem me Liberum, sed
Philocratem esse aio.

Arist.

Quid
est?
ut scelestus, Hegio, nunc iste te ludos
facit.
nam is est servos ipse, neque praeter se
umquam
580 ei servos fuit.

Tynd.

Quia tute ipse eges in patria nec tibi qui
vivas domist,
omnis inveniri similis tui vis; non mirum
facis:
est miserorum, ut malevolentes sint atque
invideant bonis.

More than I do you, surely,—or
myself. For you see, the fellow you
tell me this man is—he went away to
Elis to-day to this man's father.

Arist.

(*contemptuously*) Father! What do you
mean, when he's a slave?

Tynd.

Well, you, too, are a slave and once
were free: and (*with emphasis*) I hope
to be so myself, when I have restored
this gentleman's son to home and
liberty.

Arist.

What's that, you villain? You tell me
you were born a freeman?

Tynd.

No indeed, my name is not Freeman,
but Philocrates, that's what I say.

Arist.

What's all this? How the rascal's
making game of you, Hegio! Why he's
a slave himself—the only one he ever
had.

Tynd.

(*superior*) Just because you yourself
are poverty- stricken in your own
country, with nothing at home to live
on, you want to have every one else
put in the same list. There is nothing
strange in that: it is characteristic of

Crucior.

Tynd.

Ardent oculi: fit
opus, Hegio;
viden tu illi maculari corpus totum
maculis luridis?
atra bilis agitat hominem.

Arist.

At pol te, si hic
sapiat senex,
pix atra agitet apud carnificem tuoque
capiti inluceat.

Tynd.

Iam deliramenta loquitur, laruae stimulant
virum.
hercle qui, si hunc comprehendi iusseris,
sapias magis.

Arist.

600 Crucior, lapidem non habere me, ut illi
mastigiaie
cerebrum excutiam, qui me insanum
verbis concinnat suis.

Tynd.

Audin lapidem quaeritare?

Arist.

Solus te solum
volo,
Hegio.

Hegio

Instinc loquere, si quid vis, procul
tamen audiam.

Tynd.

Oh, this is driving me wild!

Tynd.

His eyes are blazing! He's having one,
Hegio! See how his whole body is
covered with lurid spots? It's black
fury that's tormenting the fellow!

Arist.

Now, by the Lord, if this old
gentleman did the wise thing, it's
black pitch that would torment you at
the executioner's, and light up that
head of yours!

Tynd.

Now he's got to the raving point! Evil
spirits are hounding the man, Hegio.
Heavens! You'd do more wisely to
have him seized!

Arist.

Oh, damnation! not to have a stone to
knock out the brains of this
blackguard that's driving me mad with
his talk!

Tynd.

Hear that—looking for a stone!

Arist.

(*struggling to contain himself*) Hegio,
I want a word with you all alone.

Hegio

(*timorously*) Say it from there, if
there's anything you want—from
away off there. I shall hear it all the
same.

Tynd.

Namque edepol si ad bites propius, os
denasabit tibi
mordicus.

Arist.

Neque pol me insanum,
Hegio, esse creduis
neque fuisse umquam, neque esse
morbum quem istic autumat.
verum si quid metuis a me, iube me
vinciri: volo,
dum istic itidem vinciat.

Tynd.

Immo enim vero,
Hegio,
istic, qui volt, vinciat.

Arist.

Tace modo. ego te,
Philocrates
false, faciam ut verus hodie reperiare
Tyndarus.
quid mi abnutas?

Tynd.

Tibi ego abnuto?

Arist.

Quid agat, si absis
longius?

Hegio

Quid ais? quid si adeam hunc insanum?

Tynd.

Nugas.
ludificabitur,
garriet quoi neque pes umquam neque
caput compareat.
ornamenta absunt: Aiacem, hunc cum
vides, ipsum vides.

That's right, by Jove! for if you go any
nearer, he'll bite your nose off.

Arist.

Heavens and earth, Hegio! don't
believe I'm insane, or that I have, or
ever had, the disease he's talking
about. However, if you're at all afraid
of me, have me tied up. I am willing,
provided that fellow is tied up too.

Tynd.

No indeed, Hegio, certainly not, tie up
the fellow that wants it.

Arist.

You keep still, now! I'll soon show
you up, you false Philocrates, for the
real Tyndarus. (*Tyndarus makes signs
to him behind Hegio's back*) What, are
you shaking your head at me for?

Tynd.

I shaking my head at you?

Arist.

(*to Hegio*) What would he do, if you
were farther off?

Hegio

See here, what if I should step up to
this lunatic?

Tynd.

Ridiculous! He'll make a fool of you,
jabbering something without head or
tail to it. Look at this fellow, and
you're looking at a regular Ajax^F—all
but the make-up.

Hegio

Nihili facio. tamen adibo.

Tynd.

Nunc ego omnino
occidi,
nunc ego inter sacrum saxumque sto, nec
quid faciam scio.

Hegio

Do tibi operam, Aristophontes, si quid est
quod me velis.

Arist.

Ex me audibis vera quae nunc falsa
opinare, Hegio.
620 sed hoc primum, me expurigare tibi
volo. me insaniam
neque tenere neque mi esse ullum
morbum, nisi quod servio.
at ita me rex deorum atque hominum faxit
patriae compotem,
ut istic Philocrates non magis est quam
aut ego aut tu.

Hegio

Eho dic
mihi,
quis illic igitur est?

Arist.

Quem dudum dixi a
principio tibi.
hoc si secus reperies, nullam causam dico
quin mihi
et parentum et libertatis apud te deliquio
siet.

Hegio

Quid tu ais?

Hegio

I don't care. I'm going to step up to
him just the same. (*approaches*
Aristophontes hesitantly)

Tynd.

(*aside*) Now I'm done for entirely.
Now I'm between the axe and the
altar, and what to do I don't know.

Hegio

I'm at your service, Aristophontes, if
there's anything you want of me.

Arist.

I'll show you, Hegio, that all this you
take for a lie is the truth. But first I
want to clear myself with you, and
assure you that I am not insane, and
have no affliction except captivity.
And now,—(*solemnly*) so may the
King of heaven and earth restore me
to my native land,—that fellow is no
more Philocrates than you or I.

Hegio

(*impressed*) Hey? Tell me, who is he
then?

Arist.

The man I told you he was to begin
with, a while ago. If you find it
otherwise, I make no objection to
forfeiting my parents and my liberty
and staying here with you.

Hegio

(*to Tyndarus*) And you—what have
you to say?

Tynd.

Me tuom esse servom et te
meum erum.

Hegio

istuc rogo.
fuistin liber?

Tynd.

Fui.

Arist.

Enim vero non fuit,
nugas agit.

Tynd.

Qui tu scis? an tu fortasse fuisti meae
matri obstetrix,
qui id tam audacter dicere audes?

Arist.

630 Puerum te
vidi puer.

Tynd.

At ego te video maior maiorem: em
rursum tibi.
meam rem non cures, si recte facis. num
ego curo tuam?

Hegio

Fuitne huic pater
Thensaurochrysonicochrysides?

Arist.

Non fuit, neque ego istuc nomen umquam
audivi ante hunc diem
Philocrati Theodoromedes fuit pater.

Tynd.

Pereo
probe

Tynd.

(*urbanely*) That I am your servant, and
that you are my master.

Hegio

(*impatiently*) That isn't what I'm
asking about. Were you a freeman?

Tynd.

I was.

Arist.

He certainly was not. Absurd!

Tynd.

(*superciliously*) How do you know?
Or were you my mother's midwife,
perhaps, that you venture to speak
with such assurance on this point?

Arist.

I saw you when we were both boys.

Tynd.

Well, I see you now we are both
grown-ups. There's one for you! You
wouldn't meddle with my business, if
you behaved decently. I don't meddle
with yours, do I?

Hegio

Wasn't his father called
Ducatsdoubloonsandpiecesofeightson?

Arist.

No sir, he was not, and I never heard
that name before to-day. The father of
Philocrates was Theodoromedes.

Tynd.

(*aside, dryly*) I'm jolly well done for.
Stop your noise, will you, heart? Go to

quin quiescis? idie rectum cor meum, ac
suspende te.
tu sussultas, ego miser vix asto prae
formidine.

Hegio

Satin istuc mihi exquisitum est, fuisse
hunc servom in Alide
neque esse hunc Philocratem?

Arist.

Tam satis quam
numquam hoc invenies secus.
sed ubi is nunc est?

Hegio

640 Ubi ego mimime
atque ipse se volt maxime
sed vide sis.

Arist.

Quin exploratum dico et
provisum hoc tibi.

Hegio

Certon?

Arist.

Quin nihil, inquam, invenies
magis hoc certo certus.
Philocrates iam inde usque amicus fuit
mihi a puero puer.

Hegio

Tum igitur ego deruncinatus, deartuatus
sum miser
huius scelesti techinis, qui me ut lubitum
est ductavit dolis
sed qua faciest tuos sodalis Philocrates?

Arist.

Dicam
tibi

the deuce, and be hanged to you!
Jumping up and down, while I, poor
devil, can hardly stand for fear!

Hegio

Am I to take it as absolutely clear that
this fellow was a slave in Elis, that he
is not Philocrates?

Arist.

So absolutely that you'll never find it
to be anything different. But where is
Philocrates at present?

Hegio

(savagely) Where I least want him,
and he most wants to be. Do, do, see if
there's not some mistake, though.

Arist.

No, I'm sure of my ground and fully
informed in what I tell you.

Hegio

You're certain?

Arist.

You'll never find a deader certainty
than this, I assure you. Philocrates has
been a friend of mine ever since he
was a boy.

Hegio

So then, I've been trimmed, torn limb
from limb, poor fool, by the arts of
this rogue, who's taken me in with his
tricks to suit his taste! But what does
your friend Philocrates look like?

Arist.

I'll tell you—thin face, sharp nose,
complexion fair, black eyes, hair a
little reddish, waving, and curled.

macilento ore, naso acuto, corpore albo,
oculis nigris,
subrufus aliquantum, crispus, cincinnatus.

Hegio

Convenit.

Tynd.

Ut quidem hercle in medium ego hodie
pessume processerim.
650 vae illis virgis miseris, quae hodie in
tergo morientur meo.

Hegio

Verba mihi data esse video.

Tynd.

Quid cessatis,
compedes,
currere ad me meaque amplecti crura, ut
vos custodiam?

Hegio

Satin med illi hodie scelesti capti ceperunt
dolo?
illic servom se assimilabat, hic sese
autem liberum.
nucleum amisi, retinui pignori putamina.
ita mihi stolido sursum versum os
sublevare offuciis.
his quidem me numquam irridebit.
Colaphe, Cordalio, Corax,
ite istinc, ecferte lora.

III. 5.

Cola.

Hegio

That agrees!

Tynd.

(*aside ruefully*) Gad! Indeed it does—
with my coming into damned
unpleasant prominence this day. Alas
for those poor whips that are doomed
this day to die upon my back!

Hegio

I see I've been duped!

Tynd.

(*aside*) Come on, ye shackles, run up
and embrace my shanks, so that I may
keep you safe!

Hegio

Well, haven't those rascal captives
taken me in with this day's trickery?
The other one pretended he was the
slave, while this fellow here played
the freeman. I've lost the kernel and
kept the shell for surety. That's the
way they've daubed my face up for
me, ass that I am! (*grimly*) This one
shall never have the laugh on me, at
any rate. (*stepping to door and
calling*) Box! Buffum! Bangs! Come!
Out with you! Bring your straps!

Scene 5.

ENTER OVERSEERS, CARRYING HEAVY
RAWHIDES.

Box

Num lignatum
mittimur?

Hegio

Inicite huic manicas¹⁷ mastigiaie.

Tynd.

Quid hoc est negoti? quid ego deliqui?

Hegio

660 Rogas.
sator sartorque scelerum, et messor
maxume?

Tynd.

Non occatorem dicere audebas prius?
nam semper occant prius quam sariunt
rustici.

Hegio

At tu confidenter¹⁸ mihi contra astitit.

Tynd.

Decet innocentem servom atque
innoxium
confidentem esse, suom apud erum
potissimum.

Hegio

Adstringite isti sultis vehementer manus.

Tynd.

Tuos sum, tu has quidem vel praecidi
iube.
sed quid negoti est, quam ob rem
suscenses mihi?

Hegio

670 Quia me meamque rem, quod in te
uno fuit,

(*merrily cracking a whip*) You don't
want us to go and tie up faggots, do
you, sir?

Hegio

Clap handcuffs on this rogue.
(*pointing to Tyndarus*)

Tynd.

(*as they obey*) What does this mean?
What have I done?

Hegio

Done! You sower and hoer of sin—
(*more savagely*) and reaper,
especially!

Tynd.

(*politely*) Couldn't you manage to slip
in "harrower"? Why, farmers always
harrow before they hoe.

Hegio

(*angrily*) Now look at that! the bold
way he stands up to me!

Tynd.

A guiltless, harmless slave ought to
face his own master boldly, his own
master, of all men.

Hegio

(*to overseers*) Fasten his hands, tight,
mind you!

Tynd.

I am yours. Have them cut off, even,
for that matter. But what does this
mean? Why this rage at me?

Hegio

Because as far as in you lay you've
sent me and my hopes to smash,

tuis scelestis falsidicis fallaciis
deartuasti dilaceravisti atque opes
confecisti omnes, res ac rationes meas:
ita mi exemisti Philocratem fallaciis.
illum esse servom credidi, te liberum:
ita vosmet aiebatis itaque nomina
inter vos permutastis.

Tynd.

Fateor, omnia
facta esse ita ut tu dicis, et fallaciis
abiisse eum abs te mea opera atque
astutia;

680 an, obsecro hercle te, id nunc
suscenses mihi?

Hegio

At cum cruciatu maxumo id factumst
tuo.

Tynd.

Dum ne ob male facta, peream, parvi
aestumo.
si ego hic peribo, ast ille ut dixit non
redit,
at erit mi hoc factum mortuo
memorabile,
me meum erum captum ex servitute
atque hostibus
reducem fecisse liberum in patriam ad
patrem,
meumque potius me caput periculo
praeoptavisse, quam is periret, ponere.

Hegio

Facito ergo ut Acherunti clueas gloria.

Tynd.

690 Qui per virtutem, periit, at non interit.

demolished me, with your rascally
deceitful dodges, and spoiled all my
chances, all my prospects and plans.
That's the way you, got Philocrates off
—by swindling me! I supposed he was
the slave and you the freeman; that's
what you said yourselves; that's how
you exchanged names.

Tynd.

(*coolly*) I admit it: it is all as you say
—yes, you were swindled out of him,
and it was my support and my
scheming that did it. But heavens and
earth, that isn't what sets you raging at
me, is it?

Hegio

You shall pay for doing it, though, pay
for it with your own best blood!

Tynd.

(*simply*) Provided it is not for
wrongdoing, let me die—it matters
little. If I myself do die here, and if he
does fail to return, as he said he
would, what I have done, at least, will
be remembered when I am gone—men
will tell how I saved my captured
master from slavery and from his
enemies, restored him, a free man, to
his home and his father, and how I
chose to put my own life in peril rather
than let him die.

Hegio

Well then, you can look in the next
world for that glorious name of yours.

Tynd.

The man that dies in a worthy cause
does not perish utterly.

Hegio

Quando ego te exemplis pessumis
cruciavero
atque ob sutelas tuas te morti misero,
vel te interiisse vel periisse praedicient;
dum pereas, nihil intererit: dicant vivere.

Tynd.

Pol si istuc faxis, haud sine poena
feceris,
si ille hue rebitet, sicut confido affore.

Arist.

Pro di immortales, nunc ego teneo, nunc
scio
quid hoc sit negoti. meus sodalis
Philocrates
in libertate est ad patrem in patria. bene
est,
700 nec quisquam est mihi, aequè melius
cui velim.
sed hoc mihi aegre est, me huic dedisse
operam malam,
qui nunc propter me meaque verba
vinctus est.

Hegio

Votuin te quicquam mi hodie falsum
proloqui?

Tynd.

Votuisti.

Hegio

Cur es ausus mentiri mihi?

Tynd.

Quia vera obsessent illi quoi operam
dabam:
nunc falsa prosunt.

Hegio

After I've tortured you in the most
excruciating ways possible, and sent
you to perdition for the lies you've
patched up, let 'em announce that
you've perished utterly, or that you've
merely died; so long as you're dead,
no matter—they can say you're living,
for all I care.

Tynd.

You do that, sir, and I swear it will
cost you dear, if my master comes
back, as I expect him to do.

Arist.

(*aside*) Great God! Now I see it! Now
I understand what it all means! My
chum Philocrates is free, has gone
home to his father. Good! And not a
friend have I got that I wish better luck
to, either. But I do feel bad about the
cursed way I've treated Tyndarus here!
He's got me and my tongue to thank
for being strapped up at this moment.

Hegio

Didn't I tell you not to deceive me in
the slightest particular?

Tynd.

Yes.

Hegio

Then why did you dare lie to me?

Tynd.

Because the truth would have harmed
the person I was trying to help: as it is,
deceit has served his turn.

Hegio

At tibi oberunt.

Tynd.

Optumest.

at erum servavi, quem servatum gaudeo.
cui me custodem addiderat erus maior
meus.

sed malene id factum arbitrare?

Hegio

Pessume.

Tynd.

710 At ego aio recte. qui abs te sorsum
sentio.

nam cogitato, si quis hoc gnato tuo
tuos servos faxit, qualem haberes
gratiam?

emitteresne necne eum servom manu?
essetne apud te is servos aceptissimus?
responde.

Hegio

Opinor.

Tynd.

Cur ergo iratus

mihi es?

Hegio

Quia illi fuisti quam mihi fidelior.

Tynd.

Quid? tu una nocte postulavisti et die
recens captum hominem, nuperum
novicium,
te perdocere ut melius consulerem tibi,
720 quam illi, quicum una a puero
aetatem exegeram?

Hegio

Hegio

It won't serve yours, however.

Tynd.

Very well, sir. I saved my master, at
any rate, and I'm happy in having
saved the man that my older master
put in my care. Really now, do you
think this was a wrong act?

Hegio

Atrocious!

Tynd.

Well, sir, I differ with you—I say it
was right. Why, just think! if a slave of
yours did the same thing for your own
son, what would be your feeling
toward him? Would you set this slave
free, or not? Wouldn't this slave be
your favourite? Answer me that.

Hegio

(reluctantly) I suppose so.

Tynd.

Why are you angry at me, then?

Hegio

Because you have been more faithful
to him than to me.

Tynd.

What? Did you expect in a single
night and day to teach a man just
recently captured, a slave you had
hardly bought, to consult your
interests more than those of the master
I grew up from boyhood with?

Hegio

Ergo ab eo petito gratiam istam. ducite,
ubi ponderosas crassas capiat compedes.
inde ibis porro in latomias lapidarias.
ibi quom alii octonos lapides effodiunt,
nisi
cotidiano sesquiopus confeceris,
Sescentopago nomen indetur tibi.

Arist.

Per deos atque homines ego te obtestor,
Hegio,
ne tu istunc hominem perdis.

Hegio

Curabitur;
nam noctu nervo vinctus custodibitur,
730 interdus sub terra lapides eximet:
diu ego hunc cruciabo, non uno
absolvam die.

Arist.

Certumne est tibi istuc?

Hegio

Non moriri certius.
abducite istum actutum ad Hippolytum
fabrum,
iubete huic crassas compedes impingier;
inde extra portam ad meum libertum
Cordalum
in lapidinas facite deductus siet:
atque hunc me velle dicite ita curarier,
ne qui deterius huic sit quam cui
pessume est.

Tynd.

Well then, look to him for your thanks
for it. (*to overseers*) Off with him and
have him shackled—heavy ones, solid
ones! (*to Tyndarus*) After that you
shall go straight to the stone quarries.
There, while the rest of them are
digging out their eight blocks a day,
you're to do half as much again, or
you'll be dubbed The Cracks-
collector.

Arist.

Hegio! for God's sake don't let the
man be utterly lost!

Hegio

Lost? We'll see to that! Why, at night
he'll be chained up in a cell and
guarded, and in the daytime he'll be
under ground hewing out stone. It's
agony long drawn out he'll get from
me; I won't end it for him all in one
day.

Arist.

(*distressed*) Is this your fixed
intention, sir?

Hegio

Fixed as death! (*to overseers*) Quick!
March him off to Hippolytus the
blacksmith and have some solid irons
forged on him; then he's to be escorted
outside the city to my freedman
Cordalus and the quarries. Yes, and
tell Cordalus I want it seen to that he
be treated quite as well as the man
that's treated (*ferociously*) worst.

Tynd.

Cur ego te invito me esse salvom
postulem?
740 periculum vitae meae tuo stat periculo.
post mortem in morte nihil est quod
metuam mali.
etsi pervivo usque ad summam aetatem,
tamen
breve spatium est perferendi quae
minitas mihi.
vale atque salve, etsi aliter ut dicam
meres.
tu, Aristophontes, de me ut meruisti, ita
vale;
nam mihi propter te hoc optigit.

Hegio

Abducite.

Tynd.

At unum hoc quaeso, si huc rebitet
Philocrates,
ut mi eius facias conveniundi copiam.

Hegio

Periistis, nisi hunc iam e conspectu
abducitis.

Tynd.

750 Vis haec quidem hercle est, et trahi et
trudi simul.

Hegio

Illic est abductus recta in phylacam, ut
dignus est.
ego illis captivis aliis documentum dabo,
ne tale quisquam facinus incipere audeat.

Why should I ask for mercy when you
refuse it? My life is risked at risk to
you. After death, there is no evil in
death for me to fear. And even if I live
on and on to the very limits of human
life, it's still only for a short time I
shall have to endure what you threaten
me with.

Farewell, sir, and God bless you, no
matter if you do deserve to have me
wish you something else. As for you,
Aristophontes, fare you well—as well
as you deserve of me; for it is all on
account of you that this has happened
to me.

Hegio

(to overseers) Off with him.

Tynd.

But I do ask this one thing of you, sir:
if Philocrates comes back, give me a
chance to meet him.

Hegio

(to overseers) Out of my sight with
him this instant, or I'll murder you!
(they seize Tyndarus and hurry him off
roughly)

Tynd.

(dryly) Well, well! This is positive
violence, being pushed and pulled at
the same time.

[EXEUNT.]

Hegio

That rascal is bound straight for the
prison cell he's entitled to. I'll make an
example of him for the benefit of
those other prisoners, so that none of
them will dare engage in such deviltry.

quod absque hoc esset, qui mihi hoc fecit
palam,
usque offrenatum suis me ductarent
dolis.

nunc certum est nulli posthac quicquam
credere.

satis sum semel deceptus. speravi miser
ex servitute me exemisse filium:

ea spes elapsa est. perdidici unum filium,
760 puerum quadrimum quem mihi
servos surpuit,
neque eum servom umquam repperi
neque filium;

maior potitus hostium est. quod hoc est
scelus?

quasi in orbitatem liberos produxerim.
sequere hac. reducam te ubi fuisti.
neminis

miserere certum est, quia mei miseret
neminem.

Arist.

Exauspicavi ex vinclis. nunc intellego
redauspicandum esse in catenas
denuo.

ACTVS IV

Erg.

Iuppiter supreme, servas me measque
auges opes,
maximas opimitates opiparasque offers
mihi,

If it hadn't been for this fellow here
who disclosed it all, they'd have bitted
me and led me along with their tricks
till the end of time.

Never again do I trust a soul in
anything, that's settled. Once cheated
is enough. (*pauses, then gloomily*) I
hoped, poor fool, that I had ransomed
my son from slavery—a hope that's
slipped away! I lost one son, a four-
year-old boy that a slave kidnapped,
and never a trace of slave or son since.

And my older boy in the hands of
enemies! What curse am I under? As if
I'd begotten children so as to be left
childless! (*to Aristophontes*) This way,
you. (*going toward brother's house*)
Back you go where you were before. I
am determined to pity no one, since no
one pities me.

Arist.

(*wryly*) It seemed a good omen, my
getting out of irons. Now I perceive I
must omen myself back to chains
again.

[EXEUNT.]

ACT IV

(*It is to be assumed that several hours
only have elapsed.*)

ENTER *Ergasilus*, ELATED.

Erg.

Great God on high, thou dost preserve
me and prosper me with fatness!
Boundless abundance, yea, sublime
abundance dost thou bring me! Praise,
profit, pleasure, jollity, festivity,

770 laudem lucrum, ludum iocum,
 festivitatem ferias,
 pompam penum, potationis saturitatem,
 gaudium,
 nec cuiquam homini supplicare¹⁹ nunc
 certum est mihi;
 nam vel prodesse amico possum vel
 inimicum perdere,
 ita hic me amoenitate amoena amoenus
 oneravit dies,
 sine sacris hereditatem sum aptus
 effertissimam.
 nunc ad senem cursum capessam hunc
 Hegionem, cui boni
 tantum affero quantum ipsus a dis optat,
 atque etiam amplius.
 nunc certa res est, eodem pacto ut comici
 servi solent.
 coniciam in collum pallium, primo ex
 med hanc rem ut audiat:
 780 speroque me ob hunc nuntium
 aeternum adepturum cibum.

IV. 2.

Hegio

Quanto in pectore hanc rem meo
 magis volato,
 tanto mi aegritudo auctior est in
 animo.
 ad illum modum sublitum os esse mi
 hodie!
 neque id perspicere quivi.
 quod cum scibitur, tum per urbem
 inridebor.
 cum extemplo ad forum advenero,
 omnes loquentur:

feasting, trains of victuals, eatables,
 drinkables, satiety, joy! Never will I
 toady to human being more, I now
 resolve it. Why, I can bless my friend
 or blast my foe, now that this
 delightful day has loaded me down
 with its delightful delightfulness! I've
 landed a legacy stuffed fit to burst, and
 not a single encumbrance attached!

Now for a race up to old Hegio here.
 I'm bringing him all the happiness he
 craves of Heaven, yes, and more, too.
 I know what I'll do now: like slaves in
 the comedies, I'll bundle my cloak
 round my neck and run, so that I'll be
 the first man he hears this news from;
 and I hope to get food for ever and
 ever for my information.

Scene 2.

ENTER *Hegio*.

Hegio

(soliloquizing moodily) The more I
 think it over, the sourer I feel. The
 idea of their playing upon me in that
 style to-day! And I couldn't see
 through it. When it gets known, I
 shall be the joke of the town.

The moment I appear at the forum
 they'll all be saying, "Here comes
 that smart old fellow that got

"hic ille est senex doctus, quod verba
data sunt."
sed Ergasilus estne hic, procul quem
video?
confecto quidem est pallio. quidnam
acturus?

Erg.

790 Move apud te moram atque,
Ergasile, age hanc rem.
eminor interminorque, ne mi obstiterit
obviam
nisi quis satis diu vixisse sese homo
arbitrabitur.
nam qui obstiterit, ore sistet.

Hegio

Hic homo
pugilatum incipit.

Erg.

Facere certum est. proinde ita omnes itinera
insistant sua,
ne quis in hanc plateam negoti conferat
quicquam sui.
nam meus est ballista pugnus, cubitus
catapultast mihi,
umerus aries, tum genu quemque icero ad
terram dabo,
dentilegos omnes mortales faciam,
quemque offendero.

Hegio

Quae illaec eminentiost nam? nequeo
mirari satis.

Erg.

Faciam ut huius diei locique meique
semper meminerit.²⁰ 800

humbugged." (*observing Ergasilus*)
But isn't that Ergasilus I see over
there? With his cloak all tucked up,
too! Now what in the world is he
going to do? (*steps aside*)

Erg.

(*with burlesque importance and
bustle*) No dawdling now, Ergasilus!
At it, my boy, at it! I give you to wit
by all the law's pains and penalties
that no man stand in my way, unless
he thinks he has lived long enough.
For the man that does stand in my
way shall stand on his head. (*squares
off and delivers lusty blows at
imaginary passers-by*)

Hegio

(*aside*) The fellow is going in for a
boxing match!

Erg.

I'll do it, I'm resolved. So everybody
keep where they belong, and don't
anyone bring his business into this
street! I tell you what, my fist is a
siege-gun, and this forearm is my
catapult, and my shoulder is a
battering ram, yes, and every man I
lay my knee into will bite the earth.
I'll make every man I meet a tooth-
collector.

Hegio

(*aside*) What on earth does all this
bluster mean? Quite unaccountable!

Erg.

I'll make him remember this day and
this place and me for ever.²⁰

Hegio

(802) Quid hic homo tantum incipissit
facere cum tantis minis?

Erg.

Prius edico, ne quis propter culpam
capiatur suam:
continete vos domi, prohibete a vobis vim
meam.

Hegio

Mira edepol sunt, ni hic in ventrem
sumpsit confidentiam.
vae misero illi, cuius cibo iste factust
imperiosior.

Erg.

Tum pistorum scrofipasci, qui alunt
furfuribus suis,
quorum odore praeterire nemo pistrinum
potest:
eorum si quousquam scrofam in publico
conspexero,
810 ex ipsis dominis meis pugnis
exculcabo fures.

Hegio

Basilicas edictiones atque imperiosas
habet:
satur hominem, habet profecto in ventre
confidentiam.

Erg.

Tum piscatores, qui praebent populo
pisces foetidos,
qui advehuntur quadrupedanti crucianti
cantherio,
quorum odos subbasilicanos omnes abigit
in forum,
eis ego ora verberabo surpiculis piscariis,

Hegio

(*aside*) What giant undertaking is the
fellow at, with all this big talk?

Erg.

I give you due notice, that no one
may come to grief through his own
ignorance of the law: stay at home:
keep away from me—I am a violent
man.

Hegio

(*aside*) Bless my soul! I'll be sworn
he's got some assurance put into his
inside. Heaven help the poor wretch
whose larder has set him up so!

Erg.

And as for the millers that keep
sows, and feed waste stuff to their
swine, that raise such a stench
nobody can go by the mill,—if I spy
a sow of any one of 'em on the public
highway, I'll up with my fists and
stamp the stuffing out of those
sows'—owners.

Hegio

(*aside*) Right royal and imperious
pronunciamentos. The man is
gorged: he certainly has got some
assurance stowed away inside.

Erg.

Then the fishmongers that travel
around on a jogging, jolting gelding,
and offer folk stale fish so strong it
drives every last loungeur in the
arcade out into the forum— I'll
whack their faces with their own fish
baskets, just to teach 'em what an
abomination they are to the public
nose.

ut sciant, alieno naso quam exhibeant
molestiam.

tum lanii autem, qui concinnant liberis
orbas oves,
qui locant caedundos agnos et duplam
agninam danunt,
820 qui petroni nomen indunt verveci
sectario,
eum ego si in via petronem publica
conspexero
et petronem et dominum reddam mortales
miserrumos.

Hegio

Eugepae, edictiones aedilicias hic quidem
habet,
mirumque adeost ni hunc fecere sibi
Aetoli agoranomum.

Erg.

Non ego nunc parasitus sum, sed regum
rex regalior,
tantus ventri commeatus meo adest in
portu cibus
sed ego cesso hunc Hegionem onerare
laetitia senem,
quo homine hominum adaeque nemo vivit
fortunatior?

Hegio

Quae illaec est laetitia, quam illic laetus
largitur mihi?

Erg.

830 Heus ubi estis? ecquis hic est? ecquis
hoc aperit ostium?

Hegio

Hic homo ad cenam recipit se ad me.

Yes, and the butchers, too, that
bereave sheep of their little ones, that
engage to sell you lambs fit for
slaughter, and then give you lamb as
old as two lambs, and pass off a
tough old ram as a prime wether—if
I spy that ram on a city thoroughfare,
I'll make ram and owner the saddest
men alive!

Hegio

(*aside*) Splendid! Why, he is issuing
edicts like a Comptroller of the
Victualling: I shouldn't be surprised
if the Aetolians have made him
market inspector.

Erg.

I'm no parasite now, not I! I'm a
precious potent potentate of
potentates, with all that invoice at the
harbour for my belly—food, food!
But I must hurry and load old Hegio
here with ecstasy. There's not a
luckier man alive than he!

Hegio

(*aside*) What ecstasy is it this ecstatic
creature is going to lavish on me?

Erg.

(*pounding on Hegio's door*) Hi!
Where are you? Anybody here?
Anybody going to open this door?

Hegio

(*aside*) The fellow is coming to dine
with me.

Erg.

Aperite hasce
ambas fores
prius quam pultando assulatim foribus
exitium adfero.

Hegio

Perlubet hunc hominem colloqui. Ergasile.

Erg.

Ergasilum qui vocat?

Hegio

Respice.

Erg.

Fortuna quod tibi nec facit nec
faciet, me iubes.
sed quis est?

Hegio

Respice ad me, Hegio sum.

Erg.

Oh mihi,
quantum est hominum optumorum
optume, in tempore advenis.

Hegio

Nescio quem ad portum nactus es ubi
cenes, eo fastidis.

Erg.

Cedo manum.

Hegio

Manum?

Erg.

Manum, inquam, cedo
tuam actutum.

Hegio

Erg.

Open this door—both doors—before
I knock 'em to flinders and finish 'em
for good and all!

Hegio

(*aside*) I should quite enjoy a word
with him. (*aloud*) Ergasilus!

Erg.

(*still pounding*) Who calls Ergasilus?

Hegio

Vouchsafe me a look, sir.

Erg.

(*without turning his head*) Vouchsafe
you a look, eh! That is more than
Good Luck does for you, or ever will
do, either! Who is it, though?

Hegio

Look around this way. It's Hegio.

Erg.

(*rushing up*) Oh! oh! You best of all
the best men that tread the earth, you
come just in time!

Hegio

You have hit upon some one or other
at the harbour to dine with: that's
why you are so haughty.

Erg.

(*rapturously*) Give me your hand!

Hegio

My hand?

Erg.

Your hand, I say—give me your hand
this instant!

Hegio

	Tene.	(<i>doing so</i>) Take it. (<i>Ergasilus shakes it vigorously</i>)
Erg.		Erg.
Gaude.		Rejoice!
Hegio		Hegio
Quid ego gaudeam?		Rejoice—I? What for?
Erg.		Erg.
Quia ego impero, age gaude modo.		Because I bid you to. Come now, rejoice!
Hegio		Hegio
Pol maerores mi antevortunt gaudiis. ²¹ 840		Good Lord, man! grief takes precedence of joy in my case.
Erg.		Erg.
Iam ego ex corpore exigam omnis maculas maerorum tibi. gaude audacter.		I will remove every grief spot from off your person for you this minute. Rejoice, rejoice boldly!
Hegio		Hegio
Gaudeo, etsi nil scio quod gaudeam.		Well, I am rejoicing, although I haven't the least idea why I should.
Erg.		Erg.
Bene facis. iube—		Much obliged! Order—
Hegio		Hegio
Quid iubeam?		(<i>suspiciously</i>) Order what?
Erg.		Erg.
Ignem ingentem fieri.		—a fire to be built, an enormous fire.
Hegio		Hegio
Ignem ingentem?		An enormous fire?
Erg.		Erg.
Ita dico, magnus ut sit.		That's what I say—make it a big one.
Hegio		Hegio
Quid? me, volturi, tuan causa aedis incensurum censes?		(<i>angry</i>) How's that? Do you think I'm going to burn my house down for your benefit, you vulture?

Erg.

Noli irascier.
iuben an non iubes astitui aulas, patinas
elui,
²²laridum atque epulas foveri foculis
ferventibus?
alium pisces praestinatum abire?

Hegio

Hic vigilans
somnia.

Erg.

Alium porcinam atque agninam et pullos
gallinaceos?

Hegio

Scis bene esse, si sit unde.

Erg.

ophthalmiam,
850 ²³ Pernam atque
horaeum, scombrum et trygonum et
cetum, et mollem caseum?

Hegio

Nominandi istorum tibi erit magis quam
edundi copia
his apud me, Ergasile.

Erg.

Mean me causa hoc
censes dicere?

Hegio

Nec nihil hodie nec multo plus tu hic edes,
ne frustra sis.
proin tu tui cottidiani victi ventrem ad me
afferat.

Erg.

Erg.

Calm yourself, sir. Will you order the
pots to be set near the oven, or won't
you—and the platters washed—and
bacon and lovely things to eat to be
warmed up in fire-pans piping hot?
And some one to go and lay in fish?

Hegio

Day dreams, poor fellow!

Erg.

And some one else to get pork and
lamb and spring chicken?

Hegio

You know how to enjoy yourself—
given the wherewithal.

Erg.

And ham and river-lamprey and
pickled fish, mackerel and sting ray
and tunny, and nice soft cheese?

Hegio

You will have more of an
opportunity to mention those viands,
Ergasilus, than to masticate them
here at my house.

Erg.

Do you suppose I'm saying this on
my own account?

Hegio

What you get here to-day will be a
cross between nothing and next to
nothing; make no mistake about that.
So bring me a stomach that is ready
for your ordinary fare.

Erg.

Quin ita faciam. ut tute cupias facere
sumptum, etsi ego vetem.

Hegio

Egone?

Erg.

Tune.

Hegio

Tum tu mi igitur erus es.

Erg.

Immo

benevolens.

vin te faciam fortunatum?

Hegio

Malim quam

miserum quidem.

Erg.

Cedo manum.

Hegio

Em manum.

Erg.

Di te omnes adiuvant.

Hegio

Nil sentio.

Erg.

860 Non enim es in senticeto, eo non
sentis. sed iube
vasa tibi pura apparari ad rem divinam
cito,
atque agnum afferri proprium pinguem.

Hegio

Cur?

Erg.

Why, I'll make you long to squander
money, you yourself, even though I
should forbid it.

Hegio

Me?

Erg.

Yes, sir, you!

Hegio

Then you are my master, I take it.

Erg.

No, no, your whole-souled friend. Do
you want me to make you a fortunate
man?

Hegio

Rather than unfortunate, why, yes.

Erg.

Give me your hand.

Hegio

Here it is. (*Ergasilus again shakes it
fervently*)

Erg.

The gods are with you!

Hegio

I wouldn't know it.

Erg.

You wouldn't? Well, you're out of the
wood; that's why you don't twig it.
But see they get the holy vessels
ready for worship—quick! Yes, and
have a special lamb brought in, a fat
one.

Hegio

Why?

Erg.

sacrufices.

Hegio
Cui deorum?

Erg.
Mi hercle, nam ego nunc tibi
sum summus Iuppiter,
idem ego sum Salus, Fortuna, Lux,
Laetitia, Gaudium.
proin tu deum hunc saturitate facias
tranquillum tibi.

Hegio
Esurire mihi videre.

Erg.
Mi quidem esurio, non
tibi.

Hegio
Tuo arbitrato, facile patior.

Erg.
Credo, consuetu's
puer.

Hegio
Iuppiter te dique perdant.

Erg.
Te hercle—mi
aequom est gratias
agere ob nuntium; tantum ego nunc porto
a portu tibi boni:
nunc tu mihi places.

Hegio
870 Abi, stultu's, sero
post tempus venis.

Erg.

So that you may offer sacrifice.

Hegio
To what deity?

Erg.
To me, by gad! For I'm your Jupiter
Most High now, myself; and
Salvation, Fortune, Light, Gladness,
Joy—they're all this identical I! So
mind you placate this divinity by
stuffing him full.

Hegio
You need food, I fancy.

Erg.
No sir, I need food I fancy, not food
you fancy.

Hegio
(*smiling*) Have it your own way: I'm
perfectly willing to—crawl.

Erg.
Crawl? I believe you: it's a habit you
—fell into—as a child.

Hegio
(*disgusted*) Oh, you be damned, sir!

Erg.
And by Jove, you be—grateful to
me, as you ought, for my news. The
glorious news from the port I'm just
reporting! Now your dinner begins to
tempt me.

Hegio
Be off, you idiot: you're behind time,
you have come too late.

Erg.

Igitur olim si advenissem, magis tu tum
istuc diceres;
nunc hanc laetitiam accipe a me, quam
fero. nam filium
tuom modo in portu Philopoleum vivom,
salvom et sospitem
vidi in publica celoce, ibidemque illum
adulescentulum
Aleum una et tuom Stalagmum servom,
qui aufugit domo,
qui tibi surripuit quadrimum puerum
filiolum tuom.

Hegio

Abi in malam rem, ludis me.

Erg.

Ita me amabit
sancta Saturitas,
Hegio, itaque suo me semper condecoret
cognomine,
ut ego vidi.

Hegio

Meum gnatum?

Erg.

Tuom gnatum et
genium meum.

Hegio

Et captivom illum Alidensem?

Erg.

Μὰ τὸν Ἀπόλλω.

Hegio

880 Et
servolum
meum Stalagmum, meum qui gnatum
surripuit?

Erg.

Well, if I had come before, then
you'd have had more reason to say
that. (*slowly and portentously*) Now,
sir, prepare for the ecstasy of which I
am the vehicle. A few minutes ago at
the harbour your son, your son
Philopolemus, alive, safe and sound,
—I saw him, saw him in a despatch
boat, and along with him that young
Elean and your slave Stalagmus that
stole your little four year old boy.

Hegio

To the devil with you! You're making
fun of me.

Erg.

So help me Holy Stuffing, so may
she grace me with her name for
evermore—I did see them, Hegio!

Hegio

(*sceptically*) My son?

Erg.

Your son and my guardian angel.

Hegio

And that Elean prisoner?

Erg.

Oui, par Hercules!

Hegio

And that miserable slave of mine,
Stalagmus, that kidnapped my son?

Erg.

	<u>Ναὶ τὰν</u>	<i>Oui, par Herculanum!</i>
<u>Κόραν.</u>		
<i>Hegio</i>		<i>Hegio</i>
Iam credo?		I'm to believe that?
<i>Erg.</i>		<i>Erg.</i>
	<u>Ναὶ τὰν Πραινέστην.</u>	<i>Oui, par Pompeii!</i>
<i>Hegio</i>		<i>Hegio</i>
	Venit?	He's come?
<i>Erg.</i>		<i>Erg.</i>
	<u>Ναὶ τὰν</u>	<i>Oui, par Sorrento!</i>
<u>Σιγνίαν.</u>		
<i>Hegio</i>		<i>Hegio</i>
Certon?		You're sure?
<i>Erg.</i>		<i>Erg.</i>
	<u>Ναὶ τὸν Φρουσινῶνα.</u>	<i>Oui, par Amalfi!</i>
<i>Hegio</i>		<i>Hegio</i>
	Vide sis.	Careful now!
<i>Erg.</i>		<i>Erg.</i>
	<u>Ναὶ τὸν</u>	<i>Oui, par Torre dell'Annunziata!</i>
<u>Ἀλάτριον.</u>		
<i>Hegio</i>		<i>Hegio</i>
Quid tu per barbaricas urbes iuras?		What are you swearing by foreign cities for!
<i>Erg.</i>		<i>Erg.</i>
	Quia enim	Well, because they're the same as
item asperae		you said your meals were—perfect
sunt ut tuum victum autumabas esse.		terrors.
<i>Hegio</i>		<i>Hegio</i>
	Vae aetati	Plague take you!
tuae.		
<i>Erg.</i>		<i>Erg.</i>
Quippe quando mihi nil credis, quod ego dico sedulo.		My sentiments exactly, seeing you don't believe a word I tell you in sober earnest. Stalagmus, though,—

sed Stalagmus quoniam erat tunc nationis,
cum hinc abiit?

Hegio

Siculus.

Erg.

At nunc Siculus non est, Boius est,
Boiam terit:
liberorum quaerendorum causa ei, credo,
uxor datast.

Hegio

Dic, bonam fide tu mi istaec verba dixisti?

Erg.

890

Bona.

Hegio

Di immortales, iterum gnatus videor, si
vera autumas.

Erg.

Ain tu? dubium habebis etiam, sancte
quomodo ego iurem tibi?
postremo, Hegio, si parva iuri iurandost
fides,
vise ad portum.

Hegio

Facere certumst. tu intus cura
quod opus est.
sume, posce, prome quid vis. te facio
cellarium.

Erg.

Nam hercle, nisi mantiscinatus probe ero,
fusti pectito.

Hegio

what was his nationality when he
disappeared?

Hegio

Sicilian.

Erg.

But he's no Sicilian now: he's a Gaul
—he's being galled, [G](#) anyhow, by
that thing he's attached to: he's
coupled with the article so as to get
children, I suppose?

Hegio

See here, have you told me all this in
good faith?

Erg.

In good faith.

Hegio

Great heavens! I feel like a new man,
if what you say is true.

Erg.

Eh? How's that? You'll still doubt me
when I'd give you my sacred word on
it? Very well then, Hegio, if my
solemn oath is insufficient for you,
go down to the harbour and see for
yourself.

Hegio

(*excited*) Precisely what I will do.
You go inside and attend to what's
needed. Take anything you want, ask
for it, get it from the store-room. I
make you butler.

Erg.

(*wild with joy*) Now by Jupiter, if I
don't do some handsome catering,
comb me down with a club!

Hegio

Aeternum tibi dapinabo victum, si vera
autumas.

Erg.

Unde id?

Hegio

A me meoque gnato.

Erg.

Sponden tu istud?

Hegio

Spondeo.

Erg.

At ego tuom tibi advenisse filium
respondeo.

Hegio

Cura quam optume potes.

I'll dinner you till doomsday, if it's
true.

Erg.

And who's to pay?

Hegio

I and my son.

Erg.

I have your word on that?

Hegio

My word.

Erg.

And for my part, my word to you is
—your son has arrived.

Hegio

(*making off toward harbour*) Attend
to everything the very best you can.

IV. 3.

Erg.

900 Bene ambula et

redambula.

illic hinc abiit, mihi rem summam
credidit cibariam.

di immortales, iam ut ego collos
praetruncabo tegoribus,
quanta pernis pestis veniet, quanta labes
larido,
quanta sumini absumedo, quanta callo
calamitas,
quanta laniis lassitudo, quanta
porcinariis.

nam si alia memorem, quae ad ventris
victum conducunt, morast.

nunc ibo, ut pro praefectura mea ius
dicam larido,

Scene 3.

Erg.

A pleasant walk and—backwalk—to
you.

[*EXIT Hegio.*] He's gone! And the
whole blessed commissariat left to
me! Ye immortal gods! how I'll knock
necks off backs now! Ah, ham's case is
hopeless, and bacon's in a bad, bad
way! And sow's udder—done for
utterly! Oh, how pork rind will go to
pot! Butchers and pig-dealers—won't I
bustle 'em!

Why, if I should mention all the other
things that go to bolster up a belly, it
would be a waste of time. I must off
this minute to perform my official
duties and pass judgment on bacon

et quae pendent indemnatae pernae, eis
auxilium ut feram.

IV. 4.

Puer

Diespiter te dique, Ergasile, perdant et
ventrem tuom,
910 parasitosque omnis, et qui posthac
cenam parasitis dabit.
clades, calamitasque, intemperies modo
in nostram advenit domum.
quasi lupo esuriens ille metui ne in me
faceret impetum.

ubi²⁴ voltus esurientis vidi, eius
extimescebam impetum
nimisque hercle ego illum male
formidabam. ita frendebat dentibus.
adveniens deturbavit totum cum carne
carnarium:
arripuit gladium, praetruncavit tribus
tegoribus glandia;
aulas calicesque omnes confregit, nisi
quae modiales erant.
cocus percontabatur, possentne seriae
fervescere.
cellas refregit omnis intus reclusitque
armarium.
adservate istunc, sultis, servi. ego ibo, ut
conveniam senem.
920 dicam ut sibi penum alium adornet,
siquidem sese uti volet;
nam hic quidem, ut adornat, aut iam nihil
est aut iam nihil erit.

and help out hams that are still untried
and in suspense.

[EXIT INTO HOUSE HURRIEDLY: UPROAR
WITHIN.]

Scene 4.

ENTER *Page*, ANGRY AND EXCITED, FROM
Hegio's HOUSE.

Page

(*shaking his fist at door*) May all the
powers of heaven destroy you,
Ergasilus, and that belly of yours and
all parasites and anyone that gives a
parasite a meal hereafter! Disaster,
devastation, a tornado, has just fallen
on our house. I was afraid he'd jump at
my throat like a ravening wolf!

As soon as I saw that ravenous look of
his I almost died for fear he'd make a
rush at me—Lord, how he did scare
me, how he kept grinding his teeth! In
he came and tugged down the meat,
rack and all—grabbed a knife and
lopped the choice bits off three necks
of pork—and smashed every pot and
tureen that didn't hold a peck or more!

Kept asking the cook if he couldn't
possibly use the big pickle vats to boil
things in! Broke into all the cupboards
and raided the pantry! (*shouting to
those within*) Hi, boys! watch him,
will you! I'm going to find the old
man. I'll tell him, so that he can get in
more victuals for himself, that is if he
wants any for his own use: for to judge
from the way this fellow is getting 'em
out here, there's nothing left now, or

won't be long.
[EXIT.]

ACTVS V

Hegio

Iovi disque ago gratias merito
magnas,
quom reducem tuo te patri
reddiderunt
quomque ex miseriis plurimis me
exemerunt,
quae adhuc te carens dum hic²⁵ fui
sustentabam,
quomque hunc conspikor in potestate
nostra,
quomque huius reperta est fides
firma nobis.

Philop.

Satis iam dolui ex animo, et cura me satis et
lacrumis maceravi,
satis iam audiui tuas aerumnas, ad portum
mihi quas memorasti.
hoc agamus.

Philocr.

930 Quid nunc, quoniam tecum
servavi fidem
tibi hunc reducem in libertatem feci?

Hegio

Fecisti ut tibi,

ACT V

(Half an hour has elapsed.)

ENTER *Hegio, Philopolemus,*
Philocrates, AND Stalagmus.

Hegio

(to Philopolemus) I thank God
with all my heart, as I ought, for
bringing you back to your father,
and for relieving me of the
dreadful anguish I've been
enduring as day after day went by,
and I still here without you; yes,
and for letting me see this rascal
(indicating Stalagmus) in my
power, and for this gentleman's
(indicating Philocrates) proving
himself a man of honour in
standing by his promise to us.

Philop.

(seeing Philocrates is getting impatient) I've had quite enough
bitter suffering, and enough of
wearing myself out with anxiety
and weeping, too, and I've heard
quite enough of your distress of
which you told me at the harbour,
father! So now to the main point.
(turns to Philocrates)

Philocr.

(to Hegio) What of me, sir, now
that I have kept faith with you and
secured the liberty of your son
here?

Hegio

After the way you have acted,
Philocrates, I'm entirely unable to

Philocrates, numquam referre gratiam
possim satis,
proinde ut tu promeritu's de me et filio.

Philop.

Immo potes,
pater, et poteris et ego potero, et di eam
potestatem dabunt
ut beneficium bene merenti nostro merito
muneres;
sicut tu huic²⁶ potes, pater mi, facere merito
maxume.

Hegio

Quid opust verbis? lingua nullast qua negem
quidquid roges.

Philocr.

Postulo abs te, ut mi illum reddas servom,
quem hic reliqueram
pignus pro me, qui mihi melior quam sibi
semper fuit,
940 pro bene factis eius ut ei pretium possim
reddere.

Hegio

Quod bene fecisti referetur gratia id quod
postulas;
et id et aliud, quod me orabis, impetrabis.
atque te
nolim suscensere quod ego iratus ei feci
male.

Philocr.

Quid fecisti?

Hegio

In lapidinas compeditum
condidi,
ubi rescivi mihi data esse verba.

show gratitude enough for your
treatment of me and my son.

Philop.

No, no, you are able, father, yes,
and always will be able, and so
shall I be, and Heaven will give
you the ability to do a deserved
kindness to a man that has been so
kind to us. It's just as with this
slave here, (*pointing to Stalagmus*)
father dear; you're able to give him
his full deserts.

Hegio

(*to Philocrates*) It's plain enough,
sir,—I have no tongue with which
to refuse a request of yours.

Philocr.

What I ask you to do is to give me
back the slave I left here as
security for myself—he was
always ready to sacrifice himself
for me!—so that I can reward him
for his kindnesses.

Hegio

You have been kind to us, sir, and I
shall be glad to do as you ask; both
that request, and any other, will be
granted. (*embarrassed*) And—and
I trust you won't be incensed at me
for getting angry and treating him
badly.

Philocr.

(*anxiously*) What did you do?

Hegio

I had him fettered and put down in
the stone quarries when I found out
I had been imposed upon.

Philocr.

Vae misero mihi,
propter meum caput labores homini evenisse
optumo.

Hegio

At ob eam rem mihi libellam pro eo argenti
ne duis.
gratiis a me, ut sit liber, ducito.

Philocr.

Edepol,

Hegio.
facis benigne. sed quaeso, hominem ut
iubeas arcessi.

Hegio

Licet.
950 ubi estis vos? ite actutum Tyndarum huc
arcessite,
vos ite intro. interibi ego ex hac statua
verberea volo
erogitare, meo minore quid sit factum filio.
vos lavate interibi.

Philop.

Sequere hac.
Philocrates, me intro.

Philocr.

Sequor.

Philocr.

God forgive me! To think of the
splendid fellow suffering so, and
all for my sake!

Hegio

Well, sir, this being so, you needn't
give me a single farthing for him:
take him from me gratis—he is a
free man.

Philocr.

Well, well, Hegio, many thanks!
But have him sent for, I beg you.

Hegio

By all means (*calling to slaves in
house*) Where are you? [ENTER
OVERSEERS.] Quick! go bring
Tyndarus here. [EXEUNT OVERSEERS]
(*to Philopolemus and Philocrates*)
As for you lads, step inside.
Meanwhile I want to inquire of this
whipping post here (*pointing to
Stalagmus*) what was done with
my younger son. You can take a
bath meanwhile.

Philop.

Come along in with me,
Philocrates.

Philocr.

Certainly.
[EXEUNT.]

V. 2.

Hegio

Age tu illuc procede. bone vir, lepidum
mancupium meum.

Scene 2.

Hegio

(*to Stalagmus*) Come now, you! Over
there with you, (*pointing*) my good sir,

Stal.

Quid me oportet facere, ubi tu talis vir
falsum autumas?
fui ego bellus, lepidus. bonus vir
numquam, neque frugi bonae,
neque ero umquam, ne erres: spem ponas
me bonae frugi fore.

Hegio

Propemodum ubi loci fortunae tuae sint
facile intellegis.
si eris verax, tua ex re, facies ex mala
meliusculam.
960 recte et vera loquere, sed neque vere
neque tu recte adhuc
fecisti umquam.

Stal.

Quod ego fatear, credin
pudeat cum autumes?

Hegio

At ego faciam ut pudeat, nam in ruborem
te totum dabo.

Stal.

Eia, credo ego imperito plagas minitaris
mihi.
tandem ista aufer ac dic quid fers, ut
feras hinc quod petis.

Hegio

Satis facundu's. sed iam fieri dicta
compendi volo.

Stal.

my charming piece of property.

Stal.

(*sullenly*) What can you look for from
me, when a fine gentleman like you
tells lies? I've had my day as a dandy,
a charmer; a good sir, or good for
anything, I never was, and I never will
be, make no mistake, don't you build
up hopes I will be good for anything.

Hegio

You have no difficulty in appreciating
your position pretty fairly well. Now
be truthful, and you'll be acting to
your own advantage and make a bad
prospect somewhat better. Out with
your story, make it straightforward and
honest—virtues you have never
displayed hitherto, however.

Stal.

When I'm ready to admit a thing
myself d'ye think I should be ashamed
of it just because you say it's so?

Hegio

I'll make you ashamed, though:
(*savagely*) I tell you what, I'll make
one big blush of you.

Stal.

(*ironically*) La! La! I'm promised a
whipping, it seems, and I such a
novice at it—oh, yes I am! Look here,
get done with that talk and say what
you've got to propose, so as to get
what you're after.

Hegio

Quite a gift of tongue, sir! But oblige
me by saving some of it for the
moment.

Stal.

Ut vis fiat.

Hegio

Bene morigerus fuit puer,
nunc non decet.
hoc agamus. iam animum advorte ac
mihi quae dicam edissere.²⁷ (967)

Stal.

(969) Nugae istaec sunt. non me censes
scire quid dignus siem?

Hegio

970 At ea subterfugere potis es pauca, si
non omnia.

Stal.

Pauca effugiam, scio; nam multa
evenient, et merito meo,
quia et fugi et tibi surripui filium et eum
vendidi.

Hegio

Cui homini?

Stal.

Theodoromedi in Alide
Polyplusio,
sex minis.

Hegio

Pro di immortales, is quidem
huius est pater Philocrati.

Stal.

Quin melius novi quam tu et
vidi saepius.

Hegio

Serva, Iuppiter supreme, et me et meum
gnatum mihi.
Philocrates, per tuom te genium obsecro,
exi, te volo.

Anything you like.

Hegio

(*half aside*) That compliance he
showed as a boy hardly becomes him
at present. (*aloud*) To business! Now
then, pay attention and answer me
fully.

Stal.

Rot! Don't you suppose I know what I
deserve?

Hegio

Well, you have a chance to escape a
little of it, if not all.

Stal.

Little enough I'll escape, I know that;
for there'll be plenty coming, and it
serves me right, seeing I ran away and
kidnapped your son and sold him.

Hegio

To whom?

Stal.

(*drawling*) Theodoromedes
Goldfields, in Elis, for twenty-four
pounds.

Hegio

God bless my soul! Why, he is the
father of Philocrates here!

Stal.

Well, I know him better than you, and
I've seen him oftener.

Hegio

God Almighty, save me and save my
boy for me! (*running to door and
shouting*) Philocrates! Here, here,
come, on your life! I want you!

V. 3.

Philocr.

Hegio, assum. si quid me vis, impera.

Hegio

Hic gnatum
meum
tuo patri ait se vendidisse sex minis in
Alide.

Philocr.

Quam diu id factum est?

Stal.

980 His annus incipit
vicensimus.

Philocr.

Falsa memorat.

Stal.

Aut ego aut tu. nam tibi
quadrimulum
tuos pater peculiarem parvolo puero
dedit.

Philocr.

Quid erat ei nomen? si vera dicis,
memoradum mihi.

Stal.

Paegnium vocitatust, post vos indidistis
Tyndaro.

Philocr.

Cur ego te non novi?

Stal.

Quia mos est oblivisci
hominibus

Scene 3.

[ENTER *Philocrates*.]

Philocr.

Here I am, Hegio. If I can be of any
service, command me.

Hegio

(*beside himself*) This fellow says my
son—he sold him to your father—for
twenty-four pounds—in Elis!

Philocr.

How long ago was this?

Stal.

Going on for twenty years.

Philocr.

He's lying.

Stal.

(*indifferent*) One of us is. As a matter
of fact, your father gave you a little
four year old boy for your own, when
you were nothing but a youngster
yourself.

Philocr.

(*interested*) What was his name? If
your story is true, come, tell me that.

Stal.

Styled Pettie, he was: later on you
folks called him Tyndarus.

Philocr.

How is it I don't know you?

Stal.

Because it's the regular thing to forget
a fellow and cut him, in case his good
will can't help you at all.

neque novisse cuius nihili sit faciunda
gratia.

Philocr.

Dic mihi, isne istic fuit, quem vendidisti
meo patri,
qui mihi peculiaris datus est?

Stal.

Huius filius.

Hegio

Vivitne is homo?

Stal.

Argentum accepi, nil
curavi ceterum.

Hegio

Quid tu ais?

Philocr.

990 Quin istic ipsust
Tyndarus tuos filius,
ut quidem hic argumenta loquitur. nam is
mecum a puero puer
bene pudiceque educatust usque ad
adulescentiam.

Hegio

Et miser sum et fortunatus, si vos vera
dicitis;
eo miser sum quia male illi feci, si
gnatust meus.
eheu, quom ego plus minusve feci quam
me aequom fuit.
quod male feci crucior; modo si infectum
fieri possiet.
sed eccum incedit huc ornatus haud ex
suis virtutibus.

Philocr.

Tell me, was that boy you sold my
father the same one that was given me
for my own?

Stal.

(*with a nod in Hegio's direction*) His
son.

Hegio

(*eagerly*) Is he alive, this—man?

Stal.

I got the money: that's all I bothered
about.

Hegio

(*to Philocrates*) What do you say?

Philocr.

Why, it's Tyndarus himself that is your
son, at least according to this fellow's
evidence. For Tyndarus has been
brought up with me from the time we
were boys, and brought up in good
honest fashion.

Hegio

I feel miserable and happy both, if
what you two say is true! Miserable at
having been so hard on him, if he is
my own boy! Dear, dear! how much
more I've done than I ought, or how
much less! It's torment, to think of the
horrible thing I've done—oh, if it
could only be undone! (*looking down
street*) Look, though,—there he
comes! To be decked out like that, the
noble fellow!

V. 4.

Scene 4.

Tynd.

Vidi ego multa saepe picta, quae
Acherunti fierent
cruciamenta, verum enim vero nulla
adaeque est Acheruns
1000 atque ubi ego fui, in lapicidinis. illic
ibi demumst locus,
ubi labore lassitudo est exigunda ex
corpore.

nam ubi illo adveni, quasi patricus pueris
aut monerulae.
aut anites aut coturnices dantur, quicum
lusitent
itidem mi haec advenienti upupa, qui me
delectem, datast
sed erus eccum ante ostium, et erus alter
eccum ex Alide
rediit.

Hegio

Salve, exoptate gnate mi.

Tynd.

Hem, quid
gnate mi?
attat. scio cur te patrem adsimules esse et
me filium:
quia mi item ut parentes lucis das tuendi
copiam.

Philocr.

Salve, Tyndare.

Tynd.

Et tu, quoniam causa hanc
aerumnam exigo.

ENTER *Tyndarus* ESCORTED BY
OVERSEERS. HE IS HEAVILY IRONED AND
CARRIES A CROWBAR.

Tynd.

(*dryly*) I have seen a good many
pictures whose subject was torture in
Hell: but upon my soul, there is no
hell that can match those stone
quarries where I've been. That place
down there is certainly the one where
a weary man can be dead sure of
working off his tired feeling.

Why, when I got there it was just like
your young scions of the nobility
being given daws or ducks or quails
for playfellows: my own case exactly
—the moment I arrived they gave me
this crow to have a lark with. (*looking
toward Hegio's house*) But there's my
master in front of the door—and, yes,
my other master back from Elis!

Hegio

Oh, how are you, my own longed-for
son?

Tynd.

Eh? "My son?" How's that? (*pauses,
then with a weary laugh*) Ah, yes, yes,
I see the point of your father and son
chaff: just as parents do, you give me a
chance to behold the light of day.

Philocr.

God bless you, Tyndarus!

Tynd.

And you, sir, for whose sake I'm
undergoing this confounded
experience.

Philocr.

1010 At nunc liber in divitias faxo venies.
nam tibi
pater hic est; hic servos, qui te huic hinc
quadrimum surpuit.
vendidit patri meo te sex minis, is te mihi
parvolum peculiarem parvolo puero
dedit:
illic indicium fecit; nam hunc ex Alide
huc reduximus.

Tynd.

Quid huius filium?

Philocr.

(1015) Intus eccum
fratrem germanum tuom.^{[28](#)}

Tynd.

(1023) Nunc edepol demum in memoriam
regredior, audisse me
quasi per nebulam, Hegionem meum
patrem vocarier.

Hegio

Is ego sum.

Philocr.

Compedibus quaeso ut tibi
sit levior filius
atque huic gravior servos.

Hegio

Certum est principio id
praevoortier.
eamus intro, ut arcessatur faber, ut istas
compedes
tibi adimam, huic dem.

Philocr.

But now you shall be a free man,
Tyndarus, and a rich one, I promise
you. For here is (*indicating Hegio*)
your father; this slave (*indicating*
Stalagmus) stole you away from him
here when you were four years old and
sold you to my father for twenty-four
pounds. And when we were both small
boys, father gave you to me for my
own. That fellow there has proved it
all; you see we brought him back here
from Elis.

Tynd.

(*dazed*) What about his son?

Philocr.

Look—inside there—your own
brother!^{[28](#)}

Tynd.

Great heavens! When I think back I do
now at last remember hearing—in a
cloudy sort of way—my father called
Hegio!

Hegio

(*embracing him*) I am that Hegio!

Philocr.

(*to Hegio, pointing to the shackles on*
Tyndarus). Those irons, sir,—for
mercy's sake get yourself a lighter son,
and him a heavier slave. (*indicating*
Stalagmus)

Hegio

Yes, yes, I must see to that first of all.
Let's go inside and have a blacksmith
sent for, so that I may get those irons
off of you and make this fellow

Stal.

Quoi peculi nihil est,
recte feceris.

CATERVA

Spectatores, ad pudicos mores facta haec
fabula est,
1030 neque in hac subigitationes sunt
neque ulla amatio
nec pueri suppositio nec argenti
circumductio,
neque ubi amans adulescens scortum
liberet clam suom patrem.
huius modi paucas poetae reperiunt
comoedias,
ubi boni meliores fiant. nunc vos, si
vobis placet
et si placuimus neque odio fuimus,
signum hoc mittite:
qui pudicitiae esse voltis praemium,
plausum date.

(turning to Stalagmus) a present of
them.

Stal.

Thanks awfully—seeing I haven't a
thing I can call my own.

[EXEUNT OMNES.]

EPILOGUE

SPOKEN BY THE COMPANY.

Spectators, this play was composed
with due regard to the proprieties: here
you have no vicious intrigues, no love
affair, no supposititious child, no
getting money on false pretences, no
young spark setting a wench free
without his father's knowledge.

Dramatists find few plays such as this
which make good men better. Now, if
you so please, and if we have pleased
you and have not been boring,
intimate as much: you who wish virtue
to be rewarded, give us your applause.

-

1. Corrupt (Leo): *vincti quia astant*
Fleckeisen.

2. Leo notes lacuna here: (*cette*), *iam*
hoc tenetis Schoell.

3. *vel* precedes in MSS: Leo brackets.

4. Leo notes lacuna here: *cupio (fieri)*
Schoell.

A. Implying that he had not tried to
save money to buy his liberty.

B. Here, as in the lines 880-883, the
translator craves pardon for distorting
the ages and spoiling the climes in his
efforts to secure something of the
effect of the original puns.

C. A market district in Rome.

[5.](#) Leo's correction of *multa miraculis* of the MSS.

[6.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *ea* MSS: *consili* Schoell.

[7.](#) Leo brackets the following v., 237:
quod tibi suadeam, suadeam meo patri.

[8.](#) Leo notes lacuna here: *huius (ille)* Camerarius.

[9.](#) Leo brackets the following v., 280:
Hegio

*Tum igitur ei cum in Aleis tanta gratia
est, ut praedicas.*

[10.](#) Leo brackets the following v., 288:
*nam ille quidem Theodoromedes fuit
germano nomine.*

[11.](#) Leo brackets the following v., 324:
Hegio

*Ego virtute deum et maiorum nostrum
dives sum satis.*

[12.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *quin te gratiis*
MSS: *gratiis quin te* Schoell.

[13.](#) Leo brackets the following v., 438:
*scito te hinc minis viginti aestumatum
mittier.*

[14.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *exitium* Pontanus:
exilium MSS.

[15.](#) Leo brackets the following v., 521:
*nec sycophantiis nec fucis ullum
mantellum obviam est.*

[16.](#) Corrupt (Leo): *qui venit modo
intro* MSS: *modo qui venit intro*
Lindsay.

[17.](#) Leo notes lacuna here: *manicas*
(*maxumas*) Spengel.

[18.](#) Leo notes lacuna here: *ut (etiam)*
Schoell.

[D.](#) Epilepsy.

[E.](#) Madmen, celebrated in Greek
mythology. Alcumeus = Alcmaeon.

[F.](#) Another madman of Greek
mythology.

[G.](#) Boia means a woman of the Boii,
also a malefactor's collar.

19. Leo notes lacuna here: *mihi (quod domist)* Schoell.

20. Leo brackets the following v., 801:
*Qui mihi in cursu opstiterit, faxo vitae is
extemplo opstiterit suae.*

21. *Noli irascier* follows in MSS: Leo brackets.

22. Corrupt (Leo): *laridum ac pernas* Schoell.

23. Corrupt (Leo): *pern[ul]am* Geppert.

24. *voltus esurientis (vidi, eius extimescebam)* Leo: A reading doubtful: other MSS omit the line.

25. Corrupt (Leo): *te carens dum hic*
P: *carens dum huc* A.

26. *tu huic* MSS: *nunc* Leo.

27. Leo brackets the following v., 968:
*si eris verax, ex tuis rebus feceris
meliusculas.*

28. Leo brackets the following v.,
1016-1022:

Tynd.

*Quid tu ais? adduatin illum huius
captivom filium?*

Philocr.

Quin, inquam, intus hic est.

Tynd.

*Fecisti edepol et recte
et bene.*

Philocr.

*Nunc tibi pater hic est. hic fur est tuos,
qui parvom hinc te abstulit.*

20.

The man that stands in my path shall
forthwith stand in the way of his own
existence.

28.

Tynd.

What do you say? Did you bring this
gentleman's captive son?

Philocr.

Yes, yes, he's inside, I tell you.

Tynd.

By heaven, sir, you have acted fairly
and honourably.

Philocr.

Now here is your father: and here is
the thief who stole you away from
here when you were small.

Tynd.

*At ego hunc grandis grandem natu ob
furtum ad carnificem dabo.*

Philocr.

Meritus est.

Tynd.

*1020 Ergo edepol merito
meritam mercedem dabo.
sed tu dic oro. pater meus tune es?*

Hegio.

*Ego sum,
gnate mi.*

Tynd.

*Nunc demum in memoriam redeo, cum
mecum recogito.*

Tynd.

But now that we're both big, I'll hand
him over to the executioner for that
theft.

Philocr.

He deserves it.

Tynd.

Well then, I'll give him his deserved
deserts deservedly, by gad! But you,
sir, speak I beseech you. Are you my
father?

Hegio

I am, my dear lad.

Tynd.

Now at last I remember—when I think
it over.

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